A Digital Data Story

A GLORIOUS MYSTERY: ROSARIES AND ROBBERY

OPEN CONTEXT
THE ALEXANDRIA ARCHIVE INSTITUTE

Exercise Description and Aims

The Digital Data Stories Project promotes an increased focus in archaeological education on digital data literacy. Through the use of open data sets and articles as well as active learning strategies, these exercises teach the principles of digital data literacy alongside methods in archaeological analysis. These practicums illustrate the confluence of science and humanities-based investigations in collective data about the past.

This approach promotes multiple levels of engagement with archaeological data sets, linking data-driven interactions with the key analytical and interpretive steps used to ethically analyze and present archaeological data.

In this Digital Data Story, participants will learn to:

- Define an archaeological stakeholder
- Determine the motivations of archaeological stakeholders
- Locate sources of open archaeological data
- Create a data-driven narrative through interacting with others
- Evaluate their own and others' portrayals of stakeholders through discussion

additional texts

Milan, Christopher (2018) "Teacher as Game Master: Using Role Playing Games (RPGs) to Teach Archaeology". *DePaul Department of Anthropology Blog* **https://web.archive.org/web/20220608222902/https://dpuanthropology.wordpress.com/2018/03/02/teacher-as-game-master-using-role-playing-games-rpgs-to-teach-archaeology/**

Dawson, Tom, Joanna Hambly, Alice Kelley, William Lees, and Sarah Miller (2020) "Coastal heritage, global climate change, public engagement, and citizen science". *PNAS* 117(15) : 8280–8286. **https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.1912246117**

the data set

This **Digital Data Story** uses the ***Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data*** project, available at Open Context as an introduction to Spanish mission archaeology in Florida. Each character also includes specific data sets or readings for participants to find out more about who they will portray. These data sets and readings may be used for many other purposes relating to the study of archaeological stakeholders, archaeology in Florida broadly, and salvage archaeology due to climate change.

The data for the ***Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data*** project were collected and analyzed by Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle in an initiative to link zooarchaeological data on Open Context with **VertNet**, a collaborative biodiversity project.

assessment and scaffolding options

For those who require (or desire) a more challenging data exercise, tutorials offered at **GLAM Workbench**, Part One of the Digital Data Story ***Cow-culating Your Data in Spreadsheets and R***, or Part Five of the Digital Data Story ***Of Mycenaean Men*** can be utilized as scaffolding to explore the associated data set or those associated with specific characters.

For those who require (or desire) more support, splitting into pairs to research their stakeholders for the **Digital Data Story** offers the opportunity to work together and discuss their findings.

As this **Digital Data Story** relies innately on personalization, the end results will vary. One potential assessment option is to ask students to reflect on the outcome of their playthrough of *A Glorious Mystery* and why they picked their culprit. Another option is to ask students to evaluate one another's *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* to explore what kind of clues their colleagues noted to understand each others' verdicts and to ensure the practice of observation-based note taking.

Technical Requirements

Participants should have access to a computer with browser-based internet access (to explore the resources for their stakeholder), note-taking tools (to aid their research), and access to a PDF reader (for reading their parts for the Digital Data Story before gameplay). If playing online, participants should also have access to a webcam and microphone, stable internet connection, and location where they feel comfortable role-playing. If playing in-person, participants should have access to their notes and their character guides preferably in a physical format.

Duty of Care

Because of the personal nature of role-play in the game, it is important to ensure a safe and emotionally secure environment during play and during any debrief, group sharing, or discussion. Not all students are comfortable sharing their choices, creative endeavors and influences, and facilitators should be mindful of the emotional state and safety of students. Being aware of how students are responding to feedback is key to maintaining the duty of care inherent as an educator. Ideas for how to do this are included within the Digital Data Story in the section "Round Zero discussion and duty of care" in the Host Guide and the discussion guide provides options for reflection in other formats.

Duration

The Digital Data Story varies in duration. Some participants may choose to complete their research within a compressed window, while others may embrace the creativity inherent in role-play and take longer to cultivate their character. Remind students to save their research and tutorial work regularly so can access all of their preparatory materials on the day of play. A single play-through of *A Glorious Mystery* can take between one and three hours, depending on the amount of improvisation participants are comfortable with and the amount of time they had to prepare their character. The game should be completed within one session. Post-game discussion and reflection will vary by participants and can be combined with or separate from game play.

get in touch by contacting the team

If you or your students have questions, comments, or concerns, please get in touch. We love feedback, especially from educators!

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Host Guide Overview

1. Introduction
2. Cultivating data literacy through role-play
3. Hosting essentials
4. How to play
5. Concluding the game
6. References and further reading
7. Credits
8. Acknowledgments

Estimated time to read this guide: 15 Minutes

Estimated play time: 1 - 3 hours depending on group size

Introduction

Welcome to the Digital Data Stories of the Alexandria Archive Institute and Open Context! This guide includes everything that you'll need to use *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery* — an interactive archaeological mystery game — to facilitate an authentic learning experience that explores stakeholders in archaeology and their relationship to archaeological data through role-play. Or, have some fun solving the mystery of the missing rosary alongside others interested in archaeology.

Part One, aka this guide, introduces how *A Glorious Mystery* cultivates data literacy, explains the essentials of leading the game (such as how to cast stakeholders) as well as how to play through each round and conclude the session. We encourage those who take on the role of leading the game to read through this entire guide in preparation. Once they have done so, they may decide what setting (such as whether to play in-person, online, or hybrid) or format (such as fully scripted or primarily improvised) best fits the desired learning outcomes, needs, and hosting requirements of their community.

For groups interested in cultivating their data literacy skills beyond the game, Part Two: The discussion guide explains how facilitators and players can engage more deeply with the material through questions tailored to groups with different levels of familiarity with archaeology. While the focus of that guide is on synchronous group discussion, those questions may also be reused for asynchronous discussion through message boards or adapted into response questions where participants submit their individual reflections in text, audio, video, or through another medium.

RELEASE DATE: 08/2025
VERSION: 1.0
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Hosts, facilitators, or whoever plans to lead and assign characters will find the character scripts for each player, including the playable host character Ellis Thyx, in this folder or included after Part Two in the single-PDF version of the game.

Each script, individually labeled as a Part Three for the game, comes with a character-specific summary introducing that character's personal motivations as well as suggested background materials that players can use to explore and prepare for the game when using this Digital Data Story in a formal setting. If using these scripts in an informal setting, or when players do not have time to prepare, the scripts can be a source for further information about each hypothetical stakeholder for players to use after the conclusion of gameplay.

The mystery

The purpose of this Digital Data Story is to solve the following mystery while highlighting how the process of doing so walks the players through the five components of data literacy, explained in more detail in the next section.

> *Beadbeachville, a seaside town in Florida, is excited for the excavation season! Well, at least those visiting, watching, and working at the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission Site *are excited. First identified in the late 1970s, a new team of archaeologists has returned to the site for the last few years to uncover, recover, and preserve what remains. They've been excitedly excavating because while this Spanish colonial period Catholic religious outpost — also known as a mission — sat far from the beach when it was active, climate change related events – like more intense and regular hurricanes, sea-level rise, and soil erosion – have moved it to the water's edge. Because of that, salvage archaeology is an urgent part of the project. Beyond those threats to site integrity though, the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission *is also a fantastic blend of cultural materials from all over the region and the excavation has run smoothly for years.*
>
> *Until now. Typically, the excavation uncovered belongings (often discussed as "artifacts") that fascinated archaeologists and local history buffs, but bored tourists. This season though, the team recovered an almost completely intact set of Catholic prayer beads. Called a rosary and used for both personal and group religious practice, this artifact was strung with beads made using an Indigenous style! The discovery of the piece, at a site that also included evidence for captive African and Indigenous labor, provided an intriguing example of creolization for the region. However, before a specialist could be called in to examine the rosary and its beads in more detail, a local TV and radio show host, who happened to be at the site during the discovery, broke the news to the whole county. Tourism doubled overnight and now, to everyone's dismay, that find has disappeared! How could this happen? Did a tourist think the storage facility was a gift shop? Was it sequestered away for extra safe keeping? Did someone simply make a data entry error? Or did* You *wander away with it?*

An Archaeological Investigator, Ellis Thyx, has been sent in to help facilitate solving the mystery. This role can be played by the host or represented through digital recordings linked in that character's script. As a reminder, the town, archaeological site, mystery, and the title of "archaeological investigator" though based on places in Gulf Coast Florida, similar archaeological sites, and a kind of crime that does happen, are entirely fictitious. However, Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada, whom the fictitious mission is named, is a real Saint. Learn more about her here.

Cultivating data literacy through role-play

This Digital Data Story develops data literacy in archaeological audiences (age 13 and up) through revealing and reflective role-play. As a set of standard stakeholders — such as the senior archaeologist, real estate developer, and concerned citizen — your archaeological audience will analyze the motivations, values, personalities, and complex histories that each of these archetypes has with archaeology and archaeological data. It also provides possibilities for light research, through suggested sources, as well as reflection, through Part Two.

Primarily, the game requires people to role-play as their stakeholder, arguing their aims or communicating their conclusions as that character. Each stakeholder's script summarizes the essence of that character, their personal predispositions, and their affinity with the archaeological site and the missing belonging or absconded artifact, as it's sometimes referred to. These are the "raw data" that all players will use when acting as their archetype, reading their lines, or improvising around the scripted dialogue.

Besides playing as the characters to argue and communicate, each stakeholder script includes a *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities.* Once the game begins, the host or facilitator should encourage players to formalize their observations about their culpable colleagues by note-taking in that catalog. It provides players a place to write recollections about the other characters and a chance to read, work with, and analyze the data that the other characters cough up to come to the conclusion for who stole the rosary.

To successfully complete this catalog, players must listen and record what their colleagues say and do, collecting evidence and creating data about who could have taken the rosary and why. The table tailors the traits players should note to: Suspect, Motive, Your Evidence, Verdict, and Times Accused By. The spaces for "Suspect" and "Motive" are chances for characters to create and read data by documenting what the other stakeholders say about themselves and the other characters. Then, they'll work with the data by examining their notes in "Your Evidence" to see what patterns they observed. For the "Verdict," players should analyze the data and decide if that particular character is the guilty party. Lastly, in "Times Accused By" players can record and tally the accusations leveraged against themselves and other characters.

A complete catalog creates a data diary for players to draw from and decide which stakeholder was responsible for the robbery. They'll detail their decision in their *Artifact Absconder Accusation Log,* located at the beginning of Round Four in the player scripts. The log acts as the data that players will use in a standardized accusation against another archetype.

They'll then use that to communicate who they thought the culprit was, potentially convincing other players to change their minds during the penultimate round of play. Regardless of whether they win or lose, all players will have used the five components of data literacy to reach the point of accusing an archaeological absconder.

To further cultivate these skills, players who receive their scripts ahead of time can use them to add nuance and detail to their role-play by exploring the suggested resources for their character. Players who don't have time to prepare can instead use the suggested sources after the cessation of play to learn more about the character they played as. Players who desire (or require) guidance to develop their data dexterity can use *Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R* or *Of Mycenaean Men - Part Five* to learn how to work with structured tabular data. They can also use a keyword or project search of Open Context, explore museum collections, or public libraries to find more archaeological sources to support their stakeholder.

Besides this background research, hosts or facilitators can consider continuing (or commencing) the conversation around stakeholders by incorporating Part Two: The discussion guide. Part Two provides players with different levels of familiarity with archaeology the chance to ponder questions about archaeology, ethics, and data based on what they learned, or will learn, from the game.

Hosting essentials

Beyond the learning outcomes identified in the Introduction and the Cultivating data literacy through role-play sections, the goal of the game is to figure out which suspicious stakeholder removed the rosary from the site before they admit that it was them.

This section outlines the necessities for a play through so that the facilitator or host knows what to prepare ahead of time and what to do as they facilitate the game. It provides guidance for how to assign parts; an outline of the rounds of gameplay; and concludes with optional suggestions for making the game an immersive experience.

Gathering your group of gamers

Before you can play, the facilitator, game master, or host needs to know a bit about the structure of the game. So, in this section, we explain the group sizes the game can accommodate, provide some tips on how to pair players with one of the archetypal stakeholders, and explain how players can use their scripts to help develop those characters.

Group Size

We designed the game to be played by between 3 and 15 people, mature early teenagers up through the oldest living beings. A minimum group would include the host (as a player character, not as Ellis Thyx the Archaeological Investigator) and two other players. Up to 15 people may play as their own character and groups larger than 15 will require double casting or incorporating the alternate "accomplice" characters, making for a maximum of 18 unique characters (not counting the game facilitating character Ellis Thyx).

The alternate/accomplice characters may also be used without the presence of the descendant community member they work with. We called these alternate characters "accomplices" rather than "allies" to demonstrate that they are working alongside and with that community rather than for them. You can learn more about this kind of language here.

If your group desires (or requires!) double casting, adapt the character guides to represent a “group” of people of that archetype or a group related to that archetype. For example, you could have a Jim, a Junior, and a Bubba, all of whom share a background and motivations. If including the alternate/accomplice characters, they will work alongside their descendant community member during discussion rounds or advocate for their position if that member is not part of the game.

When working with double-cast or descendant community member and accomplice groups, allow time each round for participants to prepare some variation on their scripted dialogue. That will help each participant use the same foundation for lines but come up with ones that aren't exactly the same. You may also need to alter the questioning rules slightly so that all the characters are involved. However, double-cast or accomplice groups will be either guilty or innocent as a group, so only assign them one number at the onset of play. Otherwise, other players may pick up on the differences in dialogue, revealing the mystery too soon. When you reach the final round, have each group decide who will speak on their behalf to read the innocent or guilty script.

Selecting your stakeholders

Once you've assessed your group size, provide potential players the following character table and then ask them if they’d prefer that the facilitator (you) cast them or if they’d like to select which character to play.

Character	**Archetype**
Bubba, Junior, or Jim (Depends who you ask)	*Local resident who is a compassionate version of the Florida Man.*
Durlene Cantore	*Local news reporter who is a compassionate version of the Florida Woman.*
Jetson Grantmunny	*An out-of-state tenured, senior, or primary investigating archaeologist.*
Al Butte-Desaire	*An untenured, junior, or graduate student archaeologist that accompanies the primary investigator.*
Eddie G.B or Gonzalez-Bonifay	*A Hispanic/Latine/Latinx descendant community member with ties to Florida.*
"Birdie" Osceola	*An Indigenous descendant community member with ties to the area around Beadbeachville.*
blake michaels	*An African American/Black descendant community member with ties to Florida.*
Sellsalotta Stuph	*Local small business or shop owner.*

Character	Archetype
El(le) Ike Shein	*Local government representative.*
Jess V. Z. Ting	*An out-of-state tourist and recent undergraduate.*
Emma Kaup	*Local law enforcement person with some experience with archaeological materials.*
William "Bill" Ding	*Local developer, investor, large business, and hotel owner.*
Thurston Hear	*An undergraduate student volunteer whose first experience with archaeology is at this site.*
Faith Full	*Local parishioner at a nearby Catholic church who cares about local church history.*
Sister Marie Du Beaufour	*A representative of the Catholic church, specifically a nun, there to explore the mission.*
Eddie Al Terneight	*This is the accomplice character for the Hispanic/Latine/Latinx descendant community member with ties to Florida. They work with the Floridian Latine community on archaeology projects but are not part of that community themselves.*
Parker Berth	*This is the accomplice character for the Indigenous descendant community member with ties to the area around Beadbeachville. They work as an educator in an Indigenous community that has ties to the area.*
Michael B. Alturna	*This is the accomplice character for the African American/Black descendant community member with ties to Florida. They are a nonblack graduate student who works alongside Dr. blake michaels in Louisiana.*

Should your group lack someone who would be appropriate to represent specific descendant community characters but you want those communities to be part of the game, use our alternate "accomplice" characters. These include a non-Indigenous teacher who works with Indigenous communities, a non-black graduate student who works with African American communities under Dr. michaels, and a non-Hispanic archaeologist who works closely with Hispanic communities on Latine archaeological projects in Florida.

If time permits, and this is appropriate for your group, participants may also do some research about the characters before selecting who they'd like to play as. Players who are not picky about who they portray may be assigned a character at random based on which are left and make most sense for your group.

Embroiling the Enigmatic Embezzler

Each time you host *A Glorious Mystery* a different rosary requisitor may be at fault. This allows people to play this Digital Data Story multiple times to facilitate diverse discussions around motivations and for participants to play multiple roles to consider how different stakeholders interact under the same scenario. Here, we explain how to select a playthrough's culprit.

Once you know how many archetypes will be represented, randomly assign each stakeholder or stakeholder group a number from 1 to the maximum number stakeholders. If, as facilitator, you would like to play alongside the group and/or not know each character's number, have players draw a number without replacement or use another random number assignment system before gameplay to assign them a number. You may also choose to have someone unaffiliated with the game do this if you'd like.

At the beginning of the game, as part of an introduction to the format, inform participants that the rosary's pernicious purloiner will be randomly selected after the second round, *Digging up the Dirt*. Then, use either the random number generator, a set of dice, or have players return their numbers to the hat for random selection of one number that will identify the guilty party.

Preparing participants for play

Your players will likely have different levels of familiarity with archaeology, the history of Spanish missions in Florida, and the motivations of stakeholders. With that in mind, each player guide explains how to play, provides that character's scripts to be used in the game, and includes materials to help players understand the character they'll represent. Primarily, these are in the form of open-access readings and some data sets. There are a few paywalled references listed when an article was particularly relevant to a character. Players may read these ahead of time or use them as ways to find out more once they finish the game.

Regardless of familiarity, as host, game master, or facilitator it is your responsibility to create a respectful and mindful playthrough because players are representing other people's experiences. Every character, and their player, represents or is a human being with (sometimes conflicted) motivations and they will not conform to hero or villain expectations.

Beyond this, some characters and players may have complex and negative relationships with archaeology that come across in the game. Others have different proficiencies, privileges, and permissions when it comes to interacting with archaeological data. Therefore, take care with your character assignments and the difficulty that portraying some characters might put on specific players. Remind participants that, while this is a game, they should respect the characters they are playing as well as each other.

Gameday necessities

These are the elements and tools necessary to play the game. They may be present physically — such as printed versions of the scripts and the host guide — or digitally — such as the recordings played from a laptop — and, regardless of form, hosts, facilitators, games masters, and/or players should have them ready before the game starts. These items include:

1. Player and host guides
2. Host investigator script or audio recordings (if the host wishes to play as character other than the Archaeological Investigator)
3. A method for random number assignment and selection

With these, you'll be able to host the game, regardless of platform and level of player preparedness. Time to complete this game will vary depending on the players and whether the host would like to include pre- or post-play discussion as part of the game's playthrough time.

Outline of the rounds of gameplay

Before gameplay, if possible, we encourage game masters, hosts, or facilitators to have some kind of "round" or "session" zero to establish rules and boundaries for play so that all participants understand the game and feel comfortable playing. This may be in addition to or related to a pre-game discussion.

Before starting the formal game, remind players that each of them has observed some suspicious behaviors related to the archaeological site. However, they don't have to follow their own observations and should adjust their assumptions based on who the Archaeological Investigator invited. That's because only the people *in attendance* could have committed the crime.

Once you've done this, the first formal round of play is an introduction to the characters to get the players accustomed to the role-playing system. The second is a chance for players to portray their characters using improvisation to talk with each other and learn more about what people were doing around the site. After this round and before the next, the culprit for each playthrough is selected at random. Refer to the *Embroiling the Enigmatic Embezzler* section for how to do this.

Once the culprit is selected, each player will follow their character guide according to an "innocent" or "guilty" script, using one or the other as a guideline for subsequent rounds. The next round, *Sieving through the Secrets*, expands on what they have learned to narrow down the nabber by interrogating each other in front of the whole group. There is an optional expansion of Round Three where players can choose to do an additional questioning to learn more about their fellow stakeholders.

Round Four is where players will examine what they've learned (and hopefully recorded in their *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*) and fill in their *Artifact Absconder Accusation Log*. They should use that log to accuse who they think absconded with the artifact. The fifth and final roleplay round unmasks the mysterious material culture mover by having all the characters read their confessions. Round Five concludes the game, with either the unaccused artifact absconder or players who accused accurately, "winning". Hosts may choose to continue the conversation through a post-game discussion, with more information on that available in Part Two.

Optional hosting suggestions and materials

All of the following are optional aspects that are not required for the Digital Data Story's success. They do not enhance or detract from developing the data literacy components but they may make learning them slightly more immersive. These optional features include having a physical hat for picking the culprit, sending out invitations or summons, having decorations, and providing supporting materials such as food, drink, or awards.

Slips of paper and something to draw from

To randomly select the perpetrator for the game you can use slips of paper and something to draw from, such as a physical hat or other vessel. Make sure everyone understands what their assignment is if you, or someone else, are handwriting the numbers. You may draw from any vessel available and both the numerical assignments and the vessel are great chances to bring some of the world of Beadbeachville into the game. For example, you could use the back of an unused site form or provenience log to write the numbers or use a dusty bucket (like it's from the site) to draw from.

Invitations or summons

You may choose to send the participants invitations or summons tailored to the game. As the Archaeological Investigator is asking everyone to be there, whether you play the role of Ellis or not, we encourage hosts or facilitators to make these invitations formal in some capacity. Regardless of how you choose to invite people, remember to include the date, time, location, and character guide for each person or group. You may also assign or request that different players or groups bring snacks, decor, or dress up as part of their role in the game. Feel free to share the following decoration suggestions with any attendees.

Bringing Beadbeachville to life

The fictional town of Beadbeachville is on the shores of the Florida coast. While initially farther from the water, climate change has crept closer and closer to the mission site potentially threatening its continued existence. You may wish to capture that aspect in your design as well. Otherwise, feel free to use a general beach theme, archaeological excavation, tourist town, or Spanish mission style to inspire the setting. However, make sure that your use of those themes reflect the gravity of the situation. For example, a formal approach to the tourist town theme could be to style things like a hotel or resort conference room. While one for the beach theme, would be in something like a marina office.

Food, water, and sustenance

Due to the setting in Florida, consider what foods and drinks remind you of that place. Have players state their dietary necessities and assign or obtain appropriate food. Due to the fictional seaside setting, foods associated with the sea or marine environments are encouraged. Have these available for people as a “buffet” style set up so everyone can get food or drinks as needed. Depending on the kind of food, ensure that utensils and tables are available so that snacking during play doesn't get in the way of the game.

We have one suggested recipe beverage for hosts to serve for the event. Beyond this, other suggestions for beverages include sweetened and unsweetened iced tea, fruit juices, and sparkling water.

Beadbeachville and the bush - This beverage is caffeinated and may contain dairy

1. Coconut cream
2. Espresso or other coffee concentrate
3. Chocolate sauce
4. Vanilla ice cream (or other frozen non-dairy equivalent)
5. Cinnamon or other spices to taste
6. Blend the ingredients together and adjust parts to taste. The texture of the results will be similar to a milkshake.

Awards

Depending on the framing of this game, such as playing it in a class, at a conference, amongst friends, at a professional meet up, you may want to have awards to encourage friendly competition or highlight exceptional work in the game. These could include awards for the best costume, most extensive research, or best side dish. These should highlight the work that went into developing the world for the players and align with the level of seriousness of the game.

How to play

This section explains how to play each round of the game for facilitators, game masters, or hosts who desire (or require!) help leading the game beyond the outline provided in *Hosting essentials*. It begins with general tips and then explains each round in more detail. Feel free to read or skim whatever sections you'd like to support your game as you prepare to host it or have this guide available to reference during the game for clarifications.

General tips

To facilitate in-game play, ensure that all players have some pre-game preparation so they feel confident playing. This can be as brief as allowing them a few minutes to read through the first few pages of their scripts or as elaborate as asking them to research the characters over a week, starting with their stakeholder's suggested resources.

If your group *lacks experience* with role-play or has limited time to play, suggest that all players stick to the scripts where possible. If players feel more comfortable after sticking to the script for the first round, subsequent scripted rounds can include more improvised interactions. The scripted version also makes for quicker gameplay, especially with a small group, as players do not need to take as much time to create their responses.

If your group *has experience* with role-play and time permits, allow players to use their scripts as an improvisation guide. They may draw on their suggested materials to add detail to their character interactions or specificity to their responses during questioning. Games with improvisation will take longer than the script-only method due to the need to compose their own responses, especially if played with a large group.

However, all games will require some improvisation during *Round Two "Digging up the Dirt"*. Players may also be asked about unrelated events, especially if the group does not include all playable characters, which would require improvisation as well. Regardless of the amount of improvisation, remind players to stick to the appropriate responses if they are "innocent" or "guilty". While they may choose not to answer a question, they must tell the truth.

To help players keep track of what they learn about each other's characters, everyone's script includes a *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities.* As the host, encourage participants to fill out the table in their local version (either digitally or on a printed copy) as they capture clues about their culpable colleagues during the game. By doing so, the players will create data and formalize their data literacy development during the game. It also helps them manage the evidence from or about each character to decide who was the rosary robber during their playthrough.

If any questions arise during play, feel free to pause the game to answer them or ask if it's ok to answer them after the conclusion of the game. You may also share portions of the host guide if necessary, just limit spoilers.

Round Zero discussion and duty of care

Whether as an instructor, host, facilitator, or games master, as the person reading this guide and likely leading the game you accept a duty of care for your players. Part of that duty of care is to establish a sense of safety, rapport, and respect between players. To do this, we recommend conducting a pre-game "round zero" where possible.

Round or session zeros may occur asynchronously or synchronously before the start of play and are a good time to review any codes of conduct or best practices, policies, or procedures established by affiliated institutions where you might play. Institutional guides about good behavior and best practices when working in collaboration — such as in shared spaces at conferences, other events, and in the classroom — ground our relationships to others in various settings. They remind us that being a responsible colleague or host and engaging in pedagogy through play need to go together!

The general goal for the round/session zero is to assess player interest and comfort; establish explicit boundaries; and set ground rules during gameplay. Everyone should know what game they are playing and how to play together safely. Topics of discussion can include: comfort with improvisation, comfort with new people or social situations, topics or references to avoid, time restrictions and accessibility needs, and logistical inquiries. During this discussion, establish a word or phrase that signals a pause of the game for any reason and an option for players to provide that confidentially or to the game's host without having attention called to it by the other players.

Non-educational and/or public role-playing games spaces often include pre-game discussions so folks can have fun and play well with new people. For groups who lack codes of conduct or policies about duty of care and/or collegiality, we recommend looking at materials such as the *TTRPG Safety Toolkit*, co-curated by Kienna Shaw and Lauren Bryant-Monk (and as a note their shortened hyperlink includes a short ad/loading period), and Dicebreaker's *How to run a Session 0 for D&D and other RPGs*. These provide role-play specific examples for creating safe and ethical play spaces.

Round One "Incised Introductions"

Once players have their assigned numbers and characters, the game will begin with an introduction round where each player will introduce themselves as their character. Players may improvise or read the scripted introduction from their character guides.

Go around the group beginning with yourself as the Archaeological Investigator, Ellis Thyx, by reading their script or by playing the recording of Ellis followed by an introduction of the character you're playing. This will remind people that you are acting as host and that you will begin each round to minimize confusion.

Once everyone has introduced themselves you can move on to Round Two.

Round Two "Digging up the Dirt"

The goal of this round is for players to share what they've seen and heard around town in the days leading up to the disappearance of the rosary. Each character noticed a number of strange things that could help solve the mystery. However, remind players that the archaeological investigator has already narrowed down the potential suspects to *those in the room*. That means what they know or saw might not be useful for this version of the game. But, it could be a good distraction!

To begin this round, either read or play E's recordings to start and then encourage players to mingle. This is the only round of improvisation required in the game so encourage players to share the things they've heard, seen, or picked up around town in their best approximation of their characters to help deflect suspicion from themselves or work together to solve the mystery.

While this round may be played with the whole group, we recommend separating players into smaller groups (such as talking with the players on either side of them) to chat about what they've seen and heard. You may also have players get up and walk around and mingle in small groups if time allows. Smaller groups also allow players with limited role-play experience or who are less comfortable with improvisation to do so in a low-stakes scenario. Remind players to use this round to start filling out their *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* so they can keep track of the evidence they learn through talking with each other.

After letting characters converse for five to ten minutes, bring the group back and proceed with Ellis' next script or recording. Then the host should use the method described in the *Embroiling the Enigmatic Embezzler* to reveal the number identifying the culprit and remind them to read from, or improvise around, their guilty script. Everyone else should read from, or improvise around, their innocent script.

Round Three "Sieving through the Secrets"

In this round, all players will reconvene into a single group, preferably in a circle. Now that they know whether they are innocent or guilty they may choose to read their suggested question or make one up based on the gossip they heard in the preceding rounds.

If you are playing a character other than Ellis, you'll be the first player to ask a question. Otherwise, begin with the person on your left. Rather than go in a circle after the first player, the player who *was asked* a question is the next person to ask a question. Players *may not* ask the player who asked them a question, nor may they ask someone who has already been asked a question. This pattern continues until all players have gone. Each answer should reveal more potential clues for who took the rosary and why, so remind players to keep cataloging their culprits in the included table.

Once everyone has asked and answered a question, the group will decide whether to do another round of questioning, utilizing the *Expansion "Refining the Results"* section, or skip to accusations in *Round Four "Accusing the Absconder"* section.

To do this, either read the script for Ellis Thyx in the *Refining the Results* section or play the recording for that section. As the script states, call for a vote of your players to do a second round of questioning or move on to accusations. If ready to accuse others, jump to the fourth round *Accusing the Artifact Absconder*. If not, read the next section.

Expansion "Refining the Results"

In this expansion, all players will once again get the chance to ask another player a question, following the guidelines of the original round. However, as stated in the Ellis Thyx script or recording, this round will start with the player to the host's right and then follow the same pattern of questioning as the original round.

As a reminder, players may not question the player who asked them a question in response nor may they ask someone who has already been asked a question. This system will proceed until all players have gone and should reveal even more potential clues that players can add to their culprit catalog. Once completed, move on to *Round Four "Accusing the Absconder"*.

Round Four "Accusing the Artifact Absconder"

During this round, instruct each player to examine their *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* and note down their verdicts for each character. Once they have completed this, they should write down who they think took the rosary from the site using the *Artifact Absconder Accusation Log* included in each players' script.

Once they've done this, the accusations will begin with Ellis or with their recording stating how to proceed. Beginning with yourself, if playing as a character, go around the circle and have everyone read their accusation. If not playing as one of the stakeholder characters, pick the player seated across from you (or an online equivalent) to start the accusations. As host, tally which character has the most votes to decide who, if anyone, figured out who the culprit was after *Round Five "Innocently in situ or Guilty as groundstone?"*.

Round Five "Innocently in situ or Guilty as groundstone?"

Now that you have tallied the accusations, everyone will read or improvise around their innocent or guilty speeches. Begin the round by reading or playing E's lines. Then call out the number right after the guilty party's number and go in increasing order from there. Once you get to the maximum number start again at 1. You'll end the speeches with the guilty party. Another option is to start with the number right below the guilty party and then work backwards in the same fashion. Once you reach 1, start with the maximum number and continue counting down.

If no one accuses the character who committed the crime during the fourth round, they "win" the game. If they were found out by another player, or player(s), those characters who accused them correctly "win" the game.

You may play or read Ellis' last lines to conclude the game and then as the host award prizes or other accolades as you see fit, as mentioned in the Optional Hosting suggestions. However, playing, working through the data presented through the game, and understanding the points of view of the stakeholders is the main goal of this Digital Data Story!

Optional discussion

If incorporating a post or pre-game discussion, give players a break between the last round of play or before starting and the discussion period. Encourage them to get some water, stretch, and maybe some fresh air during that break. While the players prepare themselves, rearrange or maintain the setting as a circle to facilitate ease of conversation between participants.

This transition period can be a few minutes, hours, or days depending on the game's context. Regardless, give participants time to collect their thoughts and ensure they understand the purpose of their discussion or reflections. See Part Two: The discussion guide for further guidance on facilitating discussion as well as the suggested questions with options for players with variable levels of familiarity with archaeology.

Submitted response option

The related game discussion may be replaced with a written, voice, visual, video, or other medium reflection or response. We suggest that hosts or discussion facilitators use Part Two: The discussion guide to encourage thoughtful self reflection amongst players in this alternative format, using the suggested discussion questions as a guide.

Such submitted responses can be combined, in instances where appropriate, with reflection on the character development and research process for participants. For example, these could reflect on the provided resources as well as additional ones participants used to inform their characters. It could also include reflections on how that background influenced their choices during the playthrough.

Concluding the game

Regardless of how you choose to conclude, whether by completing the game and declaring a winner or through a post game discussion or a submitted reflection, Round Five will be the final required realm for role-play. By getting to Round Five, your players and you will have developed your data literacy skills by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with the data created by playing to discover the dastardly artifact absconder.

For game masters, hosts, or facilitators who want to further develop data literacy in their group, please read our suggestions for leading a game-related discussion in Part Two: The discussion guide. Part Two includes questions that can be used for discussion as well as reflection on the experience with (or predictions for) the game and the data literacies that participants cultivated by playing. If you have any questions about playing, please don't hesitate to contact the Data Literacy Program team at: datastories@opencontext.org. With that we hope you enjoy *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery!*

References and further reading

The following are references for the game overall and for links included in this host guide. We list them in order of appearance. They include places to look to inspire your own whodunit game and for background information on the specific references included in the plot. Character specific references, suggested readings, and data sets are included alongside their character scripts. If any URLs navigate to a broken page please check the Wayback Machine for an archived copy of the material.

Check out other Digital Data Stories here: https://doi.org/10.6078/M74F1NW0

Find out about the work of the Alexandria Archive Institute at: https://alexandriaarchive.org/

Browse Open Context for yourself here: https://opencontext.org

Explore Part Two at: https://doi.org/10.6078/M7B56GVG

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Find your character script in Part Three: https://doi.org/10.6078/M79P2ZSQ

Get the whole Digital Data Story as a single PDF here: https://doi.org/10.6078/M7D798KV

Learn more about the saint whose name we use for our fictitious mission–Teresa of Avila–on her wikipedia page: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Teresa_of_%C3%81vila

Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R by Paulina F. Przystupa and L. Meghan Dennis (2022): https://doi.org/10.6078/M73N21HR

Learn how to use a spreadsheet with *Of Myceanean Men - Part Five:* https://doi.org/10.6078/M7Q81B6V

Conduct a keyword search of Open Context using *Of Mycenaean Men - Part Four*: https://doi.org/10.6078/M7TX3CHJ

Try a project search of Open Context using *It's All in the Wrist (Bones) - Part Two:* https://doi.org/10.6078/M7ZP4478

Peruse some museum collections with the help of this article: https://doi.org/10.6078/M7S46Q2R

Get at taste for some public library collections here: https://alexandriaarchive.org/2025/07/10/how-to-use-the-digital-collections-of-the-nypl/

Learn about why we might use "accomplice" instead of "ally" in this article: https://www.learningforjustice.org/magazine/ally-or-accomplice-the-language-of-activism

"TTRPG Safety Toolkit: A Quick Reference Guide" by Kienna Shaw (2023) https://web.archive.org/web/20231127094204/https://i.4pcdn.org/tg/1583202183294.pdf

You can find even more resources from the TTRPG Safety Toolkit and updates to the quick reference guide here: bit.ly/ttrpgsafetytoolkit

"How to run a Session 0 for D&D and other RPGs" by Maddie Cullen (2022) https://www.dicebreaker.com/categories/roleplaying-game/how-to/how-to-run-session-0-dnd-rpg

Grab the script for Ellis Thyx, Archaeological Investigator, at: https://doi.org/10.6078/M76D5R45

Reach out to the program at: datastories@opencontext.org

“Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data” by Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle (2018) https://doi.org/10.6078/M7H70CX3

Check out this example– *Scandal in Bodgerton*–of a murder mystery game by Masters of Mystery: https://mastersofmystery.com/products/bridgerton-jane-austen-themed-murder-mystery-game-kit

Learn more about public archaeology in Florida from the Florida Public Archaeology Network: https://www.fpan.us/about/overview/

"Science-Stakeholder Partnership Leads to Broad Use of Decision-Support Tool in Southwest Florida" by Hannah Brown (2022) https://restoreactscienceprogram.noaa.gov/decision-support-tool/science-stakeholder-partnership-leads-to-broad-use-of-decision-support-tool-in-southwest-florida

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Acknowledgements

This Digital Data Story is a collaboration between its authors, our testing audiences, and the staff of AAI/OC. We are grateful to those who participated in our alpha playthrough of the game at the First Conference on Public Archaeology hosted by the Florida Public Archaeology Network Conference. These wonderful folks helped us test a prototype of this Digital Data Story and have been waiting for its release since then. We thank you for your patience as we reworked the game. We are also indebted to Katie Brewer for her help bringing gulf coast Florida to life in this approximation of the region. We also appreciate the work of the primary investigators of the *Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data* project, Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle who provide an excellent resource for comparing and learning about Spanish Missions in Florida.

The Data Stories are part of the overarching Data Literacy Program, with support from a National Endowment for the Humanities Challenge Award and a grant from the Mellon Foundation (2021-2025). Any views, findings, conclusions, or recommendations expressed in this work do not necessarily represent those of the National Endowment for the Humanities or the Mellon Foundation.

Guide Overview

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2. Data literacy through discussion and reflection
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4. Discussion and reflection questions
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    c. Experienced level
5. Final thoughts
6. References and further reading
7. Credits
8. Acknowledgments

Estimated time to read this guide: 15 Minutes

Estimated discussion or reflection time: Variable according to host and group

Introduction

Welcome to the Digital Data Stories of the Alexandria Archive Institute and Open Context! This is Part Two of *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery,* the discussion guide. This part provides tips for guiding a discussion related to the game and a variety of questions appropriate for groups with different levels of familiarity with archaeology. If you're looking for an explanation of how to lead or play the game, check out Part One: The host guide or the script for your character. You can grab a copy of your character script in the folder of Part Three: The character scripts.

This guide provides a brief explanation for how discussion and reflection help cultivate archaeological data literacy, some tips on facilitating discussion, and the suggested discussion or reflection questions. These questions may be presented to participants either before or after the game as another chance to cultivate their arguing and communicating data literacy skills.

Discussion leaders may choose to use these questions to prepare users for their roles or to expand on specific questions that arise because they solved the mystery. The questions can also help players understand how the game functions as a data literacy exercise or be used with participants to create individual responses and reflections, when a synchronous sharing session is inappropriate for the group. Such asynchronous reflections can expand into formats such as essays, audio recordings, video presentations, or other products, whichever ones make the most sense for your community. Regardless of how you use these questions, we hope they help develop your, and your community's, data literacy skills!

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Data literacy through discussion and reflection

As explained in Part One, *A Glorious Mystery*—as a role-playing game—incorporates all five components of data literacy because the game requires players to read, work with, analyze, argue, and communicate with data to solve the mystery. Part Two provides participants the chance to further develop the last two components, arguing and communicating, by reflecting on the game as a data literacy exercise and using data literacy to explore the topics introduced by the game in more detail.

From Bhargava and colleagues (2016:198), "arguing with data involves using data to support a larger narrative intended to communicate a message to a particular audience." In a discussion, either preparing for or reflecting on playing *A Glorious Mystery*, participants will draw from what they learned about archaeological stakeholders, ethics, and data practices to communicate responses to the suggested questions. This allows them to apply the skills they learned in the game, or prepare to use them in the game, to solve the mystery. In addition to using those skills to solve the mystery, a discussion or reflection on the game provides participants the chance to use their data literacy to delve deeper into the content. By doing so, participants will learn that data literacy is a useful skill that they can use in diverse ways.

Tips for guiding discussion

Facilitating discussion and encouraging thoughtful responses begins with the discussion facilitator, or at least the person reading through this guide, being clear about the purpose of discussion. By having a clear purpose, all participants know what their role is and everyone knows that they play that role willingly, even if that role is submitting a response product rather than attending a discussion. Provide breaks in ways that help support group discussion. If questions outside the purpose of the discussion arise during the event, feel free to pause and ask if it's ok for participants to explore those at a later date.

Addressing questions and concerns is part of the duty of care that discussion leaders take on. If not previously addressed during a Session Zero, referenced in Part One, it may be good to review any codes of conduct or best practice policies and procedures established by affiliated institutions. Remember to maintain any boundaries set during a Session Zero and be clear that this part of the Digital Data Story is, at least in part, an academic discussion and exercise so should be treated in a professional manner. Rules and boundaries like this encourage respectful interactions between discussants and ensure that participants are comfortable sharing their thoughts and conclusions with others.

Besides this, the following resources provide additional guidance for facilitating discussion for various groups. Not every resource will be appropriate for your group though, so feel free to pick from what we present and only use what makes sense for their community. Some helpful resources include:

- *The Art of Gathering: How We Meet and Why It Matters* by Priya Parker
- *TTRPG Safety Toolkit: A Quick Reference Guide* co-curated by Kienna Shaw and Lauren Bryant-Monk
- *How to run a Session 0 for D&D and other RPGs* by Maddie Cullen
- *Liz Lerman's Critical Response Process: A Method for Getting Useful Feedback on Anything You Make, from Dance to Dessert* by Liz Lerman and John Borstel
- *The Anti-racist Writing Workshop: How to Decolonize the Creative Classroom* by Felicia Rose Chavez

These works provide examples of how to organize and facilitate groups in different ways. Some focus on developing a safe and equitable atmosphere, while others explain how to keep groups on topic or how to adapt your physical meeting space to align with the purpose of your gathering. Depending on the demographics of your group, you may also consider using Progressive Stack, or encourage participants to read about progressive stack, to ensure that everyone's perspective is heard equitably.

Before and during discussion, we recommend giving participants time to collect their thoughts in preparation for the conversation overall and for each question. If you'd like to formalize this, you can use techniques such as one, pair, share and repeat them throughout the conversation.

As you near the conclusion of the discussion, we suggest taking a few minutes to provide a quick summary of the major conclusions your participants came to during their discussion. This provides each player a short narrative arc for the conversation that will help guide their memory of the topics presented.

Submitted response option

For communities where a synchronous discussion is not appropriate, facilitators, hosts, or game masters may use the discussion questions to encourage participants to submit written, visual, musical, voice, or video reflection responses instead. In this case, we recommend selecting specific questions from our suggested ones for players to respond to because creating thoughtful submitted responses, without the aid of a discussion, can be an arduous task.

This option may also be used in discussion groups if the facilitator would like participants to spend some time in self reflection as well. It may also be combined, where appropriate, with reflection on the character development and research process for participants. For example, these questions could be used to reflect on the provided resources as well as additional ones participants used to inform their characters and their choices during gameplay.

In groups that opt for a submitted response, providing feedback on those responses overall, or to individual submissions, is a valuable way to engage with the players' reflections and assess the development of their data literacy.

Discussion and reflection questions

To prepare players for the game, or to debrief the group once the game has concluded, consider asking players the following questions. These questions expand the dialogue around archaeological stakeholders, both as sources of data and as people who make choices about archaeological data. We include questions for archaeology students at a variety of levels. All suggested questions can be altered, modified, or omitted depending on group needs or interests.

Organizers can give these questions to players ahead of time, so they can prepare to discuss them as they review their background readings and prepare their characters. Or, as the host, you can keep these questions a secret to assess players' interaction with their readings or how they understood the game as a data literacy exercise.

Furthermore, if you or your players have any suggestions for further questions please reach out. We're always looking to expand our pool of data literacy developing questions.

New or novice archaeology audience questions

The questions in this section are for groups who only have an introductory understanding of archaeology as a discipline. These may be first-year undergraduates, upper-level high school students, or members of the public attending an archaeology event.

- What was your biggest takeaway from playing this character or from your character's background readings? What did you learn (or what do you hope to learn) from playing this game? What did you like or dislike about this character and their associated archetype?
- How do you think the stakeholder you portrayed (or will portray) would react to the phrase "archaeological data"? How would they define "archaeological data" based on what you learned about them? What does "archaeological data" mean to you personally, now that you've played this game (or as you prepare to play)?
- What artifacts, places, or things came up (or do you predict will come up) during gameplay that you would consider "archaeological data"? Were there specific pieces of archaeological data that players mentioned (or that you think they will mention) that you'd like to learn more about?
- Based on playing this game (or your expectations for gameplay), how would you identify or define an "archaeological stakeholder" at this fictitious archaeological site and why?
- How did the different background readings influence your understanding of the stakeholders you represented or how might they help explain those characters choices? What resources were most helpful (or do you expect to be most helpful) and did you find further readings or data sources to help develop the character you played?

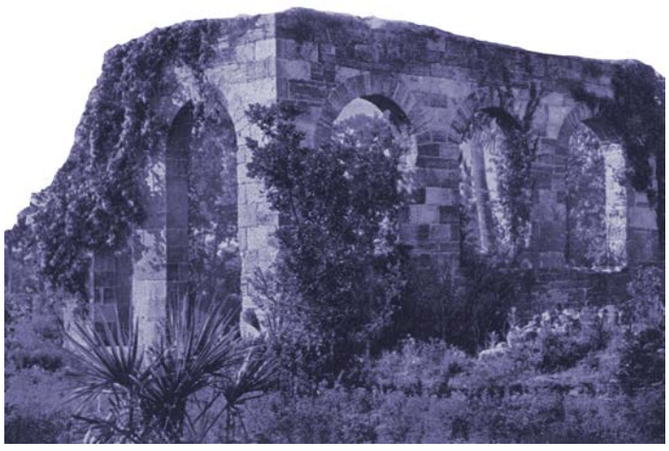
You may also choose to use some or all of these with questions as scaffolding with more advanced groups.

Queries for intermediate archaeology investigators

The questions in this section are most appropriate for players with some experience with archaeology as a discipline and an awareness of archaeological stakeholders. These may be upper division undergraduates, first-year graduate students, or members of the public who participate in open or citizen science initiatives around archaeology.

- How do you feel your character, and those played by (or to be played) everybody else, fit the role of an archaeological stakeholder at this fictitious archaeological site? How do these characters' motivations and experiences reflect their understanding of archaeology, archaeological data, and the importance of the archaeological site to them?
- How do these stakeholders draw from, or contest, archaeological data and knowledge in terms of the characters' understandings of archaeology, data, and their relationships to it? How did your character observe the events related to the fictitious site to come to the conclusion they did about who removed the artifact?
- Organization and observation are important aspects of archaeology. Playing or preparing for this game, how do you think your character—or stakeholders with similar motivations and knowledge—might choose to organize archaeological information? Would they take notes or use spreadsheets? Within those sources, what would they observe and what would their major questions be?
- Based on playing or preparing for this game, what aspects of the game or clues left behind would you consider "unstructured" archaeological data? What themes, places, or things that came up, or might come up during the game, would you consider "structured" data? How would you define each of those kinds of data and what kind do you need to create archaeological narratives?
- How do the actions of the stakeholders at the site, all drawing from their own observations and data about the site and world, reflect ethical archaeological choices? What reference point do these characters use to assess whether they made ethical choices? Which of these characters might have been bound by codes of conduct or other ethical standards?

Feel free to adapt any of these questions to better fit the needs of your group. You may also choose to combine some of these questions with those from the other sections for more advanced groups.



Reflections for experienced or expert archaeological audiences

The questions in this section are designed for people who have experience with archaeology as a discipline. These are folks who could list, describe, and provide examples of potential conflicts between different archaeological stakeholders. These could be experienced graduate students, archaeology professionals, or members of the public who are retired archaeologists, anthropologists, other cultural heritage-related professionals, or those who spent significant time volunteering in open or citizen science initiatives focused on archaeology.

- How does the diversity of the stakeholders that will be, or were, portrayed in the game reflect existing power dynamics in the real world? Were there any voices missing, under- or over- represented? How do the characters, if any, act as accomplices for specific stakeholder groups, advocating for groups they are not part of?
- How might the different characters' familiarity with archaeology and archaeological processes impact their management of archaeological data and collections? If your character had been in charge of the excavation, what sort of questions would they ask? What artifacts would they find important and why? How would they choose to share or not share that data? And with whom?
- How would your character react to the FAIR principles or the CARE principles? How might they assess the data practices at the site according to those two ways of understanding data and data-sharing?
- How did playing or preparing for this game rely on both structured and unstructured data? How does it, or might it, make connections between the two to understand stakeholders and to explore how the stakeholders understand archaeological data?
- How does the problem of the game, the disappearance of a piece of material culture, intertwine discussions of ethics and interpretation? How does the positionality of each character, the unstructured observations they made leading up to the disappearance, and the potentially structured observations they made during the game, influence how they might put data together to conclude who was guilty or innocent?

Responding to these questions requires background in archaeology and experience with different principles around data sharing. However, these may be adapted to the frameworks your groups are familiar with, such as referencing the First Nations principles of OCAP. You may also share these as reflection questions for groups who are less familiar with the content of the questions but may benefit from learning more about them on their own time.

Final thoughts

Now that you've explored how discussion develops data literacy, read some tips for facilitating discussion, and explored our suggested questions, we hope that you feel prepared to lead your own conversation based on *A Glorious Mystery*. Role-play, discussion, and reflection on archaeological data, ethics, and stakeholders can be a difficult thing so take your time developing rapport with your participants so that they can get the most out of this part of the Digital Data Story. With that, we hope that these suggestions help cultivate a meaningful discussion amongst your participants to help them develop their data literacy skills.

References and further reading

The following are references for this part of the Digital Data Story and are listed in order of appearance with some additional references where appropriate. If any URLs navigate to a broken page please check the Wayback Machine for an archived copy of the material.

Check out other Digital Data Stories here: https://doi.org/10.6078/M74F1NW0

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Explore Part One at: https://doi.org/10.6078/M7GH9G20

Find your character script in Part Three: https://doi.org/10.6078/M79P2ZSQ

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"Data Murals: Using the Arts to Build Data Literacy" by Rahul Bhargava, Rahul, Ricardo Kadouaki, Emily Bhargava, Guilherme Castro, and Catherine D'Ignazio (2016)
https://www.media.mit.edu/publications/data-murals-using-the-arts-to-build-data-literacy/

"How to run a Session 0 for D&D and other RPGs" by Maddie Cullen (2022)
https://www.dicebreaker.com/categories/roleplaying-game/how-to/how-to-run-session-0-dnd-rpg

The Art of Gathering: How We Meet and Why It Matters by Priya Parker (2020)
https://www.priyaparker.com/book-art-of-gathering

You can find more resources from the *TTRPG Safety Toolkit: A Quick Reference Guide* co-curated by Kienna Shaw and Lauren Bryant-Monk with and updates to the quick reference guide available here: bit.ly/ttrpgsafetytoolkit

Liz Lerman's Critical Response Process: A Method for Getting Useful Feedback on Anything You Make, from Dance to Dessert by Liz Lerman and John Borstel (2003)
https://www.danceexchange.org/merchandise/p/critical-response-process

The Anti-racist Writing Workshop: How to Decolonize the Creative Classroom by Felicia Rose Chavez (2021)
https://www.antiracistworkshop.com/

Learn about Progressive Stack at: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Progressive_stack

While we call it one, pair, share it's also known as think, pair, share read more at:
https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Think-pair-share

Reach out to the program at: datastories@opencontext.org

To find out more more about the FAIR principles and Go FAIR check out: https://www.go-fair.org/, https://www.go-fair.org/fair-principles or https://eos-rcn.github.io/web/

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Acknowledgments

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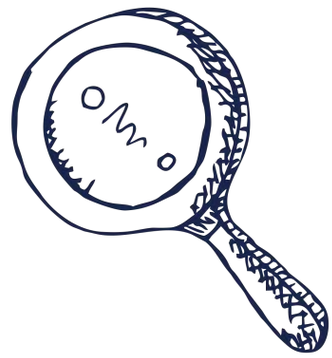
Host character guide overview



1. Introduction
2. How to play
3. Character background
4. Playing round scripts (don't read until asked to do so)
5. References and further readings
6. Credits
7. Acknowledgements

Estimated time to read this guide: 15 Minutes (do not read script ahead of time)

Estimated preparation time: Up to the player

Estimated play time: 1 - 3 hours depending on group size

Introduction

Welcome to the Digital Data Stories of the Alexandria Archive Institute and Open Context! This guide includes everything that you'll need to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery* as the host character Ellis Thyx and develop your data literacy. If you're also hosting the game, we encourage you to read the hosting guide to learn how to facilitate gameplay.

This game explores archaeological stakeholders and their relationship to archaeological data. This guide and script for the host character, Ellis Thyx, explains how the game cultivates data literacy, how to prepare to play, some background readings, and Ellis' scripts and recording links.

Developing data literacy through role-play

By hosting *A Glorious Mystery,* you'll see how role-play develops data literacy skills by encouraging your players to read, work with, analyze, argue, and communicate with data during the game. They use their Character Background to understand their character's relationship with archaeology and archaeological data and possibly learn more from their suggested sources. Your players and you can also delve deeper into character by reading, responding to and reflecting on questions from Part Two: The discussion guide.

During the game, you'll role-play as Ellis Thyx (or at least read through their lines or play their dialogue) and your players will be their designated archetypes. They'll argue their characters' aims and communicate their conclusions, using the background information and script as "raw data" that inform that archetype's actions.

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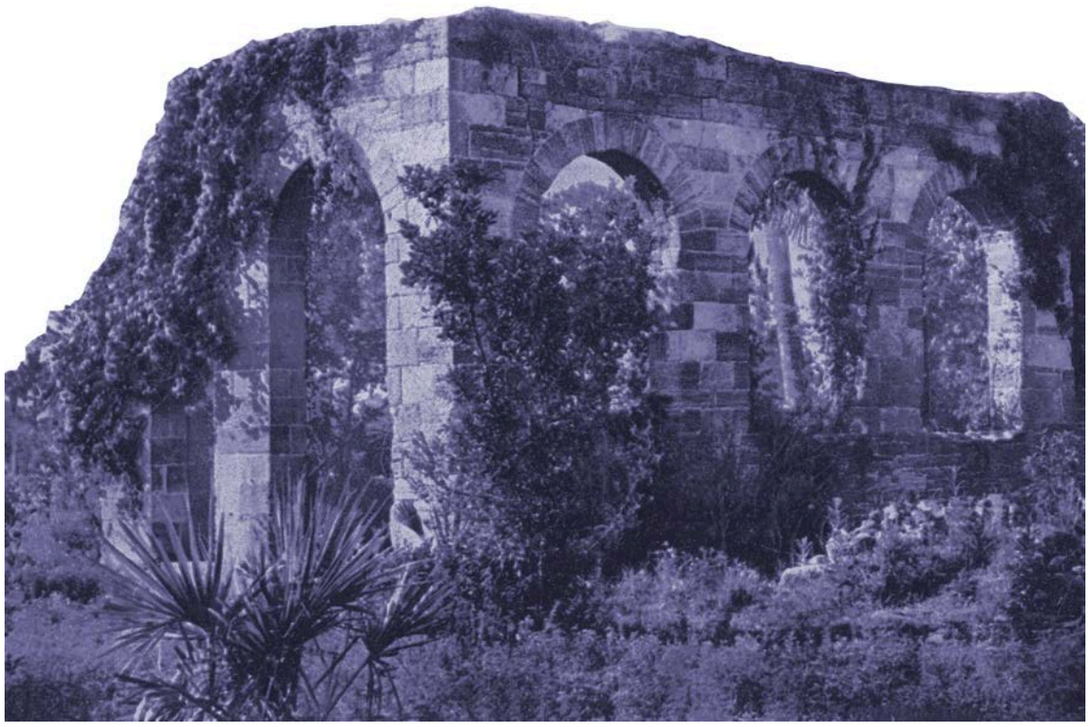

Here's an example of what an old mission site looked like in Florida. We changed the colors a bit so this is a modified version of an image courtesy of The New York Public Library. www.nypl.org. See the Credits *section for more information.*

As host, you'll encourage them to use their *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* to formalize their observations into data about the other suspicious stakeholders so they can read, work with, and analyze what the other characters cough up to come to the conclusion for who stole the rosary.

They'll then use their complete catalog to decide who to inscribe into their *Artifact Absconder Accusation Log* and formulate an argument, drawing from their evidence, to come to a conclusion. Then, during the penultimate round of play, you'll ask them to communicate their arguments. Finally, regardless of whether they concluded correctly, you can remind them that they used all five components of data literacy to accuse an archaeological absconder.

To further cultivate these skills, you and your players can explore your suggested stakeholder sources. If anyone in your playing group desires (or requires) guidance, use *Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R* or *Of Mycenaean Men - Part Five* to learn how to work with structured tabular data or conduct a keyword or project search of Open Context, explore museum collections, or public libraries to find more archaeological sources. You can also continue the conversation with Part Two: The discussion guide where you'll find questions about archaeology, ethics, and data to engage with and further cultivate your arguing and communicating skills.

How to play

This section explains how to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery* as Ellis Thyx, the host character. It begins by explaining the mystery. Following that, we provide some tips on role-play and then conclude with a synopsis of each round of play.

The mystery

> *Beadbeachville, a seaside town in Florida, is excited for the excavation season! Well, at least those visiting, watching, and working at the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission Site *are excited. First identified in the late 1970s, a new team of archaeologists has returned to the site for the last few years to uncover, recover, and preserve what remains. They've been excitedly excavating because while this Spanish colonial period Catholic religious outpost — also known as a mission — sat far from the beach when it was active, climate change related events – like more intense and regular hurricanes, sea-level rise, and soil erosion – have moved it to the water's edge. Because of that, salvage archaeology is an urgent part of the project. Beyond those threats to site integrity though, the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission *is also a fantastic blend of cultural materials from all over the region and the excavation has run smoothly for years.*
>
> *Until now. Typically, the excavation uncovered belongings (often discussed as "artifacts") that fascinated archaeologists and local history buffs, but bored tourists. This season though, the team recovered an almost completely intact set of Catholic prayer beads. Called a rosary and used for both personal and group religious practice, this artifact was strung with beads made using an Indigenous style! The discovery of the piece, at a site that also included evidence for captive African and Indigenous labor, provided an intriguing example of creolization for the region. However, before a specialist could be called in to examine the rosary and its beads in more detail, a local TV and radio show host, who happened to be at the site during the discovery, broke the news to the whole county. Tourism doubled overnight and now, to everyone's dismay, that find has disappeared! How could this happen? Did a tourist think the storage facility was a gift shop? Was it sequestered away for extra safe keeping? Did someone simply make a data entry error? Or did* You *wander away with it? An Archaeological Investigator, Ellis Thyx, has been sent to facilitate solving the mystery.*

As the host character of Ellis, you'll use the scripts included in this guide to lead the game.

Role-playing tips

You can remind players that the Archaeological Investigator, aka you, narrowed down the concerned culprits to the people in attendance. This means that while they've seen people acting suspicious, if they're not there, they definitely didn't do it. Encourage players to listen carefully to each other to suss out the real suspect or use what they've observed to distract their colleagues.

As the host character, you may choose to improvise as you like, especially if your group needs more clarification of the rules or rounds. Feel free to incorporate information from Part One - The host guide to do so. However, remember that even when playing as the host character, your primary goal is facilitating the game, not stealing the show.

While the game always requires some improvisation, we encourage groups that lack experience with role-play—or who need to finish the game quickly—to stick to the provided scripts. However, regardless of the level of improvisation, remind players that they cannot lie and need to read consistently—or consistently incorporate—the information or sentiment provided by the appropriate “innocent” or “guilty” script.

The Rounds

The game will be played in a series of rounds. The following summarizes how to play each round. If you're confused, check Part One - The host guide.

Round	**Explanation**
Zero	This is an out-of-character, pre-game discussion where you, as host, will establish boundaries for play such as level of comfort with improvisation and a way to pause the game for any reason.
One - *Incised Introductions*	This is a scripted round where you'll read Ellis' lines and then ask your players to introduce their characters and begin using their *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities.*
Two - *Digging up the Dirt*	This is an improvised round where you will encourage players to talk to each other as Ellis. You will end this round by drawing the number of one character to embroil them as the enigmatic embezzler.
Three - *Sieving through the Secrets*	This is a scripted questioning round where the players can learn more about each character's movements or motives. Once everyone has been asked and answered a question, lead the group in a vote to do another round of questioning. If the group decides to do another round, see the note for the expansion, otherwise skip to *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!* *Expansion - Refining the Results* This round is the same as the third round but when it concludes proceed directly to the next round.
Round four - *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!*	This is the accusation round. Using Ellis' script, ask each player to read their accusation and keep track of these to decide who "won" the game at the end.
Round five - *Innocently in situ or Guilty as grindstone*	This is the scripted confessions round. Proceed in the order explained in Part One - The host guide to have the players read their innocent or guilty speech. Once the guilty party confesses, read Ellis' final lines and then declare the "winner" and conclude the game in a way appropriate to your group.

Ellis Thyx, the Archaeological Investigator

The following section includes background information and the script for the character of the Archaeological Investigator, Ellis Thyx. The archaeological investigator role does not participate in the rounds. They only facilitate the transition between rounds and can answer player questions during the rounds as the host.

This role is optional and can be replaced by the recordings found here. If you (as the host, game master, or facilitator) want to use the recordings rather than play as Ellis and want to be surprised by the suspicious stakeholder, we recommend that you stop reading here.

On the subsequent pages, we provide the scripts for the role of Ellis Thyx, also known as E, below. For this character, all of the scripted language appears together without the scripted separations for the other characters to help hosts who play this character facilitate the game. The script are the lines in italics with some notes for how to alter it depending on

For role-playing facilitators, think about E as an archaeology-specific version of a detective or private investigator, the other kind of PI. They're someone who spends time tracking down stolen material culture as their job. Some background materials that can help ground this character include:

1. The work of Dr. Donna Yates - https://traffickingculture.org/people/dr-donna-yates/
2. "Florida officials and FBI recover $1 million worth of stolen gold coins from 1715 shipwreck" by Julia Musto - https://www.independent.co.uk/news/science/archaeology/gold-coins-stolen-1715-shipwreck-florida-fbi-b2654182.html
3. "How the FBI Discovered a Real-Life Indiana Jones in, of All Places, Rural Indiana" by Josh Sanburn - https://www.vanityfair.com/style/2021/10/how-the-fbi-discovered-a-real-life-indiana-jones-in-indiana

Warning: The next page begins the game's dialogue. Please do not read ahead unless you are the host and wish to see how the game unfolds.

Read the following to begin Round One "Introductions"

After looking around the storage facility, where the recently resurfaced rosary resided, I've narrowed the possible requisitors to this group before me. I will remind you that the rosary was a set of prayer beads resembling a necklace with a pendant. However, the beads are organized into groups of ten, followed by one of a different make, followed by another group of ten etc. The "pendant" style piece likely ended in a cross or crucifix or some other distinct religious image. What was unique about this specific rosary, besides its preservation, so far unheard of in the state of Florida, was that it was made using Indigenous beadworking techniques and materials. A truly remarkable demonstration of the peoples who lived in the area that is now Beadbeachville.

Unfortunately, news of the find went too quickly from the quarter-inch screen to the silver screen, with local news breaking the story to the whole county and with that, a storm surge of tourism broke onto Beadbeachville and that likely led to this rosary robbery.

You've all been around the Santa Teresa Mission for a while and, importantly, in the days before the rosary went missing. I also know that all of you are observant in your own way and probably noticed some suspicious scenes around town. So, before I reveal what I know, from my abstract attempts at attending to this artifactual abduction, I want to hear from you. Who are you, why are you here, what material matters motivate your appearance at this awesome archaeological site?

I know, I'll introduce myself first. I'm Ellis Thyx, but I usually go by E. E Thyx. I've been invited here by the State Historic Preservation Office, also known as the SHPO, to understand the motives *behind this rosary removal because, and y'all can breathe a sigh of relief, we've already recovered the rosary. We hope that by investigating the* intent, *we can educate others and improve collaboration and collective stewardship between the public and archaeology professionals. Put another way, we want the who and why the artifact perchanced to be in the improper person's possession in the first place so that everyone here will understand the importance of the rosary and each other's understanding and relationship to it.*

If host is E: *Now that you know that, and a bit about me, I'd like to learn more about the rest of you, starting with you there, to my right.*

Recording reads: *Now that you know me let's hear from the rest of you. Starting with my assistant, who will lead you from there.*

Read the following to begin Round Two "Digging up the Dirt"

Now that we've all been introduced, I know none of us want to believe that anyone here could have done it, but let's see what people were doing in the days leading up to the disappearance. I bet y'all observed some strange or suspicious scenes around town. Talk amongst yourselves and see what you can find out.

Read the following to begin Round Three "Sieving the Secrets"

I bet y'all have discovered a lot about the Santa Teresa Mission and Beadbeachville's temporary and permanent residents. While you were busy doing that, I received word from the SHPO of who the culprit is.

If host is E: *The person identified by the following number [draw the number] is the guilty party.*

Recording reads: *and my assistant will share that information in just a second so that they know, we know.*

Then continue with the following:

But don't confess just yet! I'd like to see if this group can suss out why someone might do something so strange and after learning so much about your fellow suspects you probably have some questions you'd like to ask and have them answer in front of the whole group. To do this, you'll each have the chance to ask one question of one suspect. Once they have satisfied your curiosity, they will question their own suspect, continuing in this fashion until you've all said your piece.

If host is E: *We'll start those questions with the person to my left.*

Recording reads: *I'll have my assistant go first.*

Refining the Results Script

Wheww. Y'all sure choose some strange ways to pass your time here. Are you satisfied with that round of questioning or are you burning to ask one more? Why don't we vote on it? If y'all want we can move straight to accusations, we'll do that. Otherwise, we'll do another round of questioning, proceeding like we did previously

If host is E: *with the suspicious soul to my right.*

Recording reads: *with my assistant going first.*

Read the following to begin Round Four "Accusing the Artifact Absconder"

Now that you've got your accusatory assumptions in order, let's see who's been raising your rosary RADARS.

Recording reads: *with my assistant leading this serious seriation of suspects.*

If host is E: *Let's begin with the person directly across from me, who do you think committed this ethical egress?*

Read the following to begin Round Five "Innocently in situ or Guilty as grindstone?"

I see that there's no love lost in this group but now it's time to see who the real perpetrator was. To build anticipation though, I'll save that story for last. In the meantime, I'd like to hear a good explanation from the rest of you as to why you were acting so suspicious near the Santa Teresa Site. My assistant will lead this round.

If host is E: *Starting with the number...* [then start the scripted admissions with the number preceding or after the culprit's number and continue from there].

Read the following to conclude the game

I would never have expected this outcome but I hope everyone understands why something like this might happen. Remember what you learned here today and how you learned it, you might need such skills in the future. Good luck and remember that we all need to play our part to help steward the archaeological record.

After the game

Once you read E's concluding remarks, the game ends. By reaching Round Five, your group will have developed their data literacy skills by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with the data provided through the game to discover the artifact absconder.

For those who want to further develop data literacy, explore our suggested questions in Part Two: The discussion guide. Part Two can be used for discussion as well as reflection on the experience with (or predictions for) the game and the data literacies that participants cultivated by playing. If you have any questions about playing, please don't hesitate to contact the Data Literacy Program team at: datastories@opencontext.org. With that we hope you enjoy *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery!*

References and further reading

The following is a list of hyperlinked references from this player's guide. These are presented in order of appearance and do not repeat the full references for the character included under suggested materials. If any URLs in this Digital Data Story navigate to a broken page please check the Wayback Machine for an archived copy of the material.

Check out other Digital Data Stories here: https://doi.org/10.6078/M74F1NW0

Find out about the work of the Alexandria Archive Institute at: https://alexandriaarchive.org/

Check out Open Context for yourself here: https://opencontext.org

Explore Part One - The host guide at: https://doi.org/10.6078/M7GH9G20

Find the recordings for Ellis here: https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.16777785

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Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R by Paulina F. Przystupa and L. Meghan Dennis (2022): https://doi.org/10.6078/M73N21HR

Learn how to use a spreadsheet with *Of Myceanean Men - Part Five:*
https://doi.org/10.6078/M7Q81B6V

Conduct a keyword search of Open Context using *Of Mycenaean Men - Part Four*:
https://doi.org/10.6078/M7TX3CHJ

Try a project search of Open Context using *It's All in the Wrist (Bones) - Part Two:*
https://doi.org/10.6078/M7ZP4478

Peruse some museum collections with the help of this article:
https://doi.org/10.6078/M7S46Q2R

Get at taste for some public library collections here:
https://alexandriaarchive.org/2025/07/10/how-to-use-the-digital-collections-of-the-nypl/

Explore Part Two at: https://doi.org/10.6078/M7B56GVG

"TTRPG Safety Toolkit: A Quick Reference Guide" by Kienna Shaw (2023)
https://web.archive.org/web/20231127094204/https://i.4pcdn.org/tg/1583202183294.pdf

“Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data” by Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle (2018)
https://doi.org/10.6078/M7H70CX3

Check out this example– *Scandal in Bodgerton*–of a murder mystery game by Masters of Mystery:
https://mastersofmystery.com/products/bridgerton-jane-austen-themed-murder-mystery-game-kit

Learn more about public archaeology in Florida from the Florida Public Archaeology Network:
https://www.fpan.us/about/overview/

Learn more about public domain at:
https://alexandriaarchive.org/2024/08/02/basics-of-public-domain/

Gain access to any broken links by getting an archived copy from the Wayback Machine:
https://web.archive.org/

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All other images included in this text either have their attributions cited in their captions.

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Player's guide overview

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Introduction

Welcome to the **Digital Data Stories** of the **Alexandria Archive Institute** and **Open Context**! This guide includes everything that you'll need to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery* as your assigned character and develop your data literacy. If you're also hosting the game, we encourage you to read the **hosting guide** to learn how to facilitate gameplay.

This game explores archaeological stakeholders and their relationship to archaeological data. This player's guide and script explains how the game cultivates data literacy, how to prepare to play, and the scripts for your character. This script includes character-specific background materials to use to learn more about the stakeholder you will or have portrayed.

Developing data literacy through role-play

By playing *A Glorious Mystery*, you'll develop your data literacy by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with data through the game. You'll use your **Character Background** to understand their relationship with archaeology and archaeological data and possibly learn more from their suggested sources. To delve deeper into your designated character, you can also read, respond and reflect on questions from Part Two: The discussion guide.

During the game, you'll role-play as your stakeholder, arguing their aims or communicating their conclusions using the background information and script as "raw data" that inform that archetype's actions. While playing as your character to argue and communicate, you'll use your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*** to formalize your observations into data about the other suspicious stakeholders. There you can record your recollections and use the catalog to read, work with, and analyze the data that the other characters cough up to come to the conclusion for who stole the rosary.

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The table tailors the traits you should note to: Suspect, Motive, Your Evidence, Verdict, and Times Accused By. The spaces for "Suspect" and "Motive" are where you should create and read data by documenting what the other stakeholders say about themselves and the other characters. Then, you'll work with the data by examining "Your Evidence" to see patterns. For the "Verdict," you should analyze the data and decide if that particular character is the guilty party. Lastly, in "Times Accused By" you can record and tally the accusations leveraged against yours and the others.

You'll use your complete catalog to decide who to inscribe into your Artifact Absconder Accusation Log and formulate an argument, drawing from your evidence, to come to a conclusion. Then, during the penultimate round of play, you'll communicate your argument. Regardless of whether you conclude correctly, you'll use all five components of data literacy to accuse an archaeological absconder.

To further cultivate these skills, explore your suggested stakeholder sources. If you desire (or require) guidance use **Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R** or **Of Mycenaean Men - Part Five** to learn how to work with structured tabular data or conduct a **keyword** or **project** search of Open Context, **explore museum collections**, or **public libraries** to find more archaeological sources. You can also continue the conversation with **Part Two: The discussion guide** where you'll find questions about archaeology, ethics, and data to engage with and further cultivate your arguing and communicating skills.

How to play

This section explains how to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*. It begins by explaining the mystery. Following that, we provide some tips on role-play and then conclude with a synopsis of each round of play.

The mystery

> *Beadbeachville, a seaside town in Florida, is excited for the excavation season! Well, at least those visiting, watching, and working at the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission Site *are excited. First identified in the late 1970s, a new team of archaeologists has returned to the site for the last few years to uncover, recover, and preserve what remains. They've been excitedly excavating because while this Spanish colonial period Catholic religious outpost — also known as a mission — sat far from the beach when it was active, climate change related events – like more intense and regular hurricanes, sea-level rise, and soil erosion – have moved it to the water's edge. Because of that, salvage archaeology is an urgent part of the project. Beyond those threats to site integrity though, the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission *is also a fantastic blend of cultural materials from all over the region and the excavation has run smoothly for years.*
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Your host may play this character or represent them through digital recordings, with the host as their assistant. As a reminder, the town, archaeological site, mystery, and the title of "archaeological investigator" though based on places in Gulf Coast Florida, similar archaeological sites, and a kind of crime that does happen, are entirely fictitious. However, Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada, whom the fictitious mission is named, is a real Saint. Learn more about her **here**.

Role-playing tips

The Archaeological Investigator narrowed down the concerned culprits down to the people in attendance. This means that while you've seen people acting suspicious, if they're not there, they definitely didn't do it. That means you'll need to listen to the other players closely to search out the suspect or use what you've observed to distract your colleagues.

If you lack experience with role-play, stick to the included scripts. You'll get a chance to improvise in a low stakes way during Round Two and if you feel comfortable, feel free to add more improvisation as the game goes on. If you are experienced with role-play use your script and background materials as ways to ground your improvised dialogue. Regardless, remember to read from, or incorporate, your “innocent” or “guilty” script depending on whether you are the culprit during your playthrough. You may choose not to answer a question, but must tell the truth.

The Rounds

The game will be played in a series of rounds. The following summarizes how to play each round. If you're confused, ask your host to re-explain the rules before beginning or request a pause to the game before proceeding.

Round	**Explanation**
Zero	This is an out-of-character, pre-game discussion where players and host establish boundaries for play such as level of comfort with improvisation and a way to pause the game for any reason.
One - *Incised Introductions*	This is a scripted round where you'll read or improvise around your character's introduction and begin using your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities.*
Two - *Digging up the Dirt*	This is an improvised round where you will talk with other characters to dig up more dirt on the other suspects, adding to your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*. The host will end this round by drawing the number of one character to embroil them as the enigmatic embezzler. If your number is drawn, read or improvise around your guilty scripts. If not, follow your innocent scripts.
Three - *Sieving through the Secrets*	This is a scripted questioning round where you learn more about each character's movements or motives by improvising around or reading your scripted question or answer. Once everyone has been asked and answered a question, the group will vote to do another round of questioning. If the group decides to do another round, see the note for the expansion, otherwise skip to *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!* *Expansion - Refining the Results* This round is the same as the third round but when it concludes you'll proceed directly to the next round.
Round four - *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!*	This is the accusation round. Review your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities,* decide individual verdicts, and then list who you think did it in your *Artifact Absconder Accusation Log*. Use this to fill out a standard scripted accusation, or improvise around it. Then each player will read their accusation. You can keep track of these in your catalog.
Round five - *Innocently in situ or Guilty as grindstone*	This is the scripted confessions round, which aims to unmask the mysterious material culture mover. When your number comes up, read, or improvise around, your innocent or guilty script as appropriate.

Al Butte-Desaire

Here is some background on your character, explaining who they are, what they know, and suggested materials you can read ahead of time, or after the game, to learn more about the stakeholder archetype you will, or have, portrayed. Following this character background are instructions for how much of the script you can read before playing.

Character notes and suggested background materials

Stakeholder archetype	An untenured, junior, or graduate student archaeologist that accompanies the primary investigator.
Character description	You are a graduate student and the junior archaeologist or untenured archaeologist that has accompanied Jetson Grantmunny (the senior archaeologist) for the last few seasons. You've got significant experience and are pretty well organized but focused on getting your dissertation (or another small project about the site) done soon.
Your relationship to the site	is that you want to do a comparison of the rosary with other beadwork housed at a different institution.
You're hiding the fact that...	you are not good at paperwork because no one taught you how to do it, so you're unsure if you know how to authorize an artifact loan properly.
Someone observed you...	putting your name on some loan paperwork, which you did, but you don't think you did it correctly because no one explained how that kind of thing (collections loans) actually work.
You noticed someone else...	in the crowd of a tour that Jetson was leading complain that such cool artifacts were kept in such an inaccessible place and that important pieces should go to a bigger repository.
You witnessed...	Durlene leave cigarette butts around the site after you decided to help her with her exposé. You've had to remind her to stop doing that multiple times and you'd prefer she stop smoking on the site in general.
Suggested character reference materials	"Baptizing Spring (Mission San Juan de Guacara)" entry on the Comparative Mission Archaeology Portal - **https://cmap.ufarch.org/sites/baptizing-spring/** "Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data" by Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle - **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7H70CX3** Online collection of Florida history and heritage magazines by the Florida Department of State, Division of Historical Resources available on the Internet Archive - **https://archive.org/search?query=creator%3A%22Florida+Department+of+State%2C+Division+of+Historical+Resources.%22** Political and Economic Interactions between Spaniards and Indians: Ethnohistorical and Archaeological Perspectives of the Mission System in Florida by L. J. Loucks from 1979 a University of Florida, Gainesville Ph.D. dissertation Laboring in the Fields of the Lord: Spanish Missions and Southeastern Indians by Jerald T. Milanich

You can read the next two pages before playing. The first is your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities***, where you will record what you know about the other characters. You'll want to return to this page to note new observations made during the game to help decide who committed the rosary robbery and track accusations.

The page after that is ***Round One - Incised Introductions***. You may read through your scripted introduction and the reminder of your personal secret. The scripts are an example of how your character might talk. You can read the script exactly or improvise around it as you feel comfortable. At the bottom of that page are directions that tell you to stop reading. Please follow these directions to maintain in-game suspense.

Lastly, your host should have given you a number with your character assignment or you will pick one at the start of play. Keep that handy for the end of *Round Two - Digging up the Dirt*, so you know whether you're guilty or innocent during the game.

Catalog of Culprit Capabilities

Suspect	Motive	Your Evidence	Verdict	Times Accused By

Incised Introductions

During this round, you will introduce yourself to your fellow stakeholders by reading the following script or using it as a guide for an improvised introduction. You may embody the character however you wish, but don't add any more information or details beyond the introduction right now. Let the others get to know you over the next few rounds.

> *Hi, uh, I'm Al. I'm Dr. Grantmunny's uh...assistant I guess? I've been coming to Beadbeachville these last few years with Dr. Grantmunny and am finishing up my dissertation (or short related project). I'm working on a comparison of this site and to another in Florida called* Baptizing Spring*. I think it's turning out pretty cool but there are a few more things I need to do before I have a complete draft. Though I guess that's not really that important with the rosary going missing...*

The following is a narrative version of your motivations, suspicions, and secrets as they relate to the site. You'll want to draw from this and your character notes during subsequent rounds but don't add any of this to your introduction. Also, keep some of this as secret as you can so you don't incriminate yourself as the rosary robber! But beware, you may not be the only one who knows about them. No one's as subtle as they think they are.

> *You're close to completing your dissertation (or short related project) comparing the archaeological work at the* Santa Teresa Mission *to that at* Baptizing Spring*. So far this excavation season hasn't yielded anything that you think would warrant more data collection...until the rosary was found. You'd like to borrow the rosary from the* Santa Teresa *collection so you can have it available for direct comparison with the artifacts from* Baptizing Spring. However, *although you've filled out a lot of loan paperwork, it's often been returned to you for correction before you could receive your loans. So you haven't figured out the right paperwork to fill out or how to fill out the right paperwork for the rosary and you may have left that half-finished paperwork out in the storage shed when you were showing Birdie and/or their friend Parker around the storage facility. Now you can't find the paperwork and you're reminded that while you're more organized than Jetson, it's not by much. Besides your own research, you've also attended most of Jetson's public tours and recently heard some complaints about the inaccessibility of the collection. You also met Durlene on one such tour and were familiar with her work as a journalist so you've been helping her work on an article about the site. Unfortunately, she smokes when she's stressed out and being scooped by her colleague really stressed her out. You've told her multiple times to stop smoking and especially to stop when she's on site and by the storage facility.*

Pause here until everyone has introduced themselves. The host as the character Ellis Thyx, just E for short, the Archaeological Investigator—or by playing the recording of E—will prompt you to proceed to the next page and round of the game.

Digging up the Dirt

This round your goal is to see what your fellow ethically-ambiguous allies know about the disappearance of the rosary and if they know anything about you. Be as subtle as you can because, as you inquire, these other observations could help you decide whose behavior was the most suspicious. As a reminder, here are some things that you've seen going on around Beadbeachville that you might want to ask the other stakeholders about.

You noticed someone else...	in the crowd of a tour that Jetson was leading complain that such cool artifacts were kept in such an inaccessible place and that important pieces should go to a bigger repository.
You witnessed...	Durlene leave cigarette butts around the site after you decided to help her with her exposé. You've had to remind her to stop doing that multiple times and you'd prefer she stop smoking on the site in general.

Take some time during this round to put notes in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* so you can keep track of all the evidence you uncover.

Pause here when you've finished conversing. Once the host—either as E or as the character they're playing—concludes discussion, they will reveal whether you are the culprit.

If your number is selected, read from the "guilty" scripts provided or improvise around them. If your number is not selected, portray the character using the "innocent" scripts or improvise around that information. Remember, you cannot lie but you can be evasive.

The host—either as E or by playing the recording—will prompt you to begin the next round.

Sieving the secrets

Now that you've learned more about the other stakeholders—as well as what they know about the site and you—decide which character(s) you'd like to interrogate in front of everyone. During this round, you can only ask one person, one question and you can't pick the person who asked you a question or someone who has already been asked a question, so be clever and strategic!

Feel free to use the scripted questions below, which are based on the suspicious behaviors you witnessed. You may also create your own question based on the other observations you've made and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* from the preceding rounds. Remember, only the stakeholders present in the room could have done it.

> **Looking for someone suspicious:** *Do you remember someone on the tour complaining that our collection was inaccessible? I couldn't figure out who in the crowd was complaining about that.*
>
> **You know this person was doing something odd:** *Durlene, you know smoking is bad for you, and I've told you to stop many times, why do you insist on doing it so often and so close to the storage facility?*

When another character questions you, you cannot lie but you can be evasive. If they ask you their suggested question, the following is your answer to it. You may choose to read it verbatim or improvise around it.

> **If innocent:** *Paperwork? I know something about it. That it is CONFUSING. Paperwork is hard, whether it's level forms or provenience logs or I don't know, collections paperwork. On top of that, each site and then each repository has a different way of doing it. Learning how all those different data structures fit together is its own PhD!*
>
> **If guilty:** *Paperwork? Well* I *know something about loan paperwork. I've filled out a lot of paperwork to borrow collections at a variety of places. Borrowing something from the archaeological site would be similar. I was almost done with that before something came up but filling out paperwork isn't exactly the same as actually removing something.*

If another character asks you a question where the suggested response does not make sense, answer it as truthfully as you can based on what you know or suspect. It's a great chance to share something you'd like others to know about or to deflect attention to someone else.

Pause here until all players have asked and answered a question. As you listen to the other stakeholders, add details to your catalog. Once the questioning round concludes, the host will give you the option of continuing the questioning or proceeding to accusations, so pay attention and decide what you'd like to do.

Refining the results

The group will vote on whether they'd like to do another round of questioning or if they'd like to move on to accusations. Use what you've learned and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* to guide your choice and vote accordingly.

If the group decides to do another round of questions, refer to the preceding scripts for suggested responses and questions for this *optional* round of questioning. You may need to improvise, as a lot of information has already been shared.

Otherwise, the group will proceed to the next round.

Once you complete the additional round or if the group decides to proceed without a second round of questioning, review your catalog in preparation for the accusation round. The host will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Accusing the Archaeological absconder!

Now that you've got as many observations out of other players as you can, it's time to decide who to accuse. Use what you learned and recorded in your catalog to guide your choice and fill out the following:

The Artifact Absconder Accusation Log

Suspect	Motive

You can then use the following template for your accusation.

I accuse...

of removing the recently discovered rosary from the *Santa Teresa Mission* because...

Keep your explanation brief as you will need to share it with everyone and they will all need to share theirs as well.

Once you've written your accusation, wait until E prompts you to share it with the group.

Now, it's your chance to reveal who you think rehoused the rosary! E will tell the group how to begin the accusation section. When it's your turn, read your accusation and its subsequent explanation.

Your host will take note of who gets the most accusations and tally those up for the final reveal! You can also keep track of who accused who, or how many accusations were made against each player in your catalog.

Pause again until all players have read their accusations. Then, the host as E - or by playing the recordings - will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Innocently *in situ* or Guilty as grindstone

Once everyone has stated who they think did think wandered away with the artifact it's time for the reveal. E will say their peace and then the host will begin having people perform their speeches. This round uses your assigned numbers and will begin either with the number right after—or right before—the number drawn after *Digging the Dirt*, which indicated the guilty party.

Speeches will then proceed in the sequence, leaving the selected stealer for last. When it's your turn please read, or improvise around, the provided speech depending on whether you were or not the guilty party.

> **If innocent:** *I'll admit, I'm still learning a thing or two about museum loan procedures but I do know some. While I did fill out that paperwork, incorrectly...again, I wouldn't have removed the artifact without at least getting Jetson's approval.*
>
> **If guilty:** *Paperwork is so confusing! Have you ever tried to fill out those things? Every time I tried to get Jetson's help they were too wrapped up in the funding problems to help me so I just...made it up as I went along and thought that what I'd filled out so far was "good enough" to let people know where the rosary was. I never thought people would think I stole it! It was just a case of misfiled paperwork, I swear!*

Once the robber is revealed, anyone who accurately accused them wins the game. If they were only subtly suspicious, and no one accused them, the artifact absconder wins the game. E will have a few concluding words but there's nothing more for you to do now!

After the game

Once the recording, or the host as E, reads their concluding remarks, the game ends. By reaching Round Five, you will have developed your data literacy skills by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with the data provided through the game to discover the artifact absconder.Now that you've played *A Glorious Mystery*, take a chance to reflect how the game flexed your data literacy dexterity and consider how you might apply those skills again in the future.

If you desire (or require) some structure for your reflection, consider responding to the questions posed in **Part Two: The discussion guide** to aid your reflection of the game. Or explore the suggested materials from the beginning of the script using ***Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R*** or ***Of Mycenaean Men: Part Five*** to develop your data literacy dexterity or explore **museum collections**, **public libraries**, or even **keyword** or **project** search Open Context to learn more. With that we hope you enjoy playing *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*!

References and further reading

The following is a list of hyperlinked references from this player's guide. These are presented in order of appearance and do not repeat the full references for the character included under suggested materials. If any URLs in this Digital Data Story navigate to a broken page please check the **Wayback Machine** for an archived copy of the material.

Check out other Digital Data Stories here: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M74F1NW0**

Find out about the work of the Alexandria Archive Institute at: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/**

Check out Open Context for yourself here: **https://opencontext.org**

Explore Part One - The host guide at: https://doi.org/10.6078/M7GH9G20

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Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R by Paulina F. Przystupa and L. Meghan Dennis (2022): **https://doi.org/10.6078/M73N21HR**

Learn how to use a spreadsheet with *Of Myceanean Men - Part Five*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7Q81B6V**

Conduct a keyword search of Open Context using *Of Mycenaean Men - Part Four*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7TX3CHJ**

Try a project search of Open Context using *It's All in the Wrist (Bones) - Part Two*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7ZP4478**

Peruse some museum collections with the help of this article: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7S46Q2R**

Get at taste for some public library collections here: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/2025/07/10/how-to-use-the-digital-collections-of-the-nypl/**

Learn more about the saint whose name we use for our fictitious mission–Teresa of Avila–on her Wikipedia page: **https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Teresa_of_%C3%81vila**

"TTRPG Safety Toolkit: A Quick Reference Guide" by Kienna Shaw (2023) **https://web.archive.org/web/20231127094204/https://i.4pcdn.org/tg/1583202183294.pdf**

Explore Part Two at: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7B56GVG**

"Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data" by Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle (2018) **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7H70CX3**

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Acknowledgements

This Digital Data Story is a collaboration between its authors, our testing audiences, and the staff of AAI/OC. We are grateful to those who participated in our alpha playthrough of the game at the First Conference on Public Archaeology hosted by the Florida Public Archaeology Network Conference. These wonderful folks helped us test a prototype of this Digital Data Story and have been waiting for its release since then. We thank you for your patience as we reworked the game. We are also indebted to Katie Brewer for her help bringing gulf coast Florida to life in this approximation of the region. We also appreciate the work of the primary investigators of the *Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data* project, Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle who provide an excellent resource for comparing and learning about Spanish Missions in Florida.

The Data Stories are part of the overarching Data Literacy Program, with support from a National Endowment for the Humanities Challenge Award and a grant from the Mellon Foundation (2021-2025). Any views, findings, conclusions, or recommendations expressed in this work do not necessarily represent those of the National Endowment for the Humanities or the Mellon Foundation.

Player's guide overview

1. Introduction
2. Developing data literacy through role-play
3. How to play
4. Character background
5. Playing round scripts (don't read until asked to do so)
6. References and further readings
7. Credits
8. Acknowledgements

Estimated time to read this guide: 15 Minutes (do not read script ahead of time)

Estimated preparation time: Up to the player

Estimated play time: 1 - 3 hours depending on group size

Introduction

Welcome to the **Digital Data Stories** of the **Alexandria Archive Institute** and **Open Context**! This guide includes everything that you'll need to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery* as your assigned character and develop your data literacy. If you're also hosting the game, we encourage you to read the **hosting guide** to learn how to facilitate gameplay.

This game explores archaeological stakeholders and their relationship to archaeological data. This player's guide and script explains how the game cultivates data literacy, how to prepare to play, and the scripts for your character. This script includes character-specific background materials to use to learn more about the stakeholder you will or have portrayed.

Developing data literacy through role-play

By playing *A Glorious Mystery*, you'll develop your data literacy by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with data through the game. You'll use your **Character Background** to understand their relationship with archaeology and archaeological data and possibly learn more from their suggested sources. To delve deeper into your designated character, you can also read, respond and reflect on questions from Part Two: The discussion guide.

During the game, you'll role-play as your stakeholder, arguing their aims or communicating their conclusions using the background information and script as "raw data" that inform that archetype's actions. While playing as your character to argue and communicate, you'll use your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*** to formalize your observations into data about the other suspicious stakeholders. There you can record your recollections and use the catalog to read, work with, and analyze the data that the other characters cough up to come to the conclusion for who stole the rosary.

RELEASE DATE: 08 / 2025
VERSION: 1.0
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The table tailors the traits you should note to: Suspect, Motive, Your Evidence, Verdict, and Times Accused By. The spaces for "Suspect" and "Motive" are where you should create and read data by documenting what the other stakeholders say about themselves and the other characters. Then, you'll work with the data by examining "Your Evidence" to see patterns. For the "Verdict," you should analyze the data and decide if that particular character is the guilty party. Lastly, in "Times Accused By" you can record and tally the accusations leveraged against yours and the others.

You'll use your complete catalog to decide who to inscribe into your Artifact Absconder Accusation Log and formulate an argument, drawing from your evidence, to come to a conclusion. Then, during the penultimate round of play, you'll communicate your argument. Regardless of whether you conclude correctly, you'll use all five components of data literacy to accuse an archaeological absconder.

To further cultivate these skills, explore your suggested stakeholder sources. If you desire (or require) guidance use **Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R** or **Of Mycenaean Men - Part Five** to learn how to work with structured tabular data or conduct a **keyword** or **project** search of Open Context, **explore museum collections**, or **public libraries** to find more archaeological sources. You can also continue the conversation with **Part Two: The discussion guide** where you'll find questions about archaeology, ethics, and data to engage with and further cultivate your arguing and communicating skills.

How to play

This section explains how to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*. It begins by explaining the mystery. Following that, we provide some tips on role-play and then conclude with a synopsis of each round of play.

The mystery

> *Beadbeachville, a seaside town in Florida, is excited for the excavation season! Well, at least those visiting, watching, and working at the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission Site *are excited. First identified in the late 1970s, a new team of archaeologists has returned to the site for the last few years to uncover, recover, and preserve what remains. They've been excitedly excavating because while this Spanish colonial period Catholic religious outpost — also known as a mission — sat far from the beach when it was active, climate change related events – like more intense and regular hurricanes, sea-level rise, and soil erosion – have moved it to the water's edge. Because of that, salvage archaeology is an urgent part of the project. Beyond those threats to site integrity though, the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission *is also a fantastic blend of cultural materials from all over the region and the excavation has run smoothly for years.*
>
> *Until now. Typically, the excavation uncovered belongings (often discussed as "artifacts") that fascinated archaeologists and local history buffs, but bored tourists. This season though, the team recovered an almost completely intact set of Catholic prayer beads. Called a rosary and used for both personal and group religious practice, this artifact was strung with beads made using an Indigenous style! The discovery of the piece, at a site that also included evidence for captive African and Indigenous labor, provided an intriguing example of creolization for the region. However, before a specialist could be called in to examine the rosary and its beads in more detail, a local TV and radio show host, who happened to be at the site during the discovery, broke the news to the whole county. Tourism doubled overnight and now, to everyone's dismay, that find has disappeared! How could this happen? Did a tourist think the storage facility was a gift shop? Was it sequestered away for extra safe keeping? Did someone simply make a data entry error? Or did* You *wander away with it? An Archaeological Investigator, Ellis Thyx, has been sent to facilitate solving the mystery.*

Your host may play this character or represent them through digital recordings, with the host as their assistant. As a reminder, the town, archaeological site, mystery, and the title of "archaeological investigator" though based on places in Gulf Coast Florida, similar archaeological sites, and a kind of crime that does happen, are entirely fictitious. However, Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada, whom the fictitious mission is named, is a real Saint. Learn more about her **here**.

Role-playing tips

The Archaeological Investigator narrowed down the concerned culprits down to the people in attendance. This means that while you've seen people acting suspicious, if they're not there, they definitely didn't do it. That means you'll need to listen to the other players closely to search out the suspect or use what you've observed to distract your colleagues.

If you lack experience with role-play, stick to the included scripts. You'll get a chance to improvise in a low stakes way during Round Two and if you feel comfortable, feel free to add more improvisation as the game goes on. If you are experienced with role-play use your script and background materials as ways to ground your improvised dialogue. Regardless, remember to read from, or incorporate, your “innocent” or “guilty” script depending on whether you are the culprit during your playthrough. You may choose not to answer a question, but must tell the truth.

The Rounds

The game will be played in a series of rounds. The following summarizes how to play each round. If you're confused, ask your host to re-explain the rules before beginning or request a pause to the game before proceeding.

Round	**Explanation**
Zero	This is an out-of-character, pre-game discussion where players and host establish boundaries for play such as level of comfort with improvisation and a way to pause the game for any reason.
One - *Incised Introductions*	This is a scripted round where you'll read or improvise around your character's introduction and begin using your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities.*
Two - *Digging up the Dirt*	This is an improvised round where you will talk with other characters to dig up more dirt on the other suspects, adding to your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*. The host will end this round by drawing the number of one character to embroil them as the enigmatic embezzler. If your number is drawn, read or improvise around your guilty scripts. If not, follow your innocent scripts.
Three - *Sieving through the Secrets*	This is a scripted questioning round where you learn more about each character's movements or motives by improvising around or reading your scripted question or answer. Once everyone has been asked and answered a question, the group will vote to do another round of questioning. If the group decides to do another round, see the note for the expansion, otherwise skip to *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!* *Expansion - Refining the Results* This round is the same as the third round but when it concludes you'll proceed directly to the next round.
Round four - *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!*	This is the accusation round. Review your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities,* decide individual verdicts, and then list who you think did it in your *Artifact Absconder Accusation Log*. Use this to fill out a standard scripted accusation, or improvise around it. Then each player will read their accusation. You can keep track of these in your catalog.
Round five - *Innocently in situ or Guilty as grindstone*	This is the scripted confessions round, which aims to unmask the mysterious material culture mover. When your number comes up, read, or improvise around, your innocent or guilty script as appropriate.

"Birdie" Osceola

Here is some background on your character, explaining who they are, what they know, and suggested materials you can read ahead of time, or after the game, to learn more about the stakeholder archetype you will, or have, portrayed. Following this character background are instructions for how much of the script you can read before playing.

Character notes and suggested background materials

Stakeholder archetype	An Indigenous descendant community member whose ancestors came from the lands and waters that are now called Beadbeachville.
Character description	You are an Indigenous descendant community member with ties to the area around Beadbeachville that are now considered part of the state of "Florida". You're a modern bead and fiber artist that wants to use archaeological materials to learn more about how your ancestors used local materials in their homelands.
Your relationship to the site	comes from the stories of elders who shared stories of your ancestors in the area before colonization. Those elders also mentioned how bead and fiber working changed as they were forced from their homelands so you wanted to visit the site to see if you could replicate beadwork approaches from the time before your community left Florida. The rosary being an exceptional opportunity for that.
You're hiding the fact that...	you were the one who encouraged Al to work in the area because you knew that your family was displaced from the region and thought it might be a good way to get inside information on any archaeological findings.
Someone observed you...	in the storage facility with Al where you saw the rosary before it went missing. You may have said you wanted to take it apart to learn more about it and that the storage shed didn't feel like the right place to store an belonging of this kind.
You noticed someone else...	complaining that the newly discovered rosary was a sensational find and that, if it were to go missing, people might get back to learning about the lives of the people whose forced labor went into making the mission.
You witnessed...	the entirety of a radio broadcast with Town Councillor Ike Shein, where the Councillor spoke with intimate knowledge of where the rosary was housed...an odd way to keep it safe, in your opinion.
Suggested character reference materials	Florida Archaeology from the Trail of Florida's Indian Heritage - **https://www.trailoffloridasindianheritage.org/archaeologyfl/#:~:text=Archaeology%20has%20revealed%20evidence%20of,and%20tools%2C%20weapons%20and%20weaving** Tribal Archaeology - **https://stofthpo.com/thpo-tribal-archaeology/** This character's first name comes from Bertha "Birdie" Parker - **https://trowelblazers.com/2014/05/08/bertha-birdie-parker-also-known-as/** This character's last name is related to a prominent Seminole leader and is now a common last name for Indigenous folks with ties to Florida - **https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Osceola** You can also explore the suggested resources for Parker, your accomplice character.

You can read the next two pages before playing. The first is your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities***, where you will record what you know about the other characters. You'll want to return to this page to note new observations made during the game to help decide who committed the rosary robbery and track accusations.

The page after that is ***Round One - Incised Introductions***. You may read through your scripted introduction and the reminder of your personal secret. The scripts are an example of how your character might talk. You can read the script exactly or improvise around it as you feel comfortable. At the bottom of that page are directions that tell you to stop reading. Please follow these directions to maintain in-game suspense.

Lastly, your host should have given you a number with your character assignment or you will pick one at the start of play. Keep that handy for the end of *Round Two - Digging up the Dirt*, so you know whether you're guilty or innocent during the game.

Catalog of Culprit Capabilities

Suspect	Motive	Your Evidence	Verdict	Times Accused By

Incised Introductions

During this round, you will introduce yourself to your fellow stakeholders by reading the following script or using it as a guide for an improvised introduction. You may embody the character however you wish, but don't add any more information or details beyond the introduction right now. Let the others get to know you over the next few rounds.

> *I go by Birdie and please stick to that. I'm here to pay my respects to the lands and waters of Beadbeachville, which is where colonization displaced my people from. Oh and also to visit my friend Al while they wrap up their research.*

The following is a narrative version of your motivations, suspicions, and secrets as they relate to the site. You'll want to draw from this and your character notes during subsequent rounds but don't add any of this to your introduction. Also, keep some of this as secret as you can so you don't incriminate yourself as the rosary robber! But beware, you may not be the only one who knows about them. No one's as subtle as they think they are.

> *The lands and waters around Beadbeachville are important for your people and some oral histories even mention the* Santa Teresa Mission*. So when your friend Al told you that they could work at the site, you encouraged them to do it, trusting them to take the concerns of your community seriously. You promised to visit and encouraged others, like the teacher at your local public school Parker Berth, to name drop you to Al if they visited. When you heard about the rosary, and some of the other belongings found on the site, you thought it would be a great chance to experience your ancestor's beadwork and learn how they used the organic materials found near the site. You learned traditional beadwork and fiber arts from your elders, though there's fewer and fewer of them each year to pass on their knowledge. Currently, elders work with the materials local to where your Nation now resides and you wanted to see how the beads, knotting, and braiding from the* Santa Teresa Mission *compared. You hoped to replicate some belongings from the site to share that knowledge with the elders back home as well as other bead and fiber workers. When Al invited you to see the rosary in person, the two of you discussed rehousing the rosary in a more culturally appropriate way, the best way to move it for physical comparison with other similar belongings, and considered if there was a way to safely deconstruct it to get a closer look at some of the beads, knots, and braiding, to document it in more detail. Besides visiting Al, while you were driving around Beadbeachville, you caught all of El(le) Ike Shein's radio interview and wanted to know more about their plans for the rosary. You've also dined at Mission: Meals a few times, one of the only reasonable places to eat in the area, and overheard some uncomfortable but productive discussions about whether and how the Mission used the forced labor of Indigenous and captive African people. A part of the Mission's story that Al rarely discussed with you.*

Pause here until everyone has introduced themselves. The host as the character Ellis Thyx, just E for short, the Archaeological Investigator—or by playing the recording of E—will prompt you to proceed to the next page and round of the game.

Digging up the Dirt

This round your goal is to see what your fellow ethically-ambiguous allies know about the disappearance of the rosary and if they know anything about you. Be as subtle as you can because, as you inquire, these other observations could help you decide whose behavior was the most suspicious. As a reminder, here are some things that you've seen going on around Beadbeachville that you might want to ask the other stakeholders about.

You noticed someone else...	complaining that the newly discovered rosary was a sensational find and that, if it were to go missing, people might get back to learning about the lives of the people whose forced labor went into making the mission.
You witnessed...	the entirety of a radio broadcast with Town Councillor Ike Shein, where the Councillor spoke with intimate knowledge of where the rosary was housed...an odd way to keep it safe, in your opinion.

Take some time during this round to put notes in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* so you can keep track of all the evidence you uncover.

Pause here when you've finished conversing. Once the host—either as E or as the character they're playing—concludes discussion, they will reveal whether you are the culprit.

If your number is selected, read from the "guilty" scripts provided or improvise around them. If your number is not selected, portray the character using the "innocent" scripts or improvise around that information. Remember, you cannot lie but you can be evasive.

The host—either as E or by playing the recording—will prompt you to begin the next round.

Sieving the secrets

Now that you've learned more about the other stakeholders—as well as what they know about the site and you—decide which character(s) you'd like to interrogate in front of everyone. During this round, you can only ask one person, one question and you can't pick the person who asked you a question or someone who has already been asked a question, so be clever and strategic!

Feel free to use the scripted questions below, which are based on the suspicious behaviors you witnessed. You may also create your own question based on the other observations you've made and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* from the preceding rounds. Remember, only the stakeholders present in the room could have done it.

> **Looking for someone suspicious:** *Have you talked with anyone about how the discovery of rosary deemphasized the use of forced labor at the site?*
>
> **You know this person was doing something odd:** *Councillor Shein, it was fun to hear you on the radio earlier this week. When you were talking about the rosary, it made me think you knew a lot about it, can you tell us more?*

When another character questions you, you cannot lie but you can be evasive. If they ask you their suggested question, the following is your answer to it. You may choose to read it verbatim or improvise around it.

> **If innocent:** *There's no question that I know about replicating beadwork. Al knows that's my main interest in archaeology. I love seeing what my ancestors could do and I want to be able to share that work with future generations as something to look at and be part of by embodying the skills through craft.*
>
> **If guilty:** *Of course I know someone would want to do that and wants to do that safely. Me. While I appreciate non-Indigenous people's attempts at replicas when there's no other option, I think it's best when relations do the reworking and replication of ancestral belongings.*

If another character asks you a question where the suggested response does not make sense, answer it as truthfully as you can based on what you know or suspect. It's a great chance to share something you'd like others to know about or to deflect attention to someone else.

Pause here until all players have asked and answered a question. As you listen to the other stakeholders, add details to your catalog. Once the questioning round concludes, the host will give you the option of continuing the questioning or proceeding to accusations, so pay attention and decide what you'd like to do.

Refining the results

The group will vote on whether they'd like to do another round of questioning or if they'd like to move on to accusations. Use what you've learned and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* to guide your choice and vote accordingly.

If the group decides to do another round of questions, refer to the preceding scripts for suggested responses and questions for this *optional* round of questioning. You may need to improvise, as a lot of information has already been shared.

Otherwise, the group will proceed to the next round.

Once you complete the additional round or if the group decides to proceed without a second round of questioning, review your catalog in preparation for the accusation round. The host will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Accusing the Archaeological absconder!

Now that you've got as many observations out of other players as you can, it's time to decide who to accuse. Use what you learned and recorded in your catalog to guide your choice and fill out the following:

The Artifact Absconder Accusation Log

Suspect	Motive

You can then use the following template for your accusation.

I accuse...

of removing the recently discovered rosary from the *Santa Teresa Mission* because...

Keep your explanation brief as you will need to share it with everyone and they will all need to share theirs as well.

Once you've written your accusation, wait until E prompts you to share it with the group.

Now, it's your chance to reveal who you think rehoused the rosary! E will tell the group how to begin the accusation section. When it's your turn, read your accusation and its subsequent explanation.

Your host will take note of who gets the most accusations and tally those up for the final reveal! You can also keep track of who accused who, or how many accusations were made against each player in your catalog.

Pause again until all players have read their accusations. Then, the host as E - or by playing the recordings - will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Innocently *in situ* or Guilty as grindstone

Once everyone has stated who they think did think wandered away with the artifact it's time for the reveal. E will say their peace and then the host will begin having people perform their speeches. This round uses your assigned numbers and will begin either with the number right after—or right before—the number drawn after *Digging the Dirt*, which indicated the guilty party.

Speeches will then proceed in the sequence, leaving the selected stealer for last. When it's your turn please read, or improvise around, the provided speech depending on whether you were or not the guilty party.

> **If innocent:** *In truth, archaeology isn't my thing and the rosary, while a great chance to rediscover heritage practices, isn't the only way to do that. Removing a belonging like the rosary wouldn't serve my interests.*
>
> **If guilty:** *Objects like rosaries shouldn't sit in boxes by themselves. While the religion they come from is intertwined with the horrors of colonialism, we respect them as a part of religious practice and this specific rosary is an important belonging because they connect me with the ancestors whose stories were taken by forced removal. Taking the time to treat the rosary as a relation helped me feel better about having them removed from their original resting place.*

Once the robber is revealed, anyone who accurately accused them wins the game. If they were only subtly suspicious, and no one accused them, the artifact absconder wins the game. E will have a few concluding words but there's nothing more for you to do now!

After the game

Once the recording, or the host as E, reads their concluding remarks, the game ends. By reaching Round Five, you will have developed your data literacy skills by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with the data provided through the game to discover the artifact absconder.Now that you've played *A Glorious Mystery*, take a chance to reflect how the game flexed your data literacy dexterity and consider how you might apply those skills again in the future.

If you desire (or require) some structure for your reflection, consider responding to the questions posed in **Part Two: The discussion guide** to aid your reflection of the game. Or explore the suggested materials from the beginning of the script using ***Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R*** or ***Of Mycenaean Men: Part Five*** to develop your data literacy dexterity or explore **museum collections**, **public libraries**, or even **keyword** or **project** search Open Context to learn more. With that we hope you enjoy playing *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*!

References and further reading

The following is a list of hyperlinked references from this player's guide. These are presented in order of appearance and do not repeat the full references for the character included under suggested materials. If any URLs in this Digital Data Story navigate to a broken page please check the **Wayback Machine** for an archived copy of the material.

Check out other Digital Data Stories here: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M74F1NW0**

Find out about the work of the Alexandria Archive Institute at: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/**

Check out Open Context for yourself here: **https://opencontext.org**

Explore Part One - The host guide at: https://doi.org/10.6078/M7GH9G20

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Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R by Paulina F. Przystupa and L. Meghan Dennis (2022): **https://doi.org/10.6078/M73N21HR**

Learn how to use a spreadsheet with *Of Myceanean Men - Part Five*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7Q81B6V**

Conduct a keyword search of Open Context using *Of Mycenaean Men - Part Four*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7TX3CHJ**

Try a project search of Open Context using *It's All in the Wrist (Bones) - Part Two*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7ZP4478**

Peruse some museum collections with the help of this article: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7S46Q2R**

Get at taste for some public library collections here: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/2025/07/10/how-to-use-the-digital-collections-of-the-nypl/**

Learn more about the saint whose name we use for our fictitious mission–Teresa of Avila–on her Wikipedia page: **https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Teresa_of_%C3%81vila**

"TTRPG Safety Toolkit: A Quick Reference Guide" by Kienna Shaw (2023) **https://web.archive.org/web/20231127094204/https://i.4pcdn.org/tg/1583202183294.pdf**

Explore Part Two at: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7B56GVG**

"Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data" by Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle (2018) **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7H70CX3**

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Acknowledgements

This Digital Data Story is a collaboration between its authors, our testing audiences, and the staff of AAI/OC. We are grateful to those who participated in our alpha playthrough of the game at the First Conference on Public Archaeology hosted by the Florida Public Archaeology Network Conference. These wonderful folks helped us test a prototype of this Digital Data Story and have been waiting for its release since then. We thank you for your patience as we reworked the game. We are also indebted to Katie Brewer for her help bringing gulf coast Florida to life in this approximation of the region. We also appreciate the work of the primary investigators of the *Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data* project, Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle who provide an excellent resource for comparing and learning about Spanish Missions in Florida.

The Data Stories are part of the overarching Data Literacy Program, with support from a National Endowment for the Humanities Challenge Award and a grant from the Mellon Foundation (2021-2025). Any views, findings, conclusions, or recommendations expressed in this work do not necessarily represent those of the National Endowment for the Humanities or the Mellon Foundation.

Player's guide overview

1. Introduction
2. Developing data literacy through role-play
3. How to play
4. Character background
5. Playing round scripts (don't read until asked to do so)
6. References and further readings
7. Credits
8. Acknowledgements

Estimated time to read this guide: 15 Minutes (do not read script ahead of time)

Estimated preparation time: Up to the player

Estimated play time: 1 - 3 hours depending on group size

Introduction

Welcome to the **Digital Data Stories** of the **Alexandria Archive Institute** and **Open Context**! This guide includes everything that you'll need to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery* as your assigned character and develop your data literacy. If you're also hosting the game, we encourage you to read the **hosting guide** to learn how to facilitate gameplay.

This game explores archaeological stakeholders and their relationship to archaeological data. This player's guide and script explains how the game cultivates data literacy, how to prepare to play, and the scripts for your character. This script includes character-specific background materials to use to learn more about the stakeholder you will or have portrayed.

Developing data literacy through role-play

By playing *A Glorious Mystery*, you'll develop your data literacy by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with data through the game. You'll use your **Character Background** to understand their relationship with archaeology and archaeological data and possibly learn more from their suggested sources. To delve deeper into your designated character, you can also read, respond and reflect on questions from Part Two: The discussion guide.

During the game, you'll role-play as your stakeholder, arguing their aims or communicating their conclusions using the background information and script as "raw data" that inform that archetype's actions. While playing as your character to argue and communicate, you'll use your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*** to formalize your observations into data about the other suspicious stakeholders. There you can record your recollections and use the catalog to read, work with, and analyze the data that the other characters cough up to come to the conclusion for who stole the rosary.

RELEASE DATE: 08 / 2025
VERSION: 1.0
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The table tailors the traits you should note to: Suspect, Motive, Your Evidence, Verdict, and Times Accused By. The spaces for "Suspect" and "Motive" are where you should create and read data by documenting what the other stakeholders say about themselves and the other characters. Then, you'll work with the data by examining "Your Evidence" to see patterns. For the "Verdict," you should analyze the data and decide if that particular character is the guilty party. Lastly, in "Times Accused By" you can record and tally the accusations leveraged against yours and the others.

You'll use your complete catalog to decide who to inscribe into your Artifact Absconder Accusation Log and formulate an argument, drawing from your evidence, to come to a conclusion. Then, during the penultimate round of play, you'll communicate your argument. Regardless of whether you conclude correctly, you'll use all five components of data literacy to accuse an archaeological absconder.

To further cultivate these skills, explore your suggested stakeholder sources. If you desire (or require) guidance use **Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R** or **Of Mycenaean Men - Part Five** to learn how to work with structured tabular data or conduct a **keyword** or **project** search of Open Context, **explore museum collections**, or **public libraries** to find more archaeological sources. You can also continue the conversation with **Part Two: The discussion guide** where you'll find questions about archaeology, ethics, and data to engage with and further cultivate your arguing and communicating skills.

How to play

This section explains how to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*. It begins by explaining the mystery. Following that, we provide some tips on role-play and then conclude with a synopsis of each round of play.

The mystery

> *Beadbeachville, a seaside town in Florida, is excited for the excavation season! Well, at least those visiting, watching, and working at the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission Site *are excited. First identified in the late 1970s, a new team of archaeologists has returned to the site for the last few years to uncover, recover, and preserve what remains. They've been excitedly excavating because while this Spanish colonial period Catholic religious outpost — also known as a mission — sat far from the beach when it was active, climate change related events – like more intense and regular hurricanes, sea-level rise, and soil erosion – have moved it to the water's edge. Because of that, salvage archaeology is an urgent part of the project. Beyond those threats to site integrity though, the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission *is also a fantastic blend of cultural materials from all over the region and the excavation has run smoothly for years.*
>
> *Until now. Typically, the excavation uncovered belongings (often discussed as "artifacts") that fascinated archaeologists and local history buffs, but bored tourists. This season though, the team recovered an almost completely intact set of Catholic prayer beads. Called a rosary and used for both personal and group religious practice, this artifact was strung with beads made using an Indigenous style! The discovery of the piece, at a site that also included evidence for captive African and Indigenous labor, provided an intriguing example of creolization for the region. However, before a specialist could be called in to examine the rosary and its beads in more detail, a local TV and radio show host, who happened to be at the site during the discovery, broke the news to the whole county. Tourism doubled overnight and now, to everyone's dismay, that find has disappeared! How could this happen? Did a tourist think the storage facility was a gift shop? Was it sequestered away for extra safe keeping? Did someone simply make a data entry error? Or did* You *wander away with it? An Archaeological Investigator, Ellis Thyx, has been sent to facilitate solving the mystery.*

Your host may play this character or represent them through digital recordings, with the host as their assistant. As a reminder, the town, archaeological site, mystery, and the title of "archaeological investigator" though based on places in Gulf Coast Florida, similar archaeological sites, and a kind of crime that does happen, are entirely fictitious. However, Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada, whom the fictitious mission is named, is a real Saint. Learn more about her **here**.

Role-playing tips

The Archaeological Investigator narrowed down the concerned culprits down to the people in attendance. This means that while you've seen people acting suspicious, if they're not there, they definitely didn't do it. That means you'll need to listen to the other players closely to search out the suspect or use what you've observed to distract your colleagues.

If you lack experience with role-play, stick to the included scripts. You'll get a chance to improvise in a low stakes way during Round Two and if you feel comfortable, feel free to add more improvisation as the game goes on. If you are experienced with role-play use your script and background materials as ways to ground your improvised dialogue. Regardless, remember to read from, or incorporate, your “innocent” or “guilty” script depending on whether you are the culprit during your playthrough. You may choose not to answer a question, but must tell the truth.

The Rounds

The game will be played in a series of rounds. The following summarizes how to play each round. If you're confused, ask your host to re-explain the rules before beginning or request a pause to the game before proceeding.

Round	**Explanation**
Zero	This is an out-of-character, pre-game discussion where players and host establish boundaries for play such as level of comfort with improvisation and a way to pause the game for any reason.
One - *Incised Introductions*	This is a scripted round where you'll read or improvise around your character's introduction and begin using your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities.*
Two - *Digging up the Dirt*	This is an improvised round where you will talk with other characters to dig up more dirt on the other suspects, adding to your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*. The host will end this round by drawing the number of one character to embroil them as the enigmatic embezzler. If your number is drawn, read or improvise around your guilty scripts. If not, follow your innocent scripts.
Three - *Sieving through the Secrets*	This is a scripted questioning round where you learn more about each character's movements or motives by improvising around or reading your scripted question or answer. Once everyone has been asked and answered a question, the group will vote to do another round of questioning. If the group decides to do another round, see the note for the expansion, otherwise skip to *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!* *Expansion - Refining the Results* This round is the same as the third round but when it concludes you'll proceed directly to the next round.
Round four - *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!*	This is the accusation round. Review your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities,* decide individual verdicts, and then list who you think did it in your *Artifact Absconder Accusation Log*. Use this to fill out a standard scripted accusation, or improvise around it. Then each player will read their accusation. You can keep track of these in your catalog.
Round five - *Innocently in situ or Guilty as grindstone*	This is the scripted confessions round, which aims to unmask the mysterious material culture mover. When your number comes up, read, or improvise around, your innocent or guilty script as appropriate.

Parker Berth

Here is some background on your character, explaining who they are, what they know, and suggested materials you can read ahead of time, or after the game, to learn more about the stakeholder archetype you will, or have, portrayed. Following this character background are instructions for how much of the script you can read before playing.

Character notes and suggested background materials

Stakeholder archetype	This is the accomplice character for the Indigenous descendant community member with ties to the area around Beadbeachville.
Character description	You are an alternate, accomplice, or ally to the work of Birdie, the Indigenous descendant community member with ties to the area around Beadbeachville. You've met Birdie before and are familiar with their modern bead and fiber art, as well as their interest in using archaeological materials to learn more about how their community used materials local to Beadbeachville. You are a non-Indigenous K-12 teacher in Birdie's community and wanted to bring what you learned about the site back to share with your students and Birdie (if they aren't there).
Your relationship to the site	comes from knowing about how bead and fiber working changed as the Indigenous community you work for were forced from their homelands. You learned this from elders and Birdie, who asked you to visit this site to see if you could see and maybe photograph the artifacts to help that community replicate those approaches from the time before colonization, with the rosary as an exceptional example.
You're hiding the fact that...	Birdie asked you to check in on their friend Al to get inside information on any archaeological findings. If Al or Birdie are there they might tell you more.
Someone observed you...	in the storage facility with Al, where you saw the rosary before it went missing. You may have said you wanted to take it apart to better document it and that the storage shed didn't feel like the right place to store an belonging of this kind based on what you had learned from Birdie and their elders.
You noticed someone else...	complaining that the newly discovered rosary was a sensational find and that, if it were to go missing, the archaeologists could get back to learning about the lives of the people whose forced labor went into making the mission.
You witnessed...	the entirety of a radio broadcast with Town Councillor Ike Shein, where the Councillor spoke with intimate knowledge of where the rosary was housed...an odd way to keep it safe, in your opinion.
Suggested character reference materials	Tribal Archaeology - **https://stofthpo.com/thpo-tribal-archaeology/** This character's name comes from Bertha "Birdie" Parker - **https://trowelblazers.com/2014/05/08/bertha-birdie-parker-also-known-as/** "Partnering to Prepare Teachers for Urban Indigenous Communities: St. Kateri Center of Chicago Partnering with Teaching, Learning, & Leading with Schools & Communities" by Anna Lees, Amy J. Heineke, Ann Marie Ryan, and Georgina Roy - **http://files.eric.ed.gov/fulltext/EJ1097610.pdf** You can also explore the related materials for Birdie as well.

You can read the next two pages before playing. The first is your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities***, where you will record what you know about the other characters. You'll want to return to this page to note new observations made during the game to help decide who committed the rosary robbery and track accusations.

The page after that is ***Round One - Incised Introductions***. You may read through your scripted introduction and the reminder of your personal secret. The scripts are an example of how your character might talk. You can read the script exactly or improvise around it as you feel comfortable. At the bottom of that page are directions that tell you to stop reading. Please follow these directions to maintain in-game suspense.

Lastly, your host should have given you a number with your character assignment or you will pick one at the start of play. Keep that handy for the end of *Round Two - Digging up the Dirt*, so you know whether you're guilty or innocent during the game.

Catalog of Culprit Capabilities

Suspect	Motive	Your Evidence	Verdict	Times Accused By

Incised Introductions

During this round, you will introduce yourself to your fellow stakeholders by reading the following script or using it as a guide for an improvised introduction. You may embody the character however you wish, but don't add any more information or details beyond the introduction right now. Let the others get to know you over the next few rounds.

> *Parker or (Mr., Ms., Mx.) Berth, please. I'm in town visiting the Mission on behalf of (or with) my friend Birdie. I work with the Indigenous nation that was displaced from the area that now includes Beadbeachville and wanted to bring back what I learned to my students who have deep ties to the lands and waters of this region.*

The following is a narrative version of your motivations, suspicions, and secrets as they relate to the site. You'll want to draw from this and your character notes during subsequent rounds but don't add any of this to your introduction. Also, keep some of this as secret as you can so you don't incriminate yourself as the rosary robber! But beware, you may not be the only one who knows about them. No one's as subtle as they think they are.

> *Your students, as well as their parents and the elders of the Nation where you teach, have stressed the importance of the lands and waters around Beadbeachville. So when your friend Birdie encouraged you to add the* Santa Teresa Mission *to your already planned Florida vacation you couldn't say no. They told you to search out a graduate student named Al Butte-Dessaire, a friend of theirs who they trusted to take the concerns of Birdie's Indigenous community seriously. When you heard about the rosary, and some of the other belongings found on the site, you checked in with Birdie who said it it would be a great chance to learn more about the organic materials found near the site, and to document the pieces to see if there were differences between the historical and modern fiber and beadworking approaches. You know Birdie hoped to replicate some of those belongings so volunteered (if they aren't also visiting) to take a lot of reference photos for them to use. When Al showed you the rosary in person, the two of you discussed rehousing the rosary in a more culturally appropriate way according to recommendations from Birdie's elders and asked Al if there was a way to safely deconstruct it to get a closer look at some of the beads, knots, and braiding, to document it in more detail for Birdie's Indigenous community. Al also explained some technical stuff to you like how collections loans worked and how maybe Birdie's nation could do that in the future. You also drove around Beadbeachville to explore a bit more and caught El(le) Ike Shein's radio interview. You were skeptical about their plans for the rosary and wondered if they had asked about loan paperwork before sharing their plans on the radio. You've also dined at* Mission: Meals *a few times and overheard some uncomfortable but productive discussions about whether and how the Mission used forced labor of Indigenous and captive African people. You've considered if there's a way you can bring some of those discussions into next year's coursework.*

Pause here until everyone has introduced themselves. The host as the character Ellis Thyx, just E for short, the Archaeological Investigator—or by playing the recording of E—will prompt you to proceed to the next page and round of the game.

Digging up the Dirt

This round your goal is to see what your fellow ethically-ambiguous allies know about the disappearance of the rosary and if they know anything about you. Be as subtle as you can because, as you inquire, these other observations could help you decide whose behavior was the most suspicious. As a reminder, here are some things that you've seen going on around Beadbeachville that you might want to ask the other stakeholders about.

You noticed someone else...	complaining that the newly discovered rosary was a sensational find and that, if it were to go missing, the archaeologists could get back to learning about the lives of the people whose forced labor went into making the mission.
You witnessed...	the entirety of a radio broadcast with Town Councillor Ike Shein, where the Councillor spoke with intimate knowledge of where the rosary was housed...an odd way to keep it safe, in your opinion.

Take some time during this round to put notes in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* so you can keep track of all the evidence you uncover.

Pause here when you've finished conversing. Once the host—either as E or as the character they're playing—concludes discussion, they will reveal whether you are the culprit.

If your number is selected, read from the "guilty" scripts provided or improvise around them. If your number is not selected, portray the character using the "innocent" scripts or improvise around that information. Remember, you cannot lie but you can be evasive.

The host—either as E or by playing the recording—will prompt you to begin the next round.

Sieving the secrets

Now that you've learned more about the other stakeholders—as well as what they know about the site and you—decide which character(s) you'd like to interrogate in front of everyone. During this round, you can only ask one person, one question and you can't pick the person who asked you a question or someone who has already been asked a question, so be clever and strategic!

Feel free to use the scripted questions below, which are based on the suspicious behaviors you witnessed. You may also create your own question based on the other observations you've made and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* from the preceding rounds. Remember, only the stakeholders present in the room could have done it.

> **Looking for someone suspicious:** *I know it's a hard topic to teach and talk about, but do you know anyone who might want to discuss the lives of captive Indigenous and African people at the site?*
>
> **You know this person was doing something odd:** *Councillor Shein, it was so nice to catch you on the radio earlier this week, but why do you know so much about the rosary? Did Al discuss loan paperwork with you too?*

When another character questions you, you cannot lie but you can be evasive. If they ask you their suggested question, the following is your answer to it. You may choose to read it verbatim or improvise around it.

> **If innocent:** *You know I've learned a lot about the process of replicating beadwork and other fiber arts from Birdie. They're very knowledgeable and were willing to teach me about it so I could introduce my class to the basics. That way they, my students, could start to practice making various things in the ways that their elders do and that their even older ancestors might have as well.*
>
> **If guilty:** *Well, being able to photograph each part of the rosary on its own, by taking it apart, would make for an excellent set of reference images for attempts at recreating the crafting techniques. Especially when so few Indigenous descendants have the money or time to come all the way to the site themselves.*

If another character asks you a question where the suggested response does not make sense, answer it as truthfully as you can based on what you know or suspect. It's a great chance to share something you'd like others to know about or to deflect attention to someone else.

Pause here until all players have asked and answered a question. As you listen to the other stakeholders, add details to your catalog. Once the questioning round concludes, the host will give you the option of continuing the questioning or proceeding to accusations, so pay attention and decide what you'd like to do.

Refining the results

The group will vote on whether they'd like to do another round of questioning or if they'd like to move on to accusations. Use what you've learned and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* to guide your choice and vote accordingly.

If the group decides to do another round of questions, refer to the preceding scripts for suggested responses and questions for this *optional* round of questioning. You may need to improvise, as a lot of information has already been shared.

Otherwise, the group will proceed to the next round.

Once you complete the additional round or if the group decides to proceed without a second round of questioning, review your catalog in preparation for the accusation round. The host will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Accusing the Archaeological absconder!

Now that you've got as many observations out of other players as you can, it's time to decide who to accuse. Use what you learned and recorded in your catalog to guide your choice and fill out the following:

The Artifact Absconder Accusation Log

Suspect	Motive

You can then use the following template for your accusation.

I accuse...

of removing the recently discovered rosary from the *Santa Teresa Mission* because...

Keep your explanation brief as you will need to share it with everyone and they will all need to share theirs as well.

Once you've written your accusation, wait until E prompts you to share it with the group.

Now, it's your chance to reveal who you think rehoused the rosary! E will tell the group how to begin the accusation section. When it's your turn, read your accusation and its subsequent explanation.

Your host will take note of who gets the most accusations and tally those up for the final reveal! You can also keep track of who accused who, or how many accusations were made against each player in your catalog.

Pause again until all players have read their accusations. Then, the host as E - or by playing the recordings - will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Innocently *in situ* or Guilty as grindstone

Once everyone has stated who they think did think wandered away with the artifact it's time for the reveal. E will say their peace and then the host will begin having people perform their speeches. This round uses your assigned numbers and will begin either with the number right after—or right before—the number drawn after *Digging the Dirt*, which indicated the guilty party.

Speeches will then proceed in the sequence, leaving the selected stealer for last. When it's your turn please read, or improvise around, the provided speech depending on whether you were or not the guilty party.

> **If innocent:** *I'm a school teacher, not an archaeologist, so while visiting the site was a great way to learn something to bring back to my students I have no right to take an artifact!*
>
> **If guilty:** *Even though I'm not Indigenous, seeing the rosary in that sterile bag and box didn't seem right. Such a powerful and important object for so many people deserved more respect, even if all I was going to do was photograph it for others. So after learning a bit about what it meant to fill out loan paperwork, I thought that maybe I could do a short loan to photograph it in a place where it felt more like it still had a real relationship with people. I guess I didn't understand the paperwork part as well as I thought.*

Once the robber is revealed, anyone who accurately accused them wins the game. If they were only subtly suspicious, and no one accused them, the artifact absconder wins the game. E will have a few concluding words but there's nothing more for you to do now!

After the game

Once the recording, or the host as E, reads their concluding remarks, the game ends. By reaching Round Five, you will have developed your data literacy skills by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with the data provided through the game to discover the artifact absconder.Now that you've played *A Glorious Mystery*, take a chance to reflect how the game flexed your data literacy dexterity and consider how you might apply those skills again in the future.

If you desire (or require) some structure for your reflection, consider responding to the questions posed in **Part Two: The discussion guide** to aid your reflection of the game. Or explore the suggested materials from the beginning of the script using ***Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R*** or ***Of Mycenaean Men: Part Five*** to develop your data literacy dexterity or explore **museum collections**, **public libraries**, or even **keyword** or **project** search Open Context to learn more. With that we hope you enjoy playing *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*!

References and further reading

The following is a list of hyperlinked references from this player's guide. These are presented in order of appearance and do not repeat the full references for the character included under suggested materials. If any URLs in this Digital Data Story navigate to a broken page please check the **Wayback Machine** for an archived copy of the material.

Check out other Digital Data Stories here: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M74F1NW0**

Find out about the work of the Alexandria Archive Institute at: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/**

Check out Open Context for yourself here: **https://opencontext.org**

Explore Part One - The host guide at: https://doi.org/10.6078/M7GH9G20

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Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R by Paulina F. Przystupa and L. Meghan Dennis (2022): **https://doi.org/10.6078/M73N21HR**

Learn how to use a spreadsheet with *Of Myceanean Men - Part Five*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7Q81B6V**

Conduct a keyword search of Open Context using *Of Mycenaean Men - Part Four*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7TX3CHJ**

Try a project search of Open Context using *It's All in the Wrist (Bones) - Part Two*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7ZP4478**

Peruse some museum collections with the help of this article: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7S46Q2R**

Get at taste for some public library collections here: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/2025/07/10/how-to-use-the-digital-collections-of-the-nypl/**

Learn more about the saint whose name we use for our fictitious mission–Teresa of Avila–on her Wikipedia page: **https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Teresa_of_%C3%81vila**

"TTRPG Safety Toolkit: A Quick Reference Guide" by Kienna Shaw (2023) **https://web.archive.org/web/20231127094204/https://i.4pcdn.org/tg/1583202183294.pdf**

Explore Part Two at: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7B56GVG**

"Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data" by Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle (2018) **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7H70CX3**

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Paulina F. Przystupa and L. Meghan Dennis, 2025, “A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery”, Data Stories Program, Alexandria Archive Institute / Open Context, Published Online, DOI: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M70863FG**.

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Acknowledgements

This Digital Data Story is a collaboration between its authors, our testing audiences, and the staff of AAI/OC. We are grateful to those who participated in our alpha playthrough of the game at the First Conference on Public Archaeology hosted by the Florida Public Archaeology Network Conference. These wonderful folks helped us test a prototype of this Digital Data Story and have been waiting for its release since then. We thank you for your patience as we reworked the game. We are also indebted to Katie Brewer for her help bringing gulf coast Florida to life in this approximation of the region. We also appreciate the work of the primary investigators of the *Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data* project, Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle who provide an excellent resource for comparing and learning about Spanish Missions in Florida.

The Data Stories are part of the overarching Data Literacy Program, with support from a National Endowment for the Humanities Challenge Award and a grant from the Mellon Foundation (2021-2025). Any views, findings, conclusions, or recommendations expressed in this work do not necessarily represent those of the National Endowment for the Humanities or the Mellon Foundation.

Player's guide overview

1. Introduction
2. Developing data literacy through role-play
3. How to play
4. Character background
5. Playing round scripts (don't read until asked to do so)
6. References and further readings
7. Credits
8. Acknowledgements

Estimated time to read this guide: 15 Minutes (do not read script ahead of time)

Estimated preparation time: Up to the player

Estimated play time: 1 - 3 hours depending on group size

Introduction

Welcome to the **Digital Data Stories** of the **Alexandria Archive Institute** and **Open Context**! This guide includes everything that you'll need to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery* as your assigned character and develop your data literacy. If you're also hosting the game, we encourage you to read the **hosting guide** to learn how to facilitate gameplay.

This game explores archaeological stakeholders and their relationship to archaeological data. This player's guide and script explains how the game cultivates data literacy, how to prepare to play, and the scripts for your character. This script includes character-specific background materials to use to learn more about the stakeholder you will or have portrayed.

Developing data literacy through role-play

By playing *A Glorious Mystery*, you'll develop your data literacy by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with data through the game. You'll use your **Character Background** to understand their relationship with archaeology and archaeological data and possibly learn more from their suggested sources. To delve deeper into your designated character, you can also read, respond and reflect on questions from Part Two: The discussion guide.

During the game, you'll role-play as your stakeholder, arguing their aims or communicating their conclusions using the background information and script as "raw data" that inform that archetype's actions. While playing as your character to argue and communicate, you'll use your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*** to formalize your observations into data about the other suspicious stakeholders. There you can record your recollections and use the catalog to read, work with, and analyze the data that the other characters cough up to come to the conclusion for who stole the rosary.

RELEASE DATE: 08 / 2025
VERSION: 1.0
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The table tailors the traits you should note to: Suspect, Motive, Your Evidence, Verdict, and Times Accused By. The spaces for "Suspect" and "Motive" are where you should create and read data by documenting what the other stakeholders say about themselves and the other characters. Then, you'll work with the data by examining "Your Evidence" to see patterns. For the "Verdict," you should analyze the data and decide if that particular character is the guilty party. Lastly, in "Times Accused By" you can record and tally the accusations leveraged against yours and the others.

You'll use your complete catalog to decide who to inscribe into your Artifact Absconder Accusation Log and formulate an argument, drawing from your evidence, to come to a conclusion. Then, during the penultimate round of play, you'll communicate your argument. Regardless of whether you conclude correctly, you'll use all five components of data literacy to accuse an archaeological absconder.

To further cultivate these skills, explore your suggested stakeholder sources. If you desire (or require) guidance use **Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R** or **Of Mycenaean Men - Part Five** to learn how to work with structured tabular data or conduct a **keyword** or **project** search of Open Context, **explore museum collections**, or **public libraries** to find more archaeological sources. You can also continue the conversation with **Part Two: The discussion guide** where you'll find questions about archaeology, ethics, and data to engage with and further cultivate your arguing and communicating skills.

How to play

This section explains how to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*. It begins by explaining the mystery. Following that, we provide some tips on role-play and then conclude with a synopsis of each round of play.

The mystery

> *Beadbeachville, a seaside town in Florida, is excited for the excavation season! Well, at least those visiting, watching, and working at the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission Site *are excited. First identified in the late 1970s, a new team of archaeologists has returned to the site for the last few years to uncover, recover, and preserve what remains. They've been excitedly excavating because while this Spanish colonial period Catholic religious outpost — also known as a mission — sat far from the beach when it was active, climate change related events – like more intense and regular hurricanes, sea-level rise, and soil erosion – have moved it to the water's edge. Because of that, salvage archaeology is an urgent part of the project. Beyond those threats to site integrity though, the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission *is also a fantastic blend of cultural materials from all over the region and the excavation has run smoothly for years.*
>
> *Until now. Typically, the excavation uncovered belongings (often discussed as "artifacts") that fascinated archaeologists and local history buffs, but bored tourists. This season though, the team recovered an almost completely intact set of Catholic prayer beads. Called a rosary and used for both personal and group religious practice, this artifact was strung with beads made using an Indigenous style! The discovery of the piece, at a site that also included evidence for captive African and Indigenous labor, provided an intriguing example of creolization for the region. However, before a specialist could be called in to examine the rosary and its beads in more detail, a local TV and radio show host, who happened to be at the site during the discovery, broke the news to the whole county. Tourism doubled overnight and now, to everyone's dismay, that find has disappeared! How could this happen? Did a tourist think the storage facility was a gift shop? Was it sequestered away for extra safe keeping? Did someone simply make a data entry error? Or did* You *wander away with it? An Archaeological Investigator, Ellis Thyx, has been sent to facilitate solving the mystery.*

Your host may play this character or represent them through digital recordings, with the host as their assistant. As a reminder, the town, archaeological site, mystery, and the title of "archaeological investigator" though based on places in Gulf Coast Florida, similar archaeological sites, and a kind of crime that does happen, are entirely fictitious. However, Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada, whom the fictitious mission is named, is a real Saint. Learn more about her **here**.

Role-playing tips

The Archaeological Investigator narrowed down the concerned culprits down to the people in attendance. This means that while you've seen people acting suspicious, if they're not there, they definitely didn't do it. That means you'll need to listen to the other players closely to search out the suspect or use what you've observed to distract your colleagues.

If you lack experience with role-play, stick to the included scripts. You'll get a chance to improvise in a low stakes way during Round Two and if you feel comfortable, feel free to add more improvisation as the game goes on. If you are experienced with role-play use your script and background materials as ways to ground your improvised dialogue. Regardless, remember to read from, or incorporate, your “innocent” or “guilty” script depending on whether you are the culprit during your playthrough. You may choose not to answer a question, but must tell the truth.

The Rounds

The game will be played in a series of rounds. The following summarizes how to play each round. If you're confused, ask your host to re-explain the rules before beginning or request a pause to the game before proceeding.

Round	**Explanation**
Zero	This is an out-of-character, pre-game discussion where players and host establish boundaries for play such as level of comfort with improvisation and a way to pause the game for any reason.
One - *Incised Introductions*	This is a scripted round where you'll read or improvise around your character's introduction and begin using your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities.*
Two - *Digging up the Dirt*	This is an improvised round where you will talk with other characters to dig up more dirt on the other suspects, adding to your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*. The host will end this round by drawing the number of one character to embroil them as the enigmatic embezzler. If your number is drawn, read or improvise around your guilty scripts. If not, follow your innocent scripts.
Three - *Sieving through the Secrets*	This is a scripted questioning round where you learn more about each character's movements or motives by improvising around or reading your scripted question or answer. Once everyone has been asked and answered a question, the group will vote to do another round of questioning. If the group decides to do another round, see the note for the expansion, otherwise skip to *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!* *Expansion - Refining the Results* This round is the same as the third round but when it concludes you'll proceed directly to the next round.
Round four - *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!*	This is the accusation round. Review your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities,* decide individual verdicts, and then list who you think did it in your *Artifact Absconder Accusation Log*. Use this to fill out a standard scripted accusation, or improvise around it. Then each player will read their accusation. You can keep track of these in your catalog.
Round five - *Innocently in situ or Guilty as grindstone*	This is the scripted confessions round, which aims to unmask the mysterious material culture mover. When your number comes up, read, or improvise around, your innocent or guilty script as appropriate.

Bubba, Junior, or Jim } depends who's asking

Here is some background on your character, explaining who they are, what they know, and suggested materials you can read ahead of time, or after the game, to learn more about the stakeholder archetype you will, or have, portrayed. Following this character background are instructions for how much of the script you can read before playing.

Character notes and suggested background materials

Stakeholder archetype	Local resident who is a compassionate version of the Florida Man.
Character description	You are the Florida Man. Those ones that make the news draw too much attention to the bad things about this great state. Instead, they should be focusing on the important things like a well maintained and used boat and beating the heat by grabbing a beer. You, yourself, are a proud boat owner and enjoy any kind of beer as long as it's drunk out on said boat. You regularly travel and explore the area around Beadbeachville with your boat and brews. However, you never tell people what you actually do at those places and no one knows what keeps you employed well enough to keep your boat in ship shape and your beers ice-cold.
Your relationship to the site	is through a sense of kinship with Florida generally. You view this region as part of your family's history and are fiercely protective of this idea.
You're hiding the fact that	your family is actually not from Florida. You moved down to Beadbeachville with your grandparents from the Northeast when you were a child.
Someone observed you	boating by the site after hours. You know Jetson has seen you but you don't know about anyone else.
You noticed someone else	smoking near the archaeological storage facility. You saw the light from their cigarettes burning in the early morning or after dark. Once they left, you went ashore to check it out and were frustrated that they left cigarette butts everywhere, trashing the site and creating a fire hazard.
You witnessed	Faith drop something at the site while you were boating by one night. It looked like a piece from her collection and although it looked like the missing rosary, you don't think she'd leave something that precious behind. Though it's strange that she was there at all.
Suggested character reference materials	Learning from Loss Project in Scotland: **https://web.archive.org/web/20211205182910/https://www.scottishinsight.ac.uk/Programmes/Scotland2030/LearningfromLoss.aspx** Heritage Monitoring Scouts - **https://www.fpan.us/training-courses/hms-florida/** See where the idea for a "Florida Man" came from, but remember you'll be playing a humanized version - **https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Florida_Man** "Private property, public archaeology: Resident communities as stakeholders in American archaeology" by Alice Wright - **https://libres.uncg.edu/ir/asu/f/Private%20property%20public%20archaeology%20resident%20communities%20as%20stakeholders%20in%20American%20archaeology.pdf**

You can read the next two pages before playing. The first is your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities***, where you will record what you know about the other characters. You'll want to return to this page to note new observations made during the game to help decide who committed the rosary robbery and track accusations.

The page after that is ***Round One - Incised Introductions***. You may read through your scripted introduction and the reminder of your personal secret. The scripts are an example of how your character might talk. You can read the script exactly or improvise around it as you feel comfortable. At the bottom of that page are directions that tell you to stop reading. Please follow these directions to maintain in-game suspense.

Lastly, your host should have given you a number with your character assignment or you will pick one at the start of play. Keep that handy for the end of *Round Two - Digging up the Dirt*, so you know whether you're guilty or innocent during the game.

Catalog of Culprit Capabilities

Suspect	Motive	Your Evidence	Verdict	Times Accused By

Incised Introductions

During this round, you will introduce yourself to your fellow stakeholders by reading the following script or using it as a guide for an improvised introduction. You may embody the character however you wish, but don't add any more information or details beyond the introduction right now. Let the others get to know you over the next few rounds.

> *My name is Jim but some of you know me as Bubba or Junior. You call me by whatever name I told you the first time we met. I'm Florida through and through and am proud of the rich history of this state.*

The following is a narrative version of your motivations, suspicions, and secrets as they relate to the site. You'll want to draw from this and your character notes during subsequent rounds but don't add any of this to your introduction. Also, keep some of this as secret as you can so you don't incriminate yourself as the rosary robber! But beware, you may not be the only one who knows about them. No one's as subtle as they think they are.

> *You spend a bit too much time boating by the archaeological site because you want to know what's going on there and like overhearing the archaeologists talk to each other about what they've discovered. You're fascinated by Florida history and archaeology because, while you grew up in Florida, your family is actually from the Northeast. You grew up with your grandparents in Beadbeachville but told the other kids that you'd moved from Gainesville. You let everyone assume you meant Gainesville, Florida but it was actually Gainesville, New York. Unfortunately, because Durlene moved to Gainesville, Florida for college she keeps asking you things about the city that you don't know. So, she's gotten suspicious. You've docked at the site after hours a few times and while taking a walk around, noticed an increase in cigarette butts littered around it. Specifically there was a very fresh one near the storage facility the night before the rosary went missing. On top of that, as you were about to push off, you saw Faith also walking the site after hours and strangely, it looked like she had the rosary.*

Pause here until everyone has introduced themselves. The host as the character Ellis Thyx, just E for short, the Archaeological Investigator—or by playing the recording of E—will prompt you to proceed to the next page and round of the game.

Digging up the Dirt

This round your goal is to see what your fellow ethically-ambiguous allies know about the disappearance of the rosary and if they know anything about you. Be as subtle as you can because, as you inquire, these other observations could help you decide whose behavior was the most suspicious. As a reminder, here are some things that you've seen going on around Beadbeachville that you might want to ask the other stakeholders about.

You noticed someone else	smoking near the archaeological storage facility. You saw the light from their cigarettes burning in the early morning or after dark. Once they left, you went ashore to check it out and were frustrated that they left cigarette butts everywhere, trashing the site and creating a fire hazard.
You witnessed	Faith drop something at the site while you were boating by one night. It looked like a piece from her collection and although it looked like the missing rosary, you don't think she'd leave something that precious behind. Though it's strange that she was there at all.

Take some time during this round to put notes in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* so you can keep track of all the evidence you uncover.

Pause here when you've finished conversing. Once the host—either as E or as the character they're playing—concludes discussion, they will reveal whether you are the culprit.

If your number is selected, read from the "guilty" scripts provided or improvise around them. If your number is not selected, portray the character using the "innocent" scripts or improvise around that information. Remember, you cannot lie but you can be evasive.

The host—either as E or by playing the recording—will prompt you to begin the next round.

Sieving the secrets

Now that you've learned more about the other stakeholders—as well as what they know about the site and you—decide which character(s) you'd like to interrogate in front of everyone. During this round, you can only ask one person, one question and you can't pick the person who asked you a question or someone who has already been asked a question, so be clever and strategic!

Feel free to use the scripted questions below, which are based on the suspicious behaviors you witnessed. You may also create your own question based on the other observations you've made and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* from the preceding rounds. Remember, only the stakeholders present in the room could have done it.

> **Looking for someone suspicious:** *Do you smoke or have you seen anyone smoking near the archaeological site? If so, who was it?*
>
> **You know this person was doing something odd:** *So Faith, I saw you drop something that looked a lot like the missing rosary at the site the night before it went missing, can you tell everyone more about that?*

When another character questions you, you cannot lie but you can be evasive. If they ask you their suggested question, the following is your answer to it. You may choose to read it verbatim or improvise around it.

> **If innocent:** *Of course I know the boat that's been moored by the site. It's mine, but half of the town has one and the other half wishes they owned one as nice as mine! So what does it matter if it's moored by the site? The docking fees elsewhere priced out most of us locals!*
>
> **If guilty:** *Is it a crime to leave your boat docked along the shore in Beadbeachville? Can't a man leave his vehicle in a secure place without getting the third degree? The docking fees elsewhere priced out most of us locals!*

If another character asks you a question where the suggested response does not make sense, answer it as truthfully as you can based on what you know or suspect. It's a great chance to share something you'd like others to know about or to deflect attention to someone else.

Pause here until all players have asked and answered a question. As you listen to the other stakeholders, add details to your catalog. Once the questioning round concludes, the host will give you the option of continuing the questioning or proceeding to accusations, so pay attention and decide what you'd like to do.

Refining the results

The group will vote on whether they'd like to do another round of questioning or if they'd like to move on to accusations. Use what you've learned and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* to guide your choice and vote accordingly.

If the group decides to do another round of questions, refer to the preceding scripts for suggested responses and questions for this *optional* round of questioning. You may need to improvise, as a lot of information has already been shared.

Otherwise, the group will proceed to the next round.

Once you complete the additional round or if the group decides to proceed without a second round of questioning, review your catalog in preparation for the accusation round. The host will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Accusing the Archaeological absconder!

Now that you've got as many observations out of other players as you can, it's time to decide who to accuse. Use what you learned and recorded in your catalog to guide your choice and fill out the following:

The Artifact Absconder Accusation Log

Suspect	Motive

You can then use the following template for your accusation.

I accuse...

of removing the recently discovered rosary from the *Santa Teresa Mission* because...

Keep your explanation brief as you will need to share it with everyone and they will all need to share theirs as well.

Once you've written your accusation, wait until E prompts you to share it with the group.

Now, it's your chance to reveal who you think rehoused the rosary! E will tell the group how to begin the accusation section. When it's your turn, read your accusation and its subsequent explanation.

Your host will take note of who gets the most accusations and tally those up for the final reveal! You can also keep track of who accused who, or how many accusations were made against each player in your catalog.

Pause again until all players have read their accusations. Then, the host as E - or by playing the recordings - will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Innocently *in situ* or Guilty as grindstone

Once everyone has stated who they think did think wandered away with the artifact it's time for the reveal. E will say their peace and then the host will begin having people perform their speeches. This round uses your assigned numbers and will begin either with the number right after—or right before—the number drawn after *Digging the Dirt*, which indicated the guilty party.

Speeches will then proceed in the sequence, leaving the selected stealer for last. When it's your turn please read, or improvise around, the provided speech depending on whether you were or not the guilty party.

> **If innocent:** *I would never damage a piece of precious Florida history. In fact, I'd rather see it stay in the ground than have it leave the state or the care of those who are best suited to preserve it for the future.*
>
> **If guilty:** *It's true, I was the one who removed the rosary from the site. I wanted to ensure that this precious piece of Florida history remained safely in Beadbeachville and was afraid that so many out-of-towners might rob the Mission of a precious object. I was going to return it once the tourist season died down but I'm glad it's been recovered and is in such safe hands.*

Once the robber is revealed, anyone who accurately accused them wins the game. If they were only subtly suspicious, and no one accused them, the artifact absconder wins the game. E will have a few concluding words but there's nothing more for you to do now!

After the game

Once the recording, or the host as E, reads their concluding remarks, the game ends. By reaching Round Five, you will have developed your data literacy skills by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with the data provided through the game to discover the artifact absconder.Now that you've played *A Glorious Mystery*, take a chance to reflect how the game flexed your data literacy dexterity and consider how you might apply those skills again in the future.

If you desire (or require) some structure for your reflection, consider responding to the questions posed in **Part Two: The discussion guide** to aid your reflection of the game. Or explore the suggested materials from the beginning of the script using ***Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R*** or ***Of Mycenaean Men: Part Five*** to develop your data literacy dexterity or explore **museum collections**, **public libraries**, or even **keyword** or **project** search Open Context to learn more. With that we hope you enjoy playing *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*!

References and further reading

The following is a list of hyperlinked references from this player's guide. These are presented in order of appearance and do not repeat the full references for the character included under suggested materials. If any URLs in this Digital Data Story navigate to a broken page please check the **Wayback Machine** for an archived copy of the material.

Check out other Digital Data Stories here: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M74F1NW0**

Find out about the work of the Alexandria Archive Institute at: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/**

Check out Open Context for yourself here: **https://opencontext.org**

Explore Part One - The host guide at: https://doi.org/10.6078/M7GH9G20

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Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R by Paulina F. Przystupa and L. Meghan Dennis (2022): **https://doi.org/10.6078/M73N21HR**

Learn how to use a spreadsheet with *Of Myceanean Men - Part Five*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7Q81B6V**

Conduct a keyword search of Open Context using *Of Mycenaean Men - Part Four*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7TX3CHJ**

Try a project search of Open Context using *It's All in the Wrist (Bones) - Part Two*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7ZP4478**

Peruse some museum collections with the help of this article: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7S46Q2R**

Get at taste for some public library collections here: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/2025/07/10/how-to-use-the-digital-collections-of-the-nypl/**

Learn more about the saint whose name we use for our fictitious mission–Teresa of Avila–on her Wikipedia page: **https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Teresa_of_%C3%81vila**

"TTRPG Safety Toolkit: A Quick Reference Guide" by Kienna Shaw (2023) **https://web.archive.org/web/20231127094204/https://i.4pcdn.org/tg/1583202183294.pdf**

Explore Part Two at: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7B56GVG**

"Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data" by Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle (2018) **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7H70CX3**

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Acknowledgements

This Digital Data Story is a collaboration between its authors, our testing audiences, and the staff of AAI/OC. We are grateful to those who participated in our alpha playthrough of the game at the First Conference on Public Archaeology hosted by the Florida Public Archaeology Network Conference. These wonderful folks helped us test a prototype of this Digital Data Story and have been waiting for its release since then. We thank you for your patience as we reworked the game. We are also indebted to Katie Brewer for her help bringing gulf coast Florida to life in this approximation of the region. We also appreciate the work of the primary investigators of the *Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data* project, Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle who provide an excellent resource for comparing and learning about Spanish Missions in Florida.

The Data Stories are part of the overarching Data Literacy Program, with support from a National Endowment for the Humanities Challenge Award and a grant from the Mellon Foundation (2021-2025). Any views, findings, conclusions, or recommendations expressed in this work do not necessarily represent those of the National Endowment for the Humanities or the Mellon Foundation.

Player's guide overview

1. Introduction
2. Developing data literacy through role-play
3. How to play
4. Character background
5. Playing round scripts (don't read until asked to do so)
6. References and further readings
7. Credits
8. Acknowledgements

Estimated time to read this guide: 15 Minutes (do not read script ahead of time)

Estimated preparation time: Up to the player

Estimated play time: 1 - 3 hours depending on group size

Introduction

Welcome to the **Digital Data Stories** of the **Alexandria Archive Institute** and **Open Context**! This guide includes everything that you'll need to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery* as your assigned character and develop your data literacy. If you're also hosting the game, we encourage you to read the **hosting guide** to learn how to facilitate gameplay.

This game explores archaeological stakeholders and their relationship to archaeological data. This player's guide and script explains how the game cultivates data literacy, how to prepare to play, and the scripts for your character. This script includes character-specific background materials to use to learn more about the stakeholder you will or have portrayed.

Developing data literacy through role-play

By playing *A Glorious Mystery*, you'll develop your data literacy by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with data through the game. You'll use your **Character Background** to understand their relationship with archaeology and archaeological data and possibly learn more from their suggested sources. To delve deeper into your designated character, you can also read, respond and reflect on questions from Part Two: The discussion guide.

During the game, you'll role-play as your stakeholder, arguing their aims or communicating their conclusions using the background information and script as "raw data" that inform that archetype's actions. While playing as your character to argue and communicate, you'll use your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*** to formalize your observations into data about the other suspicious stakeholders. There you can record your recollections and use the catalog to read, work with, and analyze the data that the other characters cough up to come to the conclusion for who stole the rosary.

RELEASE DATE: 08 / 2025
VERSION: 1.0
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The table tailors the traits you should note to: Suspect, Motive, Your Evidence, Verdict, and Times Accused By. The spaces for "Suspect" and "Motive" are where you should create and read data by documenting what the other stakeholders say about themselves and the other characters. Then, you'll work with the data by examining "Your Evidence" to see patterns. For the "Verdict," you should analyze the data and decide if that particular character is the guilty party. Lastly, in "Times Accused By" you can record and tally the accusations leveraged against yours and the others.

You'll use your complete catalog to decide who to inscribe into your Artifact Absconder Accusation Log and formulate an argument, drawing from your evidence, to come to a conclusion. Then, during the penultimate round of play, you'll communicate your argument. Regardless of whether you conclude correctly, you'll use all five components of data literacy to accuse an archaeological absconder.

To further cultivate these skills, explore your suggested stakeholder sources. If you desire (or require) guidance use **Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R** or **Of Mycenaean Men - Part Five** to learn how to work with structured tabular data or conduct a **keyword** or **project** search of Open Context, **explore museum collections**, or **public libraries** to find more archaeological sources. You can also continue the conversation with **Part Two: The discussion guide** where you'll find questions about archaeology, ethics, and data to engage with and further cultivate your arguing and communicating skills.

How to play

This section explains how to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*. It begins by explaining the mystery. Following that, we provide some tips on role-play and then conclude with a synopsis of each round of play.

The mystery

> *Beadbeachville, a seaside town in Florida, is excited for the excavation season! Well, at least those visiting, watching, and working at the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission Site *are excited. First identified in the late 1970s, a new team of archaeologists has returned to the site for the last few years to uncover, recover, and preserve what remains. They've been excitedly excavating because while this Spanish colonial period Catholic religious outpost — also known as a mission — sat far from the beach when it was active, climate change related events – like more intense and regular hurricanes, sea-level rise, and soil erosion – have moved it to the water's edge. Because of that, salvage archaeology is an urgent part of the project. Beyond those threats to site integrity though, the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission *is also a fantastic blend of cultural materials from all over the region and the excavation has run smoothly for years.*
>
> *Until now. Typically, the excavation uncovered belongings (often discussed as "artifacts") that fascinated archaeologists and local history buffs, but bored tourists. This season though, the team recovered an almost completely intact set of Catholic prayer beads. Called a rosary and used for both personal and group religious practice, this artifact was strung with beads made using an Indigenous style! The discovery of the piece, at a site that also included evidence for captive African and Indigenous labor, provided an intriguing example of creolization for the region. However, before a specialist could be called in to examine the rosary and its beads in more detail, a local TV and radio show host, who happened to be at the site during the discovery, broke the news to the whole county. Tourism doubled overnight and now, to everyone's dismay, that find has disappeared! How could this happen? Did a tourist think the storage facility was a gift shop? Was it sequestered away for extra safe keeping? Did someone simply make a data entry error? Or did* You *wander away with it? An Archaeological Investigator, Ellis Thyx, has been sent to facilitate solving the mystery.*

Your host may play this character or represent them through digital recordings, with the host as their assistant. As a reminder, the town, archaeological site, mystery, and the title of "archaeological investigator" though based on places in Gulf Coast Florida, similar archaeological sites, and a kind of crime that does happen, are entirely fictitious. However, Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada, whom the fictitious mission is named, is a real Saint. Learn more about her **here**.

Role-playing tips

The Archaeological Investigator narrowed down the concerned culprits down to the people in attendance. This means that while you've seen people acting suspicious, if they're not there, they definitely didn't do it. That means you'll need to listen to the other players closely to search out the suspect or use what you've observed to distract your colleagues.

If you lack experience with role-play, stick to the included scripts. You'll get a chance to improvise in a low stakes way during Round Two and if you feel comfortable, feel free to add more improvisation as the game goes on. If you are experienced with role-play use your script and background materials as ways to ground your improvised dialogue. Regardless, remember to read from, or incorporate, your “innocent” or “guilty” script depending on whether you are the culprit during your playthrough. You may choose not to answer a question, but must tell the truth.

The Rounds

The game will be played in a series of rounds. The following summarizes how to play each round. If you're confused, ask your host to re-explain the rules before beginning or request a pause to the game before proceeding.

Round	**Explanation**
Zero	This is an out-of-character, pre-game discussion where players and host establish boundaries for play such as level of comfort with improvisation and a way to pause the game for any reason.
One - *Incised Introductions*	This is a scripted round where you'll read or improvise around your character's introduction and begin using your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities.*
Two - *Digging up the Dirt*	This is an improvised round where you will talk with other characters to dig up more dirt on the other suspects, adding to your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*. The host will end this round by drawing the number of one character to embroil them as the enigmatic embezzler. If your number is drawn, read or improvise around your guilty scripts. If not, follow your innocent scripts.
Three - *Sieving through the Secrets*	This is a scripted questioning round where you learn more about each character's movements or motives by improvising around or reading your scripted question or answer. Once everyone has been asked and answered a question, the group will vote to do another round of questioning. If the group decides to do another round, see the note for the expansion, otherwise skip to *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!* *Expansion - Refining the Results* This round is the same as the third round but when it concludes you'll proceed directly to the next round.
Round four - *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!*	This is the accusation round. Review your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities,* decide individual verdicts, and then list who you think did it in your *Artifact Absconder Accusation Log*. Use this to fill out a standard scripted accusation, or improvise around it. Then each player will read their accusation. You can keep track of these in your catalog.
Round five - *Innocently in situ or Guilty as grindstone*	This is the scripted confessions round, which aims to unmask the mysterious material culture mover. When your number comes up, read, or improvise around, your innocent or guilty script as appropriate.

Dr. blake michaels

Here is some background on your character, explaining who they are, what they know, and suggested materials you can read ahead of time, or after the game, to learn more about the stakeholder archetype you will, or have, portrayed. Following this character background are instructions for how much of the script you can read before playing.

Character notes and suggested background materials

Stakeholder archetype	An African American/Black descendant community member with ties to Florida.
Character description	You are an African American/Black descendant community member whose family came from Florida. You're an archaeologist, exploring the lives of captive Africans in a variety of colonial contexts. While you focus on Louisiana, you've paid regular attention to work going on in Florida as a comparative region.
Your relationship to the site	comes from a desire to conduct comparisons between the lives of captive Africans and Indigenous people under different colonial regimes. You see the rosary as distracting from this uglier part of the history of Catholic Missions in Spanish Florida.
You're hiding the fact that...	you are an archaeologist because you're technically on vacation to visit your family. You "accidentally" added some "work" related tourist stops just so you didn't have to use your travel budget to visit the area twice.
Someone observed you...	complaining about how "sensational" the rosary was and that it was distracting from the important issues that the site could be discussing, like the use of captive and forced labor at the mission. Unfortunately, such critiques didn't do a good job of hiding the fact that you're an archaeologist.
You noticed someone else...	on the local radio talking about the rosary and how showing the physical object to state lawmakers might bring in more money for the town.
You witnessed...	Jetson admit that they'd written a memo to Al about wanting to take the rosary offsite, but can't remember where they left the memo. It could be their bad habits or a clue.
Suggested character reference materials	This character is named after Dr. Michael Blakey a prominent African American Archaeologist - **https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Michael_Blakey_(anthropologist)** The Society of Black Archaeologists - **https://www.societyofblackarchaeologists.com/about/** Cane River Creole National Historical Park - **https://www.nps.gov/cari/learn/historyculture/index.htm** A short history about "Free People of Color in Louisiana" - **https://lib.lsu.edu/sites/all/files/sc/fpoc/history.html** "Hybrid Objects and Intercultural Assemblages in Colonial Louisiana" by Lauren Zych - **https://opencontext.org/projects/ab22d409-8051-4f52-a000-7c081ddce52a** You can also explore the resources for Michael, your graduate student and accomplice character.

You can read the next two pages before playing. The first is your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities***, where you will record what you know about the other characters. You'll want to return to this page to note new observations made during the game to help decide who committed the rosary robbery and track accusations.

The page after that is ***Round One - Incised Introductions***. You may read through your scripted introduction and the reminder of your personal secret. The scripts are an example of how your character might talk. You can read the script exactly or improvise around it as you feel comfortable. At the bottom of that page are directions that tell you to stop reading. Please follow these directions to maintain in-game suspense.

Lastly, your host should have given you a number with your character assignment or you will pick one at the start of play. Keep that handy for the end of *Round Two - Digging up the Dirt*, so you know whether you're guilty or innocent during the game.

Catalog of Culprit Capabilities

Suspect	Motive	Your Evidence	Verdict	Times Accused By

Incised Introductions

During this round, you will introduce yourself to your fellow stakeholders by reading the following script or using it as a guide for an improvised introduction. You may embody the character however you wish, but don't add any more information or details beyond the introduction right now. Let the others get to know you over the next few rounds.

> *My preference is Dr. michaels, I grew up nearby and still have family in the area. I am here for a short vacation and thought that the Santa Teresa Mission would make a fun day trip.*

The following is a narrative version of your motivations, suspicions, and secrets as they relate to the site. You'll want to draw from this and your character notes during subsequent rounds but don't add any of this to your introduction. Also, keep some of this as secret as you can so you don't incriminate yourself as the rosary robber! But beware, you may not be the only one who knows about them. No one's as subtle as they think they are.

> *As an archaeologist who specializes in studying the lives of captive Africans and Indigenous peoples in Louisiana, you wanted to know more about the people who built the mission in the town near where you grew up. You're primarily in town visiting family though, so you decided to go* archaeologist incognito *on the public tour. You mentioned the site to your student Michael B. Alturna and they might visit it as well and you'll show them the ropes if they need it. The day you went on the tour, you were frustrated because all Jetson seemed to talk about was the rosary. It was one of those typical "sensationalist" narratives. The words "rare," "unique," "one-of-a-kind," "priceless," etc. got thrown around a lot. What the tour lacked was any clear context of how captive Africans and Indigenous people were essential to life at the mission. You decided that since you'd met Jetson at a previous Southeastern Archaeological Conference (SEAC), you'd step out of* incognito archaeologist *mode to discuss Jetson's narrative choice for public tours by grabbing coffee at* Mission: Meals *(and potentially bringing your student with you). When you met up Jetson to discuss the public narrative they also mentioned that they wrote a memo about moving the rosary, but doesn't know where they left it. They worry it could be incriminating, which you do too, but recall that Grantmunny doesn't have a reputation for being the most organized. While the conversation with Jetson was good, you could see the influence the public narrative was having when you caught part of a local radio show where they left all the real history out. The segment focused only on how the rosary might bring even more economic development to town without discussing how that might impact descendant communities' abilities to communicate the more difficult parts of the history of the mission.*

Pause here until everyone has introduced themselves. The host as the character Ellis Thyx, just E for short, the Archaeological Investigator—or by playing the recording of E—will prompt you to proceed to the next page and round of the game.

Digging up the Dirt

This round your goal is to see what your fellow ethically-ambiguous allies know about the disappearance of the rosary and if they know anything about you. Be as subtle as you can because, as you inquire, these other observations could help you decide whose behavior was the most suspicious. As a reminder, here are some things that you've seen going on around Beadbeachville that you might want to ask the other stakeholders about.

You noticed someone else...	on the local radio talking about the rosary and how showing the physical object to state lawmakers might bring in more money for the town.
You witnessed...	Jetson admit that they'd written a memo to Al about wanting to take the rosary offsite, but can't remember where they left the memo. It could be their bad habits or a clue.

Take some time during this round to put notes in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* so you can keep track of all the evidence you uncover.

Pause here when you've finished conversing. Once the host—either as E or as the character they're playing—concludes discussion, they will reveal whether you are the culprit.

If your number is selected, read from the "guilty" scripts provided or improvise around them. If your number is not selected, portray the character using the "innocent" scripts or improvise around that information. Remember, you cannot lie but you can be evasive.

The host—either as E or by playing the recording—will prompt you to begin the next round.

Sieving the secrets

Now that you've learned more about the other stakeholders—as well as what they know about the site and you—decide which character(s) you'd like to interrogate in front of everyone. During this round, you can only ask one person, one question and you can't pick the person who asked you a question or someone who has already been asked a question, so be clever and strategic!

Feel free to use the scripted questions below, which are based on the suspicious behaviors you witnessed. You may also create your own question based on the other observations you've made and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* from the preceding rounds. Remember, only the stakeholders present in the room could have done it.

> **Looking for someone suspicious:** *Who might be interested in bringing more money to the town and potentially said so on the radio?*
>
> **You know this person was doing something odd:** *Jetson, do you mind telling everyone about that note you were writing Al about moving the object, why would you need to do that?*

When another character questions you, you cannot lie but you can be evasive. If they ask you their suggested question, the following is your answer to it. You may choose to read it verbatim or improvise around it.

> **If innocent:** *It bothered me that the current narrative that Jetson's sharing about the rosary focuses on how "rare" and "special" it is rather than placing it in context, such as how it might be a product or byproduct of forced labor at the site.*
>
> **If guilty:** *I am so tired of "rare" artifact narratives. While an example of blended cultural practice, the rosary shouldn't overshadow the serious problems that came from missionization in Florida and elsewhere on the continent, such as the use of forced or captive Indigenous and African labor.*

If another character asks you a question where the suggested response does not make sense, answer it as truthfully as you can based on what you know or suspect. It's a great chance to share something you'd like others to know about or to deflect attention to someone else.

Pause here until all players have asked and answered a question. As you listen to the other stakeholders, add details to your catalog. Once the questioning round concludes, the host will give you the option of continuing the questioning or proceeding to accusations, so pay attention and decide what you'd like to do.

Refining the results

The group will vote on whether they'd like to do another round of questioning or if they'd like to move on to accusations. Use what you've learned and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* to guide your choice and vote accordingly.

If the group decides to do another round of questions, refer to the preceding scripts for suggested responses and questions for this *optional* round of questioning. You may need to improvise, as a lot of information has already been shared.

Otherwise, the group will proceed to the next round.

Once you complete the additional round or if the group decides to proceed without a second round of questioning, review your catalog in preparation for the accusation round. The host will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Accusing the Archaeological absconder!

Now that you've got as many observations out of other players as you can, it's time to decide who to accuse. Use what you learned and recorded in your catalog to guide your choice and fill out the following:

The Artifact Absconder Accusation Log

Suspect	Motive

You can then use the following template for your accusation.

I accuse...

of removing the recently discovered rosary from the *Santa Teresa Mission* because...

Keep your explanation brief as you will need to share it with everyone and they will all need to share theirs as well.

Once you've written your accusation, wait until E prompts you to share it with the group.

Now, it's your chance to reveal who you think rehoused the rosary! E will tell the group how to begin the accusation section. When it's your turn, read your accusation and its subsequent explanation.

Your host will take note of who gets the most accusations and tally those up for the final reveal! You can also keep track of who accused who, or how many accusations were made against each player in your catalog.

Pause again until all players have read their accusations. Then, the host as E - or by playing the recordings - will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Innocently *in situ* or Guilty as grindstone

Once everyone has stated who they think did think wandered away with the artifact it's time for the reveal. E will say their peace and then the host will begin having people perform their speeches. This round uses your assigned numbers and will begin either with the number right after—or right before—the number drawn after *Digging the Dirt*, which indicated the guilty party.

Speeches will then proceed in the sequence, leaving the selected stealer for last. When it's your turn please read, or improvise around, the provided speech depending on whether you were or not the guilty party.

> **If innocent:** *I don't study Spanish Florida directly and although it bothers me that scholars have paid little attention to the role captive Africans and Indigenous people played at building such sites, I think future generations of Black and accomplice scholars are making progress illuminating that history so I don't need to remove a rosary to prove a point.*
>
> **If guilty:** *After hearing the sensational rhetoric Jetson and many locals used for the rosary, I was appalled by the way that they refused to acknowledge the context of the mission as a place that likely relied on the labor of captive Africans and Indigenous people. I thought that if I removed this sensational find, temporarily, Jetson and some of their colleagues would come to their senses and realize that the wonder of creolization or hybridization that the rosary represented was grounded in a context of captivity, enslavement, and power as much as cultural exchange.*

Once the robber is revealed, anyone who accurately accused them wins the game. If they were only subtly suspicious, and no one accused them, the artifact absconder wins the game. E will have a few concluding words but there's nothing more for you to do now!

After the game

Once the recording, or the host as E, reads their concluding remarks, the game ends. By reaching Round Five, you will have developed your data literacy skills by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with the data provided through the game to discover the artifact absconder.Now that you've played *A Glorious Mystery*, take a chance to reflect how the game flexed your data literacy dexterity and consider how you might apply those skills again in the future.

If you desire (or require) some structure for your reflection, consider responding to the questions posed in **Part Two: The discussion guide** to aid your reflection of the game. Or explore the suggested materials from the beginning of the script using ***Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R*** or ***Of Mycenaean Men: Part Five*** to develop your data literacy dexterity or explore **museum collections**, **public libraries**, or even **keyword** or **project** search Open Context to learn more. With that we hope you enjoy playing *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*!

References and further reading

The following is a list of hyperlinked references from this player's guide. These are presented in order of appearance and do not repeat the full references for the character included under suggested materials. If any URLs in this Digital Data Story navigate to a broken page please check the **Wayback Machine** for an archived copy of the material.

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Learn more about the saint whose name we use for our fictitious mission–Teresa of Avila–on her Wikipedia page: **https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Teresa_of_%C3%81vila**

"TTRPG Safety Toolkit: A Quick Reference Guide" by Kienna Shaw (2023) **https://web.archive.org/web/20231127094204/https://i.4pcdn.org/tg/1583202183294.pdf**

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Acknowledgements

This Digital Data Story is a collaboration between its authors, our testing audiences, and the staff of AAI/OC. We are grateful to those who participated in our alpha playthrough of the game at the First Conference on Public Archaeology hosted by the Florida Public Archaeology Network Conference. These wonderful folks helped us test a prototype of this Digital Data Story and have been waiting for its release since then. We thank you for your patience as we reworked the game. We are also indebted to Katie Brewer for her help bringing gulf coast Florida to life in this approximation of the region. We also appreciate the work of the primary investigators of the *Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data* project, Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle who provide an excellent resource for comparing and learning about Spanish Missions in Florida.

The Data Stories are part of the overarching Data Literacy Program, with support from a National Endowment for the Humanities Challenge Award and a grant from the Mellon Foundation (2021-2025). Any views, findings, conclusions, or recommendations expressed in this work do not necessarily represent those of the National Endowment for the Humanities or the Mellon Foundation.

Player's guide overview

1. Introduction
2. Developing data literacy through role-play
3. How to play
4. Character background
5. Playing round scripts (don't read until asked to do so)
6. References and further readings
7. Credits
8. Acknowledgements

Estimated time to read this guide: 15 Minutes (do not read script ahead of time)

Estimated preparation time: Up to the player

Estimated play time: 1 - 3 hours depending on group size

Introduction

Welcome to the **Digital Data Stories** of the **Alexandria Archive Institute** and **Open Context**! This guide includes everything that you'll need to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery* as your assigned character and develop your data literacy. If you're also hosting the game, we encourage you to read the **hosting guide** to learn how to facilitate gameplay.

This game explores archaeological stakeholders and their relationship to archaeological data. This player's guide and script explains how the game cultivates data literacy, how to prepare to play, and the scripts for your character. This script includes character-specific background materials to use to learn more about the stakeholder you will or have portrayed.

Developing data literacy through role-play

By playing *A Glorious Mystery*, you'll develop your data literacy by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with data through the game. You'll use your **Character Background** to understand their relationship with archaeology and archaeological data and possibly learn more from their suggested sources. To delve deeper into your designated character, you can also read, respond and reflect on questions from Part Two: The discussion guide.

During the game, you'll role-play as your stakeholder, arguing their aims or communicating their conclusions using the background information and script as "raw data" that inform that archetype's actions. While playing as your character to argue and communicate, you'll use your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*** to formalize your observations into data about the other suspicious stakeholders. There you can record your recollections and use the catalog to read, work with, and analyze the data that the other characters cough up to come to the conclusion for who stole the rosary.

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The table tailors the traits you should note to: Suspect, Motive, Your Evidence, Verdict, and Times Accused By. The spaces for "Suspect" and "Motive" are where you should create and read data by documenting what the other stakeholders say about themselves and the other characters. Then, you'll work with the data by examining "Your Evidence" to see patterns. For the "Verdict," you should analyze the data and decide if that particular character is the guilty party. Lastly, in "Times Accused By" you can record and tally the accusations leveraged against yours and the others.

You'll use your complete catalog to decide who to inscribe into your Artifact Absconder Accusation Log and formulate an argument, drawing from your evidence, to come to a conclusion. Then, during the penultimate round of play, you'll communicate your argument. Regardless of whether you conclude correctly, you'll use all five components of data literacy to accuse an archaeological absconder.

To further cultivate these skills, explore your suggested stakeholder sources. If you desire (or require) guidance use **Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R** or **Of Mycenaean Men - Part Five** to learn how to work with structured tabular data or conduct a **keyword** or **project** search of Open Context, **explore museum collections**, or **public libraries** to find more archaeological sources. You can also continue the conversation with **Part Two: The discussion guide** where you'll find questions about archaeology, ethics, and data to engage with and further cultivate your arguing and communicating skills.

How to play

This section explains how to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*. It begins by explaining the mystery. Following that, we provide some tips on role-play and then conclude with a synopsis of each round of play.

The mystery

> *Beadbeachville, a seaside town in Florida, is excited for the excavation season! Well, at least those visiting, watching, and working at the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission Site *are excited. First identified in the late 1970s, a new team of archaeologists has returned to the site for the last few years to uncover, recover, and preserve what remains. They've been excitedly excavating because while this Spanish colonial period Catholic religious outpost — also known as a mission — sat far from the beach when it was active, climate change related events – like more intense and regular hurricanes, sea-level rise, and soil erosion – have moved it to the water's edge. Because of that, salvage archaeology is an urgent part of the project. Beyond those threats to site integrity though, the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission *is also a fantastic blend of cultural materials from all over the region and the excavation has run smoothly for years.*
>
> *Until now. Typically, the excavation uncovered belongings (often discussed as "artifacts") that fascinated archaeologists and local history buffs, but bored tourists. This season though, the team recovered an almost completely intact set of Catholic prayer beads. Called a rosary and used for both personal and group religious practice, this artifact was strung with beads made using an Indigenous style! The discovery of the piece, at a site that also included evidence for captive African and Indigenous labor, provided an intriguing example of creolization for the region. However, before a specialist could be called in to examine the rosary and its beads in more detail, a local TV and radio show host, who happened to be at the site during the discovery, broke the news to the whole county. Tourism doubled overnight and now, to everyone's dismay, that find has disappeared! How could this happen? Did a tourist think the storage facility was a gift shop? Was it sequestered away for extra safe keeping? Did someone simply make a data entry error? Or did* You *wander away with it? An Archaeological Investigator, Ellis Thyx, has been sent to facilitate solving the mystery.*

Your host may play this character or represent them through digital recordings, with the host as their assistant. As a reminder, the town, archaeological site, mystery, and the title of "archaeological investigator" though based on places in Gulf Coast Florida, similar archaeological sites, and a kind of crime that does happen, are entirely fictitious. However, Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada, whom the fictitious mission is named, is a real Saint. Learn more about her **here**.

Role-playing tips

The Archaeological Investigator narrowed down the concerned culprits down to the people in attendance. This means that while you've seen people acting suspicious, if they're not there, they definitely didn't do it. That means you'll need to listen to the other players closely to search out the suspect or use what you've observed to distract your colleagues.

If you lack experience with role-play, stick to the included scripts. You'll get a chance to improvise in a low stakes way during Round Two and if you feel comfortable, feel free to add more improvisation as the game goes on. If you are experienced with role-play use your script and background materials as ways to ground your improvised dialogue. Regardless, remember to read from, or incorporate, your “innocent” or “guilty” script depending on whether you are the culprit during your playthrough. You may choose not to answer a question, but must tell the truth.

The Rounds

The game will be played in a series of rounds. The following summarizes how to play each round. If you're confused, ask your host to re-explain the rules before beginning or request a pause to the game before proceeding.

Round	**Explanation**
Zero	This is an out-of-character, pre-game discussion where players and host establish boundaries for play such as level of comfort with improvisation and a way to pause the game for any reason.
One - *Incised Introductions*	This is a scripted round where you'll read or improvise around your character's introduction and begin using your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities.*
Two - *Digging up the Dirt*	This is an improvised round where you will talk with other characters to dig up more dirt on the other suspects, adding to your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*. The host will end this round by drawing the number of one character to embroil them as the enigmatic embezzler. If your number is drawn, read or improvise around your guilty scripts. If not, follow your innocent scripts.
Three - *Sieving through the Secrets*	This is a scripted questioning round where you learn more about each character's movements or motives by improvising around or reading your scripted question or answer. Once everyone has been asked and answered a question, the group will vote to do another round of questioning. If the group decides to do another round, see the note for the expansion, otherwise skip to *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!* *Expansion - Refining the Results* This round is the same as the third round but when it concludes you'll proceed directly to the next round.
Round four - *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!*	This is the accusation round. Review your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities,* decide individual verdicts, and then list who you think did it in your *Artifact Absconder Accusation Log*. Use this to fill out a standard scripted accusation, or improvise around it. Then each player will read their accusation. You can keep track of these in your catalog.
Round five - *Innocently in situ or Guilty as grindstone*	This is the scripted confessions round, which aims to unmask the mysterious material culture mover. When your number comes up, read, or improvise around, your innocent or guilty script as appropriate.

Michael B. Alturna

Here is some background on your character, explaining who they are, what they know, and suggested materials you can read ahead of time, or after the game, to learn more about the stakeholder archetype you will, or have, portrayed. Following this character background are instructions for how much of the script you can read before playing.

Character notes and suggested background materials

Stakeholder archetype	This is the accomplice character for the African American/Black descendant community member with ties to Florida.
Character description	You are an alternative, accomplice, or ally character of Dr. michaels, the African American/Black descendant community member whose family came from Florida. You're one of their non-Black graduate students and are also an archaeologist exploring the lives of captive Africans in a variety of colonial contexts. While you focus on Louisiana, you've paid regular attention to work going on in Florida as a comparative context, following in your mentor's footsteps.
Your relationship to the site	comes from a desire to help your advisor with their work comparing the lives of captive Africans and Indigenous people under different colonial regimes. You see the rosary as distracting from this uglier part of the history of Catholic missions in Spanish Florida.
You're hiding the fact that...	you are visiting the site to see if it will be a good comparison for the work you're doing under Dr. michaels in Louisiana. Dr. michaels may or may not be in town also visiting their family.
Someone observed you...	complaining and possibly discussing with others about how "sensational" the narrative around the rosary was and that it was distracting from the important issues that the site could be addressing, like the use of captive and forced labor to sustain and build the mission.
You noticed someone else...	on the local radio talking about the rosary and how showing the physical object to state lawmakers might bring in more money for the town.
You witnessed...	Jetson admit that they'd written a memo to Al about wanting to take the rosary offsite, but can't remember where they left the memo. It could be their bad habits or a clue.
Suggested character reference materials	This character is named after Dr. Michael Blakey a prominent African American Archaeologist - **https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Michael_Blakey_(anthropologist)** Cane River: The archaeology of "free people of colour" in colonial Louisiana" by Kevin MacDonald, David Morgan, and Fiona Handley - **http://dx.doi.org/10.5334/ai.0615** Creating freedom: Material culture and African American identity at Oakley Plantation, Louisiana, 1840-1950 by Laurie A. Wilkie - **https://archive.org/details/creatingfreedomm0000wilk** You can also explore the related materials for Dr. Michaels as well.

You can read the next two pages before playing. The first is your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities***, where you will record what you know about the other characters. You'll want to return to this page to note new observations made during the game to help decide who committed the rosary robbery and track accusations.

The page after that is ***Round One - Incised Introductions***. You may read through your scripted introduction and the reminder of your personal secret. The scripts are an example of how your character might talk. You can read the script exactly or improvise around it as you feel comfortable. At the bottom of that page are directions that tell you to stop reading. Please follow these directions to maintain in-game suspense.

Lastly, your host should have given you a number with your character assignment or you will pick one at the start of play. Keep that handy for the end of *Round Two - Digging up the Dirt*, so you know whether you're guilty or innocent during the game.

Catalog of Culprit Capabilities

Suspect	Motive	Your Evidence	Verdict	Times Accused By

Incised Introductions

During this round, you will introduce yourself to your fellow stakeholders by reading the following script or using it as a guide for an improvised introduction. You may embody the character however you wish, but don't add any more information or details beyond the introduction right now. Let the others get to know you over the next few rounds.

> *Michael if you please. I'm here on a short vacation checking out the mission as my advisor suggested that it was a beautiful place and possibly might make for a useful comparative site for my dissertation research.*

The following is a narrative version of your motivations, suspicions, and secrets as they relate to the site. You'll want to draw from this and your character notes during subsequent rounds but don't add any of this to your introduction. Also, keep some of this as secret as you can so you don't incriminate yourself as the rosary robber! But beware, you may not be the only one who knows about them. No one's as subtle as they think they are.

> *As an archaeologist who specializes in captive African Labor in Louisiana, you were intrigued to learn about mission sites in the town near where your advisor grew up, and decided to see what's going on in the area. Dr. michaels suggested it might make for a good comparison site in your dissertation research. The day that you decided to go on the site tour, which your advisor may or may not also have attended except as* archaeologist incognito*, you were frustrated because all Dr. Grantmunny seemed to talk about was the rosary. It was one of those typical sensationalist narratives with words like "rare," "unique," "one-of-a-kind," and "priceless" thrown around like pollen in spring. The tour definitely did not give you enough of an idea about whether the site would make for a good comparison site for your work in Louisiana because it never even mentioned the presence of captive Africans or Indigenous people. You didn't want to leave this trip empty handed though so you decided, because you had met Dr. Grantmunny at the Southeastern Archaeological Conference (SEAC), you would ask to talk with them (or potentially tag along with your mentor as they also had serious questions about the site's narrative). Y'all grab coffee at* Mission: Meals *to discuss the site and the public tour. While discussing the site, Dr. Grantmunny admitted to writing, and losing, a memo about moving the rosary. They worry it could be incriminating, which you'd agree with, but it also confirms the social media rumors that Dr. Grantmunny always…needed more grant money due to their "limited" logistical and organizational skills. While the conversation with Dr. Grantmunny made you feel confident that the* Santa Teresa Mission *would be a good comparative site for your dissertation, you could already see the influence the public narrative was having on the community. A local radio show you caught part of left all the real history and archaeology about the mission out, focusing instead on how the rosary might bring more economic development to town. You didn't like the implication that the public only cared about the site if they ignored the lives of captive Indigenous and African people.*

Pause here until everyone has introduced themselves. The host as the character Ellis Thyx, just E for short, the Archaeological Investigator—or by playing the recording of E—will prompt you to proceed to the next page and round of the game.

Digging up the Dirt

This round your goal is to see what your fellow ethically-ambiguous allies know about the disappearance of the rosary and if they know anything about you. Be as subtle as you can because, as you inquire, these other observations could help you decide whose behavior was the most suspicious. As a reminder, here are some things that you've seen going on around Beadbeachville that you might want to ask the other stakeholders about.

You noticed someone else...	on the local radio talking about the rosary and how showing the physical object to state lawmakers might bring in more money for the town.
You witnessed...	Jetson admit that they'd written a memo to Al about wanting to take the rosary offsite, but can't remember where they left the memo. It could be their bad habits or a clue.

Take some time during this round to put notes in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* so you can keep track of all the evidence you uncover.

Pause here when you've finished conversing. Once the host—either as E or as the character they're playing—concludes discussion, they will reveal whether you are the culprit.

If your number is selected, read from the "guilty" scripts provided or improvise around them. If your number is not selected, portray the character using the "innocent" scripts or improvise around that information. Remember, you cannot lie but you can be evasive.

The host—either as E or by playing the recording—will prompt you to begin the next round.

Sieving the secrets

Now that you've learned more about the other stakeholders—as well as what they know about the site and you—decide which character(s) you'd like to interrogate in front of everyone. During this round, you can only ask one person, one question and you can't pick the person who asked you a question or someone who has already been asked a question, so be clever and strategic!

Feel free to use the scripted questions below, which are based on the suspicious behaviors you witnessed. You may also create your own question based on the other observations you've made and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* from the preceding rounds. Remember, only the stakeholders present in the room could have done it.

> **Looking for someone suspicious:** *Talking about an important and easy to find site on the radio might encourage looting. Do you know anyone who might think that more money in town would offset that kind of danger to the site?*
>
> **You know this person was doing something odd:** *Dr. Grantmunny, why did you write a memo talking about moving the artifact? That's such an unprofessional thing to ask your advisee to do!*

When another character questions you, you cannot lie but you can be evasive. If they ask you their suggested question, the following is your answer to it. You may choose to read it verbatim or improvise around it.

> **If innocent:** *It takes so much effort to get the public to understand that archaeologists care about the mundane and the everyday, not just the unique. So it annoyed me that Dr. Grantmunny used that "rare" and "special" kind of language when talking about the rosary. Exceptionalizing narratives like that make it really difficult to even imply that the rosary might be a product or byproduct of forced labor at the site or actually a piece that, while rarely preserved, was part of a mundane activity.*
>
> **If guilty:** *Sure. Yeah. The rosary is a cool example of blended cultural practice but we can't let some sort of proto-melting pot narrative gloss over that fact that missionization in Florida, and elsewhere on the continent, was not a peaceful meeting of cultures but one that relied on forced and captive Indigenous and African labor and other kinds of violence.*

If another character asks you a question where the suggested response does not make sense, answer it as truthfully as you can based on what you know or suspect. It's a great chance to share something you'd like others to know about or to deflect attention to someone else.

Pause here until all players have asked and answered a question. As you listen to the other stakeholders, add details to your catalog. Once the questioning round concludes, the host will give you the option of continuing the questioning or proceeding to accusations, so pay attention and decide what you'd like to do.

Refining the results

The group will vote on whether they'd like to do another round of questioning or if they'd like to move on to accusations. Use what you've learned and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* to guide your choice and vote accordingly.

If the group decides to do another round of questions, refer to the preceding scripts for suggested responses and questions for this *optional* round of questioning. You may need to improvise, as a lot of information has already been shared.

Otherwise, the group will proceed to the next round.

Once you complete the additional round or if the group decides to proceed without a second round of questioning, review your catalog in preparation for the accusation round. The host will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Accusing the Archaeological absconder!

Now that you've got as many observations out of other players as you can, it's time to decide who to accuse. Use what you learned and recorded in your catalog to guide your choice and fill out the following:

The Artifact Absconder Accusation Log

Suspect	Motive

You can then use the following template for your accusation.

I accuse...

of removing the recently discovered rosary from the *Santa Teresa Mission* because...

Keep your explanation brief as you will need to share it with everyone and they will all need to share theirs as well.

Once you've written your accusation, wait until E prompts you to share it with the group.

Now, it's your chance to reveal who you think rehoused the rosary! E will tell the group how to begin the accusation section. When it's your turn, read your accusation and its subsequent explanation.

Your host will take note of who gets the most accusations and tally those up for the final reveal! You can also keep track of who accused who, or how many accusations were made against each player in your catalog.

Pause again until all players have read their accusations. Then, the host as E - or by playing the recordings - will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Innocently *in situ* or Guilty as grindstone

Once everyone has stated who they think did think wandered away with the artifact it's time for the reveal. E will say their peace and then the host will begin having people perform their speeches. This round uses your assigned numbers and will begin either with the number right after—or right before—the number drawn after *Digging the Dirt*, which indicated the guilty party.

Speeches will then proceed in the sequence, leaving the selected stealer for last. When it's your turn please read, or improvise around, the provided speech depending on whether you were or not the guilty party.

> **If innocent:** *While Spanish Florida provides an interesting point of comparison for my work exploring the role captive Africans and Indigenous people played at Mission sites, by taking the rosary I would prevent local communities from learning about it and, if I wanted to study it, I'd do formal loan rather than remove it.*
>
> **If guilty:** *I've learned a lot from Dr. michaels about how context grounds archaeological narratives and was frustrated by the way that Dr. Grantmunny and the local news talked about the rosary as if Dr. Grantmunny smote the ground and out appeared this miraculous belonging. I hoped that by removing the rosary, temporarily, that Dr. Grantmunny and their team would realize how negative such a narrative was and reconsider the rosary as both emblematic of creolization and hybridization but also something borne of colonialism and captive labor.*

Once the robber is revealed, anyone who accurately accused them wins the game. If they were only subtly suspicious, and no one accused them, the artifact absconder wins the game. E will have a few concluding words but there's nothing more for you to do now!

After the game

Once the recording, or the host as E, reads their concluding remarks, the game ends. By reaching Round Five, you will have developed your data literacy skills by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with the data provided through the game to discover the artifact absconder.Now that you've played *A Glorious Mystery*, take a chance to reflect how the game flexed your data literacy dexterity and consider how you might apply those skills again in the future.

If you desire (or require) some structure for your reflection, consider responding to the questions posed in **Part Two: The discussion guide** to aid your reflection of the game. Or explore the suggested materials from the beginning of the script using ***Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R*** or ***Of Mycenaean Men: Part Five*** to develop your data literacy dexterity or explore **museum collections**, **public libraries**, or even **keyword** or **project** search Open Context to learn more. With that we hope you enjoy playing *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*!

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Acknowledgements

This Digital Data Story is a collaboration between its authors, our testing audiences, and the staff of AAI/OC. We are grateful to those who participated in our alpha playthrough of the game at the First Conference on Public Archaeology hosted by the Florida Public Archaeology Network Conference. These wonderful folks helped us test a prototype of this Digital Data Story and have been waiting for its release since then. We thank you for your patience as we reworked the game. We are also indebted to Katie Brewer for her help bringing gulf coast Florida to life in this approximation of the region. We also appreciate the work of the primary investigators of the *Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data* project, Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle who provide an excellent resource for comparing and learning about Spanish Missions in Florida.

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Player's guide overview

1. Introduction
2. Developing data literacy through role-play
3. How to play
4. Character background
5. Playing round scripts (don't read until asked to do so)
6. References and further readings
7. Credits
8. Acknowledgements

Estimated time to read this guide: 15 Minutes (do not read script ahead of time)

Estimated preparation time: Up to the player

Estimated play time: 1 - 3 hours depending on group size

Introduction

Welcome to the **Digital Data Stories** of the **Alexandria Archive Institute** and **Open Context**! This guide includes everything that you'll need to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery* as your assigned character and develop your data literacy. If you're also hosting the game, we encourage you to read the **hosting guide** to learn how to facilitate gameplay.

This game explores archaeological stakeholders and their relationship to archaeological data. This player's guide and script explains how the game cultivates data literacy, how to prepare to play, and the scripts for your character. This script includes character-specific background materials to use to learn more about the stakeholder you will or have portrayed.

Developing data literacy through role-play

By playing *A Glorious Mystery*, you'll develop your data literacy by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with data through the game. You'll use your **Character Background** to understand their relationship with archaeology and archaeological data and possibly learn more from their suggested sources. To delve deeper into your designated character, you can also read, respond and reflect on questions from Part Two: The discussion guide.

During the game, you'll role-play as your stakeholder, arguing their aims or communicating their conclusions using the background information and script as "raw data" that inform that archetype's actions. While playing as your character to argue and communicate, you'll use your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*** to formalize your observations into data about the other suspicious stakeholders. There you can record your recollections and use the catalog to read, work with, and analyze the data that the other characters cough up to come to the conclusion for who stole the rosary.

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The table tailors the traits you should note to: Suspect, Motive, Your Evidence, Verdict, and Times Accused By. The spaces for "Suspect" and "Motive" are where you should create and read data by documenting what the other stakeholders say about themselves and the other characters. Then, you'll work with the data by examining "Your Evidence" to see patterns. For the "Verdict," you should analyze the data and decide if that particular character is the guilty party. Lastly, in "Times Accused By" you can record and tally the accusations leveraged against yours and the others.

You'll use your complete catalog to decide who to inscribe into your Artifact Absconder Accusation Log and formulate an argument, drawing from your evidence, to come to a conclusion. Then, during the penultimate round of play, you'll communicate your argument. Regardless of whether you conclude correctly, you'll use all five components of data literacy to accuse an archaeological absconder.

To further cultivate these skills, explore your suggested stakeholder sources. If you desire (or require) guidance use **Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R** or **Of Mycenaean Men - Part Five** to learn how to work with structured tabular data or conduct a **keyword** or **project** search of Open Context, **explore museum collections**, or **public libraries** to find more archaeological sources. You can also continue the conversation with **Part Two: The discussion guide** where you'll find questions about archaeology, ethics, and data to engage with and further cultivate your arguing and communicating skills.

How to play

This section explains how to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*. It begins by explaining the mystery. Following that, we provide some tips on role-play and then conclude with a synopsis of each round of play.

The mystery

> *Beadbeachville, a seaside town in Florida, is excited for the excavation season! Well, at least those visiting, watching, and working at the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission Site *are excited. First identified in the late 1970s, a new team of archaeologists has returned to the site for the last few years to uncover, recover, and preserve what remains. They've been excitedly excavating because while this Spanish colonial period Catholic religious outpost — also known as a mission — sat far from the beach when it was active, climate change related events – like more intense and regular hurricanes, sea-level rise, and soil erosion – have moved it to the water's edge. Because of that, salvage archaeology is an urgent part of the project. Beyond those threats to site integrity though, the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission *is also a fantastic blend of cultural materials from all over the region and the excavation has run smoothly for years.*
>
> *Until now. Typically, the excavation uncovered belongings (often discussed as "artifacts") that fascinated archaeologists and local history buffs, but bored tourists. This season though, the team recovered an almost completely intact set of Catholic prayer beads. Called a rosary and used for both personal and group religious practice, this artifact was strung with beads made using an Indigenous style! The discovery of the piece, at a site that also included evidence for captive African and Indigenous labor, provided an intriguing example of creolization for the region. However, before a specialist could be called in to examine the rosary and its beads in more detail, a local TV and radio show host, who happened to be at the site during the discovery, broke the news to the whole county. Tourism doubled overnight and now, to everyone's dismay, that find has disappeared! How could this happen? Did a tourist think the storage facility was a gift shop? Was it sequestered away for extra safe keeping? Did someone simply make a data entry error? Or did* You *wander away with it? An Archaeological Investigator, Ellis Thyx, has been sent to facilitate solving the mystery.*

Your host may play this character or represent them through digital recordings, with the host as their assistant. As a reminder, the town, archaeological site, mystery, and the title of "archaeological investigator" though based on places in Gulf Coast Florida, similar archaeological sites, and a kind of crime that does happen, are entirely fictitious. However, Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada, whom the fictitious mission is named, is a real Saint. Learn more about her **here**.

Role-playing tips

The Archaeological Investigator narrowed down the concerned culprits down to the people in attendance. This means that while you've seen people acting suspicious, if they're not there, they definitely didn't do it. That means you'll need to listen to the other players closely to search out the suspect or use what you've observed to distract your colleagues.

If you lack experience with role-play, stick to the included scripts. You'll get a chance to improvise in a low stakes way during Round Two and if you feel comfortable, feel free to add more improvisation as the game goes on. If you are experienced with role-play use your script and background materials as ways to ground your improvised dialogue. Regardless, remember to read from, or incorporate, your “innocent” or “guilty” script depending on whether you are the culprit during your playthrough. You may choose not to answer a question, but must tell the truth.

The Rounds

The game will be played in a series of rounds. The following summarizes how to play each round. If you're confused, ask your host to re-explain the rules before beginning or request a pause to the game before proceeding.

Round	**Explanation**
Zero	This is an out-of-character, pre-game discussion where players and host establish boundaries for play such as level of comfort with improvisation and a way to pause the game for any reason.
One - *Incised Introductions*	This is a scripted round where you'll read or improvise around your character's introduction and begin using your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities.*
Two - *Digging up the Dirt*	This is an improvised round where you will talk with other characters to dig up more dirt on the other suspects, adding to your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*. The host will end this round by drawing the number of one character to embroil them as the enigmatic embezzler. If your number is drawn, read or improvise around your guilty scripts. If not, follow your innocent scripts.
Three - *Sieving through the Secrets*	This is a scripted questioning round where you learn more about each character's movements or motives by improvising around or reading your scripted question or answer. Once everyone has been asked and answered a question, the group will vote to do another round of questioning. If the group decides to do another round, see the note for the expansion, otherwise skip to *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!* *Expansion - Refining the Results* This round is the same as the third round but when it concludes you'll proceed directly to the next round.
Round four - *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!*	This is the accusation round. Review your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities,* decide individual verdicts, and then list who you think did it in your *Artifact Absconder Accusation Log*. Use this to fill out a standard scripted accusation, or improvise around it. Then each player will read their accusation. You can keep track of these in your catalog.
Round five - *Innocently in situ or Guilty as grindstone*	This is the scripted confessions round, which aims to unmask the mysterious material culture mover. When your number comes up, read, or improvise around, your innocent or guilty script as appropriate.

Durlene Cantore

Here is some background on your character, explaining who they are, what they know, and suggested materials you can read ahead of time, or after the game, to learn more about the stakeholder archetype you will, or have, portrayed. Following this character background are instructions for how much of the script you can read before playing.

Character notes and suggested background materials

Stakeholder archetype	Local news reporter who is a compassionate version of the Florida Woman.
Character description	You are a Florida Woman. Or well, at least, a woman from Florida. You grew up in Beadbeachville and despite wanting to get farther away you found yourself a local news reporter in your hometown. Maybe one of the reasons you're still there is because despite your ambition you also believe and want others to recognize how cool Beadbeachville is. So you always see the news as a chance to promote the place, its inhabitants, and its history.
Your relationship to the site	is through familiarity with it by growing up in the neighborhood and writing updates about the work there for the last few seasons for the local paper. However, you were annoyed that someone scooped your story about the rosary and intend to write a better, longer piece about it in the future.
You're hiding the fact that...	you knew the person who now calls himself Bubba, Junior, or Jim as a kid, so you know that he's not actually from Florida. When he was six he was just James and now you call him BJJ to annoy him.
Someone observed you...	smoking and leaving cigarette butts by the place that the excavation team stored the artifacts (or at least until recently) despite Al reminding you it was a no smoking zone.
You noticed someone else...	using something *other than a key* to open the storage shed. However, this was while you were smoking around the back of the storage shed during one of your visits so you didn't see them, you only heard the sounds.
You witnessed...	Emma rattle the door of the storage shed while talking about how easy it was to break into and accidentally bend open the door. This was while you were on one of the official, touristy, tours of the site.
Suggested character reference materials	Learning from Loss Project in Scotland - **https://web.archive.org/web/20211205182910/https://www.scottishinsight.ac.uk/Programmes/Scotland2030/LearningfromLoss.aspx** "Sea-level rise and archaeological site destruction: An example from the southeastern United States using DINAA (Digital Index of North American Archaeology)" by David G. Anderson, Thaddeus G. Bissett, Stephen J. Yerka, Joshua J. Wells, Eric C. Kansa, Sarah W. Kansa, Kelsey Noack Myers, R. Carl DeMuth, and Devin A. White - **https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0188142** Learn about Jim Cantore, which this character is named after, a weatherman that is infamous in the Southeast - **https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Jim_Cantore** Explore archaeologists and journalism by reading some of Dr. Kristina Killgrove's work - **https://www.livescience.com/author/kristina-killgrove**

You can read the next two pages before playing. The first is your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities***, where you will record what you know about the other characters. You'll want to return to this page to note new observations made during the game to help decide who committed the rosary robbery and track accusations.

The page after that is ***Round One - Incised Introductions***. You may read through your scripted introduction and the reminder of your personal secret. The scripts are an example of how your character might talk. You can read the script exactly or improvise around it as you feel comfortable. At the bottom of that page are directions that tell you to stop reading. Please follow these directions to maintain in-game suspense.

Lastly, your host should have given you a number with your character assignment or you will pick one at the start of play. Keep that handy for the end of Round Two - Digging up the Dirt, so you know whether you're guilty or innocent during the game.

Catalog of Culprit Capabilities

Suspect	Motive	Your Evidence	Verdict	Times Accused By

Incised Introductions

During this round, you will introduce yourself to your fellow stakeholders by reading the following script or using it as a guide for an improvised introduction. You may embody the character however you wish, but don't add any more information or details beyond the introduction right now. Let the others get to know you over the next few rounds.

> *Good morning, afternoon, or evening, you can call me Durlene, Dee, or Ms. Cantore. I've lived in Beadbeachville for the majority of my life, after returning here from Gainesville, where I got my journalism degree. Go Gators. I love covering local news here in my home town and have always been fascinated by the history of the* Santa Teresa Mission*.*

The following is a narrative version of your motivations, suspicions, and secrets as they relate to the site. You'll want to draw from this and your character notes during subsequent rounds but don't add any of this to your introduction. Also, keep some of this as secret as you can so you don't incriminate yourself as the rosary robber! But beware, you may not be the only one who knows about them. No one's as subtle as they think they are.

> *You smoke when you're on a big case, like the excavations at the mission. So you were annoyed that one of your coworkers scooped the story of the rosary, especially when you'd been spending so much time learning about the site over the last few weeks in the hopes of a big find. You've been extra stressed recently and while you've been trying to be less messy with your smokes...it doesn't always work. Al reminds you to not smoke at the site or at least to clean up after yourself. While gathering information for your story, you've chatted with Al, other members of the crew, and have even been on multiple public tours. You especially enjoy seeing how people react to those tours. The weirdest thing was probably that officer Kaup woman, who complained about security and then broke the door on the storage shed. Though that's not the only weird thing you noticed about the security shed. While you were smoking and pondering your hook for your next mission missive, you heard someone unlock the door to that same storage shed using something that did not sound like a key. You'd have said something but were doing the one thing Al told you not to do by the one place Al stressed you definitely should not do it so have kept your mouth shut...so far. You've got practice with keeping secrets though because you went to school with BJJ (aka Bubba, Junior, Jim). He doesn't like to be called BJJ but that's what you nicknamed him back in elementary school because when he introduced himself as "James" it was just too much. He's lived in Beadbeachville for a while...but you know he's from the other Gainesville (New York) and forgets basic things about his fake Florida origin story, like that the Gators are the mascot of the University of Florida, which is in the real Gainesville. You've kept his secret for a long time but you're not above using it for leverage...if you need it.*

Pause here until everyone has introduced themselves. The host as the character Ellis Thyx, just E for short, the Archaeological Investigator—or by playing the recording of E—will prompt you to proceed to the next page and round of the game.

Digging up the Dirt

This round your goal is to see what your fellow ethically-ambiguous allies know about the disappearance of the rosary and if they know anything about you. Be as subtle as you can because, as you inquire, these other observations could help you decide whose behavior was the most suspicious. As a reminder, here are some things that you've seen going on around Beadbeachville that you might want to ask the other stakeholders about.

You noticed someone else...	using something *other than a key* to open the storage shed. However, this was while you were smoking around the back of the storage shed during one of your visits so you didn't see them, you only heard the sounds.
You witnessed...	Emma rattle the door of the storage shed while talking about how easy it was to break into and accidentally bend open the door. This was while you were on one of the official, touristy, tours of the site.

Take some time during this round to put notes in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* so you can keep track of all the evidence you uncover.

Pause here when you've finished conversing. Once the host—either as E or as the character they're playing—concludes discussion, they will reveal whether you are the culprit.

If your number is selected, read from the "guilty" scripts provided or improvise around them. If your number is not selected, portray the character using the "innocent" scripts or improvise around that information. Remember, you cannot lie but you can be evasive.

The host—either as E or by playing the recording—will prompt you to begin the next round.

Sieving the secrets

Now that you've learned more about the other stakeholders—as well as what they know about the site and you—decide which character(s) you'd like to interrogate in front of everyone. During this round, you can only ask one person, one question and you can't pick the person who asked you a question or someone who has already been asked a question, so be clever and strategic!

Feel free to use the scripted questions below, which are based on the suspicious behaviors you witnessed. You may also create your own question based on the other observations you've made and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* from the preceding rounds. Remember, only the stakeholders present in the room could have done it.

> **Looking for someone suspicious:** *Do you know how to open doors without using a key or do you know anyone who can do that who might want to get into the shed?*
>
> **You know this person was doing something odd:** *Hey Emma, I know you care a lot about security, so why did you decide to bend open the door of the storage shed in front of a bunch of tourists?*

When another character questions you, you cannot lie but you can be evasive. If they ask you their suggested question, the following is your answer to it. You may choose to read it verbatim or improvise around it.

> **If innocent:** *Yes I smoke, I do it when I'm stressed out! The story of the rosary was going to be* my story *but now my piece about it needs to be even bigger, to outshine this catastrophic event and that measly introduction my coworker wrote.*
>
> **If guilty:** *Oh you caught me smoking. So, I don't always pick up my butts that's true, but I've been spending time at the site to learn more about the Mission and smoking near the facility doesn't necessarily mean I took something from it. I was learning more about the site for an upcoming article.*

If another character asks you a question where the suggested response does not make sense, answer it as truthfully as you can based on what you know or suspect. It's a great chance to share something you'd like others to know about or to deflect attention to someone else.

Pause here until all players have asked and answered a question. As you listen to the other stakeholders, add details to your catalog. Once the questioning round concludes, the host will give you the option of continuing the questioning or proceeding to accusations, so pay attention and decide what you'd like to do.

Refining the results

The group will vote on whether they'd like to do another round of questioning or if they'd like to move on to accusations. Use what you've learned and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* to guide your choice and vote accordingly.

If the group decides to do another round of questions, refer to the preceding scripts for suggested responses and questions for this *optional* round of questioning. You may need to improvise, as a lot of information has already been shared.

Otherwise, the group will proceed to the next round.

Once you complete the additional round or if the group decides to proceed without a second round of questioning, review your catalog in preparation for the accusation round. The host will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Accusing the Archaeological absconder!

Now that you've got as many observations out of other players as you can, it's time to decide who to accuse. Use what you learned and recorded in your catalog to guide your choice and fill out the following:

The Artifact Absconder Accusation Log

Suspect	Motive

You can then use the following template for your accusation.

I accuse...

of removing the recently discovered rosary from the *Santa Teresa Mission* because...

Keep your explanation brief as you will need to share it with everyone and they will all need to share theirs as well.

Once you've written your accusation, wait until E prompts you to share it with the group.

Now, it's your chance to reveal who you think rehoused the rosary! E will tell the group how to begin the accusation section. When it's your turn, read your accusation and its subsequent explanation.

Your host will take note of who gets the most accusations and tally those up for the final reveal! You can also keep track of who accused who, or how many accusations were made against each player in your catalog.

Pause again until all players have read their accusations. Then, the host as E - or by playing the recordings - will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Innocently *in situ* or Guilty as grindstone

Once everyone has stated who they think did think wandered away with the artifact it's time for the reveal. E will say their peace and then the host will begin having people perform their speeches. This round uses your assigned numbers and will begin either with the number right after—or right before—the number drawn after *Digging the Dirt*, which indicated the guilty party.

Speeches will then proceed in the sequence, leaving the selected stealer for last. When it's your turn please read, or improvise around, the provided speech depending on whether you were or not the guilty party.

> **If innocent:** *Beadbeachville is my home! I'm appalled that anyone would even think that I'd exploit its history for my career and even if I did, I know how not to leave evidence.*
>
> **If guilty:** *You've found me out. I decided to borrow the rosary so that I could write my expose and get better photographs of it for the newspaper. Once the article came out I was planning on returning it back to the site, I swear!*

Once the robber is revealed, anyone who accurately accused them wins the game. If they were only subtly suspicious, and no one accused them, the artifact absconder wins the game. E will have a few concluding words but there's nothing more for you to do now!

After the game

Once the recording, or the host as E, reads their concluding remarks, the game ends. By reaching Round Five, you will have developed your data literacy skills by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with the data provided through the game to discover the artifact absconder.Now that you've played *A Glorious Mystery*, take a chance to reflect how the game flexed your data literacy dexterity and consider how you might apply those skills again in the future.

If you desire (or require) some structure for your reflection, consider responding to the questions posed in **Part Two: The discussion guide** to aid your reflection of the game. Or explore the suggested materials from the beginning of the script using ***Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R*** or ***Of Mycenaean Men: Part Five*** to develop your data literacy dexterity or explore **museum collections**, **public libraries**, or even **keyword** or **project** search Open Context to learn more. With that we hope you enjoy playing *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*!

References and further reading

The following is a list of hyperlinked references from this player's guide. These are presented in order of appearance and do not repeat the full references for the character included under suggested materials. If any URLs in this Digital Data Story navigate to a broken page please check the **Wayback Machine** for an archived copy of the material.

Check out other Digital Data Stories here: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M74F1NW0**

Find out about the work of the Alexandria Archive Institute at: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/**

Check out Open Context for yourself here: **https://opencontext.org**

Explore Part One - The host guide at: https://doi.org/10.6078/M7GH9G20

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Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R by Paulina F. Przystupa and L. Meghan Dennis (2022): **https://doi.org/10.6078/M73N21HR**

Learn how to use a spreadsheet with *Of Myceanean Men - Part Five*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7Q81B6V**

Conduct a keyword search of Open Context using *Of Mycenaean Men - Part Four*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7TX3CHJ**

Try a project search of Open Context using *It's All in the Wrist (Bones) - Part Two*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7ZP4478**

Peruse some museum collections with the help of this article: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7S46Q2R**

Get at taste for some public library collections here: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/2025/07/10/how-to-use-the-digital-collections-of-the-nypl/**

Learn more about the saint whose name we use for our fictitious mission–Teresa of Avila–on her Wikipedia page: **https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Teresa_of_%C3%81vila**

"TTRPG Safety Toolkit: A Quick Reference Guide" by Kienna Shaw (2023) **https://web.archive.org/web/20231127094204/https://i.4pcdn.org/tg/1583202183294.pdf**

Explore Part Two at: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7B56GVG**

"Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data" by Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle (2018) **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7H70CX3**

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VERSION: 1.0
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You'll use your complete catalog to decide who to inscribe into your Artifact Absconder Accusation Log and formulate an argument, drawing from your evidence, to come to a conclusion. Then, during the penultimate round of play, you'll communicate your argument. Regardless of whether you conclude correctly, you'll use all five components of data literacy to accuse an archaeological absconder.

To further cultivate these skills, explore your suggested stakeholder sources. If you desire (or require) guidance use **Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R** or **Of Mycenaean Men - Part Five** to learn how to work with structured tabular data or conduct a **keyword** or **project** search of Open Context, **explore museum collections**, or **public libraries** to find more archaeological sources. You can also continue the conversation with **Part Two: The discussion guide** where you'll find questions about archaeology, ethics, and data to engage with and further cultivate your arguing and communicating skills.

How to play

This section explains how to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*. It begins by explaining the mystery. Following that, we provide some tips on role-play and then conclude with a synopsis of each round of play.

The mystery

> *Beadbeachville, a seaside town in Florida, is excited for the excavation season! Well, at least those visiting, watching, and working at the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission Site *are excited. First identified in the late 1970s, a new team of archaeologists has returned to the site for the last few years to uncover, recover, and preserve what remains. They've been excitedly excavating because while this Spanish colonial period Catholic religious outpost — also known as a mission — sat far from the beach when it was active, climate change related events – like more intense and regular hurricanes, sea-level rise, and soil erosion – have moved it to the water's edge. Because of that, salvage archaeology is an urgent part of the project. Beyond those threats to site integrity though, the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission *is also a fantastic blend of cultural materials from all over the region and the excavation has run smoothly for years.*
>
> *Until now. Typically, the excavation uncovered belongings (often discussed as "artifacts") that fascinated archaeologists and local history buffs, but bored tourists. This season though, the team recovered an almost completely intact set of Catholic prayer beads. Called a rosary and used for both personal and group religious practice, this artifact was strung with beads made using an Indigenous style! The discovery of the piece, at a site that also included evidence for captive African and Indigenous labor, provided an intriguing example of creolization for the region. However, before a specialist could be called in to examine the rosary and its beads in more detail, a local TV and radio show host, who happened to be at the site during the discovery, broke the news to the whole county. Tourism doubled overnight and now, to everyone's dismay, that find has disappeared! How could this happen? Did a tourist think the storage facility was a gift shop? Was it sequestered away for extra safe keeping? Did someone simply make a data entry error? Or did* You *wander away with it? An Archaeological Investigator, Ellis Thyx, has been sent to facilitate solving the mystery.*

Your host may play this character or represent them through digital recordings, with the host as their assistant. As a reminder, the town, archaeological site, mystery, and the title of "archaeological investigator" though based on places in Gulf Coast Florida, similar archaeological sites, and a kind of crime that does happen, are entirely fictitious. However, Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada, whom the fictitious mission is named, is a real Saint. Learn more about her **here**.

Role-playing tips

The Archaeological Investigator narrowed down the concerned culprits down to the people in attendance. This means that while you've seen people acting suspicious, if they're not there, they definitely didn't do it. That means you'll need to listen to the other players closely to search out the suspect or use what you've observed to distract your colleagues.

If you lack experience with role-play, stick to the included scripts. You'll get a chance to improvise in a low stakes way during Round Two and if you feel comfortable, feel free to add more improvisation as the game goes on. If you are experienced with role-play use your script and background materials as ways to ground your improvised dialogue. Regardless, remember to read from, or incorporate, your “innocent” or “guilty” script depending on whether you are the culprit during your playthrough. You may choose not to answer a question, but must tell the truth.

The Rounds

The game will be played in a series of rounds. The following summarizes how to play each round. If you're confused, ask your host to re-explain the rules before beginning or request a pause to the game before proceeding.

Round	**Explanation**
Zero	This is an out-of-character, pre-game discussion where players and host establish boundaries for play such as level of comfort with improvisation and a way to pause the game for any reason.
One - *Incised Introductions*	This is a scripted round where you'll read or improvise around your character's introduction and begin using your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities.*
Two - *Digging up the Dirt*	This is an improvised round where you will talk with other characters to dig up more dirt on the other suspects, adding to your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*. The host will end this round by drawing the number of one character to embroil them as the enigmatic embezzler. If your number is drawn, read or improvise around your guilty scripts. If not, follow your innocent scripts.
Three - *Sieving through the Secrets*	This is a scripted questioning round where you learn more about each character's movements or motives by improvising around or reading your scripted question or answer. Once everyone has been asked and answered a question, the group will vote to do another round of questioning. If the group decides to do another round, see the note for the expansion, otherwise skip to *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!* *Expansion - Refining the Results* This round is the same as the third round but when it concludes you'll proceed directly to the next round.
Round four - *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!*	This is the accusation round. Review your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities,* decide individual verdicts, and then list who you think did it in your *Artifact Absconder Accusation Log*. Use this to fill out a standard scripted accusation, or improvise around it. Then each player will read their accusation. You can keep track of these in your catalog.
Round five - *Innocently in situ or Guilty as grindstone*	This is the scripted confessions round, which aims to unmask the mysterious material culture mover. When your number comes up, read, or improvise around, your innocent or guilty script as appropriate.

Eddie G.B. or Gonzalez-Bonifay

Here is some background on your character, explaining who they are, what they know, and suggested materials you can read ahead of time, or after the game, to learn more about the stakeholder archetype you will, or have, portrayed. Following this character background are instructions for how much of the script you can read before playing.

Character notes and suggested background materials

Stakeholder archetype	A Hispanic/Latine/Latinx descendant community member with ties to Florida.
Character description	You are a Latino/Latina/Latine/Latinx/Hispanic descendant community member and archaeologist with ties to Gulf Coast Florida broadly, hence your last name, and you've explored Latino/Latina/Latine/Latinx/Hispanic sites across the state.
Your relationship to the site	is through descent/cultural affiliation with the site as an important representation of Hispanic communities and practices in this area.
You're hiding the fact that...	you know that Jetson is not good with money or very organized because you and Eddie A.T. worked with them and Jetson failed to pay the two of you on time or the correct amount because Jetson overestimated how much money was left on the grant for that project.
Someone observed you...	singing to yourself about rehousing the rosary to be with other Hispanic heritage collections and critiquing Jetson's work at the site.
You noticed someone else...	had dropped a piece of paper that you (and possibly Eddie A.T.) stepped on during the tour you attended at the site the other day. That note implied someone with access to the storage facility wanted to remove important artifacts from the site for "extra" safekeeping. You found that odd.
You witnessed...	blake or Michael B. listening very attentively to Jetson's site tour and saw them raise more than a few eyebrows when Jetson started talking about "labor" at the site. Their reactions made you and Eddie A.T. think you had an ally in your goals to consider the rosary as a valuable but contested part of Hispanic heritage.
Suggested character reference materials	Comparative Mission Archaeology Portal - **https://cmap.floridamuseum.ufl.edu/** The character's last name comes from two prominent brick making families Gonzalez and Bonifay in Pensacola Florida, hyphenated rather than a traditional Hispanic double surname - **https://blogs.ifas.ufl.edu/escambiaco/2021/12/01/weekly-what-is-it-pensacola-brick/** The character's first name comes from Eduardo Matos Moctezuma, a Mexican archaeologist - **https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Eduardo_Matos_Moctezuma** See a list of archaeology related ways to celebrate Latino/Latina/Latine/Latinx/Hispanic Heritage Month - **https://www.fpan.us/educational-resources/hispanic-latine-heritage-month-2022/** You can also explore the resources for the other Eddie, your accomplice character.

You can read the next two pages before playing. The first is your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities***, where you will record what you know about the other characters. You'll want to return to this page to note new observations made during the game to help decide who committed the rosary robbery and track accusations.

The page after that is ***Round One - Incised Introductions***. You may read through your scripted introduction and the reminder of your personal secret. The scripts are an example of how your character might talk. You can read the script exactly or improvise around it as you feel comfortable. At the bottom of that page are directions that tell you to stop reading. Please follow these directions to maintain in-game suspense.

Lastly, your host should have given you a number with your character assignment or you will pick one at the start of play. Keep that handy for the end of *Round Two - Digging up the Dirt*, so you know whether you're guilty or innocent during the game.

Catalog of Culprit Capabilities

Suspect	Motive	Your Evidence	Verdict	Times Accused By

Incised Introductions

During this round, you will introduce yourself to your fellow stakeholders by reading the following script or using it as a guide for an improvised introduction. You may embody the character however you wish, but don't add any more information or details beyond the introduction right now. Let the others get to know you over the next few rounds.

> *I'm Eddie, or Eddie G.B., I'm in town revisiting my family's ties to Beadbeachville and the surrounding area. I was hoping to see if my family could be traced all the way back to the* Santa Teresa Mission*.*

The following is a narrative version of your motivations, suspicions, and secrets as they relate to the site. You'll want to draw from this and your character notes during subsequent rounds but don't add any of this to your introduction. Also, keep some of this as secret as you can so you don't incriminate yourself as the rosary robber! But beware, you may not be the only one who knows about them. No one's as subtle as they think they are.

> *You consider the* Santa Teresa Mission *an important part of Hispanic heritage. For you though, important heritage means celebrating good things and atoning for bad ones. You are aware that not everyone in your community, or in archaeology, feels that way. You've been wondering about that archaeology part when you found out Jetson Grantmunny was managing the mission because you know they're bad with managing most things. For example, on a different mission site he overestimated the amount of money left in a grant and then failed to pay you and your buddy Eddie Al Terneight (Eddie A.T.) on time and the right amount. That was on top of being pretty disorganized throughout that whole project. It was that site though that you taught Eddie A.T. your handy mnemonic song writing habit. On the other side of responsible archaeology is Dr. blake michaels, and potentially their student Michael B. Alturna, whose work you've read and that you recognized from the Southeastern Archaeology Conference (SEAC). You noticed blake, and/or his student, reacting strongly to the narrative Jetson told about the labor that built the mission, especially the way Jetson framed (or forgot to mention) the lives of captive Indigenous and African people undering Spanish colonization. They, as well as you and Eddie A.T., did not appreciate the uncritical narrative Jetson was sharing with the public. On that same tour, you stepped on a piece of paper where someone had written to themselves (or possibly to someone else) about wanting to keep the rosary "extra safe". It was weird and you tried to remember to ask someone about it later, using that mnemonic song writing habit. While you were on that tour, and possibly a few other places around town, you started singing to yourself. It began as a study technique for you during your undergraduate work undergrad but now it's just a habit. You sing about basically everything, including how good you think someone's archaeological work is (such as when you were on the site), remembering to ask about the note, about the potential for a pan-Florida exhibit or collection of Hispanic/Latine/Latinx belongings like the rosary, and being impatient about getting seated at diners (like when you visited places like* Mission: Meals*). It's unconscious so you often forget you're doing it.*

Pause here until everyone has introduced themselves. The host as the character Ellis Thyx, just E for short, the Archaeological Investigator—or by playing the recording of E—will prompt you to proceed to the next page and round of the game.

Digging up the Dirt

This round your goal is to see what your fellow ethically-ambiguous allies know about the disappearance of the rosary and if they know anything about you. Be as subtle as you can because, as you inquire, these other observations could help you decide whose behavior was the most suspicious. As a reminder, here are some things that you've seen going on around Beadbeachville that you might want to ask the other stakeholders about.

You noticed someone else...	had dropped a piece of paper that you (and possibly Eddie A.T.) stepped on during the tour you attended at the site the other day. That note implied someone with access to the storage facility wanted to remove important artifacts from the site for "extra" safekeeping. You found that odd.
You witnessed...	blake or Michael B. listening very attentively to Jetson's site tour and saw them raise more than a few eyebrows when Jetson started talking about "labor" at the site. Their reactions made you and Eddie A.T. think you had an ally in your goals to consider the rosary as a valuable but contested part of Hispanic heritage.

Take some time during this round to put notes in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* so you can keep track of all the evidence you uncover.

Pause here when you've finished conversing. Once the host—either as E or as the character they're playing—concludes discussion, they will reveal whether you are the culprit.

If your number is selected, read from the "guilty" scripts provided or improvise around them. If your number is not selected, portray the character using the "innocent" scripts or improvise around that information. Remember, you cannot lie but you can be evasive.

The host—either as E or by playing the recording—will prompt you to begin the next round.

Sieving the secrets

Now that you've learned more about the other stakeholders—as well as what they know about the site and you—decide which character(s) you'd like to interrogate in front of everyone. During this round, you can only ask one person, one question and you can't pick the person who asked you a question or someone who has already been asked a question, so be clever and strategic!

Feel free to use the scripted questions below, which are based on the suspicious behaviors you witnessed. You may also create your own question based on the other observations you've made and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* from the preceding rounds. Remember, only the stakeholders present in the room could have done it.

> **Looking for someone suspicious:** *I found a note on the tour about someone wanting to remove the rosary from the site for "extra" safekeeping. Do you know anything about that or what that might entail?*
>
> **You know this person was doing something odd:** *Dr. michaels (and/or Michael B.) I've read some of your (or your advisor's) work on captive Africans in Louisiana and you seemed particularly bothered by the narrative of the recent tour we were on, can you tell us more about that?*

When another character questions you, you cannot lie but you can be evasive. If they ask you their suggested question, the following is your answer to it. You may choose to read it verbatim or improvise around it.

> **If innocent:** *Oh you caught that? Well, I'm sorry you had to suffer through those improvised bars. It's how I process my thoughts when I consider important problems. Particularly when it comes to archaeological narratives and complex curation approaches.*
>
> **If guilty:** *I prefer not to admit to it but yes, I do sometimes sing archaeology songs that I make up. I want to emphasize though that those songs are for me. Why were you listening to my personal and private song? And when did you hear it?*

If another character asks you a question where the suggested response does not make sense, answer it as truthfully as you can based on what you know or suspect. It's a great chance to share something you'd like others to know about or to deflect attention to someone else.

Pause here until all players have asked and answered a question. As you listen to the other stakeholders, add details to your catalog. Once the questioning round concludes, the host will give you the option of continuing the questioning or proceeding to accusations, so pay attention and decide what you'd like to do.

Refining the results

The group will vote on whether they'd like to do another round of questioning or if they'd like to move on to accusations. Use what you've learned and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* to guide your choice and vote accordingly.

If the group decides to do another round of questions, refer to the preceding scripts for suggested responses and questions for this *optional* round of questioning. You may need to improvise, as a lot of information has already been shared.

Otherwise, the group will proceed to the next round.

Once you complete the additional round or if the group decides to proceed without a second round of questioning, review your catalog in preparation for the accusation round. The host will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Accusing the Archaeological absconder!

Now that you've got as many observations out of other players as you can, it's time to decide who to accuse. Use what you learned and recorded in your catalog to guide your choice and fill out the following:

The Artifact Absconder Accusation Log

Suspect	Motive

You can then use the following template for your accusation.

I accuse...

of removing the recently discovered rosary from the *Santa Teresa Mission* because...

Keep your explanation brief as you will need to share it with everyone and they will all need to share theirs as well.

Once you've written your accusation, wait until E prompts you to share it with the group.

Now, it's your chance to reveal who you think rehoused the rosary! E will tell the group how to begin the accusation section. When it's your turn, read your accusation and its subsequent explanation.

Your host will take note of who gets the most accusations and tally those up for the final reveal! You can also keep track of who accused who, or how many accusations were made against each player in your catalog.

Pause again until all players have read their accusations. Then, the host as E - or by playing the recordings - will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Innocently *in situ* or Guilty as grindstone

Once everyone has stated who they think did think wandered away with the artifact it’s time for the reveal. E will say their peace and then the host will begin having people perform their speeches. This round uses your assigned numbers and will begin either with the number right after—or right before—the number drawn after *Digging the Dirt*, which indicated the guilty party.

Speeches will then proceed in the sequence, leaving the selected stealer for last. When it’s your turn please read, or improvise around, the provided speech depending on whether you were or not the guilty party.

> **If innocent:** *While I do think that the rosary is an important part of Hispanic history in Florida and maybe a future exhibit could bring similar collections together, I know that its history isn't wholly "positive". It's a reminder of how faith can be used as a weapon and I think that the other archaeologists here are better suited to write that narrative.*
>
> **If guilty:** *The role that a rosary like this plays in Hispanic history in Florida is complicated and I didn't trust Jetson's ability to adequately represent that complexity in the narrative of the Mission or how it fits into wider narratives about Spanish Florida, especially after hearing the current tour. I wanted to take the chance to study a belonging that reflected such an obvious blending of cultural practices, like creolization, in private to consider how it might compare to similar artifacts from other Spanish mission sites in the state.*

Once the robber is revealed, anyone who accurately accused them wins the game. If they were only subtly suspicious, and no one accused them, the artifact absconder wins the game. E will have a few concluding words but there's nothing more for you to do now!

After the game

Once the recording, or the host as E, reads their concluding remarks, the game ends. By reaching Round Five, you will have developed your data literacy skills by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with the data provided through the game to discover the artifact absconder.Now that you've played *A Glorious Mystery*, take a chance to reflect how the game flexed your data literacy dexterity and consider how you might apply those skills again in the future.

If you desire (or require) some structure for your reflection, consider responding to the questions posed in **Part Two: The discussion guide** to aid your reflection of the game. Or explore the suggested materials from the beginning of the script using ***Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R*** or ***Of Mycenaean Men: Part Five*** to develop your data literacy dexterity or explore **museum collections**, **public libraries**, or even **keyword** or **project** search Open Context to learn more. With that we hope you enjoy playing *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*!

References and further reading

The following is a list of hyperlinked references from this player's guide. These are presented in order of appearance and do not repeat the full references for the character included under suggested materials. If any URLs in this Digital Data Story navigate to a broken page please check the **Wayback Machine** for an archived copy of the material.

Check out other Digital Data Stories here: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M74F1NW0**

Find out about the work of the Alexandria Archive Institute at: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/**

Check out Open Context for yourself here: **https://opencontext.org**

Explore Part One - The host guide at: https://doi.org/10.6078/M7GH9G20

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Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R by Paulina F. Przystupa and L. Meghan Dennis (2022): **https://doi.org/10.6078/M73N21HR**

Learn how to use a spreadsheet with *Of Myceanean Men - Part Five*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7Q81B6V**

Conduct a keyword search of Open Context using *Of Mycenaean Men - Part Four*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7TX3CHJ**

Try a project search of Open Context using *It's All in the Wrist (Bones) - Part Two*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7ZP4478**

Peruse some museum collections with the help of this article: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7S46Q2R**

Get at taste for some public library collections here: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/2025/07/10/how-to-use-the-digital-collections-of-the-nypl/**

Learn more about the saint whose name we use for our fictitious mission–Teresa of Avila–on her Wikipedia page: **https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Teresa_of_%C3%81vila**

"TTRPG Safety Toolkit: A Quick Reference Guide" by Kienna Shaw (2023) **https://web.archive.org/web/20231127094204/https://i.4pcdn.org/tg/1583202183294.pdf**

Explore Part Two at: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7B56GVG**

"Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data" by Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle (2018) **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7H70CX3**

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Credits

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Paulina F. Przystupa and L. Meghan Dennis, 2025, “A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery”, Data Stories Program, Alexandria Archive Institute / Open Context, Published Online, DOI: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M70863FG**.

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Acknowledgements

This Digital Data Story is a collaboration between its authors, our testing audiences, and the staff of AAI/OC. We are grateful to those who participated in our alpha playthrough of the game at the First Conference on Public Archaeology hosted by the Florida Public Archaeology Network Conference. These wonderful folks helped us test a prototype of this Digital Data Story and have been waiting for its release since then. We thank you for your patience as we reworked the game. We are also indebted to Katie Brewer for her help bringing gulf coast Florida to life in this approximation of the region. We also appreciate the work of the primary investigators of the *Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data* project, Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle who provide an excellent resource for comparing and learning about Spanish Missions in Florida.

The Data Stories are part of the overarching Data Literacy Program, with support from a National Endowment for the Humanities Challenge Award and a grant from the Mellon Foundation (2021-2025). Any views, findings, conclusions, or recommendations expressed in this work do not necessarily represent those of the National Endowment for the Humanities or the Mellon Foundation.

Player's guide overview

1. Introduction
2. Developing data literacy through role-play
3. How to play
4. Character background
5. Playing round scripts (don't read until asked to do so)
6. References and further readings
7. Credits
8. Acknowledgements

Estimated time to read this guide: 15 Minutes (do not read script ahead of time)

Estimated preparation time: Up to the player

Estimated play time: 1 - 3 hours depending on group size

Introduction

Welcome to the **Digital Data Stories** of the **Alexandria Archive Institute** and **Open Context**! This guide includes everything that you'll need to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery* as your assigned character and develop your data literacy. If you're also hosting the game, we encourage you to read the **hosting guide** to learn how to facilitate gameplay.

This game explores archaeological stakeholders and their relationship to archaeological data. This player's guide and script explains how the game cultivates data literacy, how to prepare to play, and the scripts for your character. This script includes character-specific background materials to use to learn more about the stakeholder you will or have portrayed.

Developing data literacy through role-play

By playing *A Glorious Mystery*, you'll develop your data literacy by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with data through the game. You'll use your **Character Background** to understand their relationship with archaeology and archaeological data and possibly learn more from their suggested sources. To delve deeper into your designated character, you can also read, respond and reflect on questions from Part Two: The discussion guide.

During the game, you'll role-play as your stakeholder, arguing their aims or communicating their conclusions using the background information and script as "raw data" that inform that archetype's actions. While playing as your character to argue and communicate, you'll use your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*** to formalize your observations into data about the other suspicious stakeholders. There you can record your recollections and use the catalog to read, work with, and analyze the data that the other characters cough up to come to the conclusion for who stole the rosary.

RELEASE DATE: 08 / 2025
VERSION: 1.0
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To further cultivate these skills, explore your suggested stakeholder sources. If you desire (or require) guidance use **Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R** or **Of Mycenaean Men - Part Five** to learn how to work with structured tabular data or conduct a **keyword** or **project** search of Open Context, **explore museum collections**, or **public libraries** to find more archaeological sources. You can also continue the conversation with **Part Two: The discussion guide** where you'll find questions about archaeology, ethics, and data to engage with and further cultivate your arguing and communicating skills.

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The mystery

> *Beadbeachville, a seaside town in Florida, is excited for the excavation season! Well, at least those visiting, watching, and working at the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission Site *are excited. First identified in the late 1970s, a new team of archaeologists has returned to the site for the last few years to uncover, recover, and preserve what remains. They've been excitedly excavating because while this Spanish colonial period Catholic religious outpost — also known as a mission — sat far from the beach when it was active, climate change related events – like more intense and regular hurricanes, sea-level rise, and soil erosion – have moved it to the water's edge. Because of that, salvage archaeology is an urgent part of the project. Beyond those threats to site integrity though, the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission *is also a fantastic blend of cultural materials from all over the region and the excavation has run smoothly for years.*
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Your host may play this character or represent them through digital recordings, with the host as their assistant. As a reminder, the town, archaeological site, mystery, and the title of "archaeological investigator" though based on places in Gulf Coast Florida, similar archaeological sites, and a kind of crime that does happen, are entirely fictitious. However, Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada, whom the fictitious mission is named, is a real Saint. Learn more about her **here**.

Role-playing tips

The Archaeological Investigator narrowed down the concerned culprits down to the people in attendance. This means that while you've seen people acting suspicious, if they're not there, they definitely didn't do it. That means you'll need to listen to the other players closely to search out the suspect or use what you've observed to distract your colleagues.

If you lack experience with role-play, stick to the included scripts. You'll get a chance to improvise in a low stakes way during Round Two and if you feel comfortable, feel free to add more improvisation as the game goes on. If you are experienced with role-play use your script and background materials as ways to ground your improvised dialogue. Regardless, remember to read from, or incorporate, your “innocent” or “guilty” script depending on whether you are the culprit during your playthrough. You may choose not to answer a question, but must tell the truth.

The Rounds

The game will be played in a series of rounds. The following summarizes how to play each round. If you're confused, ask your host to re-explain the rules before beginning or request a pause to the game before proceeding.

Round	**Explanation**
Zero	This is an out-of-character, pre-game discussion where players and host establish boundaries for play such as level of comfort with improvisation and a way to pause the game for any reason.
One - *Incised Introductions*	This is a scripted round where you'll read or improvise around your character's introduction and begin using your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities.*
Two - *Digging up the Dirt*	This is an improvised round where you will talk with other characters to dig up more dirt on the other suspects, adding to your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*. The host will end this round by drawing the number of one character to embroil them as the enigmatic embezzler. If your number is drawn, read or improvise around your guilty scripts. If not, follow your innocent scripts.
Three - *Sieving through the Secrets*	This is a scripted questioning round where you learn more about each character's movements or motives by improvising around or reading your scripted question or answer. Once everyone has been asked and answered a question, the group will vote to do another round of questioning. If the group decides to do another round, see the note for the expansion, otherwise skip to *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!* *Expansion - Refining the Results* This round is the same as the third round but when it concludes you'll proceed directly to the next round.
Round four - *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!*	This is the accusation round. Review your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities,* decide individual verdicts, and then list who you think did it in your *Artifact Absconder Accusation Log*. Use this to fill out a standard scripted accusation, or improvise around it. Then each player will read their accusation. You can keep track of these in your catalog.
Round five - *Innocently in situ or Guilty as grindstone*	This is the scripted confessions round, which aims to unmask the mysterious material culture mover. When your number comes up, read, or improvise around, your innocent or guilty script as appropriate.

Eddie Al Terneight

Here is some background on your character, explaining who they are, what they know, and suggested materials you can read ahead of time, or after the game, to learn more about the stakeholder archetype you will, or have, portrayed. Following this character background are instructions for how much of the script you can read before playing.

Character notes and suggested background materials

Stakeholder archetype	This is the accomplice character for the Hispanic/Latine/Latinx descendant community member with ties to Florida.
Character description	You are an alternate, accomplice, or ally to Eddie G.B. the Latino/Latina/Latine/Latinx/Hispanic descendant community who has ties to Gulf Coast Florida. You are a non-Hispanic/Latine/Latinx archaeologist who works with Hispanic/Latine/Latinx communities, predominantly in Florida. You have worked alongside Eddie G.B. in the past on archaeological sites and cultural heritage programming around the Gulf Coast and are friends.
Your relationship to the site	is through your relationship with communities who share descent/cultural affiliation with Spanish Florida. You see the site as an important representation of Hispanic/Latine/Latinx communities and practices in this area.
You're hiding the fact that...	you know that Jetson is not good with money or very organized because you and Eddie G.B. worked with them and they failed to pay either of you on time or the correct amount because Jetson overestimated how much money was left on the grant for that project.
Someone observed you...	singing to yourself about rehousing the rosary to be with other Hispanic heritage collections and critiquing Jetson's work at the site. You picked up this odd habit from Eddie G.B. when you worked with them.
You noticed someone else...	during the tour you attended at the site, drop a piece of paper that you (and/or Eddie G.B.) stepped on. That note implied someone with access to the storage facility wanted to remove important artifacts from the site for "extra" safekeeping. You're not sure what that really means.
You witnessed...	blake or Michael B. listening very attentively to Jetson's monologues during the public tour and saw them raise more than a few eyebrows when Jetson started talking about labor at the site. In those reactions you recognized a kindred spirit, hesitant to celebrate the rosary without critique.
Suggested character reference materials	Comparative Mission Archaeology Portal - **https://cmap.floridamuseum.ufl.edu/** The character's first name comes from Eduardo Matos Moctezuma, a Mexican archaeologist - **https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Eduardo_Matos_Moctezuma** See a list of archaeology related ways to celebrate Latino/Latina/Latine/Latinx/ Hispanic Heritage Month - **https://www.fpan.us/educational-resources/hispanic-latine-heritage-month-2022/** You can also explore the related materials for Eddie G.B. as well.

You can read the next two pages before playing. The first is your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities***, where you will record what you know about the other characters. You'll want to return to this page to note new observations made during the game to help decide who committed the rosary robbery and track accusations.

The page after that is ***Round One - Incised Introductions***. You may read through your scripted introduction and the reminder of your personal secret. The scripts are an example of how your character might talk. You can read the script exactly or improvise around it as you feel comfortable. At the bottom of that page are directions that tell you to stop reading. Please follow these directions to maintain in-game suspense.

Lastly, your host should have given you a number with your character assignment or you will pick one at the start of play. Keep that handy for the end of *Round Two - Digging up the Dirt*, so you know whether you're guilty or innocent during the game.

Catalog of Culprit Capabilities

Suspect	Motive	Your Evidence	Verdict	Times Accused By

Incised Introductions

During this round, you will introduce yourself to your fellow stakeholders by reading the following script or using it as a guide for an improvised introduction. You may embody the character however you wish, but don't add any more information or details beyond the introduction right now. Let the others get to know you over the next few rounds.

> *I'm Eddie A.T. and I'm in town for a short trip because some of the descendant community members I work with in another part of Florida want to know more about this site. I was hoping to see if any of their families might have an affiliation with the* Santa Teresa Mission*, like the other Eddie does if they're here too!*

The following is a narrative version of your motivations, suspicions, and secrets as they relate to the site. You'll want to draw from this and your character notes during subsequent rounds but don't add any of this to your introduction. Also, keep some of this as secret as you can so you don't incriminate yourself as the rosary robber! But beware, you may not be the only one who knows about them. No one's as subtle as they think they are.

> *From your discussion with your Hispanic community members and other archaeologists (like Eddie G.B.) you know that the Latine/Latinx/Hispanic community in Florida (and surrounding areas) value the* Santa Teresa Mission *as part of their heritage. While not everyone agrees with this perspective, more and more community members are starting to focus on celebrating the positive aspects of their heritage with the goal of acknowledging and redressing the negative, such as colonization. You started working with Hispanic and Spanish archaeological sites at a different site with Jetson, where you met and worked alongside your buddy Eddie G.B.. Due to that experience, you know Jetson's bad at managing grant money and sometimes at organization in general. Jetson is a stereotypical absent minded, and yet, over protective professor. As you've worked on and presented alongside your colleagues at numerous events, you recognize Dr. blake michaels, and potentially their student Michael B. Alturna, from the Southeastern Archaeology Conference (SEAC). While you were on the public tour for the* Santa Teresa Mission*, you noticed Dr. michaels, and/or his student, reacting strongly to the narrative Jetson shared about the labor that built the mission, especially, the way Jetson framed (or potentially left out) the lives of captive Indigenous and African people. You realized that they probably had the same hesitation about celebrating the rosary without understanding the complete context of the mission. On that same tour, you (and potentially Eddie G.B.) stepped on a piece of paper where someone had written to themselves (or possibly to someone else, it's unclear) about wanting to keep the rosary "extra safe". It was weird and you tried to remember to ask someone about it later by using that absurd mnemonic singing habit you picked up from Eddie G.B.. The two of you were terrible whenever you worked together because you'd become a two-person chorus, singing about basically everything, including archaeological narrative development, whether belongings like the Rosary should be housed with other Spanish/Hispanic/Latine/Latinx collections, or even tour quality. You try to moderate yourself in public, because it doesn't help anyone to singingly complain about getting coffee at cafes like* Mission: Meals*, but it's unconscious so you often forget you're doing it, especially if it's a catchy tune.*

Pause here until everyone has introduced themselves. The host as the character Ellis Thyx, just E for short, the Archaeological Investigator—or by playing the recording of E—will prompt you to proceed to the next page and round of the game.

Digging up the Dirt

This round your goal is to see what your fellow ethically-ambiguous allies know about the disappearance of the rosary and if they know anything about you. Be as subtle as you can because, as you inquire, these other observations could help you decide whose behavior was the most suspicious. As a reminder, here are some things that you've seen going on around Beadbeachville that you might want to ask the other stakeholders about.

You noticed someone else...	during the tour you attended at the site, drop a piece of paper that you (and/or Eddie G.B.) stepped on. That note implied someone with access to the storage facility wanted to remove important artifacts from the site for "extra" safekeeping. You're not sure what that really means.
You witnessed...	blake or Michael B. listening very attentively to Jetson's monologues during the public tour and saw them raise more than a few eyebrows when Jetson started talking about labor at the site. In those reactions you recognized a kindred spirit, hesitant to celebrate the rosary without critique.

Take some time during this round to put notes in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* so you can keep track of all the evidence you uncover.

Pause here when you've finished conversing. Once the host—either as E or as the character they're playing—concludes discussion, they will reveal whether you are the culprit.

If your number is selected, read from the "guilty" scripts provided or improvise around them. If your number is not selected, portray the character using the "innocent" scripts or improvise around that information. Remember, you cannot lie but you can be evasive.

The host—either as E or by playing the recording—will prompt you to begin the next round.

Sieving the secrets

Now that you've learned more about the other stakeholders—as well as what they know about the site and you—decide which character(s) you'd like to interrogate in front of everyone. During this round, you can only ask one person, one question and you can't pick the person who asked you a question or someone who has already been asked a question, so be clever and strategic!

Feel free to use the scripted questions below, which are based on the suspicious behaviors you witnessed. You may also create your own question based on the other observations you've made and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* from the preceding rounds. Remember, only the stakeholders present in the room could have done it.

> **Looking for someone suspicious:** *I found a note on the tour (or maybe it was the other Eddie and they shared it with me? doesn't matter) anyway it talked about "extra" safekeeping for an important artifact, what's that about?*
>
> **You know this person was doing something odd:** *Dr. michaels (and/or Michael B.) what bothered you so much about the tour we took earlier this week?*

When another character questions you, you cannot lie but you can be evasive. If they ask you their suggested question, the following is your answer to it. You may choose to read it verbatim or improvise around it.

> **If innocent:** *I hope you weren't too bothered by my singing voice. I picked it up from my buddy, Eddie. I found it a useful way to consider tough problems, especially ethically ambiguous ones like archaeological narratives and the purpose of museum collections.*
>
> **If guilty:** *Oh that's weird, why were you listening to me sing to myself? I almost forgot I did that, Eddie G.B. and used to make up songs about archaeology when we'd work together on sites but I thought I'd stopped. I guess not, but when and where did you hear me?*

If another character asks you a question where the suggested response does not make sense, answer it as truthfully as you can based on what you know or suspect. It's a great chance to share something you'd like others to know about or to deflect attention to someone else.

Pause here until all players have asked and answered a question. As you listen to the other stakeholders, add details to your catalog. Once the questioning round concludes, the host will give you the option of continuing the questioning or proceeding to accusations, so pay attention and decide what you'd like to do.

Refining the results

The group will vote on whether they'd like to do another round of questioning or if they'd like to move on to accusations. Use what you've learned and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* to guide your choice and vote accordingly.

If the group decides to do another round of questions, refer to the preceding scripts for suggested responses and questions for this *optional* round of questioning. You may need to improvise, as a lot of information has already been shared.

Otherwise, the group will proceed to the next round.

Once you complete the additional round or if the group decides to proceed without a second round of questioning, review your catalog in preparation for the accusation round. The host will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Accusing the Archaeological absconder!

Now that you've got as many observations out of other players as you can, it's time to decide who to accuse. Use what you learned and recorded in your catalog to guide your choice and fill out the following:

The Artifact Absconder Accusation Log

Suspect	Motive

You can then use the following template for your accusation.

I accuse...

of removing the recently discovered rosary from the *Santa Teresa Mission* because...

Keep your explanation brief as you will need to share it with everyone and they will all need to share theirs as well.

Once you've written your accusation, wait until E prompts you to share it with the group.

Now, it's your chance to reveal who you think rehoused the rosary! E will tell the group how to begin the accusation section. When it's your turn, read your accusation and its subsequent explanation.

Your host will take note of who gets the most accusations and tally those up for the final reveal! You can also keep track of who accused who, or how many accusations were made against each player in your catalog.

Pause again until all players have read their accusations. Then, the host as E - or by playing the recordings - will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Innocently *in situ* or Guilty as grindstone

Once everyone has stated who they think did think wandered away with the artifact it's time for the reveal. E will say their peace and then the host will begin having people perform their speeches. This round uses your assigned numbers and will begin either with the number right after—or right before—the number drawn after *Digging the Dirt*, which indicated the guilty party.

Speeches will then proceed in the sequence, leaving the selected stealer for last. When it's your turn please read, or improvise around, the provided speech depending on whether you were or not the guilty party.

> **If innocent:** *My community partners consider the site an important part of Hispanic history in Florida and would consider some kind of special exhibit bringing collections together in the future, but we can't put the rosary on some kind of pedestal knowing how Spanish colonizers used religion to oppress and harm local people.*
>
> **If guilty:** *It was clear to me that a rosary like this would play an important role in Hispanic history in Florida based on the work I've done at other sites. However, I was afraid that Jetson's previous mismanagement might lead to it going missing with so many people coming and going and scrutinizing so many parts of the project. So, I took the chance to see if I could sequester it and see how it might be incorporated into exhibits comparing Spanish Mission Sites in the state. And if I could get in and get it out, who else could too? I'd rather an archaeologist test security than a tourist.*

Once the robber is revealed, anyone who accurately accused them wins the game. If they were only subtly suspicious, and no one accused them, the artifact absconder wins the game. E will have a few concluding words but there's nothing more for you to do now!

After the game

Once the recording, or the host as E, reads their concluding remarks, the game ends. By reaching Round Five, you will have developed your data literacy skills by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with the data provided through the game to discover the artifact absconder.Now that you've played *A Glorious Mystery*, take a chance to reflect how the game flexed your data literacy dexterity and consider how you might apply those skills again in the future.

If you desire (or require) some structure for your reflection, consider responding to the questions posed in **Part Two: The discussion guide** to aid your reflection of the game. Or explore the suggested materials from the beginning of the script using ***Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R*** or ***Of Mycenaean Men: Part Five*** to develop your data literacy dexterity or explore **museum collections**, **public libraries**, or even **keyword** or **project** search Open Context to learn more. With that we hope you enjoy playing *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*!

References and further reading

The following is a list of hyperlinked references from this player's guide. These are presented in order of appearance and do not repeat the full references for the character included under suggested materials. If any URLs in this Digital Data Story navigate to a broken page please check the **Wayback Machine** for an archived copy of the material.

Check out other Digital Data Stories here: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M74F1NW0**

Find out about the work of the Alexandria Archive Institute at: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/**

Check out Open Context for yourself here: **https://opencontext.org**

Explore Part One - The host guide at: https://doi.org/10.6078/M7GH9G20

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Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R by Paulina F. Przystupa and L. Meghan Dennis (2022): **https://doi.org/10.6078/M73N21HR**

Learn how to use a spreadsheet with *Of Myceanean Men - Part Five*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7Q81B6V**

Conduct a keyword search of Open Context using *Of Mycenaean Men - Part Four*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7TX3CHJ**

Try a project search of Open Context using *It's All in the Wrist (Bones) - Part Two*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7ZP4478**

Peruse some museum collections with the help of this article: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7S46Q2R**

Get at taste for some public library collections here: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/2025/07/10/how-to-use-the-digital-collections-of-the-nypl/**

Learn more about the saint whose name we use for our fictitious mission–Teresa of Avila–on her Wikipedia page: **https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Teresa_of_%C3%81vila**

"TTRPG Safety Toolkit: A Quick Reference Guide" by Kienna Shaw (2023) **https://web.archive.org/web/20231127094204/https://i.4pcdn.org/tg/1583202183294.pdf**

Explore Part Two at: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7B56GVG**

"Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data" by Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle (2018) **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7H70CX3**

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Credits

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Paulina F. Przystupa and L. Meghan Dennis, 2025, “A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery”, Data Stories Program, Alexandria Archive Institute / Open Context, Published Online, DOI: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M70863FG**.

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Acknowledgements

This Digital Data Story is a collaboration between its authors, our testing audiences, and the staff of AAI/OC. We are grateful to those who participated in our alpha playthrough of the game at the First Conference on Public Archaeology hosted by the Florida Public Archaeology Network Conference. These wonderful folks helped us test a prototype of this Digital Data Story and have been waiting for its release since then. We thank you for your patience as we reworked the game. We are also indebted to Katie Brewer for her help bringing gulf coast Florida to life in this approximation of the region. We also appreciate the work of the primary investigators of the *Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data* project, Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle who provide an excellent resource for comparing and learning about Spanish Missions in Florida.

The Data Stories are part of the overarching Data Literacy Program, with support from a National Endowment for the Humanities Challenge Award and a grant from the Mellon Foundation (2021-2025). Any views, findings, conclusions, or recommendations expressed in this work do not necessarily represent those of the National Endowment for the Humanities or the Mellon Foundation.

Player's guide overview

1. Introduction
2. Developing data literacy through role-play
3. How to play
4. Character background
5. Playing round scripts (don't read until asked to do so)
6. References and further readings
7. Credits
8. Acknowledgements

Estimated time to read this guide: 15 Minutes (do not read script ahead of time)

Estimated preparation time: Up to the player

Estimated play time: 1 - 3 hours depending on group size

Introduction

Welcome to the **Digital Data Stories** of the **Alexandria Archive Institute** and **Open Context**! This guide includes everything that you'll need to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery* as your assigned character and develop your data literacy. If you're also hosting the game, we encourage you to read the **hosting guide** to learn how to facilitate gameplay.

This game explores archaeological stakeholders and their relationship to archaeological data. This player's guide and script explains how the game cultivates data literacy, how to prepare to play, and the scripts for your character. This script includes character-specific background materials to use to learn more about the stakeholder you will or have portrayed.

Developing data literacy through role-play

By playing *A Glorious Mystery*, you'll develop your data literacy by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with data through the game. You'll use your **Character Background** to understand their relationship with archaeology and archaeological data and possibly learn more from their suggested sources. To delve deeper into your designated character, you can also read, respond and reflect on questions from Part Two: The discussion guide.

During the game, you'll role-play as your stakeholder, arguing their aims or communicating their conclusions using the background information and script as "raw data" that inform that archetype's actions. While playing as your character to argue and communicate, you'll use your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*** to formalize your observations into data about the other suspicious stakeholders. There you can record your recollections and use the catalog to read, work with, and analyze the data that the other characters cough up to come to the conclusion for who stole the rosary.

RELEASE DATE: 08 / 2025
VERSION: 1.0
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The table tailors the traits you should note to: Suspect, Motive, Your Evidence, Verdict, and Times Accused By. The spaces for "Suspect" and "Motive" are where you should create and read data by documenting what the other stakeholders say about themselves and the other characters. Then, you'll work with the data by examining "Your Evidence" to see patterns. For the "Verdict," you should analyze the data and decide if that particular character is the guilty party. Lastly, in "Times Accused By" you can record and tally the accusations leveraged against yours and the others.

You'll use your complete catalog to decide who to inscribe into your Artifact Absconder Accusation Log and formulate an argument, drawing from your evidence, to come to a conclusion. Then, during the penultimate round of play, you'll communicate your argument. Regardless of whether you conclude correctly, you'll use all five components of data literacy to accuse an archaeological absconder.

To further cultivate these skills, explore your suggested stakeholder sources. If you desire (or require) guidance use **Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R** or **Of Mycenaean Men - Part Five** to learn how to work with structured tabular data or conduct a **keyword** or **project** search of Open Context, **explore museum collections**, or **public libraries** to find more archaeological sources. You can also continue the conversation with **Part Two: The discussion guide** where you'll find questions about archaeology, ethics, and data to engage with and further cultivate your arguing and communicating skills.

How to play

This section explains how to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*. It begins by explaining the mystery. Following that, we provide some tips on role-play and then conclude with a synopsis of each round of play.

The mystery

> *Beadbeachville, a seaside town in Florida, is excited for the excavation season! Well, at least those visiting, watching, and working at the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission Site *are excited. First identified in the late 1970s, a new team of archaeologists has returned to the site for the last few years to uncover, recover, and preserve what remains. They've been excitedly excavating because while this Spanish colonial period Catholic religious outpost — also known as a mission — sat far from the beach when it was active, climate change related events – like more intense and regular hurricanes, sea-level rise, and soil erosion – have moved it to the water's edge. Because of that, salvage archaeology is an urgent part of the project. Beyond those threats to site integrity though, the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission *is also a fantastic blend of cultural materials from all over the region and the excavation has run smoothly for years.*
>
> *Until now. Typically, the excavation uncovered belongings (often discussed as "artifacts") that fascinated archaeologists and local history buffs, but bored tourists. This season though, the team recovered an almost completely intact set of Catholic prayer beads. Called a rosary and used for both personal and group religious practice, this artifact was strung with beads made using an Indigenous style! The discovery of the piece, at a site that also included evidence for captive African and Indigenous labor, provided an intriguing example of creolization for the region. However, before a specialist could be called in to examine the rosary and its beads in more detail, a local TV and radio show host, who happened to be at the site during the discovery, broke the news to the whole county. Tourism doubled overnight and now, to everyone's dismay, that find has disappeared! How could this happen? Did a tourist think the storage facility was a gift shop? Was it sequestered away for extra safe keeping? Did someone simply make a data entry error? Or did* You *wander away with it? An Archaeological Investigator, Ellis Thyx, has been sent to facilitate solving the mystery.*

Your host may play this character or represent them through digital recordings, with the host as their assistant. As a reminder, the town, archaeological site, mystery, and the title of "archaeological investigator" though based on places in Gulf Coast Florida, similar archaeological sites, and a kind of crime that does happen, are entirely fictitious. However, Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada, whom the fictitious mission is named, is a real Saint. Learn more about her **here**.

Role-playing tips

The Archaeological Investigator narrowed down the concerned culprits down to the people in attendance. This means that while you've seen people acting suspicious, if they're not there, they definitely didn't do it. That means you'll need to listen to the other players closely to search out the suspect or use what you've observed to distract your colleagues.

If you lack experience with role-play, stick to the included scripts. You'll get a chance to improvise in a low stakes way during Round Two and if you feel comfortable, feel free to add more improvisation as the game goes on. If you are experienced with role-play use your script and background materials as ways to ground your improvised dialogue. Regardless, remember to read from, or incorporate, your “innocent” or “guilty” script depending on whether you are the culprit during your playthrough. You may choose not to answer a question, but must tell the truth.

The Rounds

The game will be played in a series of rounds. The following summarizes how to play each round. If you're confused, ask your host to re-explain the rules before beginning or request a pause to the game before proceeding.

Round	**Explanation**
Zero	This is an out-of-character, pre-game discussion where players and host establish boundaries for play such as level of comfort with improvisation and a way to pause the game for any reason.
One - *Incised Introductions*	This is a scripted round where you'll read or improvise around your character's introduction and begin using your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities.*
Two - *Digging up the Dirt*	This is an improvised round where you will talk with other characters to dig up more dirt on the other suspects, adding to your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*. The host will end this round by drawing the number of one character to embroil them as the enigmatic embezzler. If your number is drawn, read or improvise around your guilty scripts. If not, follow your innocent scripts.
Three - *Sieving through the Secrets*	This is a scripted questioning round where you learn more about each character's movements or motives by improvising around or reading your scripted question or answer. Once everyone has been asked and answered a question, the group will vote to do another round of questioning. If the group decides to do another round, see the note for the expansion, otherwise skip to *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!* *Expansion - Refining the Results* This round is the same as the third round but when it concludes you'll proceed directly to the next round.
Round four - *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!*	This is the accusation round. Review your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities,* decide individual verdicts, and then list who you think did it in your *Artifact Absconder Accusation Log*. Use this to fill out a standard scripted accusation, or improvise around it. Then each player will read their accusation. You can keep track of these in your catalog.
Round five - *Innocently in situ or Guilty as grindstone*	This is the scripted confessions round, which aims to unmask the mysterious material culture mover. When your number comes up, read, or improvise around, your innocent or guilty script as appropriate.

El(le) Ike Shein

Here is some background on your character, explaining who they are, what they know, and suggested materials you can read ahead of time, or after the game, to learn more about the stakeholder archetype you will, or have, portrayed. Following this character background are instructions for how much of the script you can read before playing.

Character notes and suggested background materials

Stakeholder archetype	Local government representative.
Character description	You are part of the local government in Beadbeachville. You're looking to get re-elected and think that supporting (and advertising) the archaeological site might be a good way to drum up support and potentially external funding for tourism from the State Government.
Your relationship to the site	comes from a desire to use the presence of the site to request more funding to support Beadbeachville as a tourist destination, using the money to develop the infrastructure that supports tourism.
You're hiding the fact that...	you are the one who gets to decide who will receive some local grant funding, so you visited the site to get more details about Jetson's plan for it because their application had too much jargon for you to follow.
Someone observed you...	discussing on public radio where the archaeological team housed the rosary and how bringing physical evidence of the importance of the site to state lawmakers might help garner you more funding for local projects.
You noticed someone else...	turn in a late application for local grant funding where they sought funding to house the newly found rosary in a highly public place.
You witnessed...	Birdie (and/or Parker) be let into the storage facility while you were talking with Jetson about the excavation, and heard them mention, "...housing the rosary in a more appropriate setting". You don't know what that means though.
Suggested character reference materials	"Archaeologists Discover Electoral Campaign Inscription Inside Pompeii House" by Sarah Kuta - **https://www.smithsonianmag.com/smart-news/archaeologists-discover-electoral-inscription-inside-pompeii-house-180983177/** "Election benchmarks" as an instrument to exert political influence for the benefit of archaeology — an opinion piece / „Wahlprüfsteine" als Instrument politischer Einflussnahme für die Archäologie – ein Meinungsbeitrag by Frank Siegmund, Diane Scherzler, and Werner Schön (in English and German) - **https://doi.org/10.11588/ai.2023.1.105484** "Archaeologists Should Be Activists Too" by Allison Mickel and Kyle Olson - **https://www.sapiens.org/archaeology/archaeology-activists/** "The politics and power of American archaeology" by Holly Norton - **https://www.theguardian.com/science/2017/apr/10/the-politics-and-power-of-american-archaeology**

You can read the next two pages before playing. The first is your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities***, where you will record what you know about the other characters. You'll want to return to this page to note new observations made during the game to help decide who committed the rosary robbery and track accusations.

The page after that is ***Round One - Incised Introductions***. You may read through your scripted introduction and the reminder of your personal secret. The scripts are an example of how your character might talk. You can read the script exactly or improvise around it as you feel comfortable. At the bottom of that page are directions that tell you to stop reading. Please follow these directions to maintain in-game suspense.

Lastly, your host should have given you a number with your character assignment or you will pick one at the start of play. Keep that handy for the end of *Round Two - Digging up the Dirt*, so you know whether you're guilty or innocent during the game.

Catalog of Culprit Capabilities

Suspect	Motive	Your Evidence	Verdict	Times Accused By

Incised Introductions

During this round, you will introduce yourself to your fellow stakeholders by reading the following script or using it as a guide for an improvised introduction. You may embody the character however you wish, but don't add any more information or details beyond the introduction right now. Let the others get to know you over the next few rounds.

> *Councilperson for the Beadbeachville Metro, El(le) Ike Shein. While some folks think any press is good press, I'd rather we celebrate things found than mourn things lost. If you have any concerns about our fair Town, please let me know. Your Councilperson is always ready to listen.*

The following is a narrative version of your motivations, suspicions, and secrets as they relate to the site. You'll want to draw from this and your character notes during subsequent rounds but don't add any of this to your introduction. Also, keep some of this as secret as you can so you don't incriminate yourself as the rosary robber! But beware, you may not be the only one who knows about them. No one's as subtle as they think they are.

> *You're on the town council and hoped that having something like the rosary could provide more weight to proposals to develop the city from the state and federal governments. Improving local infrastructure for the burgeoning tourist trade should be great for your constituents too. At least so you hope. While you are considering asking for funding from the state and the feds, sometimes people ask the town for funding too. In a reciprocal cycle, spending money on local museums or other cultural projects helps you ask for more money from the bigger fish. During one of these local grant cycles, you read a rather desperate call for funding from Jetson. It was very professional, though possibly had too many words that ended in "ism" and jargon like the "ontological turn". It came as a stark contrast to the proposal for a "private museum" display that didn't even have a name attached to it! And for some reason they talked about having the rosary at that display. Very suspicious. You wonder if Emma knows who it might be, since you know Officer Kaup had been reprimanded for some poor ethical choices in the past as it was in her file when she got hired in Beadbeachville. In support of possibly funding Jetson, and not that private display, you met them at the site in an informal capacity (not giving away that you oversee the local grants) to see if they could explain this "ontological turn" better. While there, you saw Al let Birdie (and/or that school teacher Parker) into the storage facility and heard them talk about rehousing the rosary in a more comfortable setting, whatever that means. That meeting wasn't the first time you visited the site though because you like to make sure that when you give interviews on the local radio you've got accurate information. You've included those tidbits in recent broadcasts discussing the value of the rosary, the city's official stance about the piece before it went missing, and even let yourself be recorded saying you might want to bring it in front of state lawmakers to prove your case for more tourist funding. You're not sure (and did not share) whether a high quality replica (which you've discussed creating with the help of a person who makes replicas professionally) or the real thing would be better.*

Pause here until everyone has introduced themselves. The host as the character Ellis Thyx, just E for short, the Archaeological Investigator—or by playing the recording of E—will prompt you to proceed to the next page and round of the game.

Digging up the Dirt

This round your goal is to see what your fellow ethically-ambiguous allies know about the disappearance of the rosary and if they know anything about you. Be as subtle as you can because, as you inquire, these other observations could help you decide whose behavior was the most suspicious. As a reminder, here are some things that you've seen going on around Beadbeachville that you might want to ask the other stakeholders about.

You noticed someone else...	turn in a late application for local grant funding where they sought funding to house the newly found rosary in a highly public place.
You witnessed...	Birdie (and/or Parker) be let into the storage facility while you were talking with Jetson about the excavation, and heard them mention, "...housing the rosary in a more appropriate setting". You don't know what that means though.

Take some time during this round to put notes in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* so you can keep track of all the evidence you uncover.

Pause here when you've finished conversing. Once the host—either as E or as the character they're playing—concludes discussion, they will reveal whether you are the culprit.

If your number is selected, read from the "guilty" scripts provided or improvise around them. If your number is not selected, portray the character using the "innocent" scripts or improvise around that information. Remember, you cannot lie but you can be evasive.

The host—either as E or by playing the recording—will prompt you to begin the next round.

Sieving the secrets

Now that you've learned more about the other stakeholders—as well as what they know about the site and you—decide which character(s) you'd like to interrogate in front of everyone. During this round, you can only ask one person, one question and you can't pick the person who asked you a question or someone who has already been asked a question, so be clever and strategic!

Feel free to use the scripted questions below, which are based on the suspicious behaviors you witnessed. You may also create your own question based on the other observations you've made and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* from the preceding rounds. Remember, only the stakeholders present in the room could have done it.

> **Looking for someone suspicious:** *Has anyone you know submitted any grant applications recently, in particular one for funding related to archaeology?*
>
> **You know this person was doing something odd:** *Birdie (and/or Parker), why do you care about housing the rosary in a more comfortable setting?*

When another character questions you, you cannot lie but you can be evasive. If they ask you their suggested question, the following is your answer to it. You may choose to read it verbatim or improvise around it.

> **If innocent:** *I'm so glad you caught my radio broadcast! Most people do podcasts these days but there's nothing quite like being on live radio! No edits, no filter, no take backs! It was a great opportunity to highlight Beadbeachville Town Council's special relationship with the mission and how much tourist revenue it generates! Pardon my biblical pun but it's a testament to the hard work of our citizens!*
>
> **If guilty:** *I would like to remind my constituents and any who consider requesting grants from the Beadbeachville Town Council, that talking with the local press is an important part of my job. It shows people where their tax dollars go and, in my experience, archaeologists are not always strategic about PR. So I took it upon myself to ensure that the public received an official account rather than just a sensationalized story from a reporter who hardly spent any time at the site.*

If another character asks you a question where the suggested response does not make sense, answer it as truthfully as you can based on what you know or suspect. It's a great chance to share something you'd like others to know about or to deflect attention to someone else.

Pause here until all players have asked and answered a question. As you listen to the other stakeholders, add details to your catalog. Once the questioning round concludes, the host will give you the option of continuing the questioning or proceeding to accusations, so pay attention and decide what you'd like to do.

Refining the results

The group will vote on whether they'd like to do another round of questioning or if they'd like to move on to accusations. Use what you've learned and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* to guide your choice and vote accordingly.

If the group decides to do another round of questions, refer to the preceding scripts for suggested responses and questions for this *optional* round of questioning. You may need to improvise, as a lot of information has already been shared.

Otherwise, the group will proceed to the next round.

Once you complete the additional round or if the group decides to proceed without a second round of questioning, review your catalog in preparation for the accusation round. The host will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Accusing the Archaeological absconder!

Now that you've got as many observations out of other players as you can, it's time to decide who to accuse. Use what you learned and recorded in your catalog to guide your choice and fill out the following:

The Artifact Absconder Accusation Log

Suspect	Motive

You can then use the following template for your accusation.

I accuse...

of removing the recently discovered rosary from the *Santa Teresa Mission* because...

Keep your explanation brief as you will need to share it with everyone and they will all need to share theirs as well.

Once you've written your accusation, wait until E prompts you to share it with the group.

Now, it's your chance to reveal who you think rehoused the rosary! E will tell the group how to begin the accusation section. When it's your turn, read your accusation and its subsequent explanation.

Your host will take note of who gets the most accusations and tally those up for the final reveal! You can also keep track of who accused who, or how many accusations were made against each player in your catalog.

Pause again until all players have read their accusations. Then, the host as E - or by playing the recordings - will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Innocently *in situ* or Guilty as grindstone

Once everyone has stated who they think did think wandered away with the artifact it's time for the reveal. E will say their peace and then the host will begin having people perform their speeches. This round uses your assigned numbers and will begin either with the number right after—or right before—the number drawn after *Digging the Dirt*, which indicated the guilty party.

Speeches will then proceed in the sequence, leaving the selected stealer for last. When it's your turn please read, or improvise around, the provided speech depending on whether you were or not the guilty party.

> **If innocent:** *I truly want what's best for Beadbeachville as a town councilor, but stealing an important piece of its history to show it to state lawmakers isn't going to help me do that. Sorry folks, but you've got the wrong person.*
>
> **If guilty:** *The person I consulted with for the rosary's promotional campaign said that they needed to see the rosary up close to make a high enough quality replica for me to bring to legislators, so I borrowed it before asking Jetson. I saw some partially filled out paperwork for moving it in the storage shed anyway so thought it wouldn't be a big deal.*

Once the robber is revealed, anyone who accurately accused them wins the game. If they were only subtly suspicious, and no one accused them, the artifact absconder wins the game. E will have a few concluding words but there's nothing more for you to do now!

After the game

Once the recording, or the host as E, reads their concluding remarks, the game ends. By reaching Round Five, you will have developed your data literacy skills by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with the data provided through the game to discover the artifact absconder.Now that you've played *A Glorious Mystery*, take a chance to reflect how the game flexed your data literacy dexterity and consider how you might apply those skills again in the future.

If you desire (or require) some structure for your reflection, consider responding to the questions posed in **Part Two: The discussion guide** to aid your reflection of the game. Or explore the suggested materials from the beginning of the script using ***Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R*** or ***Of Mycenaean Men: Part Five*** to develop your data literacy dexterity or explore **museum collections**, **public libraries**, or even **keyword** or **project** search Open Context to learn more. With that we hope you enjoy playing *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*!

References and further reading

The following is a list of hyperlinked references from this player's guide. These are presented in order of appearance and do not repeat the full references for the character included under suggested materials. If any URLs in this Digital Data Story navigate to a broken page please check the **Wayback Machine** for an archived copy of the material.

Check out other Digital Data Stories here: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M74F1NW0**

Find out about the work of the Alexandria Archive Institute at: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/**

Check out Open Context for yourself here: **https://opencontext.org**

Explore Part One - The host guide at: https://doi.org/10.6078/M7GH9G20

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Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R by Paulina F. Przystupa and L. Meghan Dennis (2022): **https://doi.org/10.6078/M73N21HR**

Learn how to use a spreadsheet with *Of Myceanean Men - Part Five*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7Q81B6V**

Conduct a keyword search of Open Context using *Of Mycenaean Men - Part Four*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7TX3CHJ**

Try a project search of Open Context using *It's All in the Wrist (Bones) - Part Two*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7ZP4478**

Peruse some museum collections with the help of this article: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7S46Q2R**

Get at taste for some public library collections here: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/2025/07/10/how-to-use-the-digital-collections-of-the-nypl/**

Learn more about the saint whose name we use for our fictitious mission–Teresa of Avila–on her Wikipedia page: **https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Teresa_of_%C3%81vila**

"TTRPG Safety Toolkit: A Quick Reference Guide" by Kienna Shaw (2023) **https://web.archive.org/web/20231127094204/https://i.4pcdn.org/tg/1583202183294.pdf**

Explore Part Two at: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7B56GVG**

"Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data" by Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle (2018) **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7H70CX3**

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Acknowledgements

This Digital Data Story is a collaboration between its authors, our testing audiences, and the staff of AAI/OC. We are grateful to those who participated in our alpha playthrough of the game at the First Conference on Public Archaeology hosted by the Florida Public Archaeology Network Conference. These wonderful folks helped us test a prototype of this Digital Data Story and have been waiting for its release since then. We thank you for your patience as we reworked the game. We are also indebted to Katie Brewer for her help bringing gulf coast Florida to life in this approximation of the region. We also appreciate the work of the primary investigators of the *Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data* project, Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle who provide an excellent resource for comparing and learning about Spanish Missions in Florida.

The Data Stories are part of the overarching Data Literacy Program, with support from a National Endowment for the Humanities Challenge Award and a grant from the Mellon Foundation (2021-2025). Any views, findings, conclusions, or recommendations expressed in this work do not necessarily represent those of the National Endowment for the Humanities or the Mellon Foundation.

Player's guide overview

1. Introduction
2. Developing data literacy through role-play
3. How to play
4. Character background
5. Playing round scripts (don't read until asked to do so)
6. References and further readings
7. Credits
8. Acknowledgements

Estimated time to read this guide: 15 Minutes (do not read script ahead of time)

Estimated preparation time: Up to the player

Estimated play time: 1 - 3 hours depending on group size

Introduction

Welcome to the **Digital Data Stories** of the **Alexandria Archive Institute** and **Open Context**! This guide includes everything that you'll need to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery* as your assigned character and develop your data literacy. If you're also hosting the game, we encourage you to read the **hosting guide** to learn how to facilitate gameplay.

This game explores archaeological stakeholders and their relationship to archaeological data. This player's guide and script explains how the game cultivates data literacy, how to prepare to play, and the scripts for your character. This script includes character-specific background materials to use to learn more about the stakeholder you will or have portrayed.

Developing data literacy through role-play

By playing *A Glorious Mystery*, you'll develop your data literacy by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with data through the game. You'll use your **Character Background** to understand their relationship with archaeology and archaeological data and possibly learn more from their suggested sources. To delve deeper into your designated character, you can also read, respond and reflect on questions from Part Two: The discussion guide.

During the game, you'll role-play as your stakeholder, arguing their aims or communicating their conclusions using the background information and script as "raw data" that inform that archetype's actions. While playing as your character to argue and communicate, you'll use your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*** to formalize your observations into data about the other suspicious stakeholders. There you can record your recollections and use the catalog to read, work with, and analyze the data that the other characters cough up to come to the conclusion for who stole the rosary.

RELEASE DATE: 08 / 2025
VERSION: 1.0
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The table tailors the traits you should note to: Suspect, Motive, Your Evidence, Verdict, and Times Accused By. The spaces for "Suspect" and "Motive" are where you should create and read data by documenting what the other stakeholders say about themselves and the other characters. Then, you'll work with the data by examining "Your Evidence" to see patterns. For the "Verdict," you should analyze the data and decide if that particular character is the guilty party. Lastly, in "Times Accused By" you can record and tally the accusations leveraged against yours and the others.

You'll use your complete catalog to decide who to inscribe into your Artifact Absconder Accusation Log and formulate an argument, drawing from your evidence, to come to a conclusion. Then, during the penultimate round of play, you'll communicate your argument. Regardless of whether you conclude correctly, you'll use all five components of data literacy to accuse an archaeological absconder.

To further cultivate these skills, explore your suggested stakeholder sources. If you desire (or require) guidance use **Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R** or **Of Mycenaean Men - Part Five** to learn how to work with structured tabular data or conduct a **keyword** or **project** search of Open Context, **explore museum collections**, or **public libraries** to find more archaeological sources. You can also continue the conversation with **Part Two: The discussion guide** where you'll find questions about archaeology, ethics, and data to engage with and further cultivate your arguing and communicating skills.

How to play

This section explains how to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*. It begins by explaining the mystery. Following that, we provide some tips on role-play and then conclude with a synopsis of each round of play.

The mystery

> *Beadbeachville, a seaside town in Florida, is excited for the excavation season! Well, at least those visiting, watching, and working at the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission Site *are excited. First identified in the late 1970s, a new team of archaeologists has returned to the site for the last few years to uncover, recover, and preserve what remains. They've been excitedly excavating because while this Spanish colonial period Catholic religious outpost — also known as a mission — sat far from the beach when it was active, climate change related events – like more intense and regular hurricanes, sea-level rise, and soil erosion – have moved it to the water's edge. Because of that, salvage archaeology is an urgent part of the project. Beyond those threats to site integrity though, the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission *is also a fantastic blend of cultural materials from all over the region and the excavation has run smoothly for years.*
>
> *Until now. Typically, the excavation uncovered belongings (often discussed as "artifacts") that fascinated archaeologists and local history buffs, but bored tourists. This season though, the team recovered an almost completely intact set of Catholic prayer beads. Called a rosary and used for both personal and group religious practice, this artifact was strung with beads made using an Indigenous style! The discovery of the piece, at a site that also included evidence for captive African and Indigenous labor, provided an intriguing example of creolization for the region. However, before a specialist could be called in to examine the rosary and its beads in more detail, a local TV and radio show host, who happened to be at the site during the discovery, broke the news to the whole county. Tourism doubled overnight and now, to everyone's dismay, that find has disappeared! How could this happen? Did a tourist think the storage facility was a gift shop? Was it sequestered away for extra safe keeping? Did someone simply make a data entry error? Or did* You *wander away with it? An Archaeological Investigator, Ellis Thyx, has been sent to facilitate solving the mystery.*

Your host may play this character or represent them through digital recordings, with the host as their assistant. As a reminder, the town, archaeological site, mystery, and the title of "archaeological investigator" though based on places in Gulf Coast Florida, similar archaeological sites, and a kind of crime that does happen, are entirely fictitious. However, Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada, whom the fictitious mission is named, is a real Saint. Learn more about her **here**.

Role-playing tips

The Archaeological Investigator narrowed down the concerned culprits down to the people in attendance. This means that while you've seen people acting suspicious, if they're not there, they definitely didn't do it. That means you'll need to listen to the other players closely to search out the suspect or use what you've observed to distract your colleagues.

If you lack experience with role-play, stick to the included scripts. You'll get a chance to improvise in a low stakes way during Round Two and if you feel comfortable, feel free to add more improvisation as the game goes on. If you are experienced with role-play use your script and background materials as ways to ground your improvised dialogue. Regardless, remember to read from, or incorporate, your “innocent” or “guilty” script depending on whether you are the culprit during your playthrough. You may choose not to answer a question, but must tell the truth.

The Rounds

The game will be played in a series of rounds. The following summarizes how to play each round. If you're confused, ask your host to re-explain the rules before beginning or request a pause to the game before proceeding.

Round	**Explanation**
Zero	This is an out-of-character, pre-game discussion where players and host establish boundaries for play such as level of comfort with improvisation and a way to pause the game for any reason.
One - *Incised Introductions*	This is a scripted round where you'll read or improvise around your character's introduction and begin using your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities.*
Two - *Digging up the Dirt*	This is an improvised round where you will talk with other characters to dig up more dirt on the other suspects, adding to your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*. The host will end this round by drawing the number of one character to embroil them as the enigmatic embezzler. If your number is drawn, read or improvise around your guilty scripts. If not, follow your innocent scripts.
Three - *Sieving through the Secrets*	This is a scripted questioning round where you learn more about each character's movements or motives by improvising around or reading your scripted question or answer. Once everyone has been asked and answered a question, the group will vote to do another round of questioning. If the group decides to do another round, see the note for the expansion, otherwise skip to *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!* *Expansion - Refining the Results* This round is the same as the third round but when it concludes you'll proceed directly to the next round.
Round four - *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!*	This is the accusation round. Review your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities,* decide individual verdicts, and then list who you think did it in your *Artifact Absconder Accusation Log*. Use this to fill out a standard scripted accusation, or improvise around it. Then each player will read their accusation. You can keep track of these in your catalog.
Round five - *Innocently in situ or Guilty as grindstone*	This is the scripted confessions round, which aims to unmask the mysterious material culture mover. When your number comes up, read, or improvise around, your innocent or guilty script as appropriate.

Emma Kaup

Here is some background on your character, explaining who they are, what they know, and suggested materials you can read ahead of time, or after the game, to learn more about the stakeholder archetype you will, or have, portrayed. Following this character background are instructions for how much of the script you can read before playing.

Character notes and suggested background materials

Stakeholder archetype	Local law enforcement person with some experience with archaeological materials and laws.
Character description	You are a member of local law enforcement that has been involved, on both sides, in illegal artifact trafficking. You got in trouble once, retrained on the relevant cultural heritage laws and better understand the issues. Now, you scrutinize the security of archaeological sites and museums very intensely.
Your relationship to the site	is through a critique of the site's approach to rules and security. You want to use your authority to enforce access rules on everyone else, if only these archaeologists would listen to your recommendations.
You're hiding the fact that...	you recognize Jess from a previous investigation and are unsure if they recognize you or if they know that you were a suspect in that investigation, rather than on the right side of the law.
Someone observed you...	suggesting that you'd teach the archaeological team a thing or two about security by testing it out yourself. You even went as far as "checking" the door on their storage shed and bent it open in front of a crowd.
You noticed someone else...	had left out a what looked like loan agreement for the rosary while peeking into the storage shed during the tour. Although unsigned and incomplete, the date on the paperwork suggested someone was going to remove the rosary that day.
You witnessed...	and recognized Jess' voice when they complained about the inaccessibility of the collection if it remained at Beadbeachville while on the tour. You remember them from that other cultural heritage site debacle.
Suggested character reference materials	"We don't know what we don't know about Antiquities Crime" by Donna Yates - **https://www.anonymousswisscollector.com/2024/08/we-dont-know-what-we-dont-know-about-antiquities-crime.html** "Archeology is Law Enforcement" by Carl Drexler - **https://archeology.uark.edu/archeology-is/archeology-is-law-enforcement/** Laws, Regulations, & Guidelines - **https://www.nps.gov/subjects/archeology/laws-regulations-guidelines.htm** Training for Archaeological Resource Protection (TARP) For Law Enforcement - **https://dos.fl.gov/historical/archaeology/education/training-on-archaeological-resource-protection/**

You can read the next two pages before playing. The first is your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities***, where you will record what you know about the other characters. You'll want to return to this page to note new observations made during the game to help decide who committed the rosary robbery and track accusations.

The page after that is ***Round One - Incised Introductions***. You may read through your scripted introduction and the reminder of your personal secret. The scripts are an example of how your character might talk. You can read the script exactly or improvise around it as you feel comfortable. At the bottom of that page are directions that tell you to stop reading. Please follow these directions to maintain in-game suspense.

Lastly, your host should have given you a number with your character assignment or you will pick one at the start of play. Keep that handy for the end of *Round Two - Digging up the Dirt*, so you know whether you're guilty or innocent during the game.

Catalog of Culprit Capabilities

Suspect	Motive	Your Evidence	Verdict	Times Accused By

Incised Introductions

During this round, you will introduce yourself to your fellow stakeholders by reading the following script or using it as a guide for an improvised introduction. You may embody the character however you wish, but don't add any more information or details beyond the introduction right now. Let the others get to know you over the next few rounds.

> *Officer Kaup here. I specialize in cases involving stolen or illegally obtained cultural materials. Usually I'm the one facilitating conversations like this, but I guess E here knows something I don't. I care about ensuring the safety and care of cultural heritage objects from discovery to curation and enforcing heritage laws.*

The following is a narrative version of your motivations, suspicions, and secrets as they relate to the site. You'll want to draw from this and your character notes during subsequent rounds but don't add any of this to your introduction. Also, keep some of this as secret as you can so you don't incriminate yourself as the rosary robber! But beware, you may not be the only one who knows about them. No one's as subtle as they think they are.

> *You've been in law enforcement for awhile and ended up focusing on cultural heritage issues. At first it was "collecting fines" from looters, which you initially pocketed, but since learning more about how terrible the trade is you've gone straight. You know about Sellsalotta's problem with removing artifacts illegally and have tried to educate her on the law because she's not out for personal gain, so far as you can tell. You talked it over, again, at* Mission: Meals *after the news of the rosary broke. She asked about how fines worked when artifacts were "Indigenous" and you tried to explain what you could. You know what it's like to be in the wrong when you don't know enough about the laws, having been called in as a suspect for your own improper collection of fines and sometimes finds. This experience has made you very concerned with the security of archaeological sites, like the* Santa Teresa Mission*. While on a tour of the site, you recognized Jess's voice from one of those archaeological ethics and stewardship seminars, they were very vocal with their opinions though you're not sure that they're always right. For example, they tried to convince the seminar instructor that universal open access to both archaeological data (whatever that is), sites, and artifacts was a public good. You disagreed but also know when to keep your mouth shut and listen. On the tour of the mission, Jess complained about the lack of accessibility for the artifacts at the mission, which wasn't a problem for you as less access can keep artifacts safe when the security overall of the site wasn't very good. You may have muttered something about "...testing security by removing something," but you wouldn't, although when you checked the lock on the storage shed you bent the door open. With that peek into the shed, you saw what looked like a partially filled out loan agreement. It was unsigned and incomplete, but you remember that the "date for removal" was the day the rosary, eventually, disappeared.*

Pause here until everyone has introduced themselves. The host as the character Ellis Thyx, just E for short, the Archaeological Investigator—or by playing the recording of E—will prompt you to proceed to the next page and round of the game.

Digging up the Dirt

This round your goal is to see what your fellow ethically-ambiguous allies know about the disappearance of the rosary and if they know anything about you. Be as subtle as you can because, as you inquire, these other observations could help you decide whose behavior was the most suspicious. As a reminder, here are some things that you've seen going on around Beadbeachville that you might want to ask the other stakeholders about.

You noticed someone else...	had left out a what looked like loan agreement for the rosary while peeking into the storage shed during the tour. Although unsigned and incomplete, the date on the paperwork suggested someone was going to remove the rosary that day.
You witnessed...	and recognized Jess' voice when they complained about the inaccessibility of the collection if it remained at Beadbeachville while on the tour. You remember them from that other cultural heritage site debacle.

Take some time during this round to put notes in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* so you can keep track of all the evidence you uncover.

Pause here when you've finished conversing. Once the host—either as E or as the character they're playing—concludes discussion, they will reveal whether you are the culprit.

If your number is selected, read from the "guilty" scripts provided or improvise around them. If your number is not selected, portray the character using the "innocent" scripts or improvise around that information. Remember, you cannot lie but you can be evasive.

The host—either as E or by playing the recording—will prompt you to begin the next round.

Sieving the secrets

Now that you've learned more about the other stakeholders—as well as what they know about the site and you—decide which character(s) you'd like to interrogate in front of everyone. During this round, you can only ask one person, one question and you can't pick the person who asked you a question or someone who has already been asked a question, so be clever and strategic!

Feel free to use the scripted questions below, which are based on the suspicious behaviors you witnessed. You may also create your own question based on the other observations you've made and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* from the preceding rounds. Remember, only the stakeholders present in the room could have done it.

> **Looking for someone suspicious:** *Does anyone you're familiar with know something about filling out loan paperwork for archaeological collections?*
>
> **You know this person was doing something odd:** *Jess, why does it bother you so much that the collection stays here in Beadbeachville? I know you know about the importance of archaeological stewardship and ethics.*

When another character questions you, you cannot lie but you can be evasive. If they ask you their suggested question, the following is your answer to it. You may choose to read it verbatim or improvise around it.

> **If innocent:** *As law enforcement, it's my job to care about security and upholding the law by ensuring that the site's artifacts are safe from antiquities trafficking. I will admit I may have gone too far, I didn't mean to bend the door, obviously. However, it highlights that these archaeologists need a more secure facility to house their finds, don't you think?*
>
> **If guilty:** *Well managed archaeological projects have a clear plan to evaluate the security of their site. Here, all we get is a "stern" talking-to by a graduate student and some plastic safety fencing. That's hardly enough to deter real criminals and bending that door was the best way to illustrate how lax their security was if they weren't going to take my comments seriously.*

If another character asks you a question where the suggested response does not make sense, answer it as truthfully as you can based on what you know or suspect. It's a great chance to share something you'd like others to know about or to deflect attention to someone else.

Pause here until all players have asked and answered a question. As you listen to the other stakeholders, add details to your catalog. Once the questioning round concludes, the host will give you the option of continuing the questioning or proceeding to accusations, so pay attention and decide what you'd like to do.

Refining the results

The group will vote on whether they'd like to do another round of questioning or if they'd like to move on to accusations. Use what you've learned and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* to guide your choice and vote accordingly.

If the group decides to do another round of questions, refer to the preceding scripts for suggested responses and questions for this *optional* round of questioning. You may need to improvise, as a lot of information has already been shared.

Otherwise, the group will proceed to the next round.

Once you complete the additional round or if the group decides to proceed without a second round of questioning, review your catalog in preparation for the accusation round. The host will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Accusing the Archaeological absconder!

Now that you've got as many observations out of other players as you can, it's time to decide who to accuse. Use what you learned and recorded in your catalog to guide your choice and fill out the following:

The Artifact Absconder Accusation Log

Suspect	Motive

You can then use the following template for your accusation.

I accuse...

of removing the recently discovered rosary from the *Santa Teresa Mission* because...

Keep your explanation brief as you will need to share it with everyone and they will all need to share theirs as well.

Once you've written your accusation, wait until E prompts you to share it with the group.

Now, it's your chance to reveal who you think rehoused the rosary! E will tell the group how to begin the accusation section. When it's your turn, read your accusation and its subsequent explanation.

Your host will take note of who gets the most accusations and tally those up for the final reveal! You can also keep track of who accused who, or how many accusations were made against each player in your catalog.

Pause again until all players have read their accusations. Then, the host as E - or by playing the recordings - will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Innocently *in situ* or Guilty as grindstone

Once everyone has stated who they think did think wandered away with the artifact it's time for the reveal. E will say their peace and then the host will begin having people perform their speeches. This round uses your assigned numbers and will begin either with the number right after—or right before—the number drawn after *Digging the Dirt*, which indicated the guilty party.

Speeches will then proceed in the sequence, leaving the selected stealer for last. When it's your turn please read, or improvise around, the provided speech depending on whether you were or not the guilty party.

> **If innocent:** *You may have heard of my unfortunately unlawful actions in the past but I'm done with that now. I want to see artifacts stay in their rightful places and ensure that legal and ethical stewardship rules the day.*
>
> **If guilty:** *I bent that door for a reason and Jetson didn't even try to fix it. Anyone could have gotten in to put it on the black market! So, as an officer of the law, it seemed safest to keep it in my custody until the archaeologists realized it was missing and then figured out a better way to secure their artifacts than a measly storage shed, especially, when they could not demonstrate appropriate care for the security of the find.*

Once the robber is revealed, anyone who accurately accused them wins the game. If they were only subtly suspicious, and no one accused them, the artifact absconder wins the game. E will have a few concluding words but there's nothing more for you to do now!

After the game

Once the recording, or the host as E, reads their concluding remarks, the game ends. By reaching Round Five, you will have developed your data literacy skills by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with the data provided through the game to discover the artifact absconder.Now that you've played *A Glorious Mystery*, take a chance to reflect how the game flexed your data literacy dexterity and consider how you might apply those skills again in the future.

If you desire (or require) some structure for your reflection, consider responding to the questions posed in **Part Two: The discussion guide** to aid your reflection of the game. Or explore the suggested materials from the beginning of the script using ***Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R*** or ***Of Mycenaean Men: Part Five*** to develop your data literacy dexterity or explore **museum collections**, **public libraries**, or even **keyword** or **project** search Open Context to learn more. With that we hope you enjoy playing *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*!

References and further reading

The following is a list of hyperlinked references from this player's guide. These are presented in order of appearance and do not repeat the full references for the character included under suggested materials. If any URLs in this Digital Data Story navigate to a broken page please check the **Wayback Machine** for an archived copy of the material.

Check out other Digital Data Stories here: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M74F1NW0**

Find out about the work of the Alexandria Archive Institute at: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/**

Check out Open Context for yourself here: **https://opencontext.org**

Explore Part One - The host guide at: https://doi.org/10.6078/M7GH9G20

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Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R by Paulina F. Przystupa and L. Meghan Dennis (2022): **https://doi.org/10.6078/M73N21HR**

Learn how to use a spreadsheet with *Of Myceanean Men - Part Five*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7Q81B6V**

Conduct a keyword search of Open Context using *Of Mycenaean Men - Part Four*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7TX3CHJ**

Try a project search of Open Context using *It's All in the Wrist (Bones) - Part Two*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7ZP4478**

Peruse some museum collections with the help of this article: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7S46Q2R**

Get at taste for some public library collections here: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/2025/07/10/how-to-use-the-digital-collections-of-the-nypl/**

Learn more about the saint whose name we use for our fictitious mission–Teresa of Avila–on her Wikipedia page: **https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Teresa_of_%C3%81vila**

"TTRPG Safety Toolkit: A Quick Reference Guide" by Kienna Shaw (2023) **https://web.archive.org/web/20231127094204/https://i.4pcdn.org/tg/1583202183294.pdf**

Explore Part Two at: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7B56GVG**

"Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data" by Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle (2018) **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7H70CX3**

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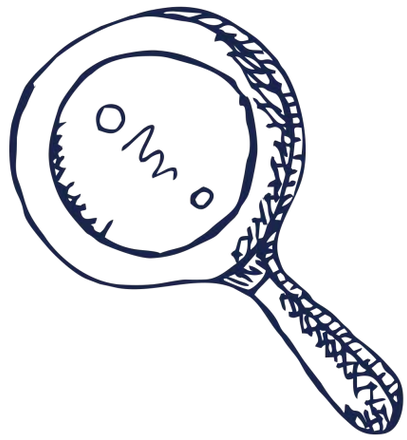
Acknowledgements

This Digital Data Story is a collaboration between its authors, our testing audiences, and the staff of AAI/OC. We are grateful to those who participated in our alpha playthrough of the game at the First Conference on Public Archaeology hosted by the Florida Public Archaeology Network Conference. These wonderful folks helped us test a prototype of this Digital Data Story and have been waiting for its release since then. We thank you for your patience as we reworked the game. We are also indebted to Katie Brewer for her help bringing gulf coast Florida to life in this approximation of the region. We also appreciate the work of the primary investigators of the *Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data* project, Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle who provide an excellent resource for comparing and learning about Spanish Missions in Florida.

The Data Stories are part of the overarching Data Literacy Program, with support from a National Endowment for the Humanities Challenge Award and a grant from the Mellon Foundation (2021-2025). Any views, findings, conclusions, or recommendations expressed in this work do not necessarily represent those of the National Endowment for the Humanities or the Mellon Foundation.

Player's guide overview



1. Introduction
2. Developing data literacy through role-play
3. How to play
4. Character background
5. Playing round scripts (don't read until asked to do so)
6. References and further readings
7. Credits
8. Acknowledgements

Estimated time to read this guide: 15 Minutes (do not read script ahead of time)

Estimated preparation time: Up to the player

Estimated play time: 1 - 3 hours depending on group size

Introduction

Welcome to the **Digital Data Stories** of the **Alexandria Archive Institute** and **Open Context**! This guide includes everything that you'll need to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery* as your assigned character and develop your data literacy. If you're also hosting the game, we encourage you to read the **hosting guide** to learn how to facilitate gameplay.

This game explores archaeological stakeholders and their relationship to archaeological data. This player's guide and script explains how the game cultivates data literacy, how to prepare to play, and the scripts for your character. This script includes character-specific background materials to use to learn more about the stakeholder you will or have portrayed.

Developing data literacy through role-play

By playing *A Glorious Mystery*, you'll develop your data literacy by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with data through the game. You'll use your **Character Background** to understand their relationship with archaeology and archaeological data and possibly learn more from their suggested sources. To delve deeper into your designated character, you can also read, respond and reflect on questions from Part Two: The discussion guide.

During the game, you'll role-play as your stakeholder, arguing their aims or communicating their conclusions using the background information and script as "raw data" that inform that archetype's actions. While playing as your character to argue and communicate, you'll use your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*** to formalize your observations into data about the other suspicious stakeholders. There you can record your recollections and use the catalog to read, work with, and analyze the data that the other characters cough up to come to the conclusion for who stole the rosary.

RELEASE DATE: 08 / 2025
VERSION: 1.0
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The table tailors the traits you should note to: Suspect, Motive, Your Evidence, Verdict, and Times Accused By. The spaces for "Suspect" and "Motive" are where you should create and read data by documenting what the other stakeholders say about themselves and the other characters. Then, you'll work with the data by examining "Your Evidence" to see patterns. For the "Verdict," you should analyze the data and decide if that particular character is the guilty party. Lastly, in "Times Accused By" you can record and tally the accusations leveraged against yours and the others.

You'll use your complete catalog to decide who to inscribe into your Artifact Absconder Accusation Log and formulate an argument, drawing from your evidence, to come to a conclusion. Then, during the penultimate round of play, you'll communicate your argument. Regardless of whether you conclude correctly, you'll use all five components of data literacy to accuse an archaeological absconder.

To further cultivate these skills, explore your suggested stakeholder sources. If you desire (or require) guidance use **Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R** or **Of Mycenaean Men - Part Five** to learn how to work with structured tabular data or conduct a **keyword** or **project** search of Open Context, **explore museum collections**, or **public libraries** to find more archaeological sources. You can also continue the conversation with **Part Two: The discussion guide** where you'll find questions about archaeology, ethics, and data to engage with and further cultivate your arguing and communicating skills.

How to play

This section explains how to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*. It begins by explaining the mystery. Following that, we provide some tips on role-play and then conclude with a synopsis of each round of play.

The mystery

> *Beadbeachville, a seaside town in Florida, is excited for the excavation season! Well, at least those visiting, watching, and working at the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission Site *are excited. First identified in the late 1970s, a new team of archaeologists has returned to the site for the last few years to uncover, recover, and preserve what remains. They've been excitedly excavating because while this Spanish colonial period Catholic religious outpost — also known as a mission — sat far from the beach when it was active, climate change related events – like more intense and regular hurricanes, sea-level rise, and soil erosion – have moved it to the water's edge. Because of that, salvage archaeology is an urgent part of the project. Beyond those threats to site integrity though, the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission *is also a fantastic blend of cultural materials from all over the region and the excavation has run smoothly for years.*
>
> *Until now. Typically, the excavation uncovered belongings (often discussed as "artifacts") that fascinated archaeologists and local history buffs, but bored tourists. This season though, the team recovered an almost completely intact set of Catholic prayer beads. Called a rosary and used for both personal and group religious practice, this artifact was strung with beads made using an Indigenous style! The discovery of the piece, at a site that also included evidence for captive African and Indigenous labor, provided an intriguing example of creolization for the region. However, before a specialist could be called in to examine the rosary and its beads in more detail, a local TV and radio show host, who happened to be at the site during the discovery, broke the news to the whole county. Tourism doubled overnight and now, to everyone's dismay, that find has disappeared! How could this happen? Did a tourist think the storage facility was a gift shop? Was it sequestered away for extra safe keeping? Did someone simply make a data entry error? Or did* You *wander away with it? An Archaeological Investigator, Ellis Thyx, has been sent to facilitate solving the mystery.*

Your host may play this character or represent them through digital recordings, with the host as their assistant. As a reminder, the town, archaeological site, mystery, and the title of "archaeological investigator" though based on places in Gulf Coast Florida, similar archaeological sites, and a kind of crime that does happen, are entirely fictitious. However, Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada, whom the fictitious mission is named, is a real Saint. Learn more about her **here**.

Role-playing tips

The Archaeological Investigator narrowed down the concerned culprits down to the people in attendance. This means that while you've seen people acting suspicious, if they're not there, they definitely didn't do it. That means you'll need to listen to the other players closely to search out the suspect or use what you've observed to distract your colleagues.

If you lack experience with role-play, stick to the included scripts. You'll get a chance to improvise in a low stakes way during Round Two and if you feel comfortable, feel free to add more improvisation as the game goes on. If you are experienced with role-play use your script and background materials as ways to ground your improvised dialogue. Regardless, remember to read from, or incorporate, your “innocent” or “guilty” script depending on whether you are the culprit during your playthrough. You may choose not to answer a question, but must tell the truth.

The Rounds

The game will be played in a series of rounds. The following summarizes how to play each round. If you're confused, ask your host to re-explain the rules before beginning or request a pause to the game before proceeding.

Round	**Explanation**
Zero	This is an out-of-character, pre-game discussion where players and host establish boundaries for play such as level of comfort with improvisation and a way to pause the game for any reason.
One - *Incised Introductions*	This is a scripted round where you'll read or improvise around your character's introduction and begin using your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities.*
Two - *Digging up the Dirt*	This is an improvised round where you will talk with other characters to dig up more dirt on the other suspects, adding to your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*. The host will end this round by drawing the number of one character to embroil them as the enigmatic embezzler. If your number is drawn, read or improvise around your guilty scripts. If not, follow your innocent scripts.
Three - *Sieving through the Secrets*	This is a scripted questioning round where you learn more about each character's movements or motives by improvising around or reading your scripted question or answer. Once everyone has been asked and answered a question, the group will vote to do another round of questioning. If the group decides to do another round, see the note for the expansion, otherwise skip to *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!* *Expansion - Refining the Results* This round is the same as the third round but when it concludes you'll proceed directly to the next round.
Round four - *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!*	This is the accusation round. Review your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities,* decide individual verdicts, and then list who you think did it in your *Artifact Absconder Accusation Log*. Use this to fill out a standard scripted accusation, or improvise around it. Then each player will read their accusation. You can keep track of these in your catalog.
Round five - *Innocently in situ or Guilty as grindstone*	This is the scripted confessions round, which aims to unmask the mysterious material culture mover. When your number comes up, read, or improvise around, your innocent or guilty script as appropriate.

Faith Full

Here is some background on your character, explaining who they are, what they know, and suggested materials you can read ahead of time, or after the game, to learn more about the stakeholder archetype you will, or have, portrayed. Following this character background are instructions for how much of the script you can read before playing.

Character notes and suggested background materials

Stakeholder archetype	Local parishioner at a nearby Catholic church who cares about church history.
Character description	You are a local parishioner in Beadbeachville's present-day Catholic Church and are a respectful portrayal of a church lady or man or religious Auntie or Uncle character. While potentially dogmatic, you aren't necessarily stuck in ideology about your faith. You read about the history of the church (including the role it played in colonization), take the time to interpret theological teaching yourself, and may be familiar with biblical archaeology broadly as a way to further complement historical accounts.
Your relationship to the site	is through the desire to have the rosary, or something else from the mission, housed at the local church to showcase the history of Catholicism in the area.
You're hiding the fact that...	you have a collection of rosaries and other prayer beads with one set that you think looked a lot like the archaeological artifacts based on what you've overheard from diners at the cafe. You're not sure where that similar looking rosary went though...
Someone observed you...	walking along the shore of the site and dropping something from your collection of beadwork, possibly the one that had a similar look as the missing rosary.
You noticed someone else...	that orders a specific coffee has been at your diner leaving napkins behind with artifact illustrations, one of which was the rosary. You remember it said, "Is this the one to keep?"
You witnessed...	William accidentally inform everyone waiting for confession about his moral struggles with the mission. While waiting your turn, his voice boomed from the confessional and you recognized it because that's the same one that's recently added an espresso with sweetened condensed milk on top of his normal black drip coffee, always signed with a little highrise.
Suggested character reference materials	HMS (Heritage Monitoring Scouts) Florida - **https://www.fpan.us/training-courses/hms-florida/** Florida Historic Cemetery Inventory - **https://www.fpan.us/projects/florida-historic-cemetery-inventory/** By These Hands: The Vernacular Markers of Pensacola's Historic African American Cemeteries - **https://www.fpan.us/projects/by-these-hands/** Biblical Archaeology - **https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Biblical_archaeology**

You can read the next two pages before playing. The first is your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities***, where you will record what you know about the other characters. You'll want to return to this page to note new observations made during the game to help decide who committed the rosary robbery and track accusations.

The page after that is ***Round One - Incised Introductions***. You may read through your scripted introduction and the reminder of your personal secret. The scripts are an example of how your character might talk. You can read the script exactly or improvise around it as you feel comfortable. At the bottom of that page are directions that tell you to stop reading. Please follow these directions to maintain in-game suspense.

Lastly, your host should have given you a number with your character assignment or you will pick one at the start of play. Keep that handy for the end of *Round Two - Digging up the Dirt*, so you know whether you're guilty or innocent during the game.

Catalog of Culprit Capabilities

Suspect	Motive	Your Evidence	Verdict	Times Accused By

Incised Introductions

During this round, you will introduce yourself to your fellow stakeholders by reading the following script or using it as a guide for an improvised introduction. You may embody the character however you wish, but don't add any more information or details beyond the introduction right now. Let the others get to know you over the next few rounds.

> *Hello. You've probably all met me already but I'm Faith and I own and operate the local diner* Mission: Meals*. I don't recognize all your faces but I probably know your voices and your coffee orders! I'm a long time resident of Beadbeachville and find the discovery at the Mission inspiring, as an active member of the current Catholic community here in town.*

The following is a narrative version of your motivations, suspicions, and secrets as they relate to the site. You'll want to draw from this and your character notes during subsequent rounds but don't add any of this to your introduction. Also, keep some of this as secret as you can so you don't incriminate yourself as the rosary robber! But beware, you may not be the only one who knows about them. No one's as subtle as they think they are.

> *You are a local and pious parishioner in Beadbeachville who owns the local diner,* Mission: Meals*. While you're a devout Catholic, your parents taught you that belief in the Savior is not the same as uncritical belief in institutions. Due to this, you're very aware and interested in opening the dialogue about Catholic history in Beadbeachville to see how the church could make amends. Because sometimes it's individuals, and sometimes its institutions, that make bad choices. Even the Pope has suggested as much. You're interested in the rosary as a sacred object but also as one that strikes at the heart of the complexities of the Catholic faith. You hoped that an object like that might help others in your parish understand this complicated part of Church history. Your interest in the complexities of Catholicism and Catholic history led to your collection of rosaries and prayer beads from all over the world and love to buy ones made by local people whenever you travel. You happened by Sellsalotta's place and noticed that they already had something that looked like the historic rosary and thought that would be cool to add to your collection. So you bought it, but seem to have misplaced it. It might have been while you were walking along the shore recently, where you go to meditate on each Sunday's readings. You remember tripping while you were walking along the shore near the archaeological site recently. You might have dropped it there but didn't notice until much later returned to the diner for the dinner rush. Generally, you're not the best with faces, but you've got a knack for connecting people's voices with their food orders. Especially if they're regulars. You don't take everyone's order but you've noticed since the archaeologists got back to town that someone who usually eats with Mr. Ding is quite the talented artist and knows quite a bit about the archaeological site. You picked up an excellent drawing of the rosary from their seat on a napkin, but were concerned that it also said, "Is this the one to take?" Finding that wasn't long before the rosary was taken. However, you also know Bill's been thinking about the site too. While it's never your intention to overhear people, the confessional at the local church was not soundproofed when it was built, so folks with bigger voices, like Bill, can often be accidentally overheard. Most people can't just recognize a voice but with your attunement from the diner, you know it's him and were reminded of his typical coffee order.*

Pause here until everyone has introduced themselves. The host as the character Ellis Thyx, just E for short, the Archaeological Investigator—or by playing the recording of E—will prompt you to proceed to the next page and round of the game.

Digging up the Dirt

This round your goal is to see what your fellow ethically-ambiguous allies know about the disappearance of the rosary and if they know anything about you. Be as subtle as you can because, as you inquire, these other observations could help you decide whose behavior was the most suspicious. As a reminder, here are some things that you've seen going on around Beadbeachville that you might want to ask the other stakeholders about.

You noticed someone else...	that orders a specific coffee has been at your diner leaving napkins behind with artifact illustrations, one of which was the rosary. You remember it said, "Is this the one to keep?"
You witnessed...	William accidentally inform everyone waiting for confession about his moral struggles with the mission. While waiting your turn, his voice boomed from the confessional and you recognized it because that's the same one that's recently added an espresso with sweetened condensed milk on top of his normal black drip coffee, always signed with a little highrise.

Take some time during this round to put notes in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* so you can keep track of all the evidence you uncover.

Pause here when you've finished conversing. Once the host—either as E or as the character they're playing—concludes discussion, they will reveal whether you are the culprit.

If your number is selected, read from the "guilty" scripts provided or improvise around them. If your number is not selected, portray the character using the "innocent" scripts or improvise around that information. Remember, you cannot lie but you can be evasive.

The host—either as E or by playing the recording—will prompt you to begin the next round.

Sieving the secrets

Now that you've learned more about the other stakeholders—as well as what they know about the site and you—decide which character(s) you'd like to interrogate in front of everyone. During this round, you can only ask one person, one question and you can't pick the person who asked you a question or someone who has already been asked a question, so be clever and strategic!

Feel free to use the scripted questions below, which are based on the suspicious behaviors you witnessed. You may also create your own question based on the other observations you've made and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* from the preceding rounds. Remember, only the stakeholders present in the room could have done it.

> **Looking for someone suspicious:** *Do you recognize the style of this illustration? It's because the drawing also says "is this the one to keep" and looks an awful lot like the rosary that I decided to keep it.*
>
> **You know this person was doing something odd:** *Bill, you've got quite a voice on you. I didn't mean to, but I think it was you asking for clarity during confession about the excavations at the mission and your developments, why would you need spiritual guidance about that?*

When another character questions you, you cannot lie but you can be evasive. If they ask you their suggested question, the following is your answer to it. You may choose to read it verbatim or improvise around it.

> **If innocent:** *I do have prayer beads that look a lot like the one that went missing. I was surprised to see how old that style of beadwork was but mine are all made of plastic. I wonder how people learned to replicate such a similar style in a synthetic material!*
>
> **If guilty:** *I collect prayer beads like rosaries from all over the world and even those of other faiths. And, I'll admit, I have lost sets before but that's because I tend to have at least one set on me wherever I go. You never know when you might need to take some time to meditate and refocus your day on the Lord!*

If another character asks you a question where the suggested response does not make sense, answer it as truthfully as you can based on what you know or suspect. It's a great chance to share something you'd like others to know about or to deflect attention to someone else.

Pause here until all players have asked and answered a question. As you listen to the other stakeholders, add details to your catalog. Once the questioning round concludes, the host will give you the option of continuing the questioning or proceeding to accusations, so pay attention and decide what you'd like to do.

Refining the results

The group will vote on whether they'd like to do another round of questioning or if they'd like to move on to accusations. Use what you've learned and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* to guide your choice and vote accordingly.

If the group decides to do another round of questions, refer to the preceding scripts for suggested responses and questions for this *optional* round of questioning. You may need to improvise, as a lot of information has already been shared.

Otherwise, the group will proceed to the next round.

Once you complete the additional round or if the group decides to proceed without a second round of questioning, review your catalog in preparation for the accusation round. The host will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Accusing the Archaeological absconder!

Now that you've got as many observations out of other players as you can, it's time to decide who to accuse. Use what you learned and recorded in your catalog to guide your choice and fill out the following:

The Artifact Absconder Accusation Log

Suspect	Motive

You can then use the following template for your accusation.

I accuse...

of removing the recently discovered rosary from the *Santa Teresa Mission* because..

Keep your explanation brief as you will need to share it with everyone and they will all need to share theirs as well.

Once you've written your accusation, wait until E prompts you to share it with the group.

Now, it's your chance to reveal who you think rehoused the rosary! E will tell the group how to begin the accusation section. When it's your turn, read your accusation and its subsequent explanation.

Your host will take note of who gets the most accusations and tally those up for the final reveal! You can also keep track of who accused who, or how many accusations were made against each player in your catalog.

Pause again until all players have read their accusations. Then, the host as E - or by playing the recordings - will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Innocently *in situ* or Guilty as grindstone

Once everyone has stated who they think did think wandered away with the artifact it's time for the reveal. E will say their peace and then the host will begin having people perform their speeches. This round uses your assigned numbers and will begin either with the number right after—or right before—the number drawn after *Digging the Dirt*, which indicated the guilty party.

Speeches will then proceed in the sequence, leaving the selected stealer for last. When it's your turn please read, or improvise around, the provided speech depending on whether you were or not the guilty party.

> **If innocent:** *I want to find a way to celebrate the Catholic history of Beadbeachville in a way that embraces the good and the bad. Learning about what all of you know about the site, I'd want to keep learning about that rather than keep just one artifact for the parish.*
>
> **If guilty:** *My hope was that by having the rosary as tangible proof of the enduring, yet complex, relationship between Missionaries and Indigenous peoples, it would inspire my fellow parishioners to improve their understanding of Church history in Florida. Specifically, that Catholicism in the Americas shouldn't only be understood from the perspective of the Spanish. And until the uproar died down, I thought the rosary could safely live amongst my collection of other prayer beads.*

Once the robber is revealed, anyone who accurately accused them wins the game. If they were only subtly suspicious, and no one accused them, the artifact absconder wins the game. E will have a few concluding words but there's nothing more for you to do now!

After the game

Once the recording, or the host as E, reads their concluding remarks, the game ends. By reaching Round Five, you will have developed your data literacy skills by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with the data provided through the game to discover the artifact absconder.Now that you've played *A Glorious Mystery*, take a chance to reflect how the game flexed your data literacy dexterity and consider how you might apply those skills again in the future.

If you desire (or require) some structure for your reflection, consider responding to the questions posed in **Part Two: The discussion guide** to aid your reflection of the game. Or explore the suggested materials from the beginning of the script using ***Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R*** or ***Of Mycenaean Men: Part Five*** to develop your data literacy dexterity or explore **museum collections**, **public libraries**, or even **keyword** or **project** search Open Context to learn more. With that we hope you enjoy playing *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*!

References and further reading

The following is a list of hyperlinked references from this player's guide. These are presented in order of appearance and do not repeat the full references for the character included under suggested materials. If any URLs in this Digital Data Story navigate to a broken page please check the **Wayback Machine** for an archived copy of the material.

Check out other Digital Data Stories here: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M74F1NW0**

Find out about the work of the Alexandria Archive Institute at: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/**

Check out Open Context for yourself here: **https://opencontext.org**

Explore Part One - The host guide at: https://doi.org/10.6078/M7GH9G20

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Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R by Paulina F. Przystupa and L. Meghan Dennis (2022): **https://doi.org/10.6078/M73N21HR**

Learn how to use a spreadsheet with *Of Myceanean Men - Part Five*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7Q81B6V**

Conduct a keyword search of Open Context using *Of Mycenaean Men - Part Four*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7TX3CHJ**

Try a project search of Open Context using *It's All in the Wrist (Bones) - Part Two*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7ZP4478**

Peruse some museum collections with the help of this article: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7S46Q2R**

Get at taste for some public library collections here: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/2025/07/10/how-to-use-the-digital-collections-of-the-nypl/**

Learn more about the saint whose name we use for our fictitious mission–Teresa of Avila–on her Wikipedia page: **https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Teresa_of_%C3%81vila**

"TTRPG Safety Toolkit: A Quick Reference Guide" by Kienna Shaw (2023) **https://web.archive.org/web/20231127094204/https://i.4pcdn.org/tg/1583202183294.pdf**

Explore Part Two at: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7B56GVG**

"Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data" by Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle (2018) **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7H70CX3**

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Acknowledgements

This Digital Data Story is a collaboration between its authors, our testing audiences, and the staff of AAI/OC. We are grateful to those who participated in our alpha playthrough of the game at the First Conference on Public Archaeology hosted by the Florida Public Archaeology Network Conference. These wonderful folks helped us test a prototype of this Digital Data Story and have been waiting for its release since then. We thank you for your patience as we reworked the game. We are also indebted to Katie Brewer for her help bringing gulf coast Florida to life in this approximation of the region. We also appreciate the work of the primary investigators of the *Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data* project, Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle who provide an excellent resource for comparing and learning about Spanish Missions in Florida.

The Data Stories are part of the overarching Data Literacy Program, with support from a National Endowment for the Humanities Challenge Award and a grant from the Mellon Foundation (2021-2025). Any views, findings, conclusions, or recommendations expressed in this work do not necessarily represent those of the National Endowment for the Humanities or the Mellon Foundation.

Player's guide overview

1. Introduction
2. Developing data literacy through role-play
3. How to play
4. Character background
5. Playing round scripts (don't read until asked to do so)
6. References and further readings
7. Credits
8. Acknowledgements

Estimated time to read this guide: 15 Minutes (do not read script ahead of time)

Estimated preparation time: Up to the player

Estimated play time: 1 - 3 hours depending on group size

Introduction

Welcome to the **Digital Data Stories** of the **Alexandria Archive Institute** and **Open Context**! This guide includes everything that you'll need to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery* as your assigned character and develop your data literacy. If you're also hosting the game, we encourage you to read the **hosting guide** to learn how to facilitate gameplay.

This game explores archaeological stakeholders and their relationship to archaeological data. This player's guide and script explains how the game cultivates data literacy, how to prepare to play, and the scripts for your character. This script includes character-specific background materials to use to learn more about the stakeholder you will or have portrayed.

Developing data literacy through role-play

By playing *A Glorious Mystery*, you'll develop your data literacy by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with data through the game. You'll use your **Character Background** to understand their relationship with archaeology and archaeological data and possibly learn more from their suggested sources. To delve deeper into your designated character, you can also read, respond and reflect on questions from Part Two: The discussion guide.

During the game, you'll role-play as your stakeholder, arguing their aims or communicating their conclusions using the background information and script as "raw data" that inform that archetype's actions. While playing as your character to argue and communicate, you'll use your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*** to formalize your observations into data about the other suspicious stakeholders. There you can record your recollections and use the catalog to read, work with, and analyze the data that the other characters cough up to come to the conclusion for who stole the rosary.

RELEASE DATE: 08 / 2025
VERSION: 1.0
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The table tailors the traits you should note to: Suspect, Motive, Your Evidence, Verdict, and Times Accused By. The spaces for "Suspect" and "Motive" are where you should create and read data by documenting what the other stakeholders say about themselves and the other characters. Then, you'll work with the data by examining "Your Evidence" to see patterns. For the "Verdict," you should analyze the data and decide if that particular character is the guilty party. Lastly, in "Times Accused By" you can record and tally the accusations leveraged against yours and the others.

You'll use your complete catalog to decide who to inscribe into your Artifact Absconder Accusation Log and formulate an argument, drawing from your evidence, to come to a conclusion. Then, during the penultimate round of play, you'll communicate your argument. Regardless of whether you conclude correctly, you'll use all five components of data literacy to accuse an archaeological absconder.

To further cultivate these skills, explore your suggested stakeholder sources. If you desire (or require) guidance use **Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R** or **Of Mycenaean Men - Part Five** to learn how to work with structured tabular data or conduct a **keyword** or **project** search of Open Context, **explore museum collections**, or **public libraries** to find more archaeological sources. You can also continue the conversation with **Part Two: The discussion guide** where you'll find questions about archaeology, ethics, and data to engage with and further cultivate your arguing and communicating skills.

How to play

This section explains how to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*. It begins by explaining the mystery. Following that, we provide some tips on role-play and then conclude with a synopsis of each round of play.

The mystery

> *Beadbeachville, a seaside town in Florida, is excited for the excavation season! Well, at least those visiting, watching, and working at the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission Site *are excited. First identified in the late 1970s, a new team of archaeologists has returned to the site for the last few years to uncover, recover, and preserve what remains. They've been excitedly excavating because while this Spanish colonial period Catholic religious outpost — also known as a mission — sat far from the beach when it was active, climate change related events – like more intense and regular hurricanes, sea-level rise, and soil erosion – have moved it to the water's edge. Because of that, salvage archaeology is an urgent part of the project. Beyond those threats to site integrity though, the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission *is also a fantastic blend of cultural materials from all over the region and the excavation has run smoothly for years.*
>
> *Until now. Typically, the excavation uncovered belongings (often discussed as "artifacts") that fascinated archaeologists and local history buffs, but bored tourists. This season though, the team recovered an almost completely intact set of Catholic prayer beads. Called a rosary and used for both personal and group religious practice, this artifact was strung with beads made using an Indigenous style! The discovery of the piece, at a site that also included evidence for captive African and Indigenous labor, provided an intriguing example of creolization for the region. However, before a specialist could be called in to examine the rosary and its beads in more detail, a local TV and radio show host, who happened to be at the site during the discovery, broke the news to the whole county. Tourism doubled overnight and now, to everyone's dismay, that find has disappeared! How could this happen? Did a tourist think the storage facility was a gift shop? Was it sequestered away for extra safe keeping? Did someone simply make a data entry error? Or did* You *wander away with it? An Archaeological Investigator, Ellis Thyx, has been sent to facilitate solving the mystery.*

Your host may play this character or represent them through digital recordings, with the host as their assistant. As a reminder, the town, archaeological site, mystery, and the title of "archaeological investigator" though based on places in Gulf Coast Florida, similar archaeological sites, and a kind of crime that does happen, are entirely fictitious. However, Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada, whom the fictitious mission is named, is a real Saint. Learn more about her **here**.

Role-playing tips

The Archaeological Investigator narrowed down the concerned culprits down to the people in attendance. This means that while you've seen people acting suspicious, if they're not there, they definitely didn't do it. That means you'll need to listen to the other players closely to search out the suspect or use what you've observed to distract your colleagues.

If you lack experience with role-play, stick to the included scripts. You'll get a chance to improvise in a low stakes way during Round Two and if you feel comfortable, feel free to add more improvisation as the game goes on. If you are experienced with role-play use your script and background materials as ways to ground your improvised dialogue. Regardless, remember to read from, or incorporate, your “innocent” or “guilty” script depending on whether you are the culprit during your playthrough. You may choose not to answer a question, but must tell the truth.

The Rounds

The game will be played in a series of rounds. The following summarizes how to play each round. If you're confused, ask your host to re-explain the rules before beginning or request a pause to the game before proceeding.

Round	**Explanation**
Zero	This is an out-of-character, pre-game discussion where players and host establish boundaries for play such as level of comfort with improvisation and a way to pause the game for any reason.
One - *Incised Introductions*	This is a scripted round where you'll read or improvise around your character's introduction and begin using your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities.*
Two - *Digging up the Dirt*	This is an improvised round where you will talk with other characters to dig up more dirt on the other suspects, adding to your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*. The host will end this round by drawing the number of one character to embroil them as the enigmatic embezzler. If your number is drawn, read or improvise around your guilty scripts. If not, follow your innocent scripts.
Three - *Sieving through the Secrets*	This is a scripted questioning round where you learn more about each character's movements or motives by improvising around or reading your scripted question or answer. Once everyone has been asked and answered a question, the group will vote to do another round of questioning. If the group decides to do another round, see the note for the expansion, otherwise skip to *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!* *Expansion - Refining the Results* This round is the same as the third round but when it concludes you'll proceed directly to the next round.
Round four - *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!*	This is the accusation round. Review your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities,* decide individual verdicts, and then list who you think did it in your *Artifact Absconder Accusation Log*. Use this to fill out a standard scripted accusation, or improvise around it. Then each player will read their accusation. You can keep track of these in your catalog.
Round five - *Innocently in situ or Guilty as grindstone*	This is the scripted confessions round, which aims to unmask the mysterious material culture mover. When your number comes up, read, or improvise around, your innocent or guilty script as appropriate.

Jess V. Z. Ting

Here is some background on your character, explaining who they are, what they know, and suggested materials you can read ahead of time, or after the game, to learn more about the stakeholder archetype you will, or have, portrayed. Following this character background are instructions for how much of the script you can read before playing.

Character notes and suggested background materials

Stakeholder archetype	An out-of-state tourist and recent undergraduate.
Character description	You are an out-of-state tourist with a recently obtained BA in anthropology and a lot of opinions about archaeology. You care about and advocate for open science but you never learned about the problems that come with "making everything open". For example, you think *all* science and data should be open and have never thought about how that would impact culturally sensitive materials, like human remains. You have turned a little bit of knowledge into a whole lot of opinion.
Your relationship to the site	is as a tourist who thinks that important artifacts, like the rosary, should go to bigger museums outside of Beadbeachville. That way the greater public, rather than just local people or visitors to this small town, can have easier access to those finds.
You're hiding the fact that...	you've tried to rehouse artifacts to a new museum before and weirdly that cop who showed up at that "archaeological ethics and stewardship" seminar, Emma, is also in Beadbeachville.
Someone observed you...	complaining about how inaccessible the collection from the mission was and how it should all be rehoused at a bigger museum. You may also have tried to do that yourself in the past (with materials from a different site) and someone in Beadbeachville might know about that.
You noticed someone else...	comment about how the storage shed at the site had poor security and that they might just show those archaeologists a thing or two by testing their security, and maybe removing a significant find.
You witnessed...	Emma and Sellsallotta discussing fines for artifact theft at Faith's Diner, specifically, Sellsalotta asking if the fines were higher if the artifacts were "Indigenous".
Suggested character reference materials	"Data Management Policies and Practices of Digital Archaeological Repositories" by Guntram Geser, Julian Richards, Flavia Massara and Holly Wright - **https://doi.org/10.11141/ia.59.2** FAIR Principles - **https://www.go-fair.org/fair-principles/** "Aligning restricted access data with FAIR: a systematic review" by Margherita Martorana, Tobias Kuhn, Ronald Siebes, and Jacco van Ossenbruggen - **https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC9454861/** The CARE Principles for Indigenous Data Governance - **https://www.gida-global.org/care** About Local Contexts and the Hub - **https://localcontexts.org/about/**

You can read the next two pages before playing. The first is your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities***, where you will record what you know about the other characters. You'll want to return to this page to note new observations made during the game to help decide who committed the rosary robbery and track accusations.

The page after that is ***Round One - Incised Introductions***. You may read through your scripted introduction and the reminder of your personal secret. The scripts are an example of how your character might talk. You can read the script exactly or improvise around it as you feel comfortable. At the bottom of that page are directions that tell you to stop reading. Please follow these directions to maintain in-game suspense.

Lastly, your host should have given you a number with your character assignment or you will pick one at the start of play. Keep that handy for the end of *Round Two - Digging up the Dirt*, so you know whether you're guilty or innocent during the game.

Catalog of Culprit Capabilities

Suspect	Motive	Your Evidence	Verdict	Times Accused By

Incised Introductions

During this round, you will introduce yourself to your fellow stakeholders by reading the following script or using it as a guide for an improvised introduction. You may embody the character however you wish, but don't add any more information or details beyond the introduction right now. Let the others get to know you over the next few rounds.

> *Jess. I decided to come to Beadbeachville because I assumed there would be, like, a beach. And maybe some, bead stores? I don't know. I just wanted to have a relaxing summer vacation. I like museums too I guess, like those big displays that include artifacts from, like, a bunch of different places. They remind me how we're, like, all citizens of the world.*

The following is a narrative version of your motivations, suspicions, and secrets as they relate to the site. You'll want to draw from this and your character notes during subsequent rounds but don't add any of this to your introduction. Also, keep some of this as secret as you can so you don't incriminate yourself as the rosary robber! But beware, you may not be the only one who knows about them. No one's as subtle as they think they are.

> *You're visiting from out of state on a whim to see Beadbeachville. You are interested in both beads and the beach but are bothered by how hard it was to get to this supposed tourist destination. You have a BA in anthropology and took a class where they discussed Spanish mission sites, so you are pretty sure you know what you're talking about when it comes to archaeology at the* Santa Teresa MIssion *(but not enough to know that you don't actually know what you're talking about). Although you definitely know* everything *about archaeology, you had to do some stupid training about "ethics" and "stewardship" once and you think Officer Kaup was there too. She seemed pretty quiet and kept giving you strange looks when you talked about "public access" and "open science" and letting "scientists do their job". You were only there because at another small site, which was restricting the public's access to collections, you tried to rehouse artifacts. Which, whatever, those other archaeologists and that seminar leader clearly did not know enough to understand your illuminating insights about open data. Back in Beadbeachville though, after hearing about the rosary you think something so fantastic should go to a city with more resources, because clearly this isn't the right spot for it, with so few ways for people to see it. Especially after walking into Sellsalotta's place and seeing "locally made" souvenirs that clearly looked like artifacts. While you were on the tour of the site you overheard someone complain about the security of the site and that they were going to test that out. Perhaps they removed a significant find at the same time? At some point during your stay, you saw Sellsalotta (who you recognized from the shop) ask Emma if the fines were higher if stuff was "Indigenous". That made you even more sure that the "locally made" souvenirs might be illegally obtained. You're not sure if it's the same person though because why would Emma let Selsallotta keep her store open with all those (you're pretty sure) real and stolen artifacts on sale?*

Pause here until everyone has introduced themselves. The host as the character Ellis Thyx, just E for short, the Archaeological Investigator—or by playing the recording of E—will prompt you to proceed to the next page and round of the game.

Digging up the Dirt

This round your goal is to see what your fellow ethically-ambiguous allies know about the disappearance of the rosary and if they know anything about you. Be as subtle as you can because, as you inquire, these other observations could help you decide whose behavior was the most suspicious. As a reminder, here are some things that you've seen going on around Beadbeachville that you might want to ask the other stakeholders about.

You noticed someone else...	comment about how the storage shed at the site had poor security and that they might just show those archaeologists a thing or two by testing their security, and maybe removing a significant find.
You witnessed...	Emma and Sellsallotta discussing fines for artifact theft at Faith's Diner, specifically, Sellsalotta asking if the fines were higher if the artifacts were "Indigenous".

Take some time during this round to put notes in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* so you can keep track of all the evidence you uncover.

Pause here when you've finished conversing. Once the host—either as E or as the character they're playing—concludes discussion, they will reveal whether you are the culprit.

If your number is selected, read from the "guilty" scripts provided or improvise around them. If your number is not selected, portray the character using the "innocent" scripts or improvise around that information. Remember, you cannot lie but you can be evasive.

The host—either as E or by playing the recording—will prompt you to begin the next round.

Sieving the secrets

Now that you've learned more about the other stakeholders—as well as what they know about the site and you—decide which character(s) you'd like to interrogate in front of everyone. During this round, you can only ask one person, one question and you can't pick the person who asked you a question or someone who has already been asked a question, so be clever and strategic!

Feel free to use the scripted questions below, which are based on the suspicious behaviors you witnessed. You may also create your own question based on the other observations you've made and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* from the preceding rounds. Remember, only the stakeholders present in the room could have done it.

> **Looking for someone suspicious:** *Do you have an interest in the security of the archaeological finds at this site and a means of testing that security?*
>
> **You know this person was doing something odd:** *Sellsalotta, why do you know so much about fines for stolen artifacts? And why do you care about whether stuff is Indigenous?*

When another character questions you, you cannot lie but you can be evasive. If they ask you their suggested question, the following is your answer to it. You may choose to read it verbatim or improvise around it.

> **If innocent:** *Yeah that was me, and I stand by that claim. If someone has to come all the way out here to learn about the mission this collection is essentially inaccessible to the public and I don't remember anyone on the tour discussing any data or collections sharing agreements with larger institutions, which just bothered me!*
>
> **If guilty:** *I know some of you might not know what stakeholders are but, as a citizen of the world, I am one. So, it bothered me that the tour didn't mention anything about how the project was going to make their collection FAIR. For those of you that don't know, FAIR is Findable, Accessible, Interoperable, and Reproducible and it's the best way for archaeology to uphold its commitment to stakeholders like me. It's hardly even accessible right now, so how can I trust that y'all will do anything about the other FAIR principles?*

If another character asks you a question where the suggested response does not make sense, answer it as truthfully as you can based on what you know or suspect. It's a great chance to share something you'd like others to know about or to deflect attention to someone else.

Pause here until all players have asked and answered a question. As you listen to the other stakeholders, add details to your catalog. Once the questioning round concludes, the host will give you the option of continuing the questioning or proceeding to accusations, so pay attention and decide what you'd like to do.

Refining the results

The group will vote on whether they'd like to do another round of questioning or if they'd like to move on to accusations. Use what you've learned and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* to guide your choice and vote accordingly.

If the group decides to do another round of questions, refer to the preceding scripts for suggested responses and questions for this *optional* round of questioning. You may need to improvise, as a lot of information has already been shared.

Otherwise, the group will proceed to the next round.

Once you complete the additional round or if the group decides to proceed without a second round of questioning, review your catalog in preparation for the accusation round. The host will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Accusing the Archaeological absconder!

Now that you've got as many observations out of other players as you can, it's time to decide who to accuse. Use what you learned and recorded in your catalog to guide your choice and fill out the following:

The Artifact Absconder Accusation Log

Suspect	Motive

You can then use the following template for your accusation.

I accuse...

of removing the recently discovered rosary from the *Santa Teresa Mission* because...

Keep your explanation brief as you will need to share it with everyone and they will all need to share theirs as well.

Once you've written your accusation, wait until E prompts you to share it with the group.

Now, it's your chance to reveal who you think rehoused the rosary! E will tell the group how to begin the accusation section. When it's your turn, read your accusation and its subsequent explanation.

Your host will take note of who gets the most accusations and tally those up for the final reveal! You can also keep track of who accused who, or how many accusations were made against each player in your catalog.

Pause again until all players have read their accusations. Then, the host as E - or by playing the recordings - will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Innocently *in situ* or Guilty as grindstone

Once everyone has stated who they think did think wandered away with the artifact it's time for the reveal. E will say their peace and then the host will begin having people perform their speeches. This round uses your assigned numbers and will begin either with the number right after—or right before—the number drawn after *Digging the Dirt*, which indicated the guilty party.

Speeches will then proceed in the sequence, leaving the selected stealer for last. When it's your turn please read, or improvise around, the provided speech depending on whether you were or not the guilty party.

> **If innocent:** *I'm just a tourist. I don't really have much stake in this place, besides in a general sense. While it would be nice to see artifacts like the rosary in a more accessible place and institution, because such rare materials belong to the world, I'm not going to ruin my vacation by stealing something to make it accessible. Or well, at least not this time.*
>
> **If guilty:** *Fine. Yes. I removed the rosary. When I was on the tour, it didn't seem like storing it in that measly storage shed was secure enough. A dented door and with windows people could peer into? So I removed it to make sure that it would go to a repository that was going to take its safety seriously. At a larger institution with a developed open collections and data policy, this artifact would clearly be better taken care of.*

Once the robber is revealed, anyone who accurately accused them wins the game. If they were only subtly suspicious, and no one accused them, the artifact absconder wins the game. E will have a few concluding words but there's nothing more for you to do now!

After the game

Once the recording, or the host as E, reads their concluding remarks, the game ends. By reaching Round Five, you will have developed your data literacy skills by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with the data provided through the game to discover the artifact absconder.Now that you've played *A Glorious Mystery*, take a chance to reflect how the game flexed your data literacy dexterity and consider how you might apply those skills again in the future.

If you desire (or require) some structure for your reflection, consider responding to the questions posed in **Part Two: The discussion guide** to aid your reflection of the game. Or explore the suggested materials from the beginning of the script using ***Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R*** or ***Of Mycenaean Men: Part Five*** to develop your data literacy dexterity or explore **museum collections**, **public libraries**, or even **keyword** or **project** search Open Context to learn more. With that we hope you enjoy playing *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*!

References and further reading

The following is a list of hyperlinked references from this player's guide. These are presented in order of appearance and do not repeat the full references for the character included under suggested materials. If any URLs in this Digital Data Story navigate to a broken page please check the **Wayback Machine** for an archived copy of the material.

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Explore Part One - The host guide at: https://doi.org/10.6078/M7GH9G20

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Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R by Paulina F. Przystupa and L. Meghan Dennis (2022): **https://doi.org/10.6078/M73N21HR**

Learn how to use a spreadsheet with *Of Myceanean Men - Part Five*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7Q81B6V**

Conduct a keyword search of Open Context using *Of Mycenaean Men - Part Four*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7TX3CHJ**

Try a project search of Open Context using *It's All in the Wrist (Bones) - Part Two*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7ZP4478**

Peruse some museum collections with the help of this article: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7S46Q2R**

Get at taste for some public library collections here: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/2025/07/10/how-to-use-the-digital-collections-of-the-nypl/**

Learn more about the saint whose name we use for our fictitious mission–Teresa of Avila–on her Wikipedia page: **https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Teresa_of_%C3%81vila**

"TTRPG Safety Toolkit: A Quick Reference Guide" by Kienna Shaw (2023) **https://web.archive.org/web/20231127094204/https://i.4pcdn.org/tg/1583202183294.pdf**

Explore Part Two at: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7B56GVG**

"Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data" by Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle (2018) **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7H70CX3**

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Acknowledgements

This Digital Data Story is a collaboration between its authors, our testing audiences, and the staff of AAI/OC. We are grateful to those who participated in our alpha playthrough of the game at the First Conference on Public Archaeology hosted by the Florida Public Archaeology Network Conference. These wonderful folks helped us test a prototype of this Digital Data Story and have been waiting for its release since then. We thank you for your patience as we reworked the game. We are also indebted to Katie Brewer for her help bringing gulf coast Florida to life in this approximation of the region. We also appreciate the work of the primary investigators of the *Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data* project, Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle who provide an excellent resource for comparing and learning about Spanish Missions in Florida.

The Data Stories are part of the overarching Data Literacy Program, with support from a National Endowment for the Humanities Challenge Award and a grant from the Mellon Foundation (2021-2025). Any views, findings, conclusions, or recommendations expressed in this work do not necessarily represent those of the National Endowment for the Humanities or the Mellon Foundation.

Player's guide overview

1. Introduction
2. Developing data literacy through role-play
3. How to play
4. Character background
5. Playing round scripts (don't read until asked to do so)
6. References and further readings
7. Credits
8. Acknowledgements

Estimated time to read this guide: 15 Minutes (do not read script ahead of time)

Estimated preparation time: Up to the player

Estimated play time: 1 - 3 hours depending on group size

Introduction

Welcome to the **Digital Data Stories** of the **Alexandria Archive Institute** and **Open Context**! This guide includes everything that you'll need to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery* as your assigned character and develop your data literacy. If you're also hosting the game, we encourage you to read the **hosting guide** to learn how to facilitate gameplay.

This game explores archaeological stakeholders and their relationship to archaeological data. This player's guide and script explains how the game cultivates data literacy, how to prepare to play, and the scripts for your character. This script includes character-specific background materials to use to learn more about the stakeholder you will or have portrayed.

Developing data literacy through role-play

By playing *A Glorious Mystery*, you'll develop your data literacy by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with data through the game. You'll use your **Character Background** to understand their relationship with archaeology and archaeological data and possibly learn more from their suggested sources. To delve deeper into your designated character, you can also read, respond and reflect on questions from Part Two: The discussion guide.

During the game, you'll role-play as your stakeholder, arguing their aims or communicating their conclusions using the background information and script as "raw data" that inform that archetype's actions. While playing as your character to argue and communicate, you'll use your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*** to formalize your observations into data about the other suspicious stakeholders. There you can record your recollections and use the catalog to read, work with, and analyze the data that the other characters cough up to come to the conclusion for who stole the rosary.

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VERSION: 1.0
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The table tailors the traits you should note to: Suspect, Motive, Your Evidence, Verdict, and Times Accused By. The spaces for "Suspect" and "Motive" are where you should create and read data by documenting what the other stakeholders say about themselves and the other characters. Then, you'll work with the data by examining "Your Evidence" to see patterns. For the "Verdict," you should analyze the data and decide if that particular character is the guilty party. Lastly, in "Times Accused By" you can record and tally the accusations leveraged against yours and the others.

You'll use your complete catalog to decide who to inscribe into your Artifact Absconder Accusation Log and formulate an argument, drawing from your evidence, to come to a conclusion. Then, during the penultimate round of play, you'll communicate your argument. Regardless of whether you conclude correctly, you'll use all five components of data literacy to accuse an archaeological absconder.

To further cultivate these skills, explore your suggested stakeholder sources. If you desire (or require) guidance use **Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R** or **Of Mycenaean Men - Part Five** to learn how to work with structured tabular data or conduct a **keyword** or **project** search of Open Context, **explore museum collections**, or **public libraries** to find more archaeological sources. You can also continue the conversation with **Part Two: The discussion guide** where you'll find questions about archaeology, ethics, and data to engage with and further cultivate your arguing and communicating skills.

How to play

This section explains how to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*. It begins by explaining the mystery. Following that, we provide some tips on role-play and then conclude with a synopsis of each round of play.

The mystery

> *Beadbeachville, a seaside town in Florida, is excited for the excavation season! Well, at least those visiting, watching, and working at the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission Site *are excited. First identified in the late 1970s, a new team of archaeologists has returned to the site for the last few years to uncover, recover, and preserve what remains. They've been excitedly excavating because while this Spanish colonial period Catholic religious outpost — also known as a mission — sat far from the beach when it was active, climate change related events – like more intense and regular hurricanes, sea-level rise, and soil erosion – have moved it to the water's edge. Because of that, salvage archaeology is an urgent part of the project. Beyond those threats to site integrity though, the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission *is also a fantastic blend of cultural materials from all over the region and the excavation has run smoothly for years.*
>
> *Until now. Typically, the excavation uncovered belongings (often discussed as "artifacts") that fascinated archaeologists and local history buffs, but bored tourists. This season though, the team recovered an almost completely intact set of Catholic prayer beads. Called a rosary and used for both personal and group religious practice, this artifact was strung with beads made using an Indigenous style! The discovery of the piece, at a site that also included evidence for captive African and Indigenous labor, provided an intriguing example of creolization for the region. However, before a specialist could be called in to examine the rosary and its beads in more detail, a local TV and radio show host, who happened to be at the site during the discovery, broke the news to the whole county. Tourism doubled overnight and now, to everyone's dismay, that find has disappeared! How could this happen? Did a tourist think the storage facility was a gift shop? Was it sequestered away for extra safe keeping? Did someone simply make a data entry error? Or did* You *wander away with it? An Archaeological Investigator, Ellis Thyx, has been sent to facilitate solving the mystery.*

Your host may play this character or represent them through digital recordings, with the host as their assistant. As a reminder, the town, archaeological site, mystery, and the title of "archaeological investigator" though based on places in Gulf Coast Florida, similar archaeological sites, and a kind of crime that does happen, are entirely fictitious. However, Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada, whom the fictitious mission is named, is a real Saint. Learn more about her **here**.

Role-playing tips

The Archaeological Investigator narrowed down the concerned culprits down to the people in attendance. This means that while you've seen people acting suspicious, if they're not there, they definitely didn't do it. That means you'll need to listen to the other players closely to search out the suspect or use what you've observed to distract your colleagues.

If you lack experience with role-play, stick to the included scripts. You'll get a chance to improvise in a low stakes way during Round Two and if you feel comfortable, feel free to add more improvisation as the game goes on. If you are experienced with role-play use your script and background materials as ways to ground your improvised dialogue. Regardless, remember to read from, or incorporate, your “innocent” or “guilty” script depending on whether you are the culprit during your playthrough. You may choose not to answer a question, but must tell the truth.

The Rounds

The game will be played in a series of rounds. The following summarizes how to play each round. If you're confused, ask your host to re-explain the rules before beginning or request a pause to the game before proceeding.

Round	**Explanation**
Zero	This is an out-of-character, pre-game discussion where players and host establish boundaries for play such as level of comfort with improvisation and a way to pause the game for any reason.
One - *Incised Introductions*	This is a scripted round where you'll read or improvise around your character's introduction and begin using your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities.*
Two - *Digging up the Dirt*	This is an improvised round where you will talk with other characters to dig up more dirt on the other suspects, adding to your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*. The host will end this round by drawing the number of one character to embroil them as the enigmatic embezzler. If your number is drawn, read or improvise around your guilty scripts. If not, follow your innocent scripts.
Three - *Sieving through the Secrets*	This is a scripted questioning round where you learn more about each character's movements or motives by improvising around or reading your scripted question or answer. Once everyone has been asked and answered a question, the group will vote to do another round of questioning. If the group decides to do another round, see the note for the expansion, otherwise skip to *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!* *Expansion - Refining the Results* This round is the same as the third round but when it concludes you'll proceed directly to the next round.
Round four - *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!*	This is the accusation round. Review your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities,* decide individual verdicts, and then list who you think did it in your *Artifact Absconder Accusation Log*. Use this to fill out a standard scripted accusation, or improvise around it. Then each player will read their accusation. You can keep track of these in your catalog.
Round five - *Innocently in situ or Guilty as grindstone*	This is the scripted confessions round, which aims to unmask the mysterious material culture mover. When your number comes up, read, or improvise around, your innocent or guilty script as appropriate.

Jetson Grantmunny

Here is some background on your character, explaining who they are, what they know, and suggested materials you can read ahead of time, or after the game, to learn more about the stakeholder archetype you will, or have, portrayed. Following this character background are instructions for how much of the script you can read before playing.

Character notes and suggested background materials

Stakeholder archetype	An out-of-state tenured, senior, or primary investigating archaeologist.
Character description	You are the tenured/senior/primary investigating archaeologist whose main job resides outside of Florida. However, you have led the excavation at the MIssion for the past few years, writing the grants and planning the research design so things run smoothly. You are a professor or professor-esque person with big ideas but no longer with much eye for detail.
Your relationship to the site	is that you consider the excavation and materials recovered from it "yours" in a way that's closer to personal ownership than collective benefit because you wrote grants for the excavation and designed the project goals.
You're hiding the fact that...	you are worried about funding because it's running out sooner than expected, so you're squeezing as much out of this field season as possible, knowing that without receiving a local history grant that you applied to, you won't be able to pay everyone at the end of this season.
Someone observed you...	lose a note you had written to yourself about rehousing the rosary to a new, safer, location while waiting for the grant money to come in.
You noticed someone else...	had dropped a very similar set of prayer beads to the missing one at the site. However, you weren't fooled because those forgotten beads were made of a synthetic rather than organic material like the real (though missing) one is.
You witnessed...	Junior boating past the site a lot more often recently, even docking his boat illegally nearby to listen to the guided tour and to the excavations.
Suggested character reference materials	"Are the Secretary of the Interior's Archaeology Standards good enough?" by William A. White - **https://www.succinctresearch.com/ secretary_of_the_interior_archaeology_standards/** "Florida Site Files" by David G. Anderson, Joshua Wells, Stephen Yerka, Kelsey Noack Myers, Robert Carl DeMuth, and Thaddeus Geoffrey Bissett - **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7PC3083** Archaeological and Historical Report Standards and Guidelines - **http://files.floridados.gov/media/700591/ch-1a-46-standards-and-guidelines.pdf** Tacachale essays on the Indians of Florida and southeastern Georgia during the historic period - **https://ufdc.ufl.edu/AA00061389/00001/pdf**

You can read the next two pages before playing. The first is your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities***, where you will record what you know about the other characters. You'll want to return to this page to note new observations made during the game to help decide who committed the rosary robbery and track accusations.

The page after that is ***Round One - Incised Introductions***. You may read through your scripted introduction and the reminder of your personal secret. The scripts are an example of how your character might talk. You can read the script exactly or improvise around it as you feel comfortable. At the bottom of that page are directions that tell you to stop reading. Please follow these directions to maintain in-game suspense.

Lastly, your host should have given you a number with your character assignment or you will pick one at the start of play. Keep that handy for the end of *Round Two - Digging up the Dirt*, so you know whether you're guilty or innocent during the game.

Catalog of Culprit Capabilities

Suspect	Motive	Your Evidence	Verdict	Times Accused By

Incised Introductions

During this round, you will introduce yourself to your fellow stakeholders by reading the following script or using it as a guide for an improvised introduction. You may embody the character however you wish, but don't add any more information or details beyond the introduction right now. Let the others get to know you over the next few rounds.

> *Colleagues and esteemed members of the public, you may call me Dr. Grantmunny. You've seen me uncover more of the* Santa Teresa Mission *than any previous archaeologists, so I hope you all know I only have the best plans for the site and the town at heart. I'll make sure things get done efficiently, I promise.*

The following is a narrative version of your motivations, suspicions, and secrets as they relate to the site. You'll want to draw from this and your character notes during subsequent rounds but don't add any of this to your introduction. Also, keep some of this as secret as you can so you don't incriminate yourself as the rosary robber! But beware, you may not be the only one who knows about them. No one's as subtle as they think they are.

> *Organization has never been your strong suit and you've managed to hire a series of great graduate assistants that have helped you keep the funding and logistics straight at previous excavations. Well, most of your previous excavations. There was one that the Eddies worked on where you were not able to cover up your disorganization and they never worked with you again. Unfortunately this year, the past is repeating itself, and you severely overestimated the amount left in the budget for the excavation from your last grant. Meaning, you are desperately waiting for word about a local history grant that will help keep the project afloat through the end of this season. You hoped the rosary might help sway the funding body and so wanted to keep it extra safe in the meantime. To remember that goal, you wrote a note to yourself that you would rehouse the rosary to a new, safer, location until the grant money came in. Unfortunately, you lost that note and are now worried that whoever reads it might view the excavation as a financial liability and you as a disorganized PI for moving artifacts without telling people. But, you're the head of this excavation and all of the artifacts are yours anyways, kind of, as it was your grand writing efforts that uncovered them! Well not exactly yours, but you do feel very protective of them and as the PI you don't exactly have anyone overseeing you...until this investigation. After one of the site tours, possibly when you lost the note, you met Dr. blake michaels and/or their student Michael B. for coffee because they wanted to talk more about the narrative surrounding labor at the site. You remembered them from the Southeastern Archaeological Conference (SEAC) a few years ago and thought it might be nice to talk shop. However, talking shop also meant you accidentally confessed to writing and losing that incriminating note! You're hoping that maybe you could mention the fact that you've seen Junior boating and mooring close to the site or the fact that you found a fake set of rosary beads near on site to deflect that confession. Not that you know that either Junior or this unknown bead enthusiast were related to the theft just that these were some suspicious behaviors you observed.*

Pause here until everyone has introduced themselves. The host as the character Ellis Thyx, just E for short, the Archaeological Investigator—or by playing the recording of E—will prompt you to proceed to the next page and round of the game.

Digging up the Dirt

This round your goal is to see what your fellow ethically-ambiguous allies know about the disappearance of the rosary and if they know anything about you. Be as subtle as you can because, as you inquire, these other observations could help you decide whose behavior was the most suspicious. As a reminder, here are some things that you've seen going on around Beadbeachville that you might want to ask the other stakeholders about.

You noticed someone else...	had dropped a very similar set of prayer beads to the missing one at the site. However, you weren't fooled because those forgotten beads were made of a synthetic rather than organic material like the real (though missing) one is.
You witnessed...	Junior boating past the site a lot more often recently, even docking his boat illegally nearby to listen to the guided tour and to the excavations.

Take some time during this round to put notes in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* so you can keep track of all the evidence you uncover.

Pause here when you've finished conversing. Once the host—either as E or as the character they're playing—concludes discussion, they will reveal whether you are the culprit.

If your number is selected, read from the "guilty" scripts provided or improvise around them. If your number is not selected, portray the character using the "innocent" scripts or improvise around that information. Remember, you cannot lie but you can be evasive.

The host—either as E or by playing the recording—will prompt you to begin the next round.

Sieving the secrets

Now that you've learned more about the other stakeholders—as well as what they know about the site and you—decide which character(s) you'd like to interrogate in front of everyone. During this round, you can only ask one person, one question and you can't pick the person who asked you a question or someone who has already been asked a question, so be clever and strategic!

Feel free to use the scripted questions below, which are based on the suspicious behaviors you witnessed. You may also create your own question based on the other observations you've made and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* from the preceding rounds. Remember, only the stakeholders present in the room could have done it.

> **Looking for someone suspicious:** *Have you seen or do you know anyone who happens to own a set of prayer beads that look like the set that went missing?*
>
> **You know this person was doing something odd:** *Junior, we've known each other for a while now, but why do you keep mooring the boat on the banks next to the site rather than at Bill's marina?*

When another character questions you, you cannot lie but you can be evasive. If they ask you their suggested question, the following is your answer to it. You may choose to read it verbatim or improvise around it.

> **If innocent:** *Oh that's where I left, or I guess dropped, that. I had hoped someone would pick it up because it's important that we keep all our documents safe and retain the documentation for anytime we house or rehouse important materials. So that was me!*
>
> **If guilty:** *It's important to keep our precious artifacts safe. All I can say about the note is that someone really cares about the welfare of this site's collections. We create a lot of notes like this at the site and maybe if there was a larger sample size that note might help you narrow down a suspect.*

If another character asks you a question where the suggested response does not make sense, answer it as truthfully as you can based on what you know or suspect. It's a great chance to share something you'd like others to know about or to deflect attention to someone else.

Pause here until all players have asked and answered a question. As you listen to the other stakeholders, add details to your catalog. Once the questioning round concludes, the host will give you the option of continuing the questioning or proceeding to accusations, so pay attention and decide what you'd like to do.

Refining the results

The group will vote on whether they'd like to do another round of questioning or if they'd like to move on to accusations. Use what you've learned and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* to guide your choice and vote accordingly.

If the group decides to do another round of questions, refer to the preceding scripts for suggested responses and questions for this *optional* round of questioning. You may need to improvise, as a lot of information has already been shared.

Otherwise, the group will proceed to the next round.

Once you complete the additional round or if the group decides to proceed without a second round of questioning, review your catalog in preparation for the accusation round. The host will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Accusing the Archaeological absconder!

Now that you've got as many observations out of other players as you can, it's time to decide who to accuse. Use what you learned and recorded in your catalog to guide your choice and fill out the following:

The Artifact Absconder Accusation Log

Suspect	Motive

You can then use the following template for your accusation.

I accuse...

of removing the recently discovered rosary from the *Santa Teresa Mission* because...

Keep your explanation brief as you will need to share it with everyone and they will all need to share theirs as well.

Once you've written your accusation, wait until E prompts you to share it with the group.

Now, it's your chance to reveal who you think rehoused the rosary! E will tell the group how to begin the accusation section. When it's your turn, read your accusation and its subsequent explanation.

Your host will take note of who gets the most accusations and tally those up for the final reveal! You can also keep track of who accused who, or how many accusations were made against each player in your catalog.

Pause again until all players have read their accusations. Then, the host as E - or by playing the recordings - will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Innocently *in situ* or Guilty as grindstone

Once everyone has stated who they think did think wandered away with the artifact it's time for the reveal. E will say their peace and then the host will begin having people perform their speeches. This round uses your assigned numbers and will begin either with the number right after—or right before—the number drawn after *Digging the Dirt*, which indicated the guilty party.

Speeches will then proceed in the sequence, leaving the selected stealer for last. When it's your turn please read, or improvise around, the provided speech depending on whether you were or not the guilty party.

> **If innocent:** *I know I'm not the best with money but I know how to keep my artifacts safe and that's through good communication. Even if I had rehoused the rosary I would have told someone about it in case of emergency. Now that it's safe, hopefully the funding committee will help pay for the project.*
>
> **If guilty:** *You're right. I couldn't afford (for my career or the longevity of this project) to have something happen to this career-changing piece of beadwork. I hoped to temporarily and subtly rehouse it to my abode, the safest place in Beadbeachville, during the peak of tourist season. With so many people visiting the site, I got worried that it would just disappear and, as the site's true steward, I decided the safest thing for the rosary would be to not tell anyone that I had sequestered it in my own vacation home in case word of its location reached the wrong ears. Or until we got the money from that grant to cover costs like buying a more secure storage shed!*

Once the robber is revealed, anyone who accurately accused them wins the game. If they were only subtly suspicious, and no one accused them, the artifact absconder wins the game. E will have a few concluding words but there's nothing more for you to do now!

After the game

Once the recording, or the host as E, reads their concluding remarks, the game ends. By reaching Round Five, you will have developed your data literacy skills by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with the data provided through the game to discover the artifact absconder.Now that you've played *A Glorious Mystery*, take a chance to reflect how the game flexed your data literacy dexterity and consider how you might apply those skills again in the future.

If you desire (or require) some structure for your reflection, consider responding to the questions posed in **Part Two: The discussion guide** to aid your reflection of the game. Or explore the suggested materials from the beginning of the script using ***Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R*** or ***Of Mycenaean Men: Part Five*** to develop your data literacy dexterity or explore **museum collections**, **public libraries**, or even **keyword** or **project** search Open Context to learn more. With that we hope you enjoy playing *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*!

References and further reading

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Acknowledgements

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Player's guide overview

1. Introduction
2. Developing data literacy through role-play
3. How to play
4. Character background
5. Playing round scripts (don't read until asked to do so)
6. References and further readings
7. Credits
8. Acknowledgements

Estimated time to read this guide: 15 Minutes (do not read script ahead of time)

Estimated preparation time: Up to the player

Estimated play time: 1 - 3 hours depending on group size

Introduction

Welcome to the **Digital Data Stories** of the **Alexandria Archive Institute** and **Open Context**! This guide includes everything that you'll need to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery* as your assigned character and develop your data literacy. If you're also hosting the game, we encourage you to read the **hosting guide** to learn how to facilitate gameplay.

This game explores archaeological stakeholders and their relationship to archaeological data. This player's guide and script explains how the game cultivates data literacy, how to prepare to play, and the scripts for your character. This script includes character-specific background materials to use to learn more about the stakeholder you will or have portrayed.

Developing data literacy through role-play

By playing *A Glorious Mystery*, you'll develop your data literacy by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with data through the game. You'll use your **Character Background** to understand their relationship with archaeology and archaeological data and possibly learn more from their suggested sources. To delve deeper into your designated character, you can also read, respond and reflect on questions from Part Two: The discussion guide.

During the game, you'll role-play as your stakeholder, arguing their aims or communicating their conclusions using the background information and script as "raw data" that inform that archetype's actions. While playing as your character to argue and communicate, you'll use your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*** to formalize your observations into data about the other suspicious stakeholders. There you can record your recollections and use the catalog to read, work with, and analyze the data that the other characters cough up to come to the conclusion for who stole the rosary.

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The table tailors the traits you should note to: Suspect, Motive, Your Evidence, Verdict, and Times Accused By. The spaces for "Suspect" and "Motive" are where you should create and read data by documenting what the other stakeholders say about themselves and the other characters. Then, you'll work with the data by examining "Your Evidence" to see patterns. For the "Verdict," you should analyze the data and decide if that particular character is the guilty party. Lastly, in "Times Accused By" you can record and tally the accusations leveraged against yours and the others.

You'll use your complete catalog to decide who to inscribe into your Artifact Absconder Accusation Log and formulate an argument, drawing from your evidence, to come to a conclusion. Then, during the penultimate round of play, you'll communicate your argument. Regardless of whether you conclude correctly, you'll use all five components of data literacy to accuse an archaeological absconder.

To further cultivate these skills, explore your suggested stakeholder sources. If you desire (or require) guidance use **Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R** or **Of Mycenaean Men - Part Five** to learn how to work with structured tabular data or conduct a **keyword** or **project** search of Open Context, **explore museum collections**, or **public libraries** to find more archaeological sources. You can also continue the conversation with **Part Two: The discussion guide** where you'll find questions about archaeology, ethics, and data to engage with and further cultivate your arguing and communicating skills.

How to play

This section explains how to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*. It begins by explaining the mystery. Following that, we provide some tips on role-play and then conclude with a synopsis of each round of play.

The mystery

> *Beadbeachville, a seaside town in Florida, is excited for the excavation season! Well, at least those visiting, watching, and working at the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission Site *are excited. First identified in the late 1970s, a new team of archaeologists has returned to the site for the last few years to uncover, recover, and preserve what remains. They've been excitedly excavating because while this Spanish colonial period Catholic religious outpost — also known as a mission — sat far from the beach when it was active, climate change related events – like more intense and regular hurricanes, sea-level rise, and soil erosion – have moved it to the water's edge. Because of that, salvage archaeology is an urgent part of the project. Beyond those threats to site integrity though, the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission *is also a fantastic blend of cultural materials from all over the region and the excavation has run smoothly for years.*
>
> *Until now. Typically, the excavation uncovered belongings (often discussed as "artifacts") that fascinated archaeologists and local history buffs, but bored tourists. This season though, the team recovered an almost completely intact set of Catholic prayer beads. Called a rosary and used for both personal and group religious practice, this artifact was strung with beads made using an Indigenous style! The discovery of the piece, at a site that also included evidence for captive African and Indigenous labor, provided an intriguing example of creolization for the region. However, before a specialist could be called in to examine the rosary and its beads in more detail, a local TV and radio show host, who happened to be at the site during the discovery, broke the news to the whole county. Tourism doubled overnight and now, to everyone's dismay, that find has disappeared! How could this happen? Did a tourist think the storage facility was a gift shop? Was it sequestered away for extra safe keeping? Did someone simply make a data entry error? Or did* You *wander away with it? An Archaeological Investigator, Ellis Thyx, has been sent to facilitate solving the mystery.*

Your host may play this character or represent them through digital recordings, with the host as their assistant. As a reminder, the town, archaeological site, mystery, and the title of "archaeological investigator" though based on places in Gulf Coast Florida, similar archaeological sites, and a kind of crime that does happen, are entirely fictitious. However, Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada, whom the fictitious mission is named, is a real Saint. Learn more about her **here**.

Role-playing tips

The Archaeological Investigator narrowed down the concerned culprits down to the people in attendance. This means that while you've seen people acting suspicious, if they're not there, they definitely didn't do it. That means you'll need to listen to the other players closely to search out the suspect or use what you've observed to distract your colleagues.

If you lack experience with role-play, stick to the included scripts. You'll get a chance to improvise in a low stakes way during Round Two and if you feel comfortable, feel free to add more improvisation as the game goes on. If you are experienced with role-play use your script and background materials as ways to ground your improvised dialogue. Regardless, remember to read from, or incorporate, your “innocent” or “guilty” script depending on whether you are the culprit during your playthrough. You may choose not to answer a question, but must tell the truth.

The Rounds

The game will be played in a series of rounds. The following summarizes how to play each round. If you're confused, ask your host to re-explain the rules before beginning or request a pause to the game before proceeding.

Round	**Explanation**
Zero	This is an out-of-character, pre-game discussion where players and host establish boundaries for play such as level of comfort with improvisation and a way to pause the game for any reason.
One - *Incised Introductions*	This is a scripted round where you'll read or improvise around your character's introduction and begin using your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities.*
Two - *Digging up the Dirt*	This is an improvised round where you will talk with other characters to dig up more dirt on the other suspects, adding to your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*. The host will end this round by drawing the number of one character to embroil them as the enigmatic embezzler. If your number is drawn, read or improvise around your guilty scripts. If not, follow your innocent scripts.
Three - *Sieving through the Secrets*	This is a scripted questioning round where you learn more about each character's movements or motives by improvising around or reading your scripted question or answer. Once everyone has been asked and answered a question, the group will vote to do another round of questioning. If the group decides to do another round, see the note for the expansion, otherwise skip to *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!* *Expansion - Refining the Results* This round is the same as the third round but when it concludes you'll proceed directly to the next round.
Round four - *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!*	This is the accusation round. Review your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities,* decide individual verdicts, and then list who you think did it in your *Artifact Absconder Accusation Log*. Use this to fill out a standard scripted accusation, or improvise around it. Then each player will read their accusation. You can keep track of these in your catalog.
Round five - *Innocently in situ or Guilty as grindstone*	This is the scripted confessions round, which aims to unmask the mysterious material culture mover. When your number comes up, read, or improvise around, your innocent or guilty script as appropriate.

Sellsalotta Stuph

Here is some background on your character, explaining who they are, what they know, and suggested materials you can read ahead of time, or after the game, to learn more about the stakeholder archetype you will, or have, portrayed. Following this character background are instructions for how much of the script you can read before playing.

Character notes and suggested background materials

Stakeholder archetype	Local small business or shop owner.
Character description	You are a local business owner who sells souvenirs and other items to tourists. Since the archaeologists came, you've also been selling approximations or replicas of artifacts. You may also have, at one point, illegally sold real artifacts. However, you've learned about the laws around that and why that wasn't okay to do so stopped doing so, usually.
Your relationship to the site	is through a hope that, as more tourists come to visit the site, they'll also pop into your store to buy a sourvenir to take home, helping grow your business.
You're hiding the fact that...	you have previously bribed Emma to overlook when you've been caught taking artifacts from other people's private property.
Someone observed you...	asking about the penalties for stealing artifacts and the differences between different kinds of trafficking crimes. You may also have submitted a grant application proposing to house the rosary in its own, special, collection.
You noticed someone else...	discussing with another person that they wanted to get a personal look at the rosary, or even take it apart to document and replicate it.
You witnessed...	Al add their name to some paperwork in the storage shed and put the rosary in a box. You don't know where that box went after that point though.
Suggested character reference materials	"Research for the Courts and Intriguing Art Crime Work that can't be Shared" by Donna Yates - **https://www.anonymousswisscollector.com/2022/02/research-for-the-courts-and-intriguing-art-crime-work-that-cant-be-shared.html** Anonymous Swiss Collector: Thoughts and opinions about the complexities of cultural objects - **https://www.anonymousswisscollector.com/** "Crowdsourcing Antiquities Crime Fighting: A Review of GlobalXplorer" by Donna Yates - **https://doi.org/10.1017/aap.2018.8** "Relationship Prediction in a Knowledge Graph Embedding Model of the Illicit Antiquities Trade" by Shawn Graham, Donna Yates, Ahmed El-Roby, Chantal Brousseau, Jonah Ellens, and Callum McDermott - **https://doi.org/10.1017/aap.2023.1**

You can read the next two pages before playing. The first is your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities***, where you will record what you know about the other characters. You'll want to return to this page to note new observations made during the game to help decide who committed the rosary robbery and track accusations.

The page after that is ***Round One - Incised Introductions***. You may read through your scripted introduction and the reminder of your personal secret. The scripts are an example of how your character might talk. You can read the script exactly or improvise around it as you feel comfortable. At the bottom of that page are directions that tell you to stop reading. Please follow these directions to maintain in-game suspense.

Lastly, your host should have given you a number with your character assignment or you will pick one at the start of play. Keep that handy for the end of *Round Two - Digging up the Dirt*, so you know whether you're guilty or innocent during the game.

Catalog of Culprit Capabilities

Suspect	Motive	Your Evidence	Verdict	Times Accused By

Incised Introductions

During this round, you will introduce yourself to your fellow stakeholders by reading the following script or using it as a guide for an improvised introduction. You may embody the character however you wish, but don't add any more information or details beyond the introduction right now. Let the others get to know you over the next few rounds.

> *Sellsalotta Stuph here! You can call me Lotti or Stuphy! But I'm definitely not stuffy! Ha, ha...I own the local souvenir and sundries shop and carry many pieces inspired by the local cultures around Beadbeachville. We're hoping to stock more locally made souvenirs but the right crafter just hasn't come along!*

The following is a narrative version of your motivations, suspicions, and secrets as they relate to the site. You'll want to draw from this and your character notes during subsequent rounds but don't add any of this to your introduction. Also, keep some of this as secret as you can so you don't incriminate yourself as the rosary robber! But beware, you may not be the only one who knows about them. No one's as subtle as they think they are.

> *As a local business owner you're familiar with the fact that Beadbeachville relies on tourist season to maintain other aspects of the town and well, your own shop. You think that the rosary, and potentially displaying it in your shop, could be good for business and encourage folks to buy more locally-made souvenirs. Unfortunately, you have (had) a bit of a problem where your interest in "locally made" and/or "locally sourced" also included archaeological artifacts. In your hope of bringing in more tourists to town, and more specifically to your shop, you submitted a grant to the local city council to create a private archaeology display hoping that maybe pivoting to a museum collection (as well as gift shop) you might earn more in the long run than selling replicas, local crafts, or the materials you've occasionally dug up from your garden. While typically the only real artifacts you sold were from your own property, sometimes they weren't and you were caught by Officer Kaup during one of your illegal collections. Initially, you thought you could pay Emma to keep quiet, but they were investigated and had to go to a training seminar so now Emma encourages you to pay the fines, return the pieces, and learn more about what Office Kaup calls "cultural heritage laws". Sometimes you still get together to discuss these laws because there are aspects you don't understand, like if something is an artifact in the area around North America is it necessarily "Indigenous"? Does whether something was "Indigenous" impact fines? While you've been trying to change your ways (paying fines is more expensive than bribery!) and learn more, you can't resist a nighttime walk across the mission, like you used to do before they reopened excavations. While out one time overheard a couple of folks talk about the rosary, saying that they wanted to take it apart! When you moved in closer to listen, you saw that one of the speakers was Al because they added their name to the loan paperwork in the shed and put the rosary in a box. You didn't hang around long enough to see where that box went though just in case Emma was snooping around to tell you off!*

Pause here until everyone has introduced themselves. The host as the character Ellis Thyx, just E for short, the Archaeological Investigator—or by playing the recording of E—will prompt you to proceed to the next page and round of the game.

Digging up the Dirt

This round your goal is to see what your fellow ethically-ambiguous allies know about the disappearance of the rosary and if they know anything about you. Be as subtle as you can because, as you inquire, these other observations could help you decide whose behavior was the most suspicious. As a reminder, here are some things that you've seen going on around Beadbeachville that you might want to ask the other stakeholders about.

You noticed someone else...	discussing with another person that they wanted to get a personal look at the rosary, or even take it apart to document and replicate it.
You witnessed...	Al add their name to some paperwork in the storage shed and put the rosary in a box. You don't know where that box went after that point though.

Take some time during this round to put notes in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* so you can keep track of all the evidence you uncover.

Pause here when you've finished conversing. Once the host—either as E or as the character they're playing—concludes discussion, they will reveal whether you are the culprit.

If your number is selected, read from the "guilty" scripts provided or improvise around them. If your number is not selected, portray the character using the "innocent" scripts or improvise around that information. Remember, you cannot lie but you can be evasive.

The host—either as E or by playing the recording—will prompt you to begin the next round.

Sieving the secrets

Now that you've learned more about the other stakeholders—as well as what they know about the site and you—decide which character(s) you'd like to interrogate in front of everyone. During this round, you can only ask one person, one question and you can't pick the person who asked you a question or someone who has already been asked a question, so be clever and strategic!

Feel free to use the scripted questions below, which are based on the suspicious behaviors you witnessed. You may also create your own question based on the other observations you've made and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* from the preceding rounds. Remember, only the stakeholders present in the room could have done it.

> **Looking for someone suspicious:** *What do you know about trying to make a replica of the rosary? Do you know someone who might have the skills to do that safely?*
>
> **You know this person was doing something odd:** *Al, I saw you put your name on some paperwork in the shed, do you mind telling us what that paperwork was for?*

When another character questions you, you cannot lie but you can be evasive. If they ask you their suggested question, the following is your answer to it. You may choose to read it verbatim or improvise around it.

> **If innocent:** *Well, uhh, why yes! I submitted a grant application recently. I thought you'd know but maybe...oh dear, did I forget to put my name on it? I might, uh, come at archaeology from a different perspective than* *ahem* *a professional, but I thought I could create an interesting display for the tourists of the rosary myself, considering my years arranging scenes in my shop specifically to tourists' eyes!*
>
> **If guilty:** *I don't know why you're asking about that application in such a public forum. The website said that it was a closed process! I'm hurt that you'd ask in front of so many people but yes, I did submit one, but I can't believe I'm the only one that asked for money to put local artifacts on display.*

If another character asks you a question where the suggested response does not make sense, answer it as truthfully as you can based on what you know or suspect. It's a great chance to share something you'd like others to know about or to deflect attention to someone else.

Pause here until all players have asked and answered a question. As you listen to the other stakeholders, add details to your catalog. Once the questioning round concludes, the host will give you the option of continuing the questioning or proceeding to accusations, so pay attention and decide what you'd like to do.

Refining the results

The group will vote on whether they'd like to do another round of questioning or if they'd like to move on to accusations. Use what you've learned and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* to guide your choice and vote accordingly.

If the group decides to do another round of questions, refer to the preceding scripts for suggested responses and questions for this *optional* round of questioning. You may need to improvise, as a lot of information has already been shared.

Otherwise, the group will proceed to the next round.

Once you complete the additional round or if the group decides to proceed without a second round of questioning, review your catalog in preparation for the accusation round. The host will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Accusing the Archaeological absconder!

Now that you've got as many observations out of other players as you can, it's time to decide who to accuse. Use what you learned and recorded in your catalog to guide your choice and fill out the following:

The Artifact Absconder Accusation Log

Suspect	Motive

You can then use the following template for your accusation.

I accuse...

of removing the recently discovered rosary from the *Santa Teresa Mission* because...

Keep your explanation brief as you will need to share it with everyone and they will all need to share theirs as well.

Once you've written your accusation, wait until E prompts you to share it with the group.

Now, it's your chance to reveal who you think rehoused the rosary! E will tell the group how to begin the accusation section. When it's your turn, read your accusation and its subsequent explanation.

Your host will take note of who gets the most accusations and tally those up for the final reveal! You can also keep track of who accused who, or how many accusations were made against each player in your catalog.

Pause again until all players have read their accusations. Then, the host as E - or by playing the recordings - will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Innocently *in situ* or Guilty as grindstone

Once everyone has stated who they think did think wandered away with the artifact it’s time for the reveal. E will say their peace and then the host will begin having people perform their speeches. This round uses your assigned numbers and will begin either with the number right after—or right before—the number drawn after *Digging the Dirt*, which indicated the guilty party.

Speeches will then proceed in the sequence, leaving the selected stealer for last. When it’s your turn please read, or improvise around, the provided speech depending on whether you were or not the guilty party.

> **If innocent:** *No, I've, uhhh, not always been a very ethical person and I have paid, you know, in actual money, my due for my unfortunate habit of forgetting to return things to where I found them. Or well, really, not take them in the first place. But this time, it wasn't me.*
>
> **If guilty:** *I'll pay whatever you want since the investigator already has the rosary! I did it again! I'm trying to stop but it's a practice that I'm still unlearning. It's not like there are a lot of places to practice not taking archaeological artifacts! Paying this fine though, whatever it is, will put the fire under me because it's going to hit me where it hurts most, my business.*

Once the robber is revealed, anyone who accurately accused them wins the game. If they were only subtly suspicious, and no one accused them, the artifact absconder wins the game. E will have a few concluding words but there's nothing more for you to do now!

After the game

Once the recording, or the host as E, reads their concluding remarks, the game ends. By reaching Round Five, you will have developed your data literacy skills by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with the data provided through the game to discover the artifact absconder.Now that you've played *A Glorious Mystery*, take a chance to reflect how the game flexed your data literacy dexterity and consider how you might apply those skills again in the future.

If you desire (or require) some structure for your reflection, consider responding to the questions posed in **Part Two: The discussion guide** to aid your reflection of the game. Or explore the suggested materials from the beginning of the script using ***Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R*** or ***Of Mycenaean Men: Part Five*** to develop your data literacy dexterity or explore **museum collections**, **public libraries**, or even **keyword** or **project** search Open Context to learn more. With that we hope you enjoy playing *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*!

References and further reading

The following is a list of hyperlinked references from this player's guide. These are presented in order of appearance and do not repeat the full references for the character included under suggested materials. If any URLs in this Digital Data Story navigate to a broken page please check the **Wayback Machine** for an archived copy of the material.

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Estimated play time: 1 - 3 hours depending on group size

Introduction

Welcome to the **Digital Data Stories** of the **Alexandria Archive Institute** and **Open Context**! This guide includes everything that you'll need to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery* as your assigned character and develop your data literacy. If you're also hosting the game, we encourage you to read the **hosting guide** to learn how to facilitate gameplay.

This game explores archaeological stakeholders and their relationship to archaeological data. This player's guide and script explains how the game cultivates data literacy, how to prepare to play, and the scripts for your character. This script includes character-specific background materials to use to learn more about the stakeholder you will or have portrayed.

Developing data literacy through role-play

By playing *A Glorious Mystery*, you'll develop your data literacy by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with data through the game. You'll use your **Character Background** to understand their relationship with archaeology and archaeological data and possibly learn more from their suggested sources. To delve deeper into your designated character, you can also read, respond and reflect on questions from Part Two: The discussion guide.

During the game, you'll role-play as your stakeholder, arguing their aims or communicating their conclusions using the background information and script as "raw data" that inform that archetype's actions. While playing as your character to argue and communicate, you'll use your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*** to formalize your observations into data about the other suspicious stakeholders. There you can record your recollections and use the catalog to read, work with, and analyze the data that the other characters cough up to come to the conclusion for who stole the rosary.

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The table tailors the traits you should note to: Suspect, Motive, Your Evidence, Verdict, and Times Accused By. The spaces for "Suspect" and "Motive" are where you should create and read data by documenting what the other stakeholders say about themselves and the other characters. Then, you'll work with the data by examining "Your Evidence" to see patterns. For the "Verdict," you should analyze the data and decide if that particular character is the guilty party. Lastly, in "Times Accused By" you can record and tally the accusations leveraged against yours and the others.

You'll use your complete catalog to decide who to inscribe into your Artifact Absconder Accusation Log and formulate an argument, drawing from your evidence, to come to a conclusion. Then, during the penultimate round of play, you'll communicate your argument. Regardless of whether you conclude correctly, you'll use all five components of data literacy to accuse an archaeological absconder.

To further cultivate these skills, explore your suggested stakeholder sources. If you desire (or require) guidance use **Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R** or **Of Mycenaean Men - Part Five** to learn how to work with structured tabular data or conduct a **keyword** or **project** search of Open Context, **explore museum collections**, or **public libraries** to find more archaeological sources. You can also continue the conversation with **Part Two: The discussion guide** where you'll find questions about archaeology, ethics, and data to engage with and further cultivate your arguing and communicating skills.

How to play

This section explains how to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*. It begins by explaining the mystery. Following that, we provide some tips on role-play and then conclude with a synopsis of each round of play.

The mystery

> *Beadbeachville, a seaside town in Florida, is excited for the excavation season! Well, at least those visiting, watching, and working at the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission Site *are excited. First identified in the late 1970s, a new team of archaeologists has returned to the site for the last few years to uncover, recover, and preserve what remains. They've been excitedly excavating because while this Spanish colonial period Catholic religious outpost — also known as a mission — sat far from the beach when it was active, climate change related events – like more intense and regular hurricanes, sea-level rise, and soil erosion – have moved it to the water's edge. Because of that, salvage archaeology is an urgent part of the project. Beyond those threats to site integrity though, the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission *is also a fantastic blend of cultural materials from all over the region and the excavation has run smoothly for years.*
>
> *Until now. Typically, the excavation uncovered belongings (often discussed as "artifacts") that fascinated archaeologists and local history buffs, but bored tourists. This season though, the team recovered an almost completely intact set of Catholic prayer beads. Called a rosary and used for both personal and group religious practice, this artifact was strung with beads made using an Indigenous style! The discovery of the piece, at a site that also included evidence for captive African and Indigenous labor, provided an intriguing example of creolization for the region. However, before a specialist could be called in to examine the rosary and its beads in more detail, a local TV and radio show host, who happened to be at the site during the discovery, broke the news to the whole county. Tourism doubled overnight and now, to everyone's dismay, that find has disappeared! How could this happen? Did a tourist think the storage facility was a gift shop? Was it sequestered away for extra safe keeping? Did someone simply make a data entry error? Or did* You *wander away with it? An Archaeological Investigator, Ellis Thyx, has been sent to facilitate solving the mystery.*

Your host may play this character or represent them through digital recordings, with the host as their assistant. As a reminder, the town, archaeological site, mystery, and the title of "archaeological investigator" though based on places in Gulf Coast Florida, similar archaeological sites, and a kind of crime that does happen, are entirely fictitious. However, Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada, whom the fictitious mission is named, is a real Saint. Learn more about her **here**.

Role-playing tips

The Archaeological Investigator narrowed down the concerned culprits down to the people in attendance. This means that while you've seen people acting suspicious, if they're not there, they definitely didn't do it. That means you'll need to listen to the other players closely to search out the suspect or use what you've observed to distract your colleagues.

If you lack experience with role-play, stick to the included scripts. You'll get a chance to improvise in a low stakes way during Round Two and if you feel comfortable, feel free to add more improvisation as the game goes on. If you are experienced with role-play use your script and background materials as ways to ground your improvised dialogue. Regardless, remember to read from, or incorporate, your “innocent” or “guilty” script depending on whether you are the culprit during your playthrough. You may choose not to answer a question, but must tell the truth.

The Rounds

The game will be played in a series of rounds. The following summarizes how to play each round. If you're confused, ask your host to re-explain the rules before beginning or request a pause to the game before proceeding.

Round	**Explanation**
Zero	This is an out-of-character, pre-game discussion where players and host establish boundaries for play such as level of comfort with improvisation and a way to pause the game for any reason.
One - *Incised Introductions*	This is a scripted round where you'll read or improvise around your character's introduction and begin using your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities.*
Two - *Digging up the Dirt*	This is an improvised round where you will talk with other characters to dig up more dirt on the other suspects, adding to your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*. The host will end this round by drawing the number of one character to embroil them as the enigmatic embezzler. If your number is drawn, read or improvise around your guilty scripts. If not, follow your innocent scripts.
Three - *Sieving through the Secrets*	This is a scripted questioning round where you learn more about each character's movements or motives by improvising around or reading your scripted question or answer. Once everyone has been asked and answered a question, the group will vote to do another round of questioning. If the group decides to do another round, see the note for the expansion, otherwise skip to *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!* *Expansion - Refining the Results* This round is the same as the third round but when it concludes you'll proceed directly to the next round.
Round four - *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!*	This is the accusation round. Review your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities,* decide individual verdicts, and then list who you think did it in your *Artifact Absconder Accusation Log*. Use this to fill out a standard scripted accusation, or improvise around it. Then each player will read their accusation. You can keep track of these in your catalog.
Round five - *Innocently in situ or Guilty as grindstone*	This is the scripted confessions round, which aims to unmask the mysterious material culture mover. When your number comes up, read, or improvise around, your innocent or guilty script as appropriate.

Sister Marie Du Beaufour

Here is some background on your character, explaining who they are, what they know, and suggested materials you can read ahead of time, or after the game, to learn more about the stakeholder archetype you will, or have, portrayed. Following this character background are instructions for how much of the script you can read before playing.

Character notes and suggested background materials

Stakeholder archetype	A representative of the Catholic church, specifically a nun, in town to explore and report on the mission.
Character description	You are a representative of the Catholic church sent to learn more about the mission and its place in local church history. However, you are a recent convert to Catholicism, and to the life of a nun, so want to do your best to understand everything going on at the site.
Your relationship to the site	comes from a desire to represent the church well on your first assignment. You want to do a good job and consider how to bring back proof of your hard work and skills back to your order.
You're hiding the fact that...	you recently converted to Catholicism so you occasionally forget how to pray the rosary under stress. When that happens, you default to your previous meditative habit, lockpicking.
Someone observed you...	practicing your lockpicking skills on the storage shed after you went on a tour visiting the archaeological site. You did not realize it was the main storage facility for the site.
You noticed someone else...	during confession at the local parish with the priest, state in a loud voice, which sounded less than contrite but torn, that the site got in the way of the needs of their company, which the town also relied on. You didn't mean to eavesdrop, they were just so loud in the confessional that you overheard them.
You witnessed...	the Eddies sing short songs to themselves. Sometimes they're about archaeology, sometimes they're about having to wait too long for coffee. You noticed the latter while waiting in line to be seated at Faith's diner.
Suggested character reference materials	"Digging In: Being an Archaeologist and a Nun" by Sister Belinda Monahan - **https://anunslife.org/blogs/nun-talk/being-a-nun-and-an-archaeologist** "Bookaholic Podcast — From Nun to Archaeologist to Writer" with Deirdre Pippins and N.L. Holmes - **https://booktrib.com/2025/07/18/bookaholic-podcast-from-nun-to-archaeologist-to-writer/** Missions in Spanish Florida - **https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Missions_in_Spanish_Florida** "Digital Index of North American Archaeology, Linking Sites and Literature" by Joshua Wells, Taylor Wiley, Patrick Finnegan, Valeria Chamorro, Mackenzie Edmonds, and Eric C. Kansa - **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7542KRZ** CMAP (Comparative Mission Archaeology Portal) - **https://cmap.ufarch.org/**

You can read the next two pages before playing. The first is your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities***, where you will record what you know about the other characters. You'll want to return to this page to note new observations made during the game to help decide who committed the rosary robbery and track accusations.

The page after that is ***Round One - Incised Introductions***. You may read through your scripted introduction and the reminder of your personal secret. The scripts are an example of how your character might talk. You can read the script exactly or improvise around it as you feel comfortable. At the bottom of that page are directions that tell you to stop reading. Please follow these directions to maintain in-game suspense.

Lastly, your host should have given you a number with your character assignment or you will pick one at the start of play. Keep that handy for the end of *Round Two - Digging up the Dirt*, so you know whether you're guilty or innocent during the game.

Catalog of Culprit Capabilities

Suspect	Motive	Your Evidence	Verdict	Times Accused By

Incised Introductions

During this round, you will introduce yourself to your fellow stakeholders by reading the following script or using it as a guide for an improvised introduction. You may embody the character however you wish, but don't add any more information or details beyond the introduction right now. Let the others get to know you over the next few rounds.

> *Brothers and Sisters I'm honored to be here with you today. I'm Sister Marie Du Beaufour and before I joined the order, I studied Catholic history in the Americas and have continued some of that work as part of my vocation. I gather records and stories about Catholic Florida because although many documents reside in Spain, my order has taken on the work of preserving this history for North American Catholics interested in the missions but who lack means for international travel.*

The following is a narrative version of your motivations, suspicions, and secrets as they relate to the site. You'll want to draw from this and your character notes during subsequent rounds but don't add any of this to your introduction. Also, keep some of this as secret as you can so you don't incriminate yourself as the rosary robber! But beware, you may not be the only one who knows about them. No one's as subtle as they think they are.

> *You converted to Catholicism after first studying it during college where Catholic teaching and practices became a source of divine inspiration and solace. Even after receiving your habit and now taking temporary vows, you continue to be fascinated by church history and how material remains help tell that story. Due to this interest and your historical training, your order has asked you to keep collecting histories, personal, documentary, and sometimes artifactual, to document Catholicism in the United States. Sometimes people send you stuff in locked boxes and neglect to bring the key or want you to help process archives people forgot about after their caretakers passed away. Due to this, you've kept up your previous meditative passtime, lockpicking. However, like anything, it is a practice so you bring practice locks with you when you travel and occasionally indulge in working with real locks. This helps test your skills on a wide variety of locks from different contexts so you can be more helpful in the future. You thought the shed at the mission site was a great place to practice, not realizing it was where they housed* all *the artifacts. When you opened the door you disturbed a young person asleep at the desk, Thurston, who looked almost as shocked for you to see them there as you were to be seen breaking in! You agreed to keep quiet because it looked like they were working and sleeping there and because you were at the site after visiting hours. It bothered you that the artifacts were stored in such an insecure place though. It seemed really sterile and a bit inappropriate considering how important or potentially sacred the artifacts were to the Catholics. Besides your...mission mission, you've also attended mass and confession at the local parish, which was where you heard someone's loud confession about considering taking the rosary from the site. You don't know people in the town that well though, so you're not sure who it was. If that wasn't strange enough, when you were waiting to be seated at* Mission: Meals *the young person (or people) ahead of you, whom you recognized as folks named Eddie, were singing about the archaeological site under their breath and what it meant to Hispanic heritage. It was a great reminder for you that you'd totally forgotten that the site might mean something more personal to those of Spanish descent who lived in the region, even more so than just Catholic people with no connections to Spain.*

Pause here until everyone has introduced themselves. The host as the character Ellis Thyx, just E for short, the Archaeological Investigator—or by playing the recording of E—will prompt you to proceed to the next page and round of the game.

Digging up the Dirt

This round your goal is to see what your fellow ethically-ambiguous allies know about the disappearance of the rosary and if they know anything about you. Be as subtle as you can because, as you inquire, these other observations could help you decide whose behavior was the most suspicious. As a reminder, here are some things that you've seen going on around Beadbeachville that you might want to ask the other stakeholders about.

You noticed someone else...	during confession at the local parish with the priest, state in a loud voice, which sounded less than contrite but torn, that the site got in the way of the needs of their company, which the town also relied on. You didn't mean to eavesdrop, they were just so loud in the confessional that you overheard them.
You witnessed...	the Eddies sing short songs to themselves. Sometimes they're about archaeology, sometimes they're about having to wait too long for coffee. You noticed the latter while waiting in line to be seated at Faith's diner.

Take some time during this round to put notes in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* so you can keep track of all the evidence you uncover.

Pause here when you've finished conversing. Once the host—either as E or as the character they're playing—concludes discussion, they will reveal whether you are the culprit.

If your number is selected, read from the "guilty" scripts provided or improvise around them. If your number is not selected, portray the character using the "innocent" scripts or improvise around that information. Remember, you cannot lie but you can be evasive.

The host—either as E or by playing the recording—will prompt you to begin the next round.

Sieving the secrets

Now that you've learned more about the other stakeholders—as well as what they know about the site and you—decide which character(s) you'd like to interrogate in front of everyone. During this round, you can only ask one person, one question and you can't pick the person who asked you a question or someone who has already been asked a question, so be clever and strategic!

Feel free to use the scripted questions below, which are based on the suspicious behaviors you witnessed. You may also create your own question based on the other observations you've made and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* from the preceding rounds. Remember, only the stakeholders present in the room could have done it.

> **Looking for someone suspicious:** *How long has it been since your last confession?*
>
> **You know this person was doing something odd:** *Eddie (or the Eddies), you've got a wonderful singing voice but you may want to keep your voice down when you're in a public place. Particularly, when you might be complaining about archaeology and Santa Teresa. Can you tell me more about your relationship to the site?*

When another character questions you, you cannot lie but you can be evasive. If they ask you their suggested question, the following is your answer to it. You may choose to read it verbatim or improvise around it.

> **If innocent:** *You might be surprised, but lockpicking is an extremely meditative and useful skill. I've been surprised how useful it's been at the convent. I often come across storerooms or boxes where no one can find the key, so I keep up my skills so I can help in any way that I can.*
>
> **If guilty:** *I know it might seem like a strange skill for a woman of the cloth to have, but I do know how to pick locks. It's a hobby of mine that I used for meditation, before I found God and became a nun. It may be incriminating but it's been useful when working with older collections stored in locked rooms or boxes where people have misplaced the keys.*

If another character asks you a question where the suggested response does not make sense, answer it as truthfully as you can based on what you know or suspect. It's a great chance to share something you'd like others to know about or to deflect attention to someone else.

Pause here until all players have asked and answered a question. As you listen to the other stakeholders, add details to your catalog. Once the questioning round concludes, the host will give you the option of continuing the questioning or proceeding to accusations, so pay attention and decide what you'd like to do.

Refining the results

The group will vote on whether they'd like to do another round of questioning or if they'd like to move on to accusations. Use what you've learned and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* to guide your choice and vote accordingly.

If the group decides to do another round of questions, refer to the preceding scripts for suggested responses and questions for this *optional* round of questioning. You may need to improvise, as a lot of information has already been shared.

Otherwise, the group will proceed to the next round.

Once you complete the additional round or if the group decides to proceed without a second round of questioning, review your catalog in preparation for the accusation round. The host will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Accusing the Archaeological absconder!

Now that you've got as many observations out of other players as you can, it's time to decide who to accuse. Use what you learned and recorded in your catalog to guide your choice and fill out the following:

The Artifact Absconder Accusation Log

Suspect	Motive

You can then use the following template for your accusation.

I accuse...

of removing the recently discovered rosary from the *Santa Teresa Mission* because...

Keep your explanation brief as you will need to share it with everyone and they will all need to share theirs as well.

Once you've written your accusation, wait until E prompts you to share it with the group.

Now, it's your chance to reveal who you think rehoused the rosary! E will tell the group how to begin the accusation section. When it's your turn, read your accusation and its subsequent explanation.

Your host will take note of who gets the most accusations and tally those up for the final reveal! You can also keep track of who accused who, or how many accusations were made against each player in your catalog.

Pause again until all players have read their accusations. Then, the host as E - or by playing the recordings - will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Innocently *in situ* or Guilty as grindstone

Once everyone has stated who they think did think wandered away with the artifact it's time for the reveal. E will say their peace and then the host will begin having people perform their speeches. This round uses your assigned numbers and will begin either with the number right after—or right before—the number drawn after *Digging the Dirt*, which indicated the guilty party.

Speeches will then proceed in the sequence, leaving the selected stealer for last. When it's your turn please read, or improvise around, the provided speech depending on whether you were or not the guilty party.

> **If innocent:** *Although I enjoy practicing my lockpicking skills, and it is useful when folks lose their keys, it was never my intention to take anything from the archaeological site, it wouldn't be right in the eyes of God.*
>
> **If guilty:** *You'd think that after a dented door and security complaints someone would have thought to look at the locks! So I'll confess, it was me who took the rosary. While I didn't plan to do so, the lack of discussion of the rosary as a sacred object bothered me. I can't claim a descendant kinship but I have a spiritual kinship with it through my faith. I also admit that the Catholic church's participation in colonialism and forced labor caused great harm but this rosary still represents many people's relationship with God, so to study it without that significance seemed wrong. I hoped that by spending time, considering them as the prayer beads they were made for, would do some good.*

Once the robber is revealed, anyone who accurately accused them wins the game. If they were only subtly suspicious, and no one accused them, the artifact absconder wins the game. E will have a few concluding words but there's nothing more for you to do now!

After the game

Once the recording, or the host as E, reads their concluding remarks, the game ends. By reaching Round Five, you will have developed your data literacy skills by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with the data provided through the game to discover the artifact absconder.Now that you've played *A Glorious Mystery*, take a chance to reflect how the game flexed your data literacy dexterity and consider how you might apply those skills again in the future.

If you desire (or require) some structure for your reflection, consider responding to the questions posed in **Part Two: The discussion guide** to aid your reflection of the game. Or explore the suggested materials from the beginning of the script using ***Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R*** or ***Of Mycenaean Men: Part Five*** to develop your data literacy dexterity or explore **museum collections**, **public libraries**, or even **keyword** or **project** search Open Context to learn more. With that we hope you enjoy playing *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*!

References and further reading

The following is a list of hyperlinked references from this player's guide. These are presented in order of appearance and do not repeat the full references for the character included under suggested materials. If any URLs in this Digital Data Story navigate to a broken page please check the **Wayback Machine** for an archived copy of the material.

Check out other Digital Data Stories here: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M74F1NW0**

Find out about the work of the Alexandria Archive Institute at: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/**

Check out Open Context for yourself here: **https://opencontext.org**

Explore Part One - The host guide at: https://doi.org/10.6078/M7GH9G20

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Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R by Paulina F. Przystupa and L. Meghan Dennis (2022): **https://doi.org/10.6078/M73N21HR**

Learn how to use a spreadsheet with *Of Myceanean Men - Part Five*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7Q81B6V**

Conduct a keyword search of Open Context using *Of Mycenaean Men - Part Four*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7TX3CHJ**

Try a project search of Open Context using *It's All in the Wrist (Bones) - Part Two*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7ZP4478**

Peruse some museum collections with the help of this article: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7S46Q2R**

Get at taste for some public library collections here: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/2025/07/10/how-to-use-the-digital-collections-of-the-nypl/**

Learn more about the saint whose name we use for our fictitious mission–Teresa of Avila–on her Wikipedia page: **https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Teresa_of_%C3%81vila**

"TTRPG Safety Toolkit: A Quick Reference Guide" by Kienna Shaw (2023) **https://web.archive.org/web/20231127094204/https://i.4pcdn.org/tg/1583202183294.pdf**

Explore Part Two at: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7B56GVG**

"Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data" by Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle (2018) **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7H70CX3**

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Paulina F. Przystupa and L. Meghan Dennis, 2025, “A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery”, Data Stories Program, Alexandria Archive Institute / Open Context, Published Online, DOI: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M70863FG**.

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Acknowledgements

This Digital Data Story is a collaboration between its authors, our testing audiences, and the staff of AAI/OC. We are grateful to those who participated in our alpha playthrough of the game at the First Conference on Public Archaeology hosted by the Florida Public Archaeology Network Conference. These wonderful folks helped us test a prototype of this Digital Data Story and have been waiting for its release since then. We thank you for your patience as we reworked the game. We are also indebted to Katie Brewer for her help bringing gulf coast Florida to life in this approximation of the region. We also appreciate the work of the primary investigators of the *Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data* project, Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle who provide an excellent resource for comparing and learning about Spanish Missions in Florida.

The Data Stories are part of the overarching Data Literacy Program, with support from a National Endowment for the Humanities Challenge Award and a grant from the Mellon Foundation (2021-2025). Any views, findings, conclusions, or recommendations expressed in this work do not necessarily represent those of the National Endowment for the Humanities or the Mellon Foundation.

Player's guide overview

1. Introduction
2. Developing data literacy through role-play
3. How to play
4. Character background
5. Playing round scripts (don't read until asked to do so)
6. References and further readings
7. Credits
8. Acknowledgements

Estimated time to read this guide: 15 Minutes (do not read script ahead of time)

Estimated preparation time: Up to the player

Estimated play time: 1 - 3 hours depending on group size

Introduction

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This section explains how to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*. It begins by explaining the mystery. Following that, we provide some tips on role-play and then conclude with a synopsis of each round of play.

The mystery

> *Beadbeachville, a seaside town in Florida, is excited for the excavation season! Well, at least those visiting, watching, and working at the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission Site *are excited. First identified in the late 1970s, a new team of archaeologists has returned to the site for the last few years to uncover, recover, and preserve what remains. They've been excitedly excavating because while this Spanish colonial period Catholic religious outpost — also known as a mission — sat far from the beach when it was active, climate change related events – like more intense and regular hurricanes, sea-level rise, and soil erosion – have moved it to the water's edge. Because of that, salvage archaeology is an urgent part of the project. Beyond those threats to site integrity though, the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission *is also a fantastic blend of cultural materials from all over the region and the excavation has run smoothly for years.*
>
> *Until now. Typically, the excavation uncovered belongings (often discussed as "artifacts") that fascinated archaeologists and local history buffs, but bored tourists. This season though, the team recovered an almost completely intact set of Catholic prayer beads. Called a rosary and used for both personal and group religious practice, this artifact was strung with beads made using an Indigenous style! The discovery of the piece, at a site that also included evidence for captive African and Indigenous labor, provided an intriguing example of creolization for the region. However, before a specialist could be called in to examine the rosary and its beads in more detail, a local TV and radio show host, who happened to be at the site during the discovery, broke the news to the whole county. Tourism doubled overnight and now, to everyone's dismay, that find has disappeared! How could this happen? Did a tourist think the storage facility was a gift shop? Was it sequestered away for extra safe keeping? Did someone simply make a data entry error? Or did* You *wander away with it? An Archaeological Investigator, Ellis Thyx, has been sent to facilitate solving the mystery.*

Your host may play this character or represent them through digital recordings, with the host as their assistant. As a reminder, the town, archaeological site, mystery, and the title of "archaeological investigator" though based on places in Gulf Coast Florida, similar archaeological sites, and a kind of crime that does happen, are entirely fictitious. However, Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada, whom the fictitious mission is named, is a real Saint. Learn more about her **here**.

Role-playing tips

The Archaeological Investigator narrowed down the concerned culprits down to the people in attendance. This means that while you've seen people acting suspicious, if they're not there, they definitely didn't do it. That means you'll need to listen to the other players closely to search out the suspect or use what you've observed to distract your colleagues.

If you lack experience with role-play, stick to the included scripts. You'll get a chance to improvise in a low stakes way during Round Two and if you feel comfortable, feel free to add more improvisation as the game goes on. If you are experienced with role-play use your script and background materials as ways to ground your improvised dialogue. Regardless, remember to read from, or incorporate, your “innocent” or “guilty” script depending on whether you are the culprit during your playthrough. You may choose not to answer a question, but must tell the truth.

The Rounds

The game will be played in a series of rounds. The following summarizes how to play each round. If you're confused, ask your host to re-explain the rules before beginning or request a pause to the game before proceeding.

Round	**Explanation**
Zero	This is an out-of-character, pre-game discussion where players and host establish boundaries for play such as level of comfort with improvisation and a way to pause the game for any reason.
One - *Incised Introductions*	This is a scripted round where you'll read or improvise around your character's introduction and begin using your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities.*
Two - *Digging up the Dirt*	This is an improvised round where you will talk with other characters to dig up more dirt on the other suspects, adding to your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*. The host will end this round by drawing the number of one character to embroil them as the enigmatic embezzler. If your number is drawn, read or improvise around your guilty scripts. If not, follow your innocent scripts.
Three - *Sieving through the Secrets*	This is a scripted questioning round where you learn more about each character's movements or motives by improvising around or reading your scripted question or answer. Once everyone has been asked and answered a question, the group will vote to do another round of questioning. If the group decides to do another round, see the note for the expansion, otherwise skip to *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!* *Expansion - Refining the Results* This round is the same as the third round but when it concludes you'll proceed directly to the next round.
Round four - *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!*	This is the accusation round. Review your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities,* decide individual verdicts, and then list who you think did it in your *Artifact Absconder Accusation Log*. Use this to fill out a standard scripted accusation, or improvise around it. Then each player will read their accusation. You can keep track of these in your catalog.
Round five - *Innocently in situ or Guilty as grindstone*	This is the scripted confessions round, which aims to unmask the mysterious material culture mover. When your number comes up, read, or improvise around, your innocent or guilty script as appropriate.

Thurston Hear

Here is some background on your character, explaining who they are, what they know, and suggested materials you can read ahead of time, or after the game, to learn more about the stakeholder archetype you will, or have, portrayed. Following this character background are instructions for how much of the script you can read before playing.

Character notes and suggested background materials

Stakeholder archetype	An undergraduate student volunteer whose first experience with archaeology is at this site.
Character description	You are a very recent student of archaeology and anthropology, attending your very first excavation as a volunteer. You want to be helpful but there's still a lot about archaeology that you don't understand but you make up for it by being early to everything. You don't know much about religious practice and even less about Catholicism specifically.
Your relationship to the site	comes from your role as lead data enter-er. Having seen all the materials coming from the site, you've been wondering what might be the best souvenir to have from your summer experience. Some dirt, a replica from Sellsalotta's store or something else...
You're hiding the fact that...	you did not know what a rosary (or most other artifacts) are called so have been misidentifying most things you've cataloged.
Someone observed you...	having regular conversations with, and showing, Mr. Ding your illustrations of the various artifacts you've been cataloging on napkins and stuff. Most of those illustrations are probably labeled wrong though.
You noticed someone else...	singing a soothing lullaby about rehousing the rosary with other collections related to Hispanic heritage, while you were dozing in the storage shed the day the rosary went missing.
You witnessed...	a nun brake into the storage shed one day when you were napping. While she apologized and introduced herself as Sister Marie, you didn't want to out yourself as sleeping in the shed so haven't mentioned it to anyone but it was super weird and technically agreed to say nothing about it.
Suggested character reference materials	"Harvard Peabody Mus. Zooarchaeology" by Levent Atici and Richard Meadow - **https://opencontext.org/projects/8d959c97-759e-2753-29c7-9be023d6c363** Video "The Archaeological Research Facility Field School" - **https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=INJShhPiDg8** The ARF FIeld School - **https://arf.berkeley.edu/field-school** "What undergraduate archaeology students can expect in college" by SuccinctBill- **https://www.succinctresearch.com/what-undergraduate-archaeology-students-expect-in-college/**

You can read the next two pages before playing. The first is your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities***, where you will record what you know about the other characters. You'll want to return to this page to note new observations made during the game to help decide who committed the rosary robbery and track accusations.

The page after that is ***Round One - Incised Introductions***. You may read through your scripted introduction and the reminder of your personal secret. The scripts are an example of how your character might talk. You can read the script exactly or improvise around it as you feel comfortable. At the bottom of that page are directions that tell you to stop reading. Please follow these directions to maintain in-game suspense.

Lastly, your host should have given you a number with your character assignment or you will pick one at the start of play. Keep that handy for the end of *Round Two - Digging up the Dirt*, so you know whether you're guilty or innocent during the game.

Catalog of Culprit Capabilities

Suspect	Motive	Your Evidence	Verdict	Times Accused By

Incised Introductions

During this round, you will introduce yourself to your fellow stakeholders by reading the following script or using it as a guide for an improvised introduction. You may embody the character however you wish, but don't add any more information or details beyond the introduction right now. Let the others get to know you over the next few rounds.

> *Hi. I go to the local community college and thought it would be fun to get some on-the-job experience at an archaeological site when Dr. Grantmunny said they needed volunteers. I'm learning a lot about archaeology and how artifacts get processed but I know there's a lot that I don't know. Oh and my name's Thurston. Thurston Hear.*

The following is a narrative version of your motivations, suspicions, and secrets as they relate to the site. You'll want to draw from this and your character notes during subsequent rounds but don't add any of this to your introduction. Also, keep some of this as secret as you can so you don't incriminate yourself as the rosary robber! But beware, you may not be the only one who knows about them. No one's as subtle as they think they are.

> *You are a local community college student, mildly interested in archaeology, and were excited to get such a unique summer job close to home. You don't have much experience in archaeology but were the first one to volunteer to work on cataloging. You find data entry a meditative and enjoyable process, while many of the other volunteers seemed super excited by, like, dirt only. Were shovels reborn as humans? You don't know but you do know that you like data entry, you're not familiar with the archaeological terminology but you've plunged on ahead despite the fact that Dr. Grantmunny and Al have been too distracted for you to get proper training. It was only after the sensational story of the rosary broke that you realized how limited your knowledge was and that you'd miscatalogued a bunch of other materials. However, you feel less bad about it now because you realized it was kind of weird that Mr. Ding bought you lunch and your special espresso with sweetened condensed milk so often. He's a nice enough guy, with his heart in the right place, but you got suspicious after the second free meal. You noticed that he really asked you only archaeology questions, and you basically told him the wrong thing until recently. Though, he might still have some of the illustrations you've made, which while labeled wrong, are pretty accurate, if you do say so yourself. You even did one of the rosary on one of those hefty napkins from* Mission: Meals*. However, once you realized your mistakes you started staying late at the site to fix the cataloging issues. And then...staying there overnight after falling asleep at your desk. It's been great for your image, as you're always the first one there, but it's not sustainable. Especially after that nun broke into the shed after hours and caught you cataloging/snoozing. You politely asked her to leave but realized it might be better to catalogue elsewhere. And you didn't think a nun would ever break the law... it's just not a habit of theirs. So you started taking artifacts back to the rented housing space and cataloging in secret. Though, while you've been at the site working and doing data entry (and maybe also napping), you heard an unfamiliar voice, or possibly voices, singing about archaeology in a sort of sarcastic but hushed undertone. The voice(s) didn't sound familiar and you're not sure how many people sing about archaeology so it's got you curious as to who might do that. The songs also inspired you to consider what skills, ideas, and maybe even a physical object you should take away from your experience at the Mission...*

Pause here until everyone has introduced themselves. The host as the character Ellis Thyx, just E for short, the Archaeological Investigator—or by playing the recording of E—will prompt you to proceed to the next page and round of the game.

Digging up the Dirt

This round your goal is to see what your fellow ethically-ambiguous allies know about the disappearance of the rosary and if they know anything about you. Be as subtle as you can because, as you inquire, these other observations could help you decide whose behavior was the most suspicious. As a reminder, here are some things that you've seen going on around Beadbeachville that you might want to ask the other stakeholders about.

You noticed someone else...	singing a soothing lullaby about rehousing the rosary with other collections related to Hispanic heritage, while you were dozing in the storage shed the day the rosary went missing.
You witnessed...	a nun brake into the storage shed one day when you were napping. While she apologized and introduced herself as Sister Marie, you didn't want to out yourself as sleeping in the shed so haven't mentioned it to anyone but it was super weird and technically agreed to say nothing about it.

Take some time during this round to put notes in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* so you can keep track of all the evidence you uncover.

Pause here when you've finished conversing. Once the host—either as E or as the character they're playing—concludes discussion, they will reveal whether you are the culprit.

If your number is selected, read from the "guilty" scripts provided or improvise around them. If your number is not selected, portray the character using the "innocent" scripts or improvise around that information. Remember, you cannot lie but you can be evasive.

The host—either as E or by playing the recording—will prompt you to begin the next round.

Sieving the secrets

Now that you've learned more about the other stakeholders—as well as what they know about the site and you—decide which character(s) you'd like to interrogate in front of everyone. During this round, you can only ask one person, one question and you can't pick the person who asked you a question or someone who has already been asked a question, so be clever and strategic!

Feel free to use the scripted questions below, which are based on the suspicious behaviors you witnessed. You may also create your own question based on the other observations you've made and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* from the preceding rounds. Remember, only the stakeholders present in the room could have done it.

> **Looking for someone suspicious:** *Do you like to sing, particularly songs about archaeology that you'd prefer no one ever repeat?*
>
> **You know this person was doing something odd:** *Sister Marie, I know I said I wouldn't say anything, but it was super weird that you got into the storage shed like that, why do you know how to pick locks and why were you doing that at the mission site?*

When another character questions you, you cannot lie but you can be evasive. If they ask you their suggested question, the following is your answer to it. You may choose to read it verbatim or improvise around it.

> **If innocent:** *Oh, you found one of my drawings? That's awesome, did you keep it? Do you think it's an accurate rendering of that artifact? I was considering keeping some kind of illustration for myself as a souvenir of the site.*
>
> **If guilty:** *I guess, maybe, that looks like one of my drawings. but I don't really, exactly, totally, recall saying anything about keeping any specific, particular souvenir but I doubt, I mean, at least probably I would have meant that piece. Artifacts aren't supposed souvenirs you know, don't leave a trace right?*

If another character asks you a question where the suggested response does not make sense, answer it as truthfully as you can based on what you know or suspect. It's a great chance to share something you'd like others to know about or to deflect attention to someone else.

Pause here until all players have asked and answered a question. As you listen to the other stakeholders, add details to your catalog. Once the questioning round concludes, the host will give you the option of continuing the questioning or proceeding to accusations, so pay attention and decide what you'd like to do.

Refining the results

The group will vote on whether they'd like to do another round of questioning or if they'd like to move on to accusations. Use what you've learned and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* to guide your choice and vote accordingly.

If the group decides to do another round of questions, refer to the preceding scripts for suggested responses and questions for this *optional* round of questioning. You may need to improvise, as a lot of information has already been shared.

Otherwise, the group will proceed to the next round.

Once you complete the additional round or if the group decides to proceed without a second round of questioning, review your catalog in preparation for the accusation round. The host will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Accusing the Archaeological absconder!

Now that you've got as many observations out of other players as you can, it's time to decide who to accuse. Use what you learned and recorded in your catalog to guide your choice and fill out the following:

The Artifact Absconder Accusation Log

Suspect	Motive

You can then use the following template for your accusation.

I accuse...

of removing the recently discovered rosary from the *Santa Teresa Mission* because...

Keep your explanation brief as you will need to share it with everyone and they will all need to share theirs as well.

Once you've written your accusation, wait until E prompts you to share it with the group.

Now, it's your chance to reveal who you think rehoused the rosary! E will tell the group how to begin the accusation section. When it's your turn, read your accusation and its subsequent explanation.

Your host will take note of who gets the most accusations and tally those up for the final reveal! You can also keep track of who accused who, or how many accusations were made against each player in your catalog.

Pause again until all players have read their accusations. Then, the host as E - or by playing the recordings - will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Innocently *in situ* or Guilty as grindstone

Once everyone has stated who they think did think wandered away with the artifact it's time for the reveal. E will say their peace and then the host will begin having people perform their speeches. This round uses your assigned numbers and will begin either with the number right after—or right before—the number drawn after *Digging the Dirt*, which indicated the guilty party.

Speeches will then proceed in the sequence, leaving the selected stealer for last. When it's your turn please read, or improvise around, the provided speech depending on whether you were or not the guilty party.

> **If innocent:** *Souvenirs are fun but artifacts aren't souvenirs. What I should really take away from the site are memories, skills, and maybe some appropriate photos or illustrations. I guess I can get a souvenir from Sellsalotta! And it might look better than the real thing.*
>
> **If guilty:** *When the rosary came into my office, the...um...storage shed, I miscataloged it in our database. Then, when the story broke, I realized that it wasn't the only thing I'd miscataloged! I'd been staying late to fix my mistakes but after Sister Marie caught me after hours I decided it would be better to fix my errors offsite. But when I got to the box with the rosary I forgot to put it back into the box when I returned the rest of the artifacts whose records I fixed. By the time I realized it was gone, everyone else had too, so there was no good way to return it without admitting I'd messed up way more than just with data entry.*

Once the robber is revealed, anyone who accurately accused them wins the game. If they were only subtly suspicious, and no one accused them, the artifact absconder wins the game. E will have a few concluding words but there's nothing more for you to do now!

After the game

Once the recording, or the host as E, reads their concluding remarks, the game ends. By reaching Round Five, you will have developed your data literacy skills by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with the data provided through the game to discover the artifact absconder.Now that you've played *A Glorious Mystery*, take a chance to reflect how the game flexed your data literacy dexterity and consider how you might apply those skills again in the future.

If you desire (or require) some structure for your reflection, consider responding to the questions posed in **Part Two: The discussion guide** to aid your reflection of the game. Or explore the suggested materials from the beginning of the script using ***Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R*** or ***Of Mycenaean Men: Part Five*** to develop your data literacy dexterity or explore **museum collections**, **public libraries**, or even **keyword** or **project** search Open Context to learn more. With that we hope you enjoy playing *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*!

References and further reading

The following is a list of hyperlinked references from this player's guide. These are presented in order of appearance and do not repeat the full references for the character included under suggested materials. If any URLs in this Digital Data Story navigate to a broken page please check the **Wayback Machine** for an archived copy of the material.

Check out other Digital Data Stories here: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M74F1NW0**

Find out about the work of the Alexandria Archive Institute at: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/**

Check out Open Context for yourself here: **https://opencontext.org**

Explore Part One - The host guide at: https://doi.org/10.6078/M7GH9G20

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Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R by Paulina F. Przystupa and L. Meghan Dennis (2022): **https://doi.org/10.6078/M73N21HR**

Learn how to use a spreadsheet with *Of Myceanean Men - Part Five*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7Q81B6V**

Conduct a keyword search of Open Context using *Of Mycenaean Men - Part Four*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7TX3CHJ**

Try a project search of Open Context using *It's All in the Wrist (Bones) - Part Two*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7ZP4478**

Peruse some museum collections with the help of this article: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7S46Q2R**

Get at taste for some public library collections here: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/2025/07/10/how-to-use-the-digital-collections-of-the-nypl/**

Learn more about the saint whose name we use for our fictitious mission–Teresa of Avila–on her Wikipedia page: **https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Teresa_of_%C3%81vila**

"TTRPG Safety Toolkit: A Quick Reference Guide" by Kienna Shaw (2023) **https://web.archive.org/web/20231127094204/https://i.4pcdn.org/tg/1583202183294.pdf**

Explore Part Two at: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7B56GVG**

"Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data" by Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle (2018) **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7H70CX3**

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Credits

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Paulina F. Przystupa and L. Meghan Dennis, 2025, “A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery”, Data Stories Program, Alexandria Archive Institute / Open Context, Published Online, DOI: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M70863FG**.

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Acknowledgements

This Digital Data Story is a collaboration between its authors, our testing audiences, and the staff of AAI/OC. We are grateful to those who participated in our alpha playthrough of the game at the First Conference on Public Archaeology hosted by the Florida Public Archaeology Network Conference. These wonderful folks helped us test a prototype of this Digital Data Story and have been waiting for its release since then. We thank you for your patience as we reworked the game. We are also indebted to Katie Brewer for her help bringing gulf coast Florida to life in this approximation of the region. We also appreciate the work of the primary investigators of the *Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data* project, Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle who provide an excellent resource for comparing and learning about Spanish Missions in Florida.

The Data Stories are part of the overarching Data Literacy Program, with support from a National Endowment for the Humanities Challenge Award and a grant from the Mellon Foundation (2021-2025). Any views, findings, conclusions, or recommendations expressed in this work do not necessarily represent those of the National Endowment for the Humanities or the Mellon Foundation.

Player's guide overview

1. Introduction
2. Developing data literacy through role-play
3. How to play
4. Character background
5. Playing round scripts (don't read until asked to do so)
6. References and further readings
7. Credits
8. Acknowledgements

Estimated time to read this guide: 15 Minutes (do not read script ahead of time)

Estimated preparation time: Up to the player

Estimated play time: 1 - 3 hours depending on group size

Introduction

Welcome to the **Digital Data Stories** of the **Alexandria Archive Institute** and **Open Context**! This guide includes everything that you'll need to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery* as your assigned character and develop your data literacy. If you're also hosting the game, we encourage you to read the **hosting guide** to learn how to facilitate gameplay.

This game explores archaeological stakeholders and their relationship to archaeological data. This player's guide and script explains how the game cultivates data literacy, how to prepare to play, and the scripts for your character. This script includes character-specific background materials to use to learn more about the stakeholder you will or have portrayed.

Developing data literacy through role-play

By playing *A Glorious Mystery*, you'll develop your data literacy by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with data through the game. You'll use your **Character Background** to understand their relationship with archaeology and archaeological data and possibly learn more from their suggested sources. To delve deeper into your designated character, you can also read, respond and reflect on questions from Part Two: The discussion guide.

During the game, you'll role-play as your stakeholder, arguing their aims or communicating their conclusions using the background information and script as "raw data" that inform that archetype's actions. While playing as your character to argue and communicate, you'll use your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*** to formalize your observations into data about the other suspicious stakeholders. There you can record your recollections and use the catalog to read, work with, and analyze the data that the other characters cough up to come to the conclusion for who stole the rosary.

RELEASE DATE: 08 / 2025
VERSION: 1.0
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The table tailors the traits you should note to: Suspect, Motive, Your Evidence, Verdict, and Times Accused By. The spaces for "Suspect" and "Motive" are where you should create and read data by documenting what the other stakeholders say about themselves and the other characters. Then, you'll work with the data by examining "Your Evidence" to see patterns. For the "Verdict," you should analyze the data and decide if that particular character is the guilty party. Lastly, in "Times Accused By" you can record and tally the accusations leveraged against yours and the others.

You'll use your complete catalog to decide who to inscribe into your Artifact Absconder Accusation Log and formulate an argument, drawing from your evidence, to come to a conclusion. Then, during the penultimate round of play, you'll communicate your argument. Regardless of whether you conclude correctly, you'll use all five components of data literacy to accuse an archaeological absconder.

To further cultivate these skills, explore your suggested stakeholder sources. If you desire (or require) guidance use **Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R** or **Of Mycenaean Men - Part Five** to learn how to work with structured tabular data or conduct a **keyword** or **project** search of Open Context, **explore museum collections**, or **public libraries** to find more archaeological sources. You can also continue the conversation with **Part Two: The discussion guide** where you'll find questions about archaeology, ethics, and data to engage with and further cultivate your arguing and communicating skills.

How to play

This section explains how to play *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*. It begins by explaining the mystery. Following that, we provide some tips on role-play and then conclude with a synopsis of each round of play.

The mystery

> *Beadbeachville, a seaside town in Florida, is excited for the excavation season! Well, at least those visiting, watching, and working at the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission Site *are excited. First identified in the late 1970s, a new team of archaeologists has returned to the site for the last few years to uncover, recover, and preserve what remains. They've been excitedly excavating because while this Spanish colonial period Catholic religious outpost — also known as a mission — sat far from the beach when it was active, climate change related events – like more intense and regular hurricanes, sea-level rise, and soil erosion – have moved it to the water's edge. Because of that, salvage archaeology is an urgent part of the project. Beyond those threats to site integrity though, the* Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada Mission *is also a fantastic blend of cultural materials from all over the region and the excavation has run smoothly for years.*
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> *Until now. Typically, the excavation uncovered belongings (often discussed as "artifacts") that fascinated archaeologists and local history buffs, but bored tourists. This season though, the team recovered an almost completely intact set of Catholic prayer beads. Called a rosary and used for both personal and group religious practice, this artifact was strung with beads made using an Indigenous style! The discovery of the piece, at a site that also included evidence for captive African and Indigenous labor, provided an intriguing example of creolization for the region. However, before a specialist could be called in to examine the rosary and its beads in more detail, a local TV and radio show host, who happened to be at the site during the discovery, broke the news to the whole county. Tourism doubled overnight and now, to everyone's dismay, that find has disappeared! How could this happen? Did a tourist think the storage facility was a gift shop? Was it sequestered away for extra safe keeping? Did someone simply make a data entry error? Or did* You *wander away with it? An Archaeological Investigator, Ellis Thyx, has been sent to facilitate solving the mystery.*

Your host may play this character or represent them through digital recordings, with the host as their assistant. As a reminder, the town, archaeological site, mystery, and the title of "archaeological investigator" though based on places in Gulf Coast Florida, similar archaeological sites, and a kind of crime that does happen, are entirely fictitious. However, Santa Teresa Sánchez de Cepeda Dávila y Ahumada, whom the fictitious mission is named, is a real Saint. Learn more about her **here**.

Role-playing tips

The Archaeological Investigator narrowed down the concerned culprits down to the people in attendance. This means that while you've seen people acting suspicious, if they're not there, they definitely didn't do it. That means you'll need to listen to the other players closely to search out the suspect or use what you've observed to distract your colleagues.

If you lack experience with role-play, stick to the included scripts. You'll get a chance to improvise in a low stakes way during Round Two and if you feel comfortable, feel free to add more improvisation as the game goes on. If you are experienced with role-play use your script and background materials as ways to ground your improvised dialogue. Regardless, remember to read from, or incorporate, your “innocent” or “guilty” script depending on whether you are the culprit during your playthrough. You may choose not to answer a question, but must tell the truth.

The Rounds

The game will be played in a series of rounds. The following summarizes how to play each round. If you're confused, ask your host to re-explain the rules before beginning or request a pause to the game before proceeding.

Round	**Explanation**
Zero	This is an out-of-character, pre-game discussion where players and host establish boundaries for play such as level of comfort with improvisation and a way to pause the game for any reason.
One - *Incised Introductions*	This is a scripted round where you'll read or improvise around your character's introduction and begin using your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities.*
Two - *Digging up the Dirt*	This is an improvised round where you will talk with other characters to dig up more dirt on the other suspects, adding to your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities*. The host will end this round by drawing the number of one character to embroil them as the enigmatic embezzler. If your number is drawn, read or improvise around your guilty scripts. If not, follow your innocent scripts.
Three - *Sieving through the Secrets*	This is a scripted questioning round where you learn more about each character's movements or motives by improvising around or reading your scripted question or answer. Once everyone has been asked and answered a question, the group will vote to do another round of questioning. If the group decides to do another round, see the note for the expansion, otherwise skip to *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!* *Expansion - Refining the Results* This round is the same as the third round but when it concludes you'll proceed directly to the next round.
Round four - *Accusing the Archaeological absconder!*	This is the accusation round. Review your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities,* decide individual verdicts, and then list who you think did it in your *Artifact Absconder Accusation Log*. Use this to fill out a standard scripted accusation, or improvise around it. Then each player will read their accusation. You can keep track of these in your catalog.
Round five - *Innocently in situ or Guilty as grindstone*	This is the scripted confessions round, which aims to unmask the mysterious material culture mover. When your number comes up, read, or improvise around, your innocent or guilty script as appropriate.

William "Bill" Ding

Here is some background on your character, explaining who they are, what they know, and suggested materials you can read ahead of time, or after the game, to learn more about the stakeholder archetype you will, or have, portrayed. Following this character background are instructions for how much of the script you can read before playing.

Character notes and suggested background materials

Stakeholder archetype	Local developer, investor, large business and hotel owner.
Character description	You are a profit-for-purpose developer, investor, and hotel owner and believe that everyone should earn a living wage. You own multiple businesses but, in contrast to Sellsalotta, you own bigger businesses and develop properties. You're often looking to develop land in and around Beadbeachville to help improve your hometown. You own two local boutique hotels that border the mission site and thought that the location of the mission site would be a good spot for a third but understand that archaeology is important too.
Your relationship to the site	is through a desire to see if removing important discoveries might mean that you could get the area around the site re-zoned to benefit your company in some way.
You're hiding the fact that...	you are financially invested in the site's excavations finishing because you're recovering from climate change-related damage to your properties. You went to confession to discuss your predicament.
Someone observed you...	having regular conversations with Thurston about the site at *Mission: Meals*.
You noticed someone else...	had moored their boat really close to the site, which requires a permit, when they could have docked at one of your low-fee marinas.
You witnessed...	Thurston's admit that they'd wanted a "souvenir" of their first excavation and they've even drawn you illustrations of the various artifacts on napkins to show what they'd cataloged recently.
Suggested character reference materials	"Laying the Foundations of Discovery: What is Developer-led Archaeology?" by Bruce Mann - **https://www.digitscotland.com/laying-the-foundations-of-discovery-what-is-developer-led-archaeology/** "Why Would I Need an Archaeologist in Land Development?" by Glen H. Perez - **https://www.landdevelopmentrealities.com/home/2020/8/3/v09ipvf9g9osk15z75xgdv5wskbiit-fktfy-jb8nf-dbfhh-c2xey-67bef-jyhwg-zbf58-wfhhj-wgcd7-aslck-cb3pr-hrdlc-bhkr6-cpxt5-38fs5-eggct** "How Archeologists Keep Builders Building" by Stacey Freed - **https://blog.bluebeam.com/archeologists-construction/** "Seattle CEO who pays workers at least $70K US says it's paying off in spades" transcript written by Sheena Goodyear. Interview with Dan Price produced by Tayo Bero - **https://www.cbc.ca/radio/asithappens/as-it-happens-monday-edition/seattle-ceo-who-pays-workers-at-least-70k-us-says-it-s-paying-off-in-spades**

You can read the next two pages before playing. The first is your ***Catalog of Culprit Capabilities***, where you will record what you know about the other characters. You'll want to return to this page to note new observations made during the game to help decide who committed the rosary robbery and track accusations.

The page after that is ***Round One - Incised Introductions***. You may read through your scripted introduction and the reminder of your personal secret. The scripts are an example of how your character might talk. You can read the script exactly or improvise around it as you feel comfortable. At the bottom of that page are directions that tell you to stop reading. Please follow these directions to maintain in-game suspense.

Lastly, your host should have given you a number with your character assignment or you will pick one at the start of play. Keep that handy for the end of *Round Two - Digging up the Dirt*, so you know whether you're guilty or innocent during the game.

Catalog of Culprit Capabilities

Suspect	Motive	Your Evidence	Verdict	Times Accused By

Incised Introductions

During this round, you will introduce yourself to your fellow stakeholders by reading the following script or using it as a guide for an improvised introduction. You may embody the character however you wish, but don't add any more information or details beyond the introduction right now. Let the others get to know you over the next few rounds.

> *William Ding, I'm a local developer and investor here in Beadbeachville and own the lands adjacent to the* Santa Teresa Mission*. The last few years' hurricanes have made operating my boutique hotels harder but I believe in the economic development and sustainability of Beadbeachville so I want to keep my money in the town. Some of you may also know me as just Bill and yes, I know it's funny. I'm in construction with my name, but I see it as my guiding light.*

The following is a narrative version of your motivations, suspicions, and secrets as they relate to the site. You'll want to draw from this and your character notes during subsequent rounds but don't add any of this to your introduction. Also, keep some of this as secret as you can so you don't incriminate yourself as the rosary robber! But beware, you may not be the only one who knows about them. No one's as subtle as they think they are.

> *You own the two boutique hotels that bookend the* Santa Teresa Mission*, but recent hurricanes caused significant damage to both of them. You're recovering, but climate change is really harming your ability to build up reserves for those hard times. You've considered how having the archaeological site is a boon to bring in more tourists, but you also think the land would make for another great hotel. If this dig season could be the last one that might mean the land could get rezoned. However, the rosary killed that dream and in its place you've found yourself fantasizing about the rosary going missing. However, you feel conflicted about that possibility, so went to confession to discuss your intrusive thoughts of removing the rosary from the site. You feel so conflicted because your hotels (including this hypothetical third one) are good for you personally, you won't deny that, but they also create good paying jobs and year-round employment for the residents of Beadbeachville, which the excavation does not. In addition, you've always been a profit-for-purpose entrepreneur, which means one of the reasons economic recovery is slow for your businesses is because you pay all your employees a living wage (based on the estimate for a single adult with no children in the area) of at least $17 an hour, which means there's less cushion for hard times. You're doing what you can though and it seems like guests enjoy watching the excavation from their rooms, so you've kept an eye on the work going on at the site and a positive frame of mind. While doing a spot check of one of the excavation-adjacent rooms, you noticed a strange boat moored close to the site. It looked vaguely familiar but you can't quite remember from where. So many people have boats, between tourists and locals, that keeping them all straight is a challenge. You're concerned that such a craft could slip away almost unnoticed if they were to remove something from the site. With these myriad concerns about and for the site, you started treating Thurston to food at* Mission: Meals *to get insider information. Thurston describes what they've been cataloging to you and occasionally draws you depictions of artifacts. The drawings look realistic to you, but sometimes you're not sure if Thurston is intentionally lying or not, because they use different words to describe things than you thought they would. Thurston's also been trying to decide what sort of "souvenir" they'd like to have of their time at the site, which you don't feel like you can judge considering what you confessed recently and between the boat, your thoughts, and Thurston, you're sure that your next confession will require a lot of penitent Hail Marys to absolve you.*

Pause here until everyone has introduced themselves. The host as the character Ellis Thyx, just E for short, the Archaeological Investigator—or by playing the recording of E—will prompt you to proceed to the next page and round of the game.

Digging up the Dirt

This round your goal is to see what your fellow ethically-ambiguous allies know about the disappearance of the rosary and if they know anything about you. Be as subtle as you can because, as you inquire, these other observations could help you decide whose behavior was the most suspicious. As a reminder, here are some things that you've seen going on around Beadbeachville that you might want to ask the other stakeholders about.

You noticed someone else...	had moored their boat really close to the site, which requires a permit, when they could have docked at one of your low-fee marinas.
You witnessed...	Thurston's admit that they'd wanted a "souvenir" of their first excavation and they've even drawn you illustrations of the various artifacts on napkins to show what they'd cataloged recently.

Take some time during this round to put notes in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* so you can keep track of all the evidence you uncover.

Pause here when you've finished conversing. Once the host—either as E or as the character they're playing—concludes discussion, they will reveal whether you are the culprit.

If your number is selected, read from the "guilty" scripts provided or improvise around them. If your number is not selected, portray the character using the "innocent" scripts or improvise around that information. Remember, you cannot lie but you can be evasive.

The host—either as E or by playing the recording—will prompt you to begin the next round.

Sieving the secrets

Now that you've learned more about the other stakeholders—as well as what they know about the site and you—decide which character(s) you'd like to interrogate in front of everyone. During this round, you can only ask one person, one question and you can't pick the person who asked you a question or someone who has already been asked a question, so be clever and strategic!

Feel free to use the scripted questions below, which are based on the suspicious behaviors you witnessed. You may also create your own question based on the other observations you've made and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* from the preceding rounds. Remember, only the stakeholders present in the room could have done it.

> **Looking for someone suspicious:** *Can you identify the boat illegally moored by the site lately? My docks are walking distance from the site so I don't know why someone would choose to do something illegal instead.*
>
> **You know this person was doing something odd:** *Thurston, we've been having coffee pretty regularly these last few weeks, so, can you tell the kind people more about your drawings and why you decided to illustrate the rosary recently? And perhaps explain about how you were looking for a souvenir?*

When another character questions you, you cannot lie but you can be evasive. If they ask you their suggested question, the following is your answer to it. You may choose to read it verbatim or improvise around it.

> **If innocent:** *Why Sister, isn't that something a priest should ask? Well, as it happens I went to confession very recently. I had a lot weighing on me and felt the need to confess, privately. However, I've made my peace and that's between myself and God now.*
>
> **If guilty:** *I don't think it's your, or anyone else's, business when the last time that I went to confession was. It bothers me that you would consider asking about such a personal thing in front of other people. Confession is about forgiveness and an honest dialogue between yourself and the Lord.*

If another character asks you a question where the suggested response does not make sense, answer it as truthfully as you can based on what you know or suspect. It's a great chance to share something you'd like others to know about or to deflect attention to someone else.

Pause here until all players have asked and answered a question. As you listen to the other stakeholders, add details to your catalog. Once the questioning round concludes, the host will give you the option of continuing the questioning or proceeding to accusations, so pay attention and decide what you'd like to do.

Refining the results

The group will vote on whether they'd like to do another round of questioning or if they'd like to move on to accusations. Use what you've learned and recorded in your *Catalog of Culprit Capabilities* to guide your choice and vote accordingly.

If the group decides to do another round of questions, refer to the preceding scripts for suggested responses and questions for this *optional* round of questioning. You may need to improvise, as a lot of information has already been shared.

Otherwise, the group will proceed to the next round.

Once you complete the additional round or if the group decides to proceed without a second round of questioning, review your catalog in preparation for the accusation round. The host will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Accusing the Archaeological absconder!

Now that you've got as many observations out of other players as you can, it's time to decide who to accuse. Use what you learned and recorded in your catalog to guide your choice and fill out the following:

The Artifact Absconder Accusation Log

Suspect	Motive

You can then use the following template for your accusation.

I accuse...

of removing the recently discovered rosary from the *Santa Teresa Mission* because...

Keep your explanation brief as you will need to share it with everyone and they will all need to share theirs as well.

Once you've written your accusation, wait until E prompts you to share it with the group.

Now, it's your chance to reveal who you think rehoused the rosary! E will tell the group how to begin the accusation section. When it's your turn, read your accusation and its subsequent explanation.

Your host will take note of who gets the most accusations and tally those up for the final reveal! You can also keep track of who accused who, or how many accusations were made against each player in your catalog.

Pause again until all players have read their accusations. Then, the host as E - or by playing the recordings - will prompt you to proceed to the next round.

Innocently *in situ* or Guilty as grindstone

Once everyone has stated who they think did think wandered away with the artifact it's time for the reveal. E will say their peace and then the host will begin having people perform their speeches. This round uses your assigned numbers and will begin either with the number right after—or right before—the number drawn after *Digging the Dirt*, which indicated the guilty party.

Speeches will then proceed in the sequence, leaving the selected stealer for last. When it's your turn please read, or improvise around, the provided speech depending on whether you were or not the guilty party.

> **If innocent:** *I confess, it would be wonderful to build another hotel where the site is, but after much reflection, I prefer to find other ways to help the community benefit from the site. So I've decided to focus on how I can provide visitors a good view of the ongoing work rather than altering the land itself.*
>
> **If guilty:** *It's wrong in the eyes of the law and I hope God forgives me but I removed the rosary from the archaeological site. I didn't really think that removing it would have helped me get the rights to develop the land, considering everyone already knew about the rosary, but I thought removing it would distract the public and local officials so I could figure out a different way to recoup my losses from the last hurricane season.*

Once the robber is revealed, anyone who accurately accused them wins the game. If they were only subtly suspicious, and no one accused them, the artifact absconder wins the game. E will have a few concluding words but there's nothing more for you to do now!

After the game

Once the recording, or the host as E, reads their concluding remarks, the game ends. By reaching Round Five, you will have developed your data literacy skills by reading, working with, analyzing, arguing, and communicating with the data provided through the game to discover the artifact absconder.Now that you've played *A Glorious Mystery*, take a chance to reflect how the game flexed your data literacy dexterity and consider how you might apply those skills again in the future.

If you desire (or require) some structure for your reflection, consider responding to the questions posed in **Part Two: The discussion guide** to aid your reflection of the game. Or explore the suggested materials from the beginning of the script using ***Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R*** or ***Of Mycenaean Men: Part Five*** to develop your data literacy dexterity or explore **museum collections**, **public libraries**, or even **keyword** or **project** search Open Context to learn more. With that we hope you enjoy playing *A Glorious Mystery: Rosaries and Robbery*!

References and further reading

The following is a list of hyperlinked references from this player's guide. These are presented in order of appearance and do not repeat the full references for the character included under suggested materials. If any URLs in this Digital Data Story navigate to a broken page please check the **Wayback Machine** for an archived copy of the material.

Check out other Digital Data Stories here: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M74F1NW0**

Find out about the work of the Alexandria Archive Institute at: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/**

Check out Open Context for yourself here: **https://opencontext.org**

Explore Part One - The host guide at: https://doi.org/10.6078/M7GH9G20

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Cow-culating Your Data with Spreadsheets and R by Paulina F. Przystupa and L. Meghan Dennis (2022): **https://doi.org/10.6078/M73N21HR**

Learn how to use a spreadsheet with *Of Myceanean Men - Part Five*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7Q81B6V**

Conduct a keyword search of Open Context using *Of Mycenaean Men - Part Four*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7TX3CHJ**

Try a project search of Open Context using *It's All in the Wrist (Bones) - Part Two*: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7ZP4478**

Peruse some museum collections with the help of this article: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7S46Q2R**

Get at taste for some public library collections here: **https://alexandriaarchive.org/2025/07/10/how-to-use-the-digital-collections-of-the-nypl/**

Learn more about the saint whose name we use for our fictitious mission–Teresa of Avila–on her Wikipedia page: **https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Teresa_of_%C3%81vila**

"TTRPG Safety Toolkit: A Quick Reference Guide" by Kienna Shaw (2023) **https://web.archive.org/web/20231127094204/https://i.4pcdn.org/tg/1583202183294.pdf**

Explore Part Two at: **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7B56GVG**

"Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data" by Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle (2018) **https://doi.org/10.6078/M7H70CX3**

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Acknowledgements

This Digital Data Story is a collaboration between its authors, our testing audiences, and the staff of AAI/OC. We are grateful to those who participated in our alpha playthrough of the game at the First Conference on Public Archaeology hosted by the Florida Public Archaeology Network Conference. These wonderful folks helped us test a prototype of this Digital Data Story and have been waiting for its release since then. We thank you for your patience as we reworked the game. We are also indebted to Katie Brewer for her help bringing gulf coast Florida to life in this approximation of the region. We also appreciate the work of the primary investigators of the *Baptizing Spring Zooarchaeological Data* project, Kitty F Emery, L. Jill Loucks, Jerald Milanich, Charles Fairbanks, Cynthia Heath, Arlene Fradkin, Michelle LeFebvre, and Laura Brenskelle who provide an excellent resource for comparing and learning about Spanish Missions in Florida.

The Data Stories are part of the overarching Data Literacy Program, with support from a National Endowment for the Humanities Challenge Award and a grant from the Mellon Foundation (2021-2025). Any views, findings, conclusions, or recommendations expressed in this work do not necessarily represent those of the National Endowment for the Humanities or the Mellon Foundation.